GREEN
CLIMATE
FUND

Meeting of the Board
15 – 18 July 2024
Songdo, Incheon, Republic of Korea
Provisional agenda item 10

GCF/B.39/02/Add.08

24 June 2024

Consideration of funding proposals – Addendum VIII

Funding proposal package for FP233

Summary

This addendum contains the following seven parts:

a) A funding proposal titled "Community-based Agriculture Support Programme 'plus' (CASP+)";
b) No-objection letter issued by the national designated authority(ies) or focal point(s);
c) Environmental and social report(s) disclosure;
d) Secretariat's assessment;
e) Independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment;
f) Response from the accredited entity to the independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment; and
g) Gender documentation.

Table of Contents

Funding Proposal

Project/Programme title:	Community-based Agriculture Support Programme 'plus' (CASP+)
Country(ies):	Tajikistan
Accredited Entity:	International Fund for Agriculture Programme (IFAD)
Date of first submission:	[2021/12/08]
Date of current submission	[2024/04/30]
Version number	[V.6.0]

Contents

Note to Accredited Entities on the use of the funding proposal template

- Accredited Entities should provide summary information in the proposal with cross-reference to annexes such as feasibility studies, gender action plan, term sheet, etc.
- Accredited Entities should ensure that annexes provided are consistent with the details provided in the funding proposal. Updates to the funding proposal and/or annexes must be reflected in all relevant documents.
- The total number of pages for the funding proposal (excluding annexes) **should not exceed 60**. Proposals exceeding the prescribed length will not be assessed within the usual service standard time.
- The recommended font is Arial, size 11.
- Under the GCF Information Disclosure Policy, project and programme funding proposals will be disclosed on the GCF website, simultaneous with the submission to the Board, subject to the redaction of any information that may not be disclosed pursuant to the IDP. Accredited Entities are asked to fill out information on disclosure in section G.4.

Please submit the completed proposal to:

fundingproposal@gcfund.org

Please use the following name convention for the file name:

"FP-[Accredited Entity Short Name]-[Country/Region]-[YYYY/MM/DD]"

A

A. PROJECT/PROGRAMME SUMMARY

A.1. Project or programme	Project	**A.2. Public or private sector**	Public
A.3. Request for Proposals (RFP)	Not applicable		

A.4. Result area(s)

	GCF contribution	Co-financers' contribution[1]
Mitigation total	**55 %**	**32 %**
☐ Energy generation and access	0 %	0 %
☐ Low-emission transport	0 %	0 %
☐ Buildings, cities, industries and appliances	0 %	0 %
☒ Forestry and land use	55%	32 %
Adaptation total	**45 %**	**68 %**
☒ Most vulnerable people and communities	25%	35 %
☒ Health and well-being, and food and water security	2%	2 %
☒ Infrastructure and built environment	10%	1 %
☒ Ecosystems and ecosystem services	8%	30 %

A.5. Expected mitigation outcome *(Core indicator 1: GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed / sequestered)*	***6,854,822 tonnes of CO2e*** *(27 years, 7 years project execution and 20 years capitalization)*[2]	**A.6. Expected adaptation outcome** *(Core indicator 2: direct and indirect beneficiaries reached)*	*650,000 individuals (51,5% women), or 100,000 households (20% female headed)*	
			Direct beneficiaries: 650,000	*Indirect beneficiaries: 2,268,426*
			7% of total population (31% of Target area population)	*24% of the total population*

A.7. Total financing (GCF + co-finance[3])	79,690,370 USD	**A.9. Project size**	Medium (Upto USD 250 million)
A.8. Total GCF funding requested	39,000,000 USD		

A.10. Financial instrument(s) requested for the GCF funding

☒ Grant	30.000.000	☐ Equity	Enter number
☒ Loan	9.000.000	☐ Results-based payment	Enter number
☐ Guarantee	Enter number		

A.11. Implementation period	*7 years*	**A.12. Total lifespan**	*20 years*
A.13. Expected date of AE internal approval	Click or tap to enter a date.	**A.14. ESS category**	B
A.15. Has this FP been submitted as a CN before?	Yes ☒ No ☐	**A.16. Has Readiness or PPF support been used to prepare this FP?**	Yes ☐ No ☒
A.17. Is this FP included in the entity work programme?	Yes ☒ No ☐	**A.18. Is this FP included in the country programme?**	Yes ☒ No ☐
A.19. Complementarity and coherence	Yes ☒ No ☐		

A.20. Executing Entity information	i. Republic of Tajikistan, acting through (a) Ministry of Finance and (b) Ministry of Agriculture (via the State Enterprise Project Management Unit Livestock and Pasture Development (PMU)) ii. Committee on Environmental Protection (through the Center for Implementation of Investment Projects) iii. Food and Agriculture Organization of the UN (FAO)

A.21. Executive summary (max. 750 words, approximately 1.5 pages)

Climate change problem

(i) Tajikistan is one of the most vulnerable countries in Central Asia to climate risks.[4] Temperatures are increasing across the country and there is a clear shift in precipitation patterns. These changes pose a threat to the agricultural cropping calendar as well as to the productivity of pastures. Crop productivity is also negatively impacted by the higher temperatures that increase evapotranspiration and have an overall negative impact on plant growth. Specialised tools developed to predict the impact of climate change on agriculture production, such as the Climate Adaptation in Rural Development (CARD)[5] predicts that climate change will affect both irrigated and rain-fed production systems - and under the pessimistic risk setting all crop yields are projected to decrease moderately in the next five years up to 2025 and more severely by 2050. Rice production will be most affected, after wheat and sunflower.[6] Climate change is also expected to impact production of fodder and the carrying capacity of pastures and animal morbidity and mortality which can, paradoxically, lead to overstocking as a risk mitigation measure by smallholder farmers trying to sustain their vulnerable livelihoods. Climate change can also affect availability of water for livestock, as well as animal health, welfare and productivity through emergence of new diseases, and increased temperature on animal physiology. The country is also prone to frequent natural disasters including floods, mudflows, landslides and droughts. Climate projections predict a worsening of the trends and events, with significant impacts on ecosystems, livelihoods and the economy. The country's geographic characteristics as well as its high levels of poverty and dependence on the agriculture sector present significant challenges for future adaptation. The climate change vulnerability analyses suggest higher adaptation needs in rural mountainous area.

Proposed interventions

(ii) ***The proposed interventions build on the successful experiences of four IFAD-funded projects over the last 15 years*** in vulnerable mountainous areas of Tajikistan, specifically, on the Livestock and Pasture Development Projects (phase I and II) while adding the missing focus on climate resilience and reinforcing the demonstrated mechanisms leading to carbon sequestration[7] through rangeland rehabilitation, improved livestock management and livelihoods diversification (relevant projects referred to in **Section B.3** and results and impact reported in **Annex 18**, building on lessons learned summarized in **Annex 29** and **Annex 30** explaining the evolution of IFAD country programme and how the latter has evolved into the CASP+ with a full fledged climate focus). ***At the national level*** the proposed investments will build the communities and country's capacity to plan for climate risks and modify its policy and regulatory framework to incentivise production practices that are more resilient to climate change and improve the governance of natural resources. ***At the district, village and community level****, the project investments are designed to incorporate climate diagnostics in the local level planning frameworks.* This will help to identify investments that can make the communities, their livelihoods and their ecosystems (rangelands, forests) more climate resilient through investments in water and irrigation infrastructure, technologies and farm equipment which helps to increase agriculture productivity and protect smallholders from climate change. ***At the market level, the proposed investments will strengthen the links with the private sector*** by supporting market-driven diversification of livelihoods as element of resilience and by building productive alliances in selected value chains which are most vulnerable to climate risks such as livestock, dairy, meat, horticulture to increase productivity, reduce loss and wastage due to weather conditions and reverting the ecosystem degradation. The project has a seven year duration, with GCF financing and multiple co-financiers, as one coordinated climate investment. CASP+ will be executed by three executing entities according to respective comparative advantages and areas of expertise: (i). Republic of Tajikistan, acting through (a) Ministry of Finance and (b) Ministry of Agriculture (via the State Enterprise Project Management Unit Livestock and Pasture Development (PMU)); (ii). Committee on Environmental Protection (through the Center for Implementation of Investment Projects); and (iii). Food and Agriculture Organization of the UN (FAO)

Climate results/benefits

(iii) It is expected that the proposed activities can catalyze impact beyond a one-off project investment and lead to a paradigm shift in key areas. The project is designed to ***transform Government of Tajikistan's approach*** through ***explicit consideration of climate change risks, vulnerabilities and adaptation measures in national policies and programmes*** and in ***development planning at the district and village levels*** to assist households diversify their livelihoods. At the local level, the project will develop mechanisms to support locally-led adaptation by ***building capacities of local*** agencies ***to assess climate risks and identify and implement locally-appropriate solutions*** that can build a long-term legacy of local capacity for climate change adaptation. At the household level, the project will instill a paradigm shift in agriculture production practices in the crop and livestock sectors by enhanced awareness and access to climate responsive inputs and services. ***A key paradigm shift that will be facilitated will be reduced reliance on low productivity animals through appropriate pasture and herd management practices, refinements in relevant regulatory framework and breeding strategy and enhanced capacity of households to reduce post-production losses through timely access to markets by working in close collaboration with the private sector.***

(iv) The project is expected to have an impact on both adaptation and mitigation. Specifically, the project will contribute to the sequestration of an estimated ***6,854,822 tonnes of CO2 equivalent***[8] through management of degraded forests and pastures, improved agricultural practices, and improved livestock and herd management leading to reduction of emission intensities (**Annex 23** EX-ACT and GLEAM-I Carbon Accounting). The project is expected to reach out ***650,000 direct individual beneficiaries*** or about 100,000 rural households and ***2,268,426 indirect individual beneficiaries across the country****, 51.5% women* (**Annex 24**: Beneficiary Estimates) in 21 of the most climate vulnerable districts (**Annex 2.1, Annex 30**). The economic analysis of the project indicates an Economic Internal Rate of Return of 23.08% and a Net Present Value of USD 178.3 million with significant co-benefits from economic, social and environmental factors (**Annex 3**: Economic and Financial Analysis).

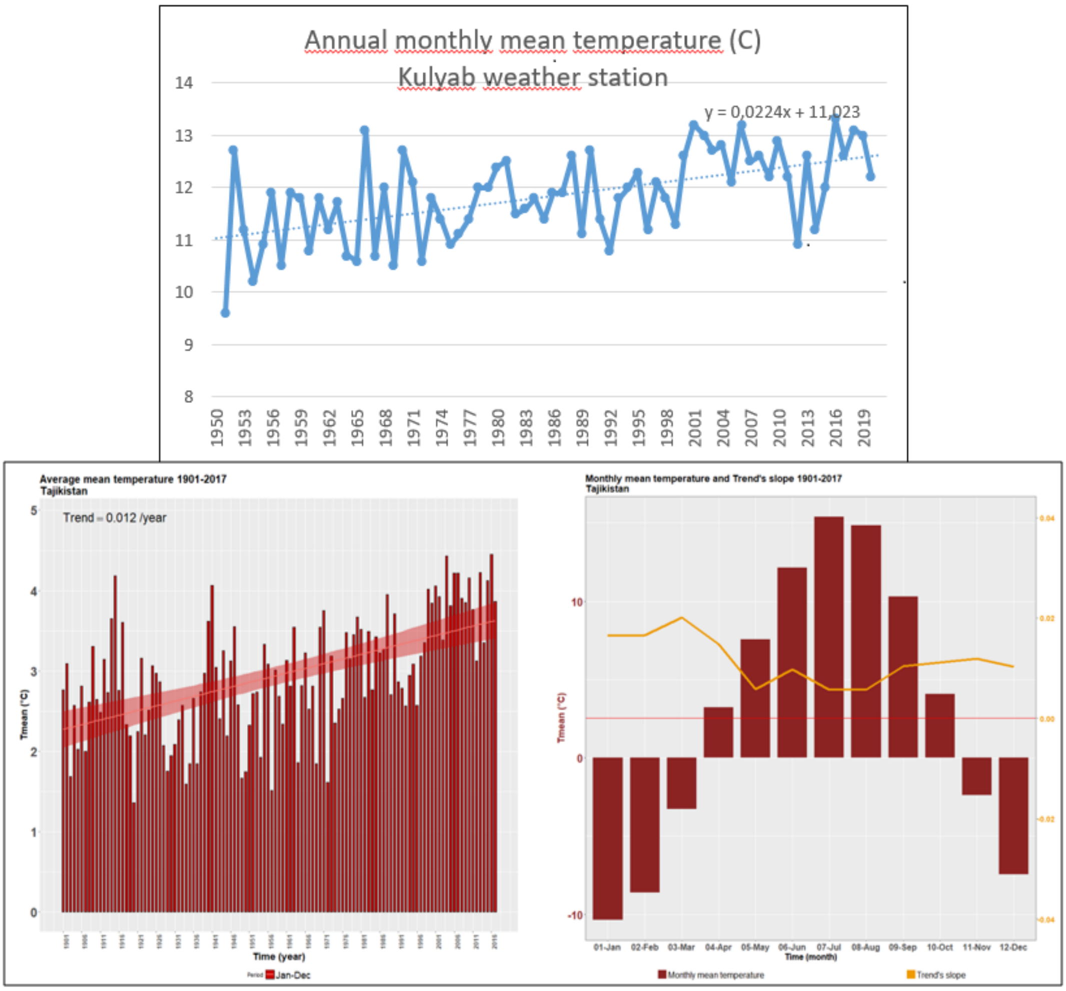
(v) The project is aligned with national and international climate change commitments of Tajikistan, in particular the National Determined Contributions (NDC, 2021)[9] that identify agriculture and forestry among the vehicles to ensure a progressive reduction of climate change vulnerability as well as to enhance the carbon sequestration potential of the country, and soil protection, grazing management, and tree plantation as needed investments for adaptation and disaster risk reduction. References to measures relevant to the project are also found in the National Development Strategy, that integrates climate change needs, disaster risk reduction, and social inclusiveness, specifically focusing on gender-based development.

B. PROJECT/PROGRAMME INFORMATION

B.1. Climate context (max. 1000 words, approximately 2 pages)

1. **Climate profile**: Tajikistan has been described as one of the most vulnerable countries to climate change in the Central Asian region. In 2021, it ranks in this regard on 98th position on the ND-Gain ranking whose indicators highlight among others a low capacity to acquire and deploy climate smart agriculture technology.[10] Its vulnerability is exacerbated due to the country's terrain, as 93% of its territory is considered mountainous and roughly half of all settlements in the country are located above 3000 meters.[11] The country's climate strongly exhibits aridity, high temperatures and significant inter-annual variability in almost all the climatic variables (**Annex 2** and **Annex 6**). The local weather station data analyzed shows that temperatures are rising across the country, with a sharper increase in the period 1970-2017 (*Figure 1*).[12,13]

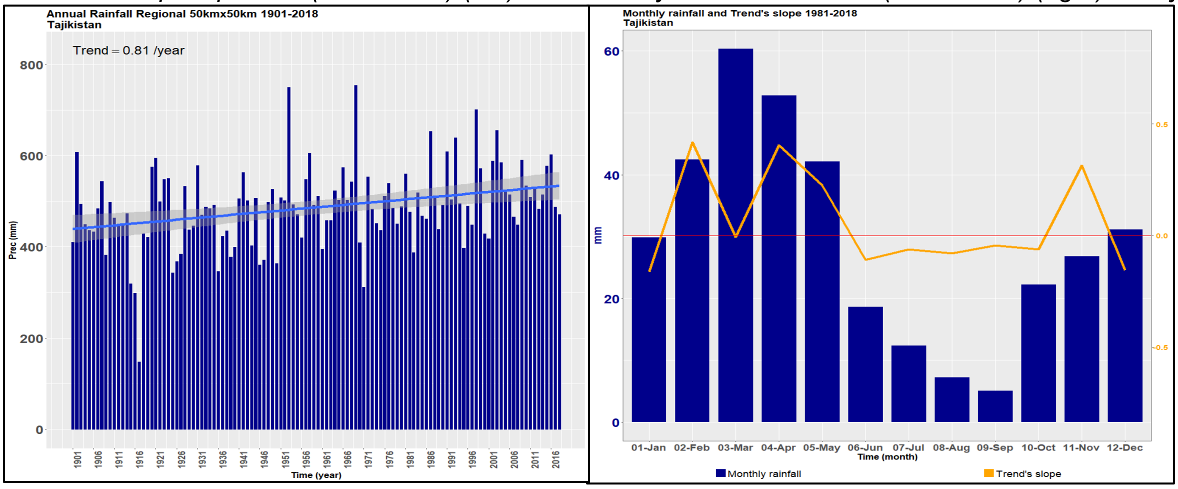
Figure 1: Average mean temperature in Kulyab and in Tajikistan for the period 1901-2019.[14]



2. The trend is higher during winter months, as registered by the local weather station in Fedchenko glacier,[15] with detected impacts on glacier and snow cover. A significant decrease in the snow extent in more than 50% of Tajikistan was observed for the period 2000-2020.[16]

3. At the national level, annual precipitation (rain, sleet, and snow) rose by 15-20% through the 1901-2018 period. The increase in precipitation is concentrated in the February-May season mostly in Western Tajikistan, with positive trend of snow occurrence in high mountains and negative in the plains,[17] while the June-October season is experiencing a significant decrease of 4 mm/decade at the national level (**Figure 2**).[18]

Figure 2: Annual precipitation (1901-2018) (left) and Monthly rainfall and trend (1981-2018) (right) in Tajikistan.[19]



4. There is a clear shift in the precipitation pattern, which has a major impact on water availability between the end of the wet season in May and the beginning of it in November-December, which, in turn, contribute to increasing the vulnerability of the ecosystems (i.e. heavy rainfall events, extreme temperatures, droughts) and, therefore, of the population. These changes pose a threat to the agricultural cropping calendar as well as to the pasture productivity within the year, changing availability of pastures and increasing seasonal forage deficits. In 2010, 11% of the total population was living on degraded land.[20] The negative trend is more evident in grassland compared to cropland.[21] The main differences between the two can be attributed to the fact that parts of crops are irrigated and can better withstand changes in precipitation. The grassland suffers greatly from climate change and extreme events (see below and **Annex 2.1, p. 12**), exacerbated by poor management practices and limited capacity to adapt to climate risks. Mountainous regions are especially vulnerable to climate change, and thus require greater efforts to encourage optimal land and water management practices.[22,23] A World Bank estimate puts losses dues to forest degradation in Tajikistan as annually exceeding $39 million (or 0.6% of GDP).[24] Systematic reforestation, improved pasture management and increased fodder conservation will be a considerable contribution to the reduction of adverse impacts of climate change.[25]

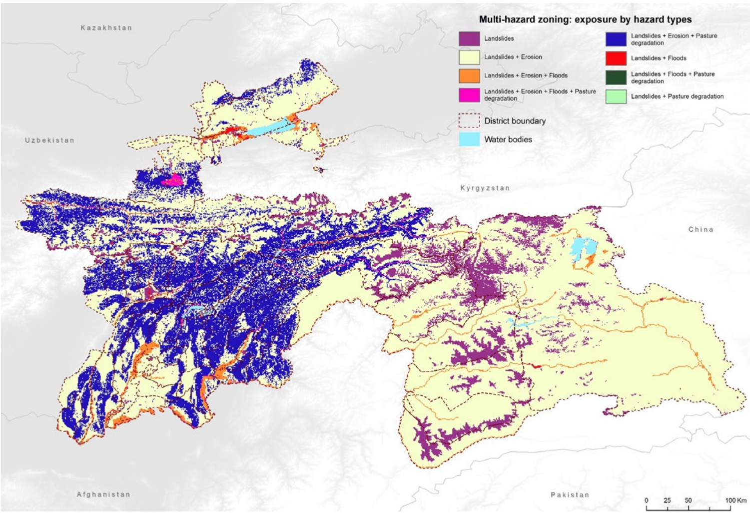
5. Climate projections predict a worsening of the trends and events, with significant impacts on ecosystems, livelihoods and the economy.[26,27,28] Crops are already experiencing reduction due to climate change and extreme weather events. There is an increase of 30 percent in irrigation demand by crops (driven by higher temperatures that push up evaporation) combined with increased heat extremes that negatively affect crop productivity. The Climate Adaptation in Rural Development (CARD)[29] analysis concludes that climate change affects both production systems - with and without irrigation - and under the Pessimistic risk setting all crop yields are projected to decrease moderately in the next five years up to 2025 and more severely by 2050. Rice production will be most affected, after wheat and sunflower.[30] Furthermore, under the Moderate risk setting, most of the crops' yields are projected to decrease moderately (under full irrigation), decrease on the short term and then increase slightly on the long term (managed grass, no irrigation) or stay stable in some cases (no irrigation) or increase (Rice, no irrigation).

6. ***Climate hazards***. Climate-induced extreme weather events (such as floods, droughts, heatwaves, landslides and avalanches) are already present in the project area. Weather events are expected to increase in both frequency and intensity as a result of warming as indicated in **Figure 3** below.[31] Heavy rainfall events (>10mm/day) are becoming more intense at the end of summer, beginning of Fall in Ganjina, Aznob and Dushanbe,[32] when soils are drier and with less vegetation cover (i.e. more prone to landslides and mudflows). From 1992 to 2016, natural disasters affected 7 million people in Tajikistan (more than 80% of the population) and caused economic losses of US$1.8 billion.[33] Annual losses from climate change and climate-induced extreme weather events are currently estimated at $600 million, or 4.8% of GDP.[34] The mudflows and floods in 1998, 1999, 2005 and 2010 were the most devastating,[35] calling for strengthening

soil and forest protection measures as a high investment priority in Tajikistan's Third National Communication on Climate Change to the UNFCCC.

7. The 2000-01 drought damaged Tajikistan economy by an estimated 5% of its GDP, with cereal output down by 36 percent compared to the previous five years average. An estimated 172,000 hectares out of 200,000 hectares of rain-fed land suffered from drought,[36] affecting more than 3 million people (or half of the countries' population at that time) and high temperature events (2008 and 2013) affected more than 1 million people.[37] Over 1981-2019, droughts have affected large parts of the country, and negative impacts on grassland and croplands are visible through the Agricultural Stress Index System.[38] The Standardised Precipitation-Evapotranspiration Index (SPEI)[39] analysis at 18 months shows a significant worsening over the period 1980-2019 (Annex 2.1, page 8), attesting to a risk of depletion in water reserves in deep soil layers. As the instance and magnitude of these events increases, the impacts of such disasters are also expected to increase. Climate related impacts on freshwater systems have also been observed (**Annex 2.1**).

Figure 3*: Multi-hazard zoning in Tajikistan. Source: Climate Resilience Cluster of the EO4SD*

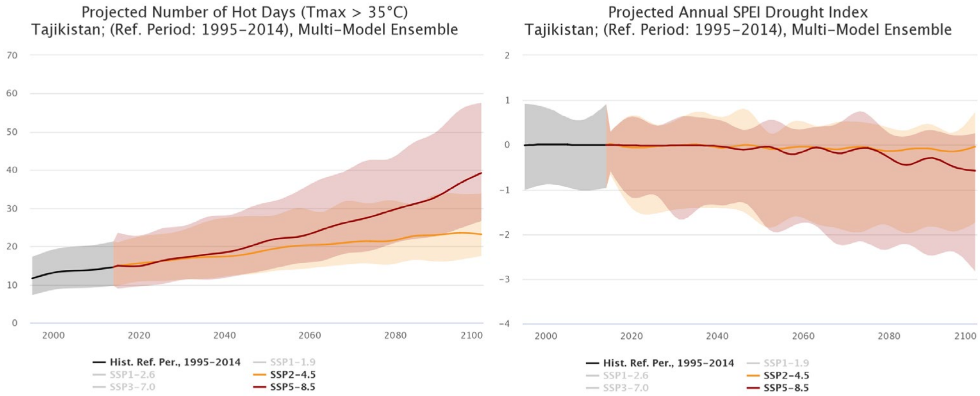


8. ***Emission trends***. Tajikistan is not a major emitter when assessed on emissions per capita. The latest Nationally Determined Contribution (2023) reports that after energy (60% of greenhouse gas emission), agriculture is a key source of greenhouse gas emissions (35% of greenhouse gases). The Fourth National Communication reports enteric fermentation, manure management and nitrogen application as main sources. Specifically, methane (CH4) emissions from agriculture comprehend the 91% of all emissions of this gas (related to enteric fermentation and manure management).[40] Similarly, emissions from Nitrous Oxide (N2O) from agriculture sector represent the 94.7% emissions of this gas. Based on FAOSTAT data estimates, emissions from the AFOLU sector have increased around 40% in the past ten years.[41] Within the agriculture sector, 57% of GHG emissions were estimated to be due to enteric fermentation from livestock[42], further significant emissions originate mainly from feed production and N deposited during grazing.[43] Despite being a low emitter, Tajikistan has an important potential to reduce its emissions through both traditional methods like improving feeding practices and improved digestibility of diets improved animal health and overall animal management; reducing land-use change arising from feed crop cultivation; the sequestration of carbon, through reforestation and improving pasture management (**Annex 23**).

9. ***Climate projections***. Projections by the Coupled Model Intercomparison Project, Phase 6 (CMIP6)[44] produced in view of the IPCC's Sixth Assessment Report (AR6) foresees that the mean annual temperatures will be warmer by approximately 1.0°C to 1.2°C by 2030 and 1.8°C to 2.4°C by 2050, while frost days (<0°C) are projected to decrease by 12 to 16 days by 2030 and by 20 to 28 days by 2050.[45] By 2050, the mean annual precipitation is projected to remain stable, but the number of consecutive dry days is expected to increase by 4 to 11 days, depending on the region and the scenario, contributing to the increasing risk of severe droughts.[46] The higher temperatures and melting glaciers[47] are already contributing to higher risk of severe droughts in several areas of the country.[48] Similarly, projected hot day (>35°C) would steadily

increase and projected mean drought index should decrease at national level under both RCP 4.5 and 8.5 scenario by 2050 as presented in Figure 4. By 2050, the intensity of the wettest precipitation events is expected to increase by 4.5 mm to 5.3 mm, increasing the risks of mudflows, landslides, and avalanches.

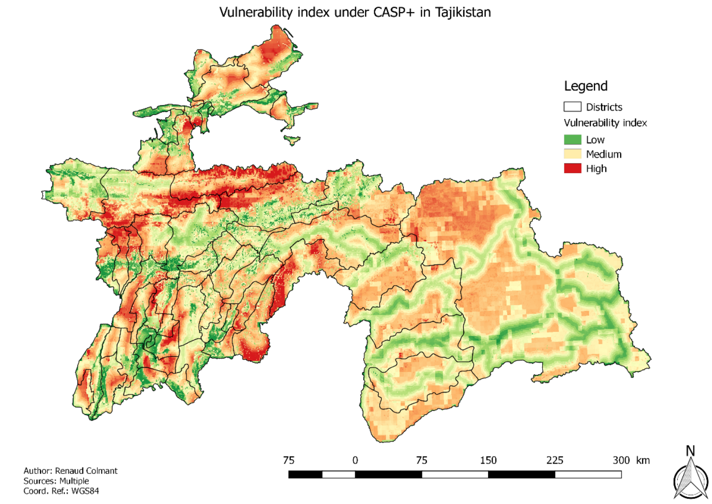
Figure 4. Projected hot day (Tmax>35C), and Mean SPEI drought Index until 2100 (Reference period 1995-2014).



Source: The World Bank Climate Change Knowledge Portal (reported in Annex 2.1)

10. **Climate vulnerability analysis**: A climate vulnerability index analysis[49] was carried out for the design of CASP+ (**Annex 2**, Chapter I.IV – summary of results in Figure 5).[50] The analysis shows higher vulnerability to climate in the Eastern and Centre Khatlon, Western DRS and in the South East of Sughd. On the climatic side, these areas are associated with more adverse climate change impacts, *on slow onset*: increasing temperatures – posing higher challenges for animal health and agricultural productivity; changing rainfall patterns – modifying the grazing seasons and forcing herders to alternative feeding and water sources; *as well as on the rapid onset*: higher risks of droughts, mudslides, landslides – further reducing the productivity of soils and calling for disaster management measures.

Figure 5: Climate Vulnerability analysis (Annex 2.1)



11. Indeed, Tajikistan is expected to have very strong hydrological changes and impacts given its snow based hydrological systems, and thus, would have serious implications for its future land use (see climate data from weather stations of glaciers and snow presence analysis (trend map + chart) presented in **Annex 2.1**). By 2050, the main crops' yield[51] could decrease by between 5% and 35%, and pastures on which livestock depend are also expected to see a reduction in quality and quantity due to pressures from high temperatures and increased evaporation rates.[52] Temperature increases are also likely to modify ecosystems and provide opportunities for pests and diseases to emerge and/or multiply, affecting a wide range of agricultural sectors.[53,54] In addition, Tajik agriculture is exposed to climate-sensitive diseases for livestock[55], (including new diseases that could emerge because of climate change and for which animals

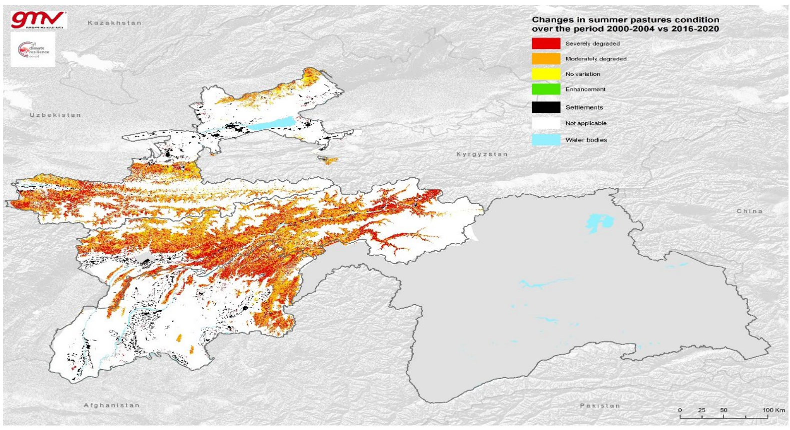
have no immunity), and crops[56] such as cotton budworm in cotton, potato leafroll virus (spread by aphids) and late blight in potato production and locust.[57,58]

12. From a socio-economic perspective, these areas present higher vulnerability of the population,[59] lower quality of life (access to water which will be worsen because of climate change and electricity) and income. Khatlon accounts for the highest percentage of extreme poverty at 21% and almost 2/3 of the poor are in the regions of Sughd (30.2%) and Khatlon (36.7%). These findings are in line and complement relevant WFP[60] and UNDP[61] assessments. The climate change vulnerability analyses suggest higher adaptation needs in rural mountainous area, with predominance of agroforestry and livestock related livelihoods (requiring optimization of land and water resources).[62,63]

13. Climate change has a direct impact on pasture areas as described in **Annex 2.1**. The degradation of pastures over time is evident in the country and is directly affected by climate change creating more stress for the plants (summary of results in **Figure 6**). The areas that have seen their condition severely degraded over time are the ones that are affected by more concentrated rainfall and longer dry periods - heavier daily rainfall events and cumulative 5 days rainfall events, less distributed over the year. Furthermore, the temperature in spring and summer is on average higher when compared with the less degraded pasture areas. As consequences, the drought events were more severe (the drought index SPEI was lower) in these severely degraded areas. Due to climate change, the plants are affected by higher maximum temperatures, heavier precipitation but fewer and more ad hoc rainfall events, which affect plant growth and health.

14. Forage production is also decreasing because of climate trends which are contributing to declining soil fertility[64] and decreasing area, variable patterns of water availability, and more frequent and severe drought episodes. Projections of managed grass yields for median and pessimistic risk settings under RCP8.5 show continuous decrease in time (CARD analysis).[65] Farmers have limited knowledge and technical support in production and conservation of fodder, which could be an appropriate adaptation measure to seasonal feed deficit. Climate Change will have far reaching consequences for dairy, meat and wool production mainly arising from its impact on grassland and fodder.[66] While natural pastures and hayfields play an important role in protecting soil from erosion and increasing its fertility, their productivity is dependent in turn on climate change and its spatial distribution during the vegetation period. For instance, rising temperature of 2-4°C in February and March can lead to 20% decrease in winter – spring pasture productivity, a decline that is greatly exacerbated during dry spells.

*Figure 6: Changes in summer pastures condition over the period 2000-2004 vs. 2016-2020. Source: Climate Resilience Cluster of the EO4SD (**Annex 16**)*



15. Reductions in agriculture and pasture productivity will adversely affect the overall nutritional status and health of the population, especially women, children, and elderly. Women and young girls are extremely vulnerable to the effects of climate change since they already have poor access to water and sanitation. Due to these factors and processes, coordinated action on climate change in Tajikistan is an urgent concern.[67] In Tajikistan, about 30% of the population is undernourished, half of the children under five suffer from iodine deficiency and a quarter from stunting (WFP, 2019). The country's food insecurity will increase

in the long run because of limited capacity to respond to climate-induced shocks, which would adversely affect agricultural production.[68] The poverty headcount ratio is 26.3% at national level (World Bank), reaching 36.1% in rural areas. Female Headed Households (FHH) are 9% of total HHs and represent 30% of the total poor households. Women face discrimination and inequality in social, economic and political life (UN Women).[69] The share of women working in the agriculture sector is higher (75% of all working women)[70]. Yet, gender imbalances in access to and control over productive resources, limited decision-making, and discrimination are also characteristic of agricultural work.

16. The COVID-19 pandemic has exacerbated the already highly vulnerable conditions, impacting severely on food production systems. A recent assessment[71] showed high declines in households' incomes for self-employed, migrant labourers and non-registered workers. Lack of savings and the presence of loans forced into further indebtedness, with high risks of perpetual indebtedness and poverty intensification. Three out of five micro-small and medium enterprises (MSMEs)[72] were negatively affected by the pandemic, with higher impact in rural areas where access to advisory services and markets is lower. Sales decreased by an estimated 85%, pushing MSMEs' into further indebtedness. Tajikistan is also affected by the economic impact of the war in Ukraine. The adverse effects of the pandemics, coupled by the impact of climate change are threatening food and nutrition security and economic recovery.

17. ***Geographic focus*** CASP+ has been designed to liaise with ongoing projects financed by other IFIs and development partners, and its geographic targeting ensures complementarity with ongoing projects (see also **Annex 21**, PIM, whereby Section 2.3.c specify that villages with previous/ongoing meaningful intervention providing the community with similar community investments are excluded from the targeting). CASP+ will build synergies with these projects in identifying the scope of the community action plans and assess how to capitalize on these initiatives in building resilience of local communities and infrastructure. Within the selected districts, CASP+ has adopted criteria to exclude villages that benefit from previous or ongoing interventions of a similar nature (**Annex 21**, ¶28)[73]. The participatory identification of the interventions with *Jamoat* Administration and local communities will also help to avoid gaps and duplications and ensure transparency and equity in selection of villages. Hence, there is expected to be no duplication in the investments at the village level or in the nature of the activities financed by World Bank, WFP, ADB, EBRD and other donor projects and CASP+. The Government and the EEs have a list of villages in the 21 districts and the selection is taking place as a preliminary IFAD-financed project activity. Available statistics for rural villages comprise demographic variables as well as socio-economic aspects needed to guarantee objective selection (the procedure and criteria are described in Annex 21 (Section 2.3, ¶28 and subsequent).

18. The geographic targeting was based on climate change vulnerability and the potential of the project to enhance climate resilience. The project area is situated in 21 districts, 16 in Khatlon region, 3 in RRS region and 2 in the Sughd region (**Figure 7**). The selection was based on the IFAD developed Vulnerability Index (**Annex 2.1**, Chapter I.IV), encompassing social, environmental and climatic and infrastructure parameters.[74] The average vulnerability index of the project area is higher than the national average (Figure 7). The area has suffered repeated long-term droughts[75] in recent years (excluding Farkhor and Danghara). The selected districts experienced heavy precipitation events, specifically in Sh.Sholin, Khovaling, Baljuvon, Gissor and Shakrinav in Khatlon. Most of the project districts are also situated in the area where the average maximum temperature is the highest in the country (except high mountain areas).

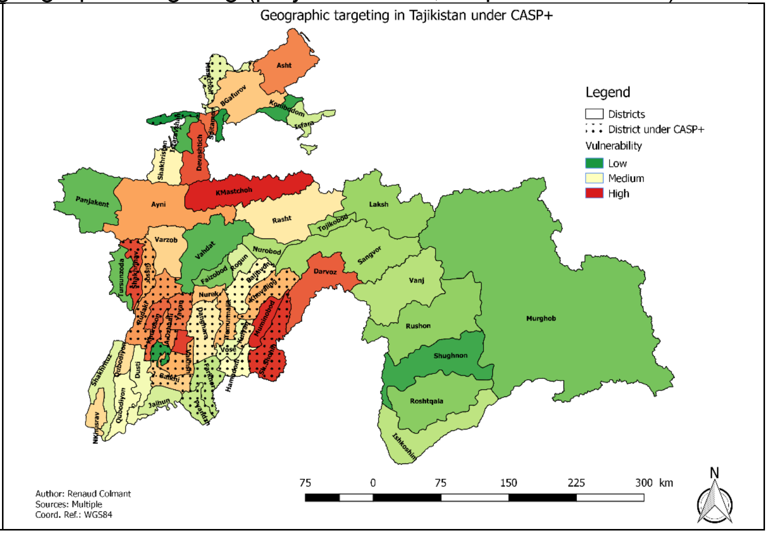
19. After selecting the districts, a water sub-catchments basins approach was used to identify the most vulnerable basins within each district. The vulnerability criteria was calculated at sub-catchment level (see targeting strategy criteria, **Annex 21**). The approach will allow to group the most vulnerable villages at water sub-catchment basin level to apply a landscape approach (each village will be assigned a vulnerability index depending on its localization).

19. ***Synergies with on-going climate finance***. TheCEP is leading a broad programme to support the enabling environment on climate change, comprising the GCF NAP among others. The interventions address climate change across a wide range of sectors including agriculture, water, energy, transport, etc. CASP+ specifically tackles the issues in the agriculture sector and natural resource management which are

key for a significant number of rural households complementing existing investment, including GCF-financed interventions (World Bank, ADB, EBRD, and WFP). Additional information in Section D.5 and **Annex 27**.

Figure 7. CASP+ geographic targeting (project districts, maps in **Annex 16**)

Region	District	Other projects
Khatlon	A. Jomi	
Khatlon	Baljuvon	*ELMARL*[76]
Khatlon	Bokhtar/ Kushoniyon	
Khatlon	Dangara	CAMP4ASB, LPDP II[76]
Khatlon	Farkhor	LPDP II[76], *ELMARL*[76]
Khatlon	Hamadoni	LPDP II[76], *ELMARL*[76]
Khatlon	J. Balkhi	
Khatlon	Khovaling	WFP GCF, *ELMARL*[76]
Khatlon	Khuroson	
Khatlon	Kulob	LPDP II[76], *ELMARL*[76]
Khatlon	Panj	
Khatlon	Sh. Shohin	
Khatlon	Temurmalik	*LPDP I*[76]
Khatlon	Vakhsh	
Khatlon	Vose	CAMP4ASB, LPDP II[76]
Khatlon	Yovon	
RRS	Gissor	
RRS	Rudaki	
RRS	Shakhrinav	
Sughd	Mastchoh	
Sughd	Zafarobod	



20. ***Synergies with community-based ecosystem restoration IFI-funded interventions***. Ongoing projects relevant to CASP+ scope include: **a/** the World Bank-financed Tajikistan Resilient Landscapes Restoration Project (RESILAND) which is designed to increase adoption of landscape restoration practices by rural communities and includes investment in Joint Forest Management;[77] **b/** the World Bank financed Climate Adaptation and Mitigation Program for the Aral Sea Basin (CAMP4ASB)[78] designed to scale up the project's successful regional initiatives and climate investments and to equip and ultimately enable countries in Central Asia to address climate challenges through better access to improved climate change knowledge services, investments, and capacity-building of key stakeholders; **c/** the World Bank is also supporting the Tajikistan Strengthening Water and Irrigation Management Project for enhanced climate resilience and improved rural livelihoods and food security in Tajikistan. The World Bank funds are expected to be used to benefit small-scale irrigation schemes in Upper Vakhsh Basin, prone to floods and mudflow; **d/** KfW provided support through the Climate Adaptation through Sustainable Forestry in Important River Catchment Areas in Tajikistan, CAFT (2015-2019) that supported piloting Joint Forestry Management and a second phase is under consideration; **e/** CASP+ will also build on the experience of GIZ in joint forestry management and has incorporated many of its lessons in the design. Overall coordination and synergies will be built through use of the Coordinating Council on the Green Climate Fund[79] and to the Development Coordination Council where relevant with other government and donor initiatives.

21. ***Additional synergies with and lessons from IFAD investment***. CASP+ builds on the successful experience of ongoing and past IFAD-financed and MoA-implemented projects in the country targeting vulnerable rural and mountainous communities[80]. These have been paving the road to define the approach of CASP+ which complements such successful investment with interventions to enhance climate resilience and carbon sequestration. Besides this, there is expected to be considerable scope of learning and sharing with other IFAD operations in the country and in similar fields. This includes **a.** synergies with the GEF programming; **b.** Innovations on integrating actions on remittances and migrants' entrepreneurship; and **c.** forward-looking synergies with IFAD's methane-emission reduction Eastern Africa climate finance operation. ***First***, on GEF: CASP+ will identify synergies with the new GEF 8 programme titled "Tajikistan Ecosystem Restoration and Resilient Agriculture" (TERRA) Project. IFAD management is currently coordinating between GEF and GCF to identify the steps for further development of the design and finalization. The synergies between CASP+ and the TERRA initiative will be capitalised upon. Discussions are ongoing to consider TERRA as a potential CASP+ co-financing or parallel financing. ***Second***, to boost additional socio-

economic opportunities for resilience building, IFAD will also liaise CASP+ with its EU-funded Action titled "Platform for Remittances, Investments and Migrants' Entrepreneurship in Central Asia" (PRIME). The project is designed to promote faster, safer and cheaper transfer of remittances, as well as leveraging these flows to advance digital financial inclusion and income-generating activities for sustainable development and well-being of migrant workers' families in Central Asia including in Tajikistan. ***Third***, there is a considerable scope of cross-learning and sharing between CASP+ and the ongoing IFAD design of the climate finance programme titled "Dairy Interventions for Adaptation and Mitigation" (DAIMA) which seeks to promote Low Carbon and Climate Resilient Livestock in East Africa. The project components and activities and the CASP+ are well aligned, with due differences depending on contexts, also benefitting of the assessment carried out for the design of CASP+. CASP+ and the DAIMA Project can explore opportunities for exchange of information and successful approaches, tools, methodologies, policy guidelines, etc. IFAD will facilitate exchange of experiences between these projects through exchange visits budget lines embedded in the national projects and in DAIMA, and through own resources, including the China-IFAD South-South and Triangular Cooperation (SSTC), as well as through documentation and sharing of knowledge and lessons.[81] The projects will capitalize on the collaboration between IFAD and FAO, and leverage technical assistance of the World Organization for Animal Health (OIE).[82]

B.2 (a). Theory of change narrative and diagram (max. 1500 words, approximately 3 pages plus diagram)

22. **The overall goal of the project is to contribute to the country's shift towards low emission sustainable development pathways and climate-adaptive agricultural production practices.** The *specific objective* is to increase public sector coordination and technical capacity for building climate resilience at the national level, enhance capacity at the district and village level for climate adaptive planning and mitigating the impact of climate change, and building more effective links with the private sector to help address climate risks by improving integration with markets.

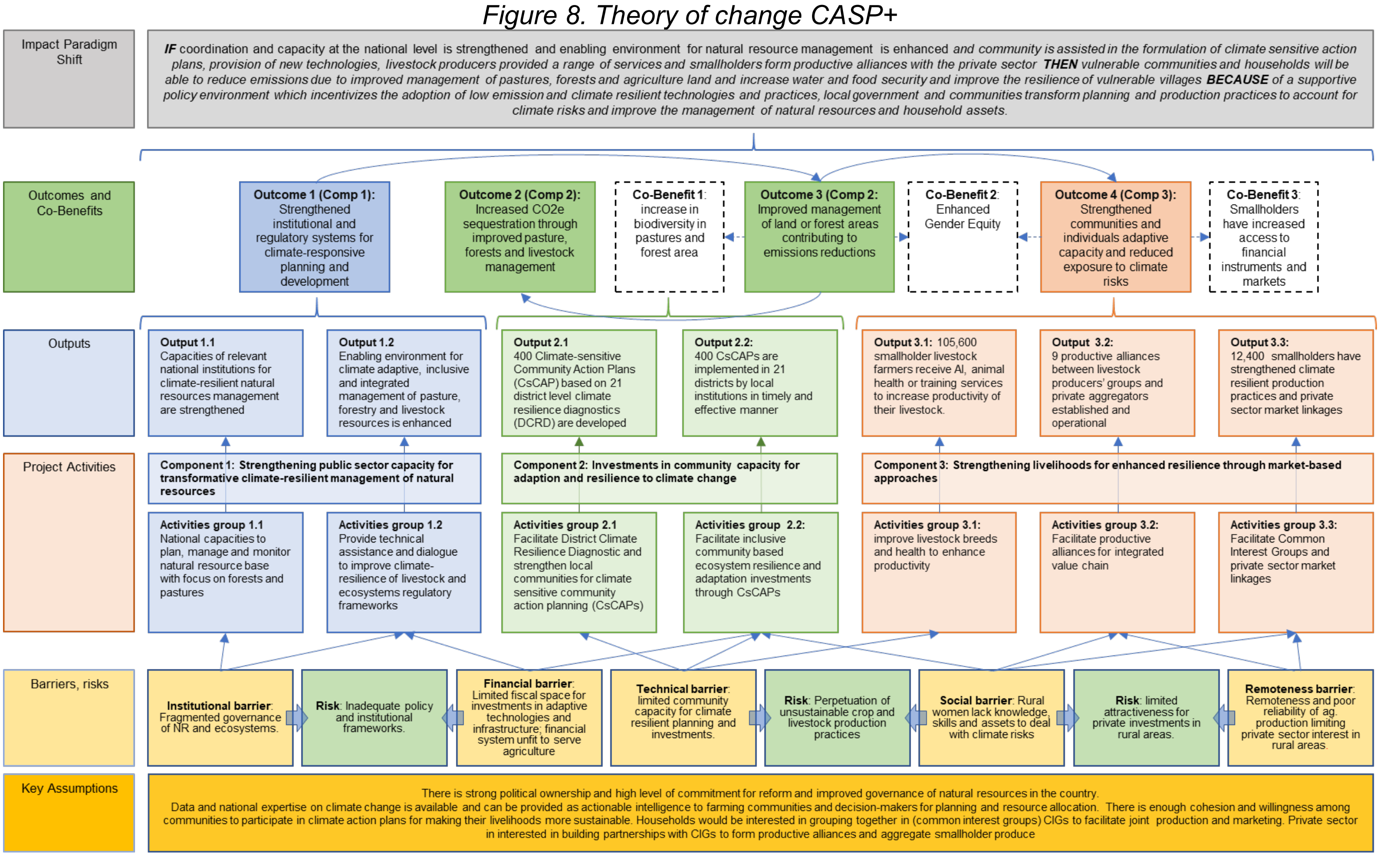
23. The Theory of Change has been developed to address some of the key barriers in the path to improve livelihood resilience and carbon sequestration in rural areas (see ***Figure 8****. Theory of change CASP+*, and **Annex 22**). These include:

- **[a] Institutional barriers:** limited capacity for evidence-based planning, management and evaluation of natural resources at national and local levels; **translating into** fragmented governance of the natural resources, at local, as well as national level (e.g., pastures and forests are under different institutions regulating the access in different ways.
- **[b] Technical barriers:** limited understanding of climate change impacts for rural populations; and low productivity of agricultural systems, limited capacity at local level and lack of stimuli to revert the trend of unproductive livestock population growth, hampering efficient and sustainable rangeland management.
- **[c] Financial barriers**: related to **limited public investment**, increasing but geographically still scattered and not always aligned in methodology to promote integrated ecosystem management; as well as **inadequate financial system** with consequent limited financial options (products, system) in rural areas for productive investments in forestry, livestock/rangeland management and income diversification.
- **[d] Social barriers**: such as unequal socio-economic structure, discriminating rural women and disadvantaged people, particularly within poor households and especially **female headed households** (representing 9% of the total) (**Annex 8**).
- **[e] remoteness barriers**, related to inadequate road network especially in mountainous areas, hampering **access to markets**, **financial services** and ultimately **investment** for rural populations.

24. The underlying theory of change of the project is that **IF** coordination and capacity at the national level is strengthened and enabling environment for natural resource management is enhanced and community is assisted in the formulation of climate sensitive action plans, provision of new technologies,

livestock producers provided a range of services and smallholders form productive alliances with the private sector **THEN** vulnerable communities and households will be able to reduce emissions due to improved management of pastures, forests and agriculture land and increase water and food security and improve the resilience of vulnerable villages **BECAUSE** of a supportive policy environment which incentivizes the adoption of low emission and climate resilient technologies and practices, local government and communities transform planning and production practices to account for climate risks and improve the management of natural resources and household assets.

Figure 8. Theory of change CASP+



25. ***One of the key postulates of CASP+ theory of change is premised on the assertion that helping to shift the development pathway in a low emission and climate resilient direction requires a series of investments in the public sector at the national level to strengthen the governance and management regime of the natural resource base.*** CASP+ aims to bolster institutional mechanisms, enhance coordination among stakeholders, and build capacity to govern natural resources effectively. While the Government of the Republic of Tajikistan has secured readiness support from GCF[83] to develop a National Adaptation Plan, further legislative and policy reforms in natural resource management are imperative. Also, the implementation mechanisms of the National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy (NCCAS) require strengthening. Besides reinforcing the enabling environment (component 1), CASP+ intends to facilitate community investment (component 2) to enhance resilience of the households in the project area, stimulating more sustainable livelihood options. It will also support livelihood diversification for vulnerable households and commercialisation and agribusiness development for common interest groups (component 3). These investments are expected to generate multiplier affects along the selected value chains that will help to further build demand for local enterprises and aid in diversification.

26. ***Strategic investments in regulatory and policy actions have the potential to change behaviour in markets and economies beyond one-off investments***. By refining existing laws, enhancing technical capacity for climate change adaptation, and providing tools like geo-referencing and

remote sensing, decision-making processes can improve, fostering better management systems and resilience. CASP+ targets policy constraints in pasture law, breeding strategy, and capacity development for improved public projects and green economy development options.[84]

27. ***The theory of change of the project is based on the understanding that with facilitation support and investments in planning, infrastructure, inputs and equipment,*** communities can mobilize, plan and implement Community Action Plans that address some of the key issues of vulnerability to climate risks. CASP+ will support communities to develop and implement climate-sensitive Community Action Plans addressing vulnerability to climate risks. In rural mountainous areas, the role of Pasture User Unions (PUUs) is pivotal. Adequately supported and accompanied in climate-sensitive community investment, PUUs will be enable innovative strategies to improve pasture productivity, reverse pasture degradation, and with the appropriate incentives also reduce methane emission intensity. Evidence from previous IFAD investments[85] shows very positive results on pasture productivity (+15% on average), as well as on reverting the pasture degradation trend (summarized in **Annex 18f**).[86] In addition, the assessment has also shown that the past project investment generated a decrease of livestock units owned by the beneficiaries[87]. This approach can ultimately lead to a reduced methane emission intensity of the economic output and to an overall net incremental sequestration thanks to improved rangeland management and forestry.

28. ***By introducing a specialization in the field of climate change in the master's programme in leading universities and by further strengthening the capacity to understand and implement the principles of agro-ecology in various disciplines such as agriculture, ecology, livestock, etc., there can be a significant paradigm shift in how resources are managed and allocated.*** **Annex 6**[88] and **Annex 25** provide a detailed description on how the project has the potential to adhere to the agro-ecology principles. The capacity of the public sector to understand climate change issues and influence their policy and allocative decision-making towards more resilient pathways can be facilitated through orientation sessions for civil servants at the Academy of Public Administration which has a mandate to upgrade their modern theoretical and practical knowledge.

29. **The project's theory of change is premised on the evidence the farmers can transform their production practices to low emissions pathways and adopt production practices more adaptive to climate change and reduction in emissions with guidance and support**. Livestock plays a vital role in Tajikistan's agriculture sector but also contributes significantly to greenhouse gas emissions (see details in **Annex 23**, and **Annex 28**, para 8). Without the project, the upward trend of livestock will continue and the trends of the last 5-10 years that show annual growth rates of 2% for cattle and sheep and 1% for goats are likely to continue. There are several methodologies that can be adopted that result in lower emissions and at the same time maintains or increases productivity. With the extensive grazing system largely relying on pastures vulnerable to temperature increase and shifting rainfall patterns, livestock productivity is very low. The damages of climate change to the rural ecosystems (pasture and forests mostly) require communities to take ***adaptation and mitigation measures, including pasture management plans and husbandry practices*** tailored to the carrying capacity, stipulating resting periods and rotational grazing to enable regeneration, etc.[89] ***Investments in climate resilient pastures and agroforestry*** have the potential to restore damaged ecosystems, reduce GHG emissions, enhance carbon sequestration, reduce erosion and limit risk from mudflows, landslides and soil loss. Specifically, CASP+ will adopt a three-pronged approach for livestock investment: improving feed, breeds, health plus pasture management. Besides community investment in the CsCAPs in **output 2.2**, under **output 3.1** the project will support improvement of the genetic potential of smallholder farmers' livestock and the adoption of climate resilient innovative technologies (introduction of fodder varieties and conservation, manure management, through demonstrations and FFS). Genetic improvement is expected to encourage commercial and smallholders to switch from low yield animals to higher and more efficient stock. This is also expected to encourage reduction in herd size thereby helping to reduce GHG emissions. Climate-sensitive livestock practices promoted by CASP+ (comprising improved pasture management, better fodder production including by using climate

resilient varieties, and fodder conservation, silage preparation techniques and better manure management), and promotion of livelihoods diversification will ultimately improve animal resilience and contribute reducing emissions from livestock practices (better pasture conditions, better productivity, reduction of inventories, lower emission intensity). While addressing livelihoods resilience, the project will also address gender-based discriminations identified in previous experiences not only through affirmative actions (e.g., by setting quotas and targets for women on an equal basis) but having specific gender responsive actions (direct activities targeting for women); dedicated resources (dedicated staff) and proper monitoring tools (details are provided also in FP Section **B3**, as an introduction to each component's investment, in **Annex 8**, and in **Annex 26**). Responding to the critical gender barriers identified in the gender assessment, CASP+ envisages dedicated interventions aimed to: (i) women accessing technologies, knowledge, skills, business development / orientation, (ii) improved agriculture practices through FFs, (iii) improved access to market and capital (e.g. grants) through facilitate market linkages and value chain development initiatives, (iv) increase economic opportunities for women through formation of Common Interest Groups (CIGs), and (v) increase decision making through enhancing leadership skills (leadership training).

30. **The average farm size is small with limited household resources to invest in productive infrastructure.** The physical and productive infrastructure in rural areas which can help enhance the resilience of smallholders, is dilapidated and despite a commitment at strategic and policy level,[90] the public sector is still failing to invest on a substantial scale and depth in them. However, ***communities have the commitment and incentive to organize and form groups and undertake collective action to solve issues associated with their productive and common property resources.*** The experience of previous projects financed by IFAD (the Khatlon Livelihoods Support Project, KLSP; Livestock and Pasture Development Project, LPDP – Phase I and II)[91] shows that communities have been very effective in organizing and preparing collective action plans and implementing a range of sub-projects which can help them improve the productivity of their resources and make their livelihoods more climate resilient through improved adaptive skills and diversification into off-farm enterprises. The projects had environmental objectives linked to the restoration of degraded pastureland through pasture rotation plans implemented by the Paster User Unions (PUUs). According to the KLSP evaluation,[92] the success of the approach was to establish and strengthen village organizations as agents for rural development and governance with the capacity to devise and implement innovative strategies for pasture management. KLSP's evaluation confirmed that the village level institutions are likely to continue playing a key role as rural agents of change. Building on these, CASP+ will complement the successes of community mobilization for transformative integrated ecosystem restoration (see also **Annex 29**).

31. **Forests perform an essential function in regulating the water balance and providing protection against natural disasters.** Also, forests play a key role in the lives of Tajikistan's rural population. Firewood, fodder, medicinal plants, fruit and nuts can be sold locally at a profit and represent an important source of income diversification. Following the collapse of the Soviet Union, large areas were deforested to meet the need for fuelwood. This now makes the country more vulnerable to climate hazards and exacerbates climate change's negative impacts. Conflicts over land use between forestry offices and the local population also continue to lead to overuse and degradation of forest areas. Rehabilitating and protecting forests is therefore of vital importance in the process of adapting to climate change. The involvement of local people in resolving land use conflicts and managing the forests sustainably in a few pilot areas has helped to slow the rate of forest degradation and promote the rehabilitation of existing forests. ***Participatory management models bring about a paradigm shift in how forests are managed though Joint Forest Management (JFM) under which forest land is leased to local communities over the long term***.[93] Those leasing the lands are allocated plots by a community-based committee and use their own labour to plant the trees according to management plans which are jointly made with the local Leskhoz, who also organize the other activities such as nurseries, fencing, site preparation and irrigation and will share the resulting produce. ***Biodiversity conservation is also contributing to the rehabilitation and long-term stability of forests and mitigating the negative impacts of climate change and carbon sequestration.*** Communities are being

encouraged to work out agreements designed to prevent conflicts of interest between forest and pastureland users. This is because forests and pastureland are often in competition with each other. Women can supplement their incomes from the processing and marketing of non-wood forest products. While the country does not yet have the policy in place to enable carbon trading, through policy dialogue the project presents a potential to work with a range of partners[94] who can put in place enabling conditions for the development of carbon markets for the benefit of smallholders and provide them payments for ecosystem services. IFAD is beginning to develop its approach to carbon trading which could provide additional incentives for smallholders to drive sustainable change.

32. ***At the household level, livestock is a key component of the mixed farming systems and contributes significantly to agriculture GDP, food security, nutrition and household incomes. While livestock herd size has grown from 70% to 116% for the different species from 1991 to 2019[95], productivity of the sector is extremely low due to poor feeding, low genetic potential, inadequate herd management, poor animal health, etc***. The livestock sector in the country also displays poor reproductive performance. This has a major direct impact on carrying capacity and over-utilization of pastures, on the water footprint and GHG emissions, since around 40% of adult cows utilizing the pasture resource base are unproductive (**Annex 2**). This proportion could be reduced to 20% to 25% with proper herd management. There is strong demand and interest from smallholder farmers for techniques that contribute to intensifying production systems, such as improved breeding, fodder production and improved animal health. Improvements in feed quality, animal health and husbandry, coupled with stimuli to diversify livelihoods could lead to increased productivity, along with gradual reduction of the livestock population and related emissions.[96] There is a significant opportunity to reduce GHG emissions, particularly methane emissions from enteric fermentation. Tajikistan has an important potential to reduce its emissions through improving feeding practices and digestibility of diets, improving yields through genetics, feeding practices and animal health, and overall animal management. High-quality veterinary services can provide the basis for increasing animal productivity, improving the detrimental health impacts of climate change[97] and reducing greenhouse gas emissions. ***Incentives to reduce herd growth are critical elements to adaptation and typically include investments in more productive animals.*** Other measures include ***fodder production*** techniques, ***Artificial Insemination campaigns*** with large outreach but limited logistical burden, improving skills through ***Farmer Field Schools*** as the appropriate tool to enhance climate sensitivity at community level and adoption of adaptation techniques including on livestock related issues in the Tajik context.

33. **Private Sector Engagement:** CASP+ envisages a key role for the private sector through helping to reduce their transaction costs in dealing with rural communities. IFAD has extensive experience of attracting the private sector in its project areas for the benefit of the smallholder by helping to organize communities so that their fragmented production is consolidated. The project intends to facilitate business partnerships or Productive Alliances between groups of smallholder farmers and private sector actors (e.g. aggregators, processors) for a range of value chains. The main rationale for this activity is the need to create incentives for more efficient livestock production. CASP+ will facilitate market linkages through ensuring the private sector a minimum volume of produce and the specified quality through helping them to build linkages with private sector input suppliers and wholesalers and retailers. The TOC is premised on the experience that these linkages require initial facilitation for holding consultation meetings with potential Productive Alliance partners such as producer groups and business operators. In addition, some of the producers also require technical assistance through a specialized service provider to help in the development of feasibility studies and business plans. Once these are established the interaction and linkages between the private sector and producer groups become sustainable through formal contracts and mutually beneficial partnerships. Discussions with the Private sector during the development of the FP indicated that the private sector is interested in building partnerships with CIGs as long as they are assured of good quality produce and production at scale.

34. **Access to Finance:** The project will not directly provide credit lines but will facilitate access to financial resources for its target beneficiaries through facilitating their links with existing financial services providers and with new and emerging opportunities for access to finance. Local currency financing of long-term maturity is scarce in Tajikistan given that domestic microfinance institutions have been exposed to a foreign currency risk as their source of funds were designated in foreign currency. IFAD will also liaise CASP+ with its EU-funded "Platform for Remittances, Investments and Migrants' Entrepreneurship in Central Asia" (PRIME, designed to promote faster, safer and cheaper transfer of remittances, as well as leveraging these flows to advance digital financial inclusion and income-generating activities).

35. **Carbon Markets:** IFAD is currently also developing its strategy for entering carbon markets which can in the future help projects like CASP+ which have a significant potential for carbon-sequestration through its forestry and agro-forestry activities. As an organization committed to the alignment of its operations with the Paris Agreement and the global efforts to address climate change, IFAD has been focusing increasingly on the part it can play in helping smallholders adapt to climate change and reducing Green House Gas (GHG) emissions and carbon sequestration. IFAD can increasingly capitalize on the new opportunities which have opened up through which it can help translate its efforts in adaptation and mitigation into increased productivity, food security, incomes and employment for its primary target group, the small-holders and those most vulnerable to climate change. IFAD can learn from the experience of others in this arena who have developed successful pathways through, for example, making direct payments to farmers in many projects dealing with agroforestry, soil and water conservation, etc. Ensuring fair payment to farmers for payments for ecosystem services (PES) and their contribution is a way to ensure IFAD investments will result in sustainable change. IFAD can potential introduce some of these measures into CASP+.

36. In order to bring about some of these changes, it is critical to enhance the ***technical capacities of national livestock institutions*** to ensure efficient provision of public animal health and production services to smallholder farmers through partnership between public and private institutions. Provision of breeding services will play a key role by allowing farmers to improve the productivity and value of animals, which will compensate for the reduction of numbers. This will also have a significant impact on emissions from the livestock sector. Dissemination of technical innovations on fodder production and conservation will support the shift to reduced dependence on pastures. Further, the project will provide pastoralists with enhanced confidence that their livestock capital will not be eroded by excess preventable mortality and that increased productivity will more than compensate for a smaller herd. This will be undertaken through the incorporation of measures recommended by the World Organisation for Animal Health (OIE) on veterinary public health, animal welfare, separation of powers between public and private veterinarians, creating an appropriate business environment for the development of private veterinary services, and controlling the use of veterinary drugs and management of biological waste disposal processes. The experience of other countries also shows that livestock productivity and production systems can be transformed by developing the institutions responsible for the development of private veterinary services such as the Veterinary Associations and the Veterinary Statutory Body. Bringing the curriculum for veterinary education in line with international standards and by enhancing the competence of the graduates of the Faculty of Veterinary Medicine will allow the sustainable development of the veterinary system in general and the provision of quality services to the animal owners by graduates.

Key assumptions and risk mitigation strategies

37. ***The theory of change for scaling up the scope and impact of the project in a cost-effective and efficient manner*** is based on several key and well tested assumptions that have proved the test of time (see also **Table 1** in **Annex 28**); (i) the focus of the project on institutional strengthening, policy reform and capacity building is expected to have impact at the national level and well beyond the selected project districts; (ii) the incorporation of climate change in the curricula of the academic and vocational institutions will be used for teaching and training to students and professionals on a regular basis for coverage across

a range of sectors; iii) the establishment of a system of private veterinarian service is expected to be sustained by the demand for the service due to increased livestock productivity, reduced morbidity and mortality; (iv) the institutional strengthening of PUUs and the investments that they make are expected to be sustained beyond the project period and lead to scaling up of some of the successful management systems by the PUUs with reform in pasture laws which gives strong incentives to communities to manage the pastures; (v) the strengthening and diversification of livelihoods will generate multiplier affects that will increase incomes and employment in rural areas and the (vi) the engagement with the private sector will increase access to market for smallholders and help to forge strong and growing opportunities for both.

B.2 (b). Outcome mapping to GCF results areas and co-benefit categorization

Outcome number	GCF Mitigation Results Area (MRA 1-4)				GCF Adaptation Results Area (ARA 1-4)			
	MRA 1 Energy generation and access	**MRA 2** Low-emission transport	**MRA 3** Building, cities, industries, appliances	**MRA 4** Forestry and land use	**ARA 1** Most vulnerable people and communities	**ARA 2** Health, well-being, food and water security	**ARA 3** Infrastructure and built environment	**ARA 4** Ecosystems and ecosystem services
Outcome 1: Strengthened institutional and regulatory systems for climate-responsive planning and development	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	☒
Outcome 2: Increased CO2e sequestration through improved pasture, forests and livestock management	☐	☐	☐	☒	☒	☐	☒	☐
Outcome 3: Improved management of land or forest areas contributing to emissions reductions	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☒	☒
Outcome 4: Strengthened communities and individuals' adaptive capacity and reduced exposure to climate risks	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☒	☒	☐

Co-benefit number	Co-benefit					
	Environmental	Social	Economic	Gender	Adaptation	Mitigation
Co-benefit 1: increase in biodiversity in pastures and forest area	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒
Co-benefit 2: Enhanced Gender Equity	☐	☒	☒	☐	☐	☐
Co-benefit 3: Smallholders have increased access to financial instruments and markets	☐	☐	☒	☒	☒	☐

B.3. Project/programme description (max. 2500 words, approximately 5 pages)

38. The Community-Based Agriculture Support Programme Plus (CASP+) builds on the successful experience of long IFAD-funded investments in the country, comprising the Khatlon Livelihoods Support Project (**KLSP**, 2008-2015, US$12.3m)[98,99]; the Livestock and Pasture Development Project[100] phase I and II (LPDP I, 2011-2018, US$15.8m; LPDP II, 2015-2021, US$24.2m); and the Community-Based Agriculture Support Programme[101] (CASP, 2017-2024, US$40.6m). A description of IFAD-funded portfolio is provided in **Annex 29** and a synoptic table of IFAD-funded investment in Tajikistan is presented in **Annex 30** (a simplified one is reported below). The **approach on ecosystem restoration and climate resilience adopted by CASP+ is building upon the implementation experience of LPDP I and LPDP II**. Those projects, operating in remote mountainous areas of Khatlon region, were particularly appreciated for their high participatory approach and inclusion of local communities (through the use of Community Action Plans) as a means to empowering them on the decision-making process on natural resources, and for their positive economic results on livelihoods, agriculture productivity and rangeland restoration[102]. A recent assessment (IFAD, 2022) showed also that LPDP II approach[103] helped increasing beneficiaries' income by 15 percent, improve conditions of rangeland (through improved infrastructure and rotational grazing), and reduce the livestock inventories by 29 percent. CASP+ builds on a number of lessons and evidence from its past investment in the country, including on the improved livelihoods and role of women in their communities and institutions. Specifically on gender, the LPDP II experience (documented in **Annex 18e**) reports a significant improvement for women headed households' agricultural income (from crop, milk, and value of livestock

sales). CASP+ has placed significant emphasis on women inclusion, including at community level, to improve women empowerment and their participation in institutions decision making processes. The proposed investment under CASP+ represent a step up in further building climate resilience with significant carbon sequestration potential. CASP+ is expected to add significant value by institutional capacity building at the national level for implementation and monitoring, incorporating climate diagnostics in the planning framework at the district and village level and making investments that will build the resilience of local communities to growing climate risks at the community and household level (**Annex 29** and **Annex 30** provide further details on relevant experiences, lessons learned, and IFAD-funded projects in the country. A synoptic table is presented below).

***Table 1**. Simplified information on IFAD-funded investment: targeting and approaches (Annex 30).*

IFAD funded Project names	**KLSP** Khatlon Livelihoods Support Project	**LPDP I** Livestock and Pasture Development Project	**LPDP II** Livestock and Pasture Development Project (Phase II)	**CASP** Community-based Agriculture Support Programme – CASP	**CASP+** Community-based Agriculture Support Programme – CASP+
Timeframe	2008-2015	2011-2018	2015-2021	2017-2024	2021-2030
Sector	Rural development	Livestock	Livestock	Agricultural Development	Climate-sensitive rural development
Project focus	increase incomes and improve the lives of farmers in 250 villages in the project area.	Increase the nutritional status and incomes of targeted households by sustainably enhancing livestock productivity. In particular, the project will focus on institutional development, livestock and pasture development and income generation for women.	Contribute to the reduction of poverty in the Khatlon region and to increase the nutritional status and incomes of some 38,000 poor households by enhancing livestock productivity and resilience to climate change.	Improve access of communities to productive infrastructure and services leading to sustainable agricultural production and equitable returns.	Increase resilience of at least 80% of the 100,000 target households and contribute to the sequestration of an estimated 6.82 m tons of CO2 equivalent from improved pasture and forest management, afforestation and improved herd management
	Community Action Plans (CAPs)	Community Action Plans (CAPs) and Common Interest Groups (CIGs)	Community Action Plans (CAPs) and Common Interest Groups (CIGs)	Community Action Plans (CAPs) and Common Interest Groups (CIGs)	Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAPs) Common Interest Groups (CIGs) Productive rural alliances Farmers Field Schools
Geographical target	Two districts in **Khatlon region** (reduced after mid-term review): Muminobod, Sh. Shohin.	Five districts of the **Khatlon region**: Muminabad, Sh. Shohin, Temurmalik, Khovaling, and Baljuvon	Five additional districts of the **Khatlon region**: Vose, Dangara, Hamadoni, Farkhor, and Kulob	Seven districts: Rasht and Tojikobod in **RRS**, Norak, Jaihun, and Dusti in **Khatlon**, and Shahriston and Devashtich in **Sughd**.	Twenty-One climate-vulnerable districts in the **Khatlon**, **RRS** and **Sughd** regions (see **Figure 7** above and **Annex 30**).
	All projects had a complementary geographic targeting. When target districts coincided, specific community selection took into account of previous/ongoing relevant interventions and excluded villages with similar community investments (see criteria in Annex 21).				
Project Cost	USD 12.3 million	USD 15.78 million	USD 24.19 million	USD 40.64 million	USD 79.69 million
IFAD financing	USD 9.65 million	USD 14.6 million	USD 22.4 million	USD 30.66 million	USD 37.85 million

39. CASP+ is expected to increase resilience of at least 80% of the households in the 400 target villages and reach 100,000 target households as direct beneficiaries (equivalent to about 650,000 people), and indirectly reach ***2.27 m individuals*** (details provided in **Annex 24** – Breakdown of Project Beneficiaries). ***In addition, the project will contribute to the sequestration of an estimated 6.82 m tons of CO_2 equivalent from improved pasture and forest management, afforestation and improved herd management*** (**Annex 23**). Special activities will be undertaken for women and are outlined in detail in the Gender Action Plan (**Annex 8**) given their prominent role in agriculture especially livestock production, the high rates of outmigration of men from rural areas and the high proportion of women headed households and the lack of gender equity in the country.

40. The project has three components which will be implemented at the national level with the public sector institutions, at the community level to build community resilience and management of common property resources and at the group and household level to strengthen and diversify livelihoods and access markets. The three components are: **(1)** ***Strengthening public sector capacity for transformative climate-resilient management of natural resources***; **(2)** ***Investments in community capacity for adaption and resilience to climate change***; and **(3)** ***Strengthening livelihoods for enhanced resilience through market-based approaches***.

41. The project embraces various dimensions of climate resilience and decarbonization co-benefits. It requires the solid collaboration and partnership between different institutions, all involved in design and in implementation as executing entities. The project will be implemented as one climate finance investment required to address climate vulnerability of rural mountainous population (ref to B2(a), Annex 2.1, Annex 16). The approval of IFAD financing allowed the project to enter into effectiveness in April 2023, thus benefitting of a preliminary implementation phase co-financed by IFAD and other financiers.[104] According to the detailed budget and implementation timeframe in **Annex 4** and **Annex 5** respectively,[105] GCF financing will provide the required additional financing to reinforce national investments to address climate related challenges and to achieve the relevant climate objectives. For the first two years, IFAD financing will therefore serve to ignite preliminary and preparatory activities, expanded and rolled out under GCF financing. The specific responsibility of the financiers up to detailed sub-activities is provided in **Table 2** (Section B.4, below), and reflected in detailed in manner in **Annex 4** and **Annex 21**.

Component 1: Strengthening public sector capacity for transformative climate-resilient management of natural resources

42. Tajikistan has achieved important progress in developing a strategic vision for some of its development priorities such as water and disaster management. However, the integration of a climate change perspective in the agriculture sector and in the management of natural resources particularly pastures, forests and livestock is not very strong. There is limited technical capacity and lack of tools for evidence-based planning, management and evaluation of natural resources and the impact of climate change. This leads to fragmented governance of natural resources and limits the opportunities and potential for sustainable development for rural livelihoods. This component is designed to address some of these issues and includes two specific outputs focused on capacity development and improving the policy environment. The two outputs and their associated activities are elaborated below. Additional details of financiers of activities and sub-activities are provided in **Table 2**, Section B4.

Output 1.1: By year 7, capacities and enhanced coordination among relevant national institutions for climate-resilient natural resource management strengthened

43. National capacities to plan, manage and monitor the natural resource base at central and at lower administrative tiers will be strengthened with a focus on forests and pastures. The capacity of the State Forestry Agency (SFA) will be strengthened. A forestry curriculum recently developed for Tajikistan with the assistance of GIZ will be rolled out to the 14 project Leskhoz. Operational capacities of national institutions responsible for pasture management (Pasture Meliorative Trust, PMT), livestock (National Veterinary Authority, NVA; and State Enterprise for Animal Breeding and Artificial Insemination, SEABAI); as well as research and academic institutions (Tajik Agrarian University, Tajik Academy of Agricultural Science and the Public Administration Academy) will be strengthened, with the project assisting them in the review of existing curricula for training of climate change specialists in key decision making positions in the government. The output will also focus on capacities to map and monitor natural resources, to allow proper decision making on ecosystem services management. A system that combines remote and participatory natural resources monitoring and management will be introduced. In addition, the project will pilot test an innovative approach to undertake pasture monitoring using hives on a pilot area of 3,500 ha. To encourage the generation of knowledge and the practical application of innovations in the project area, the project will encourage research institutions to produce evidence on effective approaches to NRM through a call for proposals. The private sector will also be invited to present proposals for the production of technical innovations that can help in climate adaptation which can then be disseminated through the private sector and facilitate the adoption of climate adaptation technologies and practices.

44. Under this output, GCF proceeds will finance the improvement of the enabling environment for a climate sensitive pasture and rangeland management including improved monitoring mechanisms, using remote sensing data. GCF funds will also contribute improving the curricula at university to integrate climate change issues (also identified as a priority in the NDC), and will enable research institutes and the private sector to produce evidence on NRM and Climate Change for climate sensitive technical innovations (additional details of financiers of activities and sub-activities are provided in **Table 2**, Section B4).

Activity 1.1.1: Capacity Development of public institutions on climate resilient ecosystem management. Develop capacities of public institutions to streamline climate sensitive, participatory and gender inclusive ecosystem management approaches such as landscape approach, integrated watershed management, joint forest management and community-based pasture management. This activity is coordinated by CEP and MOA.

Activity 1.1.2: Introduce combined remote and participatory Natural Resources monitoring and management. Establish remote and participatory management of natural resources as basis for climate adaptive development and enable exchange of information between the different competent state agencies and communities. This activity builds on the results of the FAO readiness activities establishing national MRV capacity, will address the capacity building related to conducting land use cover monitoring and will also address ex-post evaluation of the mitigation action of the project itself. The activity is executed by CEP.

Activity 1.1.3: Enhance technical capacities of national livestock institutions to ensure efficient provision of public animal health and production services to smallholder farmers through efficient partnership between public and private institutions. Strengthen capacities of public agencies in charge of animal health and breeding services to improve outreach and quality of their technical assistance (under MOA execution).

Activity 1.1.4: Build capacities of research and academia institutions on climate resilient ecosystem management. Streamline Climate Change and Ecosystem management approaches in the training curricula and research programmes of National and Research Institutions and academia (under CEP and FAO execution)

Output 1.2: By year 7, enabling environment for climate adaptive, inclusive and integrated management of pasture, forestry and livestock resources is enhanced

45. CASP+ has chosen strategic areas for policy engagement from the climate perspective and will focus animal husbandry and health, pasture management, implications of promoting the Green Economy on the existing system of incentives and regulation and lessons learned from the experience of joint forestry management and monitoring of pastures. The lead agency CEP has the mandate to enhance the enabling environment for addressing climate risks and is already engaged with the preparatory work for National Adaptation Plan (NAP) readiness. To facilitate coordination among the main stakeholders, the project will organize regular workshops to facilitate interaction and enhance the mainstreaming of climate adaptive natural resource management practices, in close coordination with existing thematic platforms such as the Pasture Working Group and the National River Basin Organization to better understand the changing trends and prepare to deal with growing climate risks. The dialogue will also include the integration in the Pasture Law of critical aspects related to control of livestock inventories (currently not included). One of the possible entry points to address this issue from a policy and regulatory point of view would be to include in the law, provisions to enable PUUs to establish systems (grazing permits, quotas) that ensure that carrying capacities are observed and that stock accumulation is discouraged. If these types of measures were framed in the Pasture Law and applied by all PUUs, the impact on animal inventories would be expected to be substantial. Given the centrality of an integrated ecosystem approach for a transformative and climate adaptive livestock sector for rural livelihoods, and the concerns regarding its contribution to ecosystem services, the project will also provide assistance in the use of carbon assessment decision tools such as the EX-Ante Carbon Balance Tool (EX-ACT),[106] the Global Livestock Environmental Assessment Model-interactive (GLEAM-i), and the Biodiversity Integrated Assessment and Computational Tool (B-Intact),[107] leading to enhanced capacities for national accounting, and will interact (through FAO as co-executing entity) with the FAO-implemented GCF Readiness project that includes support to MRV capacities. Under this output, GCF proceeds will also finance stock taking of policy development and mainstreaming of gender sensitive climate adaptive agricultural practices and support strategic activities relevant to developing capacities towards implementing the Article 6 of the Paris Agreement, within the approved Green Economy strategy. Through the central role of CEP, synergies will be sought with other interventions in the country to support country capacity to access and deploy climate finance.[108]

46. **Social inclusion dimension**. Social mobilization and inclusion process promoted by this component will focus specifically on youth, as an empowerment measure and to ensure that the policy and regulatory framework changes embed youth and gender perspectives. To this end, CASP+ will partner with existing youth unions and youth committees (districts and village levels) already formed and receiving public and self-sustained support.

47. The output will comprise the following activities:

Activity 1.2.1: Promote an inclusive and integrated policy dialogue. Enhance the mainstreaming of climate adaptive management practices of natural resources in all national institutions (including gender and climate change) and verification of the effectiveness of policies on the ground. The activity is implemented by CEP and FAO.

Activity 1.2.2: Technical assistance for review of livestock related regulatory frameworks. Review and update of the Pasture Law and animal health and breeding regulatory and strategic framework to ensure compliance with international guidelines and streamline climate resilience and environmental protection. The activity is implemented by MOA and FAO.

Activity 1.2.3: Support government's capacity to coordinate and monitor Green investments.[109] This activity will comprise technical assistance to strengthen capacity on the legislation and regulatory framework related to the Green Economy, including assessing potential for carbon finance, providing complementary support to any readiness or CEP action in that regard. The activity is coordinated by CEP, with MOA and FAO support.

Component 2: Investments in community capacity for adaption and resilience to climate change

48. This component will develop and implement 400 Climate Sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAPs.) in the selected districts. The project will encourage a collaborative and a participatory diagnostic and implementation process. The community planning will be preceded by a District level Climate Resilience Diagnostic (DCRD), defining the main challenges related to climate change and the main avenues for investment. CsCAPs will include ecosystem improvement and agricultural resilience investments, including improved pasture management, afforestation and forest rehabilitation, climate resilient infrastructures, and community agricultural equipment for improved productivity.

49. **Social inclusion dimension**. Women will represent 50 percent of the overall beneficiaries and youth will represent 30 percent of the overall beneficiaries. It is expected that community consultations will include at least 30 percent of women and youth as participants. This will ensure that their needs and priorities are identified during the community prioritization process for the CsCAPs and selection of CIGs. As part of direct targeted interventions, trainings for 2,400 women will be conducted. The objective is preparing women members of community organizations to be leaders and change agents in their organizations. They will be provided with sensitization on topics including gender relations, self-awareness, leadership and accountability, negotiation and conflict management, advocacy, lobbying and effective communication (among others). To provide youth with long-term employment opportunities, 15 percent of the joint forest management contracts will be provided to youth, swaying them to remain in rural areas and develop livelihood opportunities there. Additional details are provided in **Table 2**, Section B4.

Output 2.1: By year 3, 400 Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAP) based on 21 district level climate diagnostics are developed

50. A diagnostic analysis of community needs will be mapped using an advanced desktop geospatial analysis of climate risk and vulnerability. A map-based profile of each district will be created to indicate the geographic areas where the effects of climate change pose the greatest threat to the safety and livelihood of inhabitants, built assets, agriculture, livestock and natural resources. Given the importance of water control, conservation and topography in disaster risk reduction and climate change resilience, each district will be divided into planning units based on sub-catchments. This will stimulate a landscape management approach. The District level Climate Resilience Diagnostic (DCRD) will be regarded as a discrete 'information product' output of the project and an information campaign will explain the basis of the diagnostic to Jamoats in the selected 21 districts, benefitting the entire population of each district, in the frame of CASP+ and is expected to also inform future investment decisions. At operational level, the DCRD will outline the climate-related changes that can be expected and the best strategies to cope with them including adaptation investments and forestry Investments (Output 2.2).[110] The presence and capacity of local institutions will be assessed, thus defining actions to strengthen local capacities to plan and monitor climate sensitive community action plans (CsCAPs). Based on the evidence and on the needs emerging from consultations in the 400 selected villages, the output will support the communities and their groups in designing CsCAPs screened against social and environmental safeguards,[111] and in establishing Common Interest Groups within the selected villages. These will be self-selecting groups of up to 10 households per

village organised into two themes (i) climate resilient food or fodder production and (ii) processing and storage which will be financed through a matching grant (see component 3).

51. Under this output, GCF will at first contribute to define the District Climate Resilience Diagnostic (DCRD) for 21 districts, which represent the basis for all community planning and for the ecosystem improvement investment envisaged in the component. GCF proceeds will also be the financing element to ensure strengthening communities capacities to identify climate stressors and prepare relevant climate sensitive community action plans (CsCAPs), providing the climate rationale for the climate-sensitive investments (additional details are provided in **Table 2**, Section B4).

Activity 2.1.1: **District Climate Resilience Diagnostic.** Elaborate district diagnostic (by CP) and disseminate the results to institutional stakeholders (by MOA and CEP).

Activity 2.1.2: **Establishing relevant local institutions.** Identify institutional and community capacity gaps, establish community institutions where needed and strengthen the existing. (executed by MOA, with support by CEP on forest-related matters).

Activity 2.1.3: **CsCAP planning and design.** Design of 400 CsCAPs in the targeted communities, including all relevant prioritized subprojects (under MOA implementation)

Activity 2.1.4: **Strengthening local institutions capacity to monitor and evaluate CsCAPs.** Strengthen local capacity to monitor ecosystem impact of CsCAPs (MOA and CEP)

Output 2.2: By year 7, 400 Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAP) implemented in 21 districts with benefits for 100,000 rural households

52. This output will make sure that CsCAPs include a balanced mix of investment activities, and that they properly capture the need for specific interventions on climate change adaptation, mitigation and disaster risk reduction. The list of options is indicative as they will be identified by the beneficiary households based on climate diagnostic analysis and village level priorities. The **CsCAPs** will include ***ecosystem resilience and adaptation investments***, including sub-projects in the following categories:

- Pasture Management investments identified through the forum of PUU (where VOs don't exist) or PUG (where VOs exist). The pasture plans will include pasture rotation and protection, pasture restoration, or plantation of forage shrubs and trees, and summer pasture infrastructure such as shepherd cabins, night fences and shelters for animals (e.g., cattle crushes for treatments). In some cases, a sub-class of cross-village pasture management investments could simultaneously benefit multiple communities, for example where plans are made for transhumance routes. Overall, pasture investments will represent minimum 20 percent of the total CsCAP Adaptation investment.
- Forestry investment, operated in collaboration with leskhoz (Forest enterprises depending on the State Forest Agency), and with the participation of forest users groups, will aim to complement the restoration of ecosystems and the protection of areas vulnerable to climate hazards (disaster risk reduction), at the same time providing additional sources of income to rural communities. As part of the CsCAPs, Forest investment will be part of a broad ecosystem plan, which will be monitored by the communities and Leskhoz. Specifically, investments will include: (i) Joint Forest Management (JFM)[112] where a contract is established between household and Leskhoz for an initial 20 years management of a plot of land where the yield from the plot is split between each party to the contract; (ii) Direct Leskhoz Forestry:[113] where forest is re-established on Leskhoz land mobilizing community labour , usually in sites more remote from villages and include more typical forest species; and (c) Forestry investments in buffer zones of protected areas: applied through Leskhoz in the buffer zone of Protected Area (in CASP+ this is limited to Sh. Shohin district). All forestry investment includes concessional project support for site works, irrigation, fencing, seedlings, equipment and required climate adaptive forest nursery establishment. Training will be provided to participants in tree planting and aftercare, while forest user groups and Leskhoz will provide labour.[114] As part of the CsCAPs, the forestry investments will include a management plan, monitored by the project as well as by Leskhoz and the communities themselves.
- Climate Resilient infrastructure investments, related to addressing water stresses and the need to adapt to increasing risks of climate-related hazards. The communities will ensure operation and maintenance, including a plan to finance it. Water investments aim to support diversification activities (backyard garden, fruticulture, small animal husbandry), alleviate the burden on women and increase water availability, and ensure meeting basic livelihood requirements in isolated areas. Soil and water conservation structures to prevent soil erosion, mudslides and floods will be considered where

appropriate.[115] This could include the plantation of bushes and trees, small hydrological works that slow down torrential water flows, where there is potential for aquifer recharge and enhance infiltration, reduce impacts of storms and reduce soil erosion, such as roads, protective works and erosion reduction, water points and irrigation schemes, etc. The project will ensure that infrastructure is adapted to the increased risks caused by more frequent torrential precipitation events.

- Community agriculture equipment for productivity improvement. CsCAPs will include the procurement of agricultural equipment such as tractors, bailers, etc., that will contribute to support transformation of production systems. The equipment will be owned and managed (including maintenance) by the community institutions, and will be rented to individual community members, generating financial income for the communities to be earmarked for operation and maintenance of the investments. The focus of equipment investment will be on fodder harvesting and conservation material, in order to help farmers to cope with feed shortages in summer and winter exacerbated by climate change.[116] In addition, other category of mechanization equipment that could be considered are those that can be used both for hay/fodder and other crops such as: tractors, tillage equipment (plough, harrows, cultivator, etc.), trailers, planters, fertilizer spreaders (used with good agricultural practices). Equipment that are only for non-fodder crops (e.g., combine harvester) will need to be justified in the CsCAPs according to specific climate vulnerability upfront and shall ensure they benefit smallholders.

53. **CsCAP Monitoring**. The monitoring and evaluation of the CsCAPs will be an intrinsic part of the approach under this component. The MOA will recruit a national monitoring consultant and will use ‘Open Source’ smartphone tools for project planning, monitoring and control to minimize supervision costs and improve the speed and frequency of supervision reports. During implementation of physical infrastructure investments, the Engineer recruited by the MOA and technical works Supervisor will be responsible for supervision and will support the local communities with monitoring their plans. A bridge will be established between the diagnostic maps and citizen reporting to provide a means of tracking the achievement of objectives of the plans and the outcomes achieved from CSCAPs implementation. All investments will be georeferenced. This will allow communities to better monitor all CsCAP investments using digital tools. Innovative methods will be employed to engage and incentivize stakeholders, including youth, to use smartphones for field reporting and ground truthing of remote sensing.

54. Under this output, GCF will contribute financing the CsCAPs, specifically for the portion of community plans that pertains to the investment with the highest potential for carbon sequestration (namely forest restoration, Pasture and rangeland rehabilitation), while IFAD financing will complement on the most climate adaptive and resilience building investments (additional details are provided in **Table 2**, Section B4).

Activity 2.2.1: Implement Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans. Implementation of the ecosystem resilience and adaptation investments of the CsCAP in the targeted 400 villages, comprising the multiple dimensions of improved pasture management (including cross-village when required), Forestry investments of the CsCAP in the selected villages (in the proximity of Leskhoz), climate resilient infrastructures, agricultural productivity improvement (implemented by MOA, with CEP responsible for forest investments).

Component 3: Strengthening livelihoods for enhanced resilience through market based approaches

55. This component aims to strengthen the capacities of smallholders to identify and invest in climate resilient and diversified production systems that link to local and national value chains. The current production systems are not adapted to climate change impacts, rely on rainfed agriculture and are not integrated with market opportunities. The project will invest in developing linkages between smallholders and private sector actors, building smallholders capacities in climate resilient production practices and conducting farming as a business.

56. **Social inclusion dimension**. The whole component is supporting women and youth participation in the project’s activities. Women and youth will represent respectively 50 percent and 30 percent of the beneficiaries of the component’s activities, including as part of the promotion of climate smart innovations, Farmers Field Schools, Common Interest Groups (CIG) for livelihoods diversification (window 1). Women and youth will represent 30 percent of the beneficiaries for CIG window 2 (for commercialization and agribusiness development). Criteria for selection and prioritization of youth, women, women head of households (WHHs) and the most poor and vulnerable (including PWD) are presented in the SECAP

Appendix I. Finally, **youth** will be trained on artificial insemination and trained and equipped to operate private enterprises as private veterinarians to diversify their existing skill set and become involved in additional income generating activities. The component is structured in three outputs. Additional details of financiers of activities and sub-activities are provided in **Table 2**, Section B4.

Output 3.1: By year 7, 105,600[117] smallholder livestock farmers receive Artificial Insemination (AI) services, animal health or training services to increase productivity of their livestock

57. Livestock productivity is currently low and limited by the poor genetic potential of animals, the poor animal health status, and inadequate animal husbandry practices, including in particular the feeding and reproduction management. This output will focus on increasing the productivity of livestock production systems, which combined with the comprehensive project investments to transform livestock production systems (feeding practices, fodder production, improved breeds, access to animal health services and supporting policies and strategies), will encourage farmers to engage a path of reduction of herd and flock sizes while increasing production and productivity. The combination of provision of breeding services through Artificial Insemination (AI) and provision of improved bulls, increased access to animal health services and capacity building of farmers on animal husbandry will result in significant improvement in livestock productivity.[118] In parallel, this output will also support the dissemination of technical innovations and their adoption by smallholder farmers through a combination of demonstrations and hands-on training activities, including Farmers Field Schools.

58. Under this output, GCF will also finance the interventions most relevant to improve reduction of methane emissions including animal health, as well as innovative livestock farmers field schools and demonstrations of climate smart innovations (additional details are provided in **Table 2**, Section B4).

Activity 3.1.1: Improving the genetic potential of smallholder farmers' livestock. Provision of breeding services (AI and improved bulls) to farmers in the 400 targeted communities to improve productivity of cattle and support transition towards more intensive production systems involving a reduced number of animals. The activity is implemented by MOA.

Activity 3.1.2: Support to delivery of private animal health services. Ensuring population's access to quality veterinary services through training and provision of veterinary instruments, motorcycles to private veterinarians and support of institutions responsible for the development of a private veterinary service. This activity is under MOA implementation.

Activity 3.1.3: Support adoption of climate resilient innovative technologies. Support the dissemination of technical innovations and their adoption by smallholder farmers through a combination of demonstrations (under MOA responsibility) and hands-on training activities including Farmers Field Schools (under FAO implementation).

Output 3.2: By year 4, 9 productive alliances[119] between livestock producers' groups and private aggregators established and operational

59. This output will facilitate business partnerships between groups of smallholder farmers and private sector actors (e.g. aggregators, processors) on dairy and beef value chains.[120] These partnerships or Productive Alliances will be formalized through agreements with selected private sector partners on an implementation plan, commitments on prices, delivery and quality requirements. This will enable farmers and the private sector farmers to plan their production, processing, procurement, supplies, as well as marketing. Benefits for the producers will include secure and predictable market and prices and could also include access to services (e.g. production inputs, TA, access to finance) provided by the private sector companies to improve the productivity and reduce the seasonality of production. As a general principle, the entry point for all business partnerships supported by CASP+ will be climate vulnerability. Supported Value Chain and business arrangements will contribute to the economic inclusion of climate vulnerable households. Moreover, via support to improved agricultural practices, they will contribute to reduce environmental degradation.

60. Under this output, GCF will contribute to developing innovative livelihoods opportunities related to private sector and market linkages (details of sub-activities' financiers are provided in **Table 2**, Section B4).

Activity 3.2.1: Identification of market and business opportunities. Facilitate identification and contracting of business partnerships between groups of small holder farmers and aggregators, to facilitate access to market and services (all under MOA responsibility).

Activity 3.2.2: Provision of financing and technical support to the business partnerships for selected livestock commodities. Provide financial and technical support to the business partnerships for selected livestock commodities (all under MOA responsibility).

Output 3.3: By year 7, 12,400 [121] smallholders have strengthened climate resilient production practices and private sector market linkages

61. This output will facilitate two types of Common Interest Groups (CIGs) to access support services to identify, analyse and adopt climate resilient production practices.[122] The first CIG type (Window 1) will comprise of 1,020 CIGs, strengthening capacity to adapt production systems to changing climate conditions and identifying opportunities to link to local markets. This support will increase access for CIGs to productive assets and services to increase agricultural productivity and diversification. Farmers accessing Window 1 will match the grant with a 10 percent cash contribution. The second type of market-linked groups (Window 2) will comprise 110 CIGs, trained in entrepreneurial skills and business plan development, to link to profitable agrifood value chains (e.g. small-scale poultry, horticulture, processing, etc.). Window 2 beneficiaries will match the grant with a 20 percent cash contribution. A Matching Grant Facility (MGF) will be established, and support will be provided to ensure CIG members' readiness to effectively utilize the funds. Where needed, follow-up trainings on climate resilient technologies, equipment, productive assets and technical assistance will be provided by the service provider hired for the purpose.

62. Under this output, GCF financing will be instrumental in mobilizing resources and expertise to support climate-sensitive economic activities that reinforce livelihoods and diversify to more sustainable livelihood options. It will also facilitate the establishment of market linkages with private sectors and facilitate linkages with existing green credit lines. Additional details of financiers of activities and sub-activities are provided in **Table 2**, Section B4.

Activity 3.3.1: Strengthening of CIGs capacity. Facilitate establishment of two types of common interest groups (CIGs) to access support services to identify, analyze and adopt climate resilient production practices (all under MOA responsibility).

Activity 3.3.2: Management of the CIG matching grant program. Establish and manage a Matching Grant Facility for the **implementation** of matching grant program for Window 1 and Window 2 (all under MOA responsibility).

63. **Project Management Component (PMC)**. CASP+ will be jointly executed by three executing entities according to respective comparative advantages and areas of expertise: (i). Republic of Tajikistan, acting through (a) Ministry of Finance and (b) Ministry of Agriculture (via the State Enterprise Project Management Unit Livestock and Pasture Development (PMU)); (ii). Committee on Environmental Protection (through the Center for Implementation of Investment Projects); and (iii). Food and Agriculture Organization of the UN (FAO).

64. The Ministry of Agriculture will serve as Lead Project Agency.[123] The Project Management Component will also benefit from dedicated support to facilitate implementation under procurement, financial management, planning, monitoring and reporting, safeguard compliance, etc, to increase pace and quality of implementation. The PMC will ensure (a) effective and timely coordination of project's interventions; (b) provision of technical assistance and specialist input in implementing project activities; (c) timely financial management and procurement for project activities; (d) preparation of AWPB and procurement plan for approval of all financing institutions; (e) support in monitoring, submission of reports to GCF, IFAD and Government, supervision and impact assessment (full details are outlined in Annex 21, PIM).

B.4. Implementation arrangements (max. 1500 words, approximately 3 pages plus diagrams)

65. **Accredited Entity**: The International Fund for Agriculture Development (IFAD) is the Accredited Entity for the CASP+ project. IFAD will sign a Funded Activity Agreement (the "FAA") with the GCF, and relevant agreements will be signed between IFAD and the Executing Entities[124] which will specify the role and responsibility of each and their contribution to the project. All required letters of no objection (**Annex 1**) letters of commitment (**Annex 13**) and internal approvals (**Annex 15**) will be obtained as required. IFAD will manage the funds from GCF and will disburse the funds quarterly in advance against agreed work plans, to

designated accounts. Regular progress reports will be provided by IFAD to GCF to keep it informed of project performance including the physical achievements and financial aspects. IFAD will undertake regular supervision of the project and commission evaluation reports based on the plan indicated (**Annex 11**). IFAD will supervise the execution of CASP+ with regular supervision and implementation support missions. IFAD will ensure the quality of the project deliverables, adherence to environmental, climate and social safeguards, undertake procurement reviews and ensure fiduciary risk management[125], assess project performance and undertake value for money analysis. IFAD will apply its georeferenced protocol to monitor investment progress and impact.

66. **Executing Entities** of CASP+ will include: (i) **Republic of Tajikistan**, acting through the Ministry of Finance (MoF) and the **Ministry of Agriculture (**MoA **via the State Enterprise PMU LPD**; (ii) the **Committee on Environmental Protection** (CEP) (through the Center for Implementation of Investment Projects), and (iii) the **Food and Agriculture Organization** (FAO). The **Ministry of Agriculture** (as Lead Project Agency) will hold overall execution responsibility of the project. CASP+ is conceived as one project, with all financiers aligned to the project theory of change and contributing to the project objectives solidly grounded on climate vulnerability of the target areas/ populations (as also climate scenario, TOC and project structure demonstrate). Considering the urgency of action emerging from the NDA (also EE) country programme and in the revised NDC (revised in early 2022), the project started as soon as IFAD approved the financing (effectiveness in April 2023). This ensures preparing the ground for GCF financing once approved. Specifically, such initial IFAD (and other co-financiers)-funded activities are allowing to advance on enabling conditions to deploy the community resilience and landscape restoration investments (in component 2) and individual resilience and diversification investment (in component 3), required as preliminary activities for the full implementation of the project. The implementation of the project with IFAD and co-financiers (without GCF proceeds) are preparing the ground and as such ensuring the speeding up of GCF disbursement as soon as available. As a result, GCF funds will start being disbursed with an increased readiness of MOA, CEP and FAO on project implementation. This would also allow to disburse effectively the GCF proceeds in the estimated timeframe (six years for GCF proceeds). The division of responsibility is indicated in the **Table 2. Execution responsibility and financiers by sub-activity**, at the end of this section. District Governments and Jamoats at the village level are expected to play an important role in coordination and helping to raise awareness about the project among key stakeholders and helping to incorporate climate vulnerability assessments in local development planning based on district diagnostics. The project will procure the services of local NGOs, service providers and partner agencies in the implementation of the project on the ground. The inclusion and engagement of the private sector will be encouraged to ensure that the project puts in place market-based solutions and productive alliances that can ensure the sustainability of the project investments.

67. **Executing Entity – Republic of Tajikistan**, acting through the Ministry of Finance (MoF) and the **Ministry of Agriculture (MoA)** via the State Enterprise “Project Management Unit” Livestock and Pasture Development (State Enterprise PMU LPD- in CASP+), under the Ministry of Agriculture (MoA). The State Enterprise PMU LPD was established in 2012 to support the implementation of investment projects in the agriculture sector. The State Enterprise PMU LPD has been managing IFAD-financed investment projects valued at USD 91.6 million.[126] The State Enterprise PMU LPD has successfully implemented KLSP and LPDP-I and LPDP-II, and is currently implementing CASP. It has solid experience in rural areas where the population face challenges similar to those of CASP+ target groups. It has a team of 33 specialists, covering a wide range of expertise in project management, financial, procurement functions as well as technical expertise in pasture, animal husbandry and health, agriculture, climate change adaptation, community mobilization, gender and social inclusion. It has technical experts and civil engineers, business development, GIS and M&E specialists. Between its central office in Dushanbe and its regional office in Kulob, the PMU will manage the execution of CASP+ interventions in all selected districts. It will also establish a small office for the implementation of project activities in Sughd and the RSS.

68. **Executing Entity – Committee on Environmental Protection (CEP)** was established in 2008 and is responsible for control of the use of natural resources, protection of land, minerals, forests, water and other resources, and also coordinates activities on environmental protection among the government agencies. In Tajikistan, CEP is the National Designated Authority (NDA) for managing GCF related projects

since 2014. As the NDA, it coordinates project implementation, engages potential and current Accredited Entities, provides strategic oversight for GCF supported projects to ensure alignment with national polices, convenes various stakeholders (public, private, civil society, etc.). Through its central administration and permanent staff in each district as well as at the regional level, CEP will guide the national and decentralized dialogues to enhance climate-sensitivity of policy, regulatory and investment frameworks. CEP will also play a key coordinating role in providing technical assistance for climate vulnerability diagnostic analysis at the district level and in screening community action plans from the climate resilience perspective and guide relevant agencies and the district level institutions to assist communities in implementing the plans.

69. **Executing Entity – Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** has long and extensive experience in the country. Cooperation between Tajikistan and FAO has been ongoing since the country joined the Organization in 1995. FAO assistance has evolved from providing emergency assistance to deal with locust attacks to a more comprehensive approach to build a sustainable and competitive agriculture sector, including improved food security and nutrition, and resilience to climate change. Currently FAO is engaged with CEP on the Readiness Programme, and contributed to the update of the NDC, along with the implementation of other climate change-focused projects. The FAO Regional Office for Central Asia is currently supervising and executing a large climate finance portfolio, including GCF-funded projects in Kyrgyzstan (“Carbon-sequestration through climate investment in Forests and Rangelands - CS-FOR”, USD 49.9m) and Armenia (“Forest resilience of Armenia, enhancing adaptation and rural green growth via mitigation”, USD 18.7m). FAO’s specific role in the project will be to provide assistance in policy refinement and in implementing Farmer Field schools (FFS) based on the methodology it has developed and implemented in a large number of countries.

70. **Contractual arrangements.** For the channelling of the GCF proceeds and the implementation of the Project, IFAD will enter into the following subsidiary agreements:

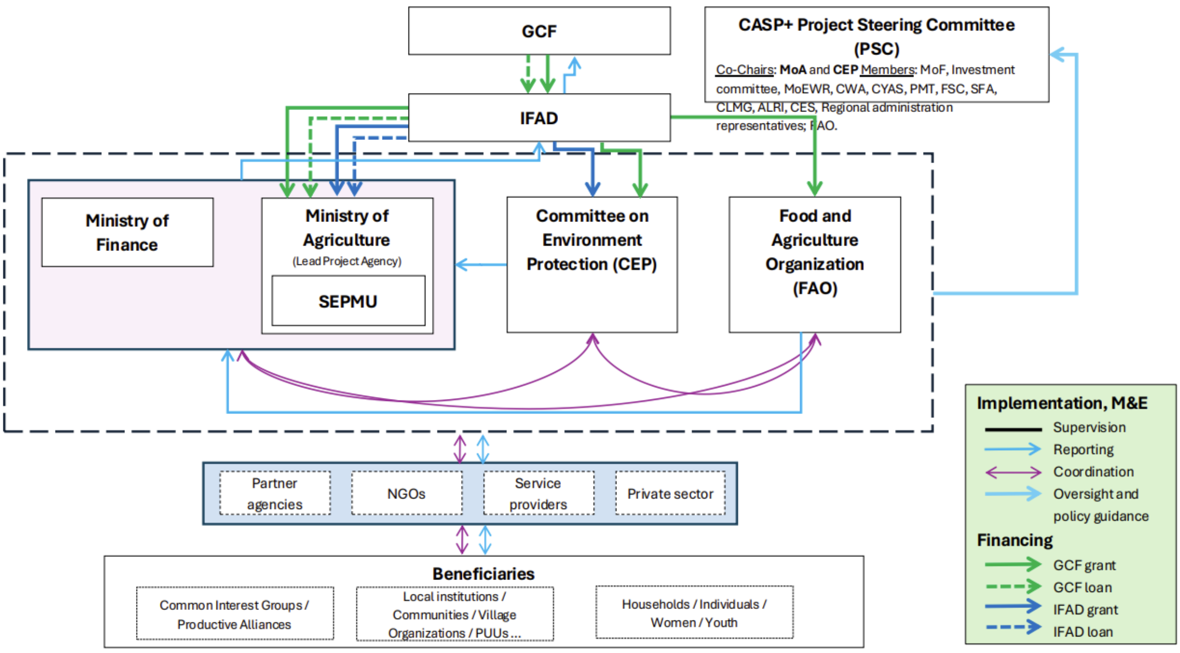
- ***one Subsidiary Agreement with the Republic of Tajikistan*** (the “RoT” or the “Borrower/Recipient”), as represented by the Ministry of Finance (the “MoF”) for the purposes of the signature of the Subsidiary Agreement and the Ministry of Agriculture (the “MoA”) for the execution of the Project. This Subsidiary Agreement will (i) define the terms and conditions of the execution of the Project by the following ***two Executing Entities***: Republic of Tajikistan, acting through MoF and MoA (via State Enterprise PMU LPDP - ‘SEPMU’) and CEP; and (ii) establish the terms that allow MoF to direct IFAD to transfer the GCF Grant to CEP. IFAD ensures that the Republic of Tajikistan acting through MoA enters into an agreement with CEP (the “RoT-CEP Agreement”). IFAD will include the relevant AMA and FAA provisions into the Subsidiary Agreement with RoT, as was done in the past for other projects with the GCF and will ensure that RoT passes down the relevant requirement to CEP in the RoT-CEP Agreement so that the relevant AMA and FAA provisions are then passed down from RoT to CEP.
- ***one Subsidiary Agreement with FAO*** that will define the terms and conditions of the execution of the project by FAO as ***Executing Entity***.

71. **Funds and fund flow:** The IFAD co-financing was approved at the December 2022 IFAD Executive Board and the Financing Agreement signed on 09 January 2023, and then IFAD entered into a Financing Agreement in April 2023 with the Republic of Tajikistan extending one loan (USD 6,750,000) and two grants (USD 6,750,000 and USD 24,349,000) for a project duration of 7 years. As per the above said agreement entered into force on the date of the countersignature as above for a duration of 7 years.

72. For the GCF proceeds, IFAD will enter into a Financing Agreement, which will serve as the Subsidiary Agreement, with the Republic of Tajikistan, represented by the Ministry of Finance and the Ministry of Agriculture. In consultation with the MOF, separate designated bank accounts will be opened for the SEPMU (under MOA) (one for the loan portion and one for the grant portion) and the CEP (one for the grant portion) for them to access the funds directly. Each disbursement request from the national EEs will be confirmed by the MOF. The direct fund flow from IFAD to FAO will be arranged subject to the formal confirmation of MOF. The fund flow arrangements to three EEs will be described in the Financing Agreement.

73. **Project Steering Committee (PSC):** The PSC will provide **overall policy guidance** for CASP+ to ensure that the Project objectives are achieved, and will maintain oversight of the annual workplan and budget of the project. It is co-chaired by MoA and CEP, and is composed of the national institutions relevant to the project implementation. It will meet at least on annual basis, to ensure effective decision making on project implementation, and to coordination amongst stakeholders as required. IFAD will be consulted by the co-chairs to facilitate decisions. Additional members will comprise: the Ministry of Energy and Water Resources (MoEWR), the Pasture Meliorative Trust (PMT), the Food Security Committee, the State Forest Agency (SFA), the Committee on Land Management and Geodesy (CLMG), the Tajik Academy of Agricultural Sciences (TAAS), the Agency for Land Reclamation and Irrigation (ALRI), State Agency for Hydrometeorology, State Enterprise for Animal Breeding and Artificial Insemination, Committee on Civil Defence and Disaster Risk Reduction and representatives from Civil Society Organizations. Development partners committed to climate-adaptive strategies and mitigation will participate as observers. The PSC will also ensure institutional coordination with the Coordinating Council on the Green Climate Fund[127] to strengthen linkages with and build on the on-going GCF and other climate investments in the country.

Figure 9: CASP+ Implementation arrangements and funds flow



74. There are several agencies at the national level which are critical in CASP+ institutional environment. These agencies will not have discretion in implementing CASP+ activities, and will play a supportive role in coordinating project activities and enhancing project impact. These are described in this and the following paragraphs. The **Hydrometeorological Agency of Tajikistan (Hydromet)** reports to CEP and is the lead agency for climate change. It is responsible for leading the preparation of national communications to the UNFCCC in coordination with key ministries and agencies as well as the preparation of GHG inventories. Hydromet is the government agency providing climate and weather information and forecasting to the general public in Tajikistan. **The Climate Change Center (CCC)** within Hydromet is responsible for managing climate-related re-search and reporting related to adaptation and mitigation. The CCC is expected to support the district level climate vulnerability analysis and support district governments in incorporating climate vulnerabilities and risks in local level development planning and resource allocation for enhanced adaptation and mitigation. **The National Biodiversity and Biosafety Centre** is responsible for biological diversity and it will be key stakeholder in helping to protect threatened species in pastures and forests.

75. **Additional institutions with consultative role comprise: a.** the **Ministry of Economic Development and Trade (MEDT)**, on climate-related governance and is responsible for state investment plans and coordination of the National Development Strategy. MEDT as co-executive body for the National

Action Plan for Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation will be involved in the project in policy dialogues and identifying entry points for national and subnational planning processes for climate change adaptation and mitigation. **b.** the **Committee on Emergency Situations and Civil Defence (COES)** with central role in early warning, disaster prevention, and recovery, supporting the identification of hotspots of climate hazards and related CsCAP investments. **c.** the **Committee on Land Use, Geodesy and Cartography (COLUGC),** responsible for the formulation and implementation of policy in state land management, land cadastre, land surveying, mapping, and state control over land use and conservation.

76. **Civil society organizations and community-based organizations** mobilized by the project will play a key role in the mobilization of the communities through the well tested Village organization approach and through them identify climate sensitive community action plans. The NGO will mobilise communities into Village Organizations, Pasture User Unions, Pasture User Associations, Joint Forest Management Groups or Common Interest Groups as required for implementing local plans. Other relevant public institutions will be engaged as service providers and at the same time as beneficiaries of CASP+ capacity strengthening activities. Private sector players who are engaged in the value chains identified for investments will be invited in policy dialogues and specific platforms for their feedback.

77. **The terms and conditions for the highly concessional loan that IFAD is providing to Tajikistan as co-financing to CASP+** are as follows: The loan is free of interest but bear a 1.48% of fixed service charge as determined, the service charge rate applicable at the date of approval of the Loan by the Fund's Executive Board, payable semi-annually in the USD. The Loan has a maturity period of forty (40) years, including a grace period of ten (10) years. The principal of the Loan will be repaid at four and half per cent (4.5%) of the total principal per annum for years eleven (11) to thirty (30), and one per cent (1%) of the total principal per annum for years thirty-first (31) to forty (40). Thus, to clarify, IFAD does not charge any interest to the loan, but only a service charge, and the 4.5% & 1% percentages are the proportions of the total repayments of the loan principle over the years from 11 to 40.

78. The **proposed terms and conditions for the GCF loan to Tajikistan CASP+ are as follows**: The proposed loan is free of interest; 0.25% service fee pr annum; 0.5% commitment fee per annum. The Loan has a maturity period of forty (40) years, including a grace period of ten (10) years. These terms and conditions will be passed down by IFAD to the EEs.

***Table 2**. Execution responsibility and financiers by sub-activity*

Outputs, Activities, Sub-activities	EE	Fin
Output 1.1. By year 7, capacities of relevant national institutions for climate-resilient natural resources management are strengthened		
Activity 1.1.1: Capacity Development of public institutions on climate resilient ecosystem management		
1.1.1.1. Strengthen capacities of Pasture Meliorative Trust to roll out Pasture Law at community level and provide technical assistance to PUUs, PUAs, PCs	MOA[128]	IFAD
1.1.1.2. Rolling out and Strengthen capacities of PMT to roll out Pasture Law at community level and provide technical assistance to PUUs, PUAs and PCs	MOA[128]	GCF
1.1.1.3. Upgrade the technical skills of the Forestry Department	CEP	IFAD
Activity 1.1.2: Introduce combined remote and participatory Natural Resources monitoring and management		
1.1.2.1. Kick-off Training on remote and participatory NRM	CEP	IFAD
1.1.2.2. Roll-out Training on remote and participatory NRM	CEP	GCF
1.1.2.3. Kick-off Field testing of NRM approaches	CEP	IFAD
1.1.2.4. Rolling-out Field testing of NRM approaches	CEP	GCF
Activity 1.1.3. Enhance technical capacities of national livestock institutions to ensure efficient provision of public animal health and production services to smallholder farmers through efficient partnership between public and private institutions		
1.1.3.1. Step up veterinary public health services of the National Veterinary Authority through provision of technical assistance and equipment	MOA[128]	IFAD
1.1.3.2. Improve the outreach of breeding services provided by State Enterprise for Animal Breeding and Artificial Insemination to areas and communities targeted by the Project	MOA[128]	IFAD
Activity 1.1.4: Build capacities of research and academia institutions on climate resilient ecosystem management		
1.1.4.1. Integrate climate change issues in university and training institutions curricula	CEP	GCF
1.1.4.2. Promote enrollment of male and female youth in training curricula on climate-resilient natural resources management	CEP	GCF
1.1.4.3. Enable research institutes and the private sector to produce evidence on NRM and Climate Change for policy dialogue and climate sensitive technical innovations	FAO	GCF
Output 1.2. By year 7, enabling environment for climate adaptive, inclusive and integrated management of pasture, forestry and livestock resources is enhanced		
Activity 1.2.1: Promote an inclusive and integrated policy dialogue		
1.2.1.1. Stock taking of policy development and mainstreaming of gender sensitive climate adaptive agricultural practices	FAO	GCF
1.2.1.2. Training on the utilization of policy support tools e.g. SIPT, GLEAM, EXACT, B-INTACT	FAO	FAO
1.2.1.3. Kick-off workshops for institutional networking	CEP	IFAD
1.2.1.4. Kick-off workshops for institutional networking (SFA funded)	CEP	SFA
1.2.1.5. Roll-out workshops for institutional networking	CEP	GCF
Activity 1.2.2: Technical assistance for review of livestock related regulatory frameworks		
1.2.2.1: Improvement of the Pasture Law	FAO	GCF
1.2.2.2: Consultations on the Pasture Law	MOA[128]	GCF
1.2.2.3. Mobilizing technical assistance of the OIE	FAO	GCF
1.2.2.4. Improvement of veterinary legislation	MOA[128]	IFAD
1.2.2.5. Review of the national breeding strategy	FAO	FAO
Activity 1.2.3. Support government's capacity to coordinate and monitor Green investments		

1.2.3.1. Support Development of the Green Economy strategy	FAO	GCF
1.2.3.2. Capacity Development of MEDT staff	CEP	IFAD
1.2.3.3. Capacity Development of Ministry of Finance staff	MOA[128]	IFAD
Output 2.1. By year 3, 400 Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAP) based on 21 District level Climate Resilience Diagnostics are developed		
Activity 2.1.1: District Climate Resilience Diagnostic		
2.1.1.1: Diagnostic - create a District Climate Resilience Diagnostic (DCRD) for each District	CEP	IFAD[129]
2.1.1.2: Dissemination of diagnostic	MOA[128]	IFAD
Activity 2.1.2: Establishing relevant local institutions		
2.1.2.1: Establishment VO's	MOA[128]	IFAD
2.1.2.2: Strengthening VOs	MOA[128]	GCF
2.1.2.3: Establishment and strengthening PUU or PUG	MOA[128]	IFAD
2.1.2.4: Establishment and strengthening of PUAs	MOA[128]	IFAD
2.1.2.5: Establishment and strengthening of Pasture Commissions	MOA[128]	IFAD
2.1.2.6: Kick-off of the promotion of JFM and establishment of Forest User Groups	CEP	IFAD
2.1.2.7: Rolling out of the Promotion of FM and establishment of Forest User Groups	CEP	GCF
2.1.2.8: Kick-off the establishment of Common Interest Groups (CIGs)	MOA[128]	IFAD
2.1.2.9: Roll-out the establishment Common Interest Groups (CIGs)	MOA[128]	GCF
2.1.2.10: Organize kick-off leadership training for women representatives in PUUs/VOs	MOA[128]	IFAD
2.1.2.11: Organize roll-out leadership training for women representatives in PUUs/VOs	MOA[128]	GCF
Activity 2.1.3: CsCAP planning and design		
2.1.3.1: CsCAP planning and design	MOA[128]	IFAD[130]
Activity 2.1.4: Strengthening local institutions capacity to monitor and evaluate CsCAPs		
2.1.4.1: Strengthening local institutions capacity to monitor and evaluate CsCAPs	MOA[128]	GCF
2.1.4.2: Strengthening and follow-up local institutions capacity to monitor and evaluate CsCAPs	MOA[128]	GCF
2.1.4.3: Strengthening knowledge and capacities of local administration and institutions	MOA[128]	IFAD
2.1.4.4: Provision of PMU vehicles for monitoring	MOA[128]	MoA
2.1.4.5: Kick-off the Implementation of the Community Forest Investments	CEP	IFAD
2.1.4.6: Rolling-out the Implementation of the Community Forest Investments	CEP	GCF
2.1.4.7: Provision of CEP staff and field specialist for project monitoring	CEP	CEP
Output 2.2. By year 7, 400 Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAP) implemented in 21 districts benefitting at least 100,000 rural HHs		
Activity 2.2.1: Implement Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans		
2.2.1.1. Kick off implementation of the Pasture Restoration Investment	MOA[128]	IFAD
2.2.1.2. Roll-out of the Implementation of Pasture Restoration Investment	MOA[128]	GCF
2.2.1.3. Implement cross-village Pasture Management Investments	MOA[128]	IFAD
2.2.1.4: Kick-off the implementation of Joint Forest Management Investments	CEP	IFAD
2.2.1.5: Roll-out of the Implementation of the Joint Forest Management Investments	CEP	GCF
2.2.1.6: Provision of SFA staff and field specialist for Joint Forest Management implementation	CEP	SFA
2.2.1.7: Kick-off of the implementation of Direct Leskhoz Forestry Investments	CEP	IFAD
2.2.1.8: Roll-out of the Implementation of the Direct Leskhoz Forestry Investments	CEP	GCF
2.2.1.9: Provision of forestry specialists for Leskhoz forestry investment	CEP	SFA
2.2.1.10: Kick-off of the Implementation JFM in Protected Area buffer zones	CEP	IFAD
2.2.1.11: Roll-out of the Implementation JFM in Protected Area buffer zones	CEP	GCF
2.2.1.12. Implement Climate Resilient infrastructure investments	MOA[128]	GCF
2.2.1.13. Community Agricultural equipment for productivity improvement	MOA[128]	IFAD
Output 3.1. By end of year 7, 105,600 smallholder livestock farmers receive AI, animal health or training services to increase productivity of their livestock		
Activity 3.1.1. Improving the genetic potential of smallholder farmers' livestock		
3.1.1.1. Training of youth in Artificial Insemination	MOA[128]	IFAD
3.1.1.2. Organization of Artificial Insemination Campaigns	MOA[128]	IFAD
3.1.1.3. Establish Off-Farm Mating stations	MOA[128]	IFAD
Activity 3.1.2. Support to delivery of private animal health services		
3.1.2.1. Institutional support to Tajik Veterinary Association (TVA)	MOA[128]	GCF
3.1.2.2. Training of private veterinarians	MOA[128]	GCF
3.1.2.3. Equipping private veterinarians	MOA[128]	GCF
3.1.2.4. Mobility of private veterinarians	MOA[128]	GCF
Activity: 3.1.3: Support adoption of climate resilient innovative technologies		
3.1.3.1. Promotion of technical climate smart innovations through kick-off demonstrations and exchange visits	MOA[128]	IFAD
3.1.3.2. Promotion of technical climate smart innovations through roll-out demonstrations and exchange visits	MOA[128]	GCF
3.1.3.3. Organization of Exchange visits to promote the use of technical climate smart innovations	FAO	GCF
3.1.3.4. Development of FFS curricula and training of facilitators	FAO	FAO
3.1.3.5: Roll out of FFS	FAO	GCF
Output 3.2. By end of year 4, 9 productive alliances between livestock producers' groups and private aggregators established and operational		
Activity 3.2.1 Identification of market and business opportunities		
3.2.1.1. Kick-off of the identification of the market and business opportunities	MOA[128]	IFAD
3.2.1.2. Rolling-out the Identification of market and business opportunities	MOA[128]	GCF
3.2.1.3. Feasibility studies of proposed business arrangements including Productive Alliances	MOA[128]	IFAD
Activity 3.2.2. Provision of financing and technical support to the business partnerships for selected livestock commodities		
3.2.2.1. Financing of business arrangements including Productive Alliances	MOA[128]	IFAD
3.2.2.2. Technical and business assistance to business arrangements including Productive Alliances	MOA[128]	IFAD
Output 3.3. By end of year 7, 12,400 smallholders have strengthened climate resilient production practices and private sector market linkages		
Activity 3.3.1. Strengthening of CIGs capacity		
3.3.1.1 Support to production/diversification CIGs	MOA[128]	GCF
3.3.1.2: Provision of rooms and halls for meetings, trainings	MOA[128]	MoA
3.3.1.3: Support to market-linked CIGs	MOA[128]	GCF
3.3.1.4: Capacity building on climate smart resilient technologies for Window 1 and 2 beneficiaries	MOA[128]	GCF
Activity 3.3.2. Management of the CIG matching grant program		
3.3.2.1: Matching grant manual developed	MOA[128]	IFAD
3.3.2.2: Involvement of specialists from agricultural departments for matching grants implementation	MOA[128]	MoA
3.3.2.3: Launch of the MGF	MOA[128]	IFAD
3.3.2.4: Launch of the MGF (Window 2)	MOA[128]	IFAD

B.5. Justification for GCF funding request (max. 1000 words, approximately 2 pages)

79. The revised NDC (2021)[131] states that Tajikistan's agriculture is very vulnerable to climate change. Without substantial adaptation measures, food and nutrition security, poverty eradication and sustainable development may be adversely affected. Adaptation measures are of priority both for crop production

(including cereals and leguminous crops, technical crops, vegetables and horticulture and viticulture) and livestock subsectors. Lack of appropriate financing is reducing the potential of the country for effective allocation of own as well as donor resources to climate priorities and to achieve the 'fair and ambitious' objectives set in the NDCs. In addition, the financial system is inadequate to serve the vulnerable agriculture sector and market mechanisms to attract carbon finance are missing.

80. The CASP+ project requires GCF financing as the Government does not have the resources to make investments in many areas that are critical for its long-term development. Tajikistan is the poorest country in Central Asia and confirmed as low-income country (World Bank, 2021).[132] The COVID-19 pandemic had a significant adverse impact on the Tajik economy. Real GDP growth slowed to 4.2 percent in the first nine months of 2020, compared to 7.2 percent a year earlier. Restrictions on labour mobility and economic activity at home and abroad resulted in lower migrant remittances, weaker consumer demand, and reduced investments. The external current account has faced a deterioration due to weak exports and remittances and increased imports and the risk of debt distress for Tajikistan remains high (World Bank/IMF Debt Sustainability Analysis).[133] A growing share of the population reported reducing their food intake and overall consumption to cope with the changed circumstances. To ameliorate the economic fallout, the authorities deferred tax collections, boosted health and social spending, and eased monetary policy. In Tajikistan, gross financing needs were foreseen to increase from 3.8% of GDP in 2019 to 7.7% by the end of 2020.[134] The general reduction of the fiscal capacity of the country has put considerable pressure on the Government which on the one hand is reluctant to take additional loans and on the other hand, needs additional financial support to meet the challenge posed by the pandemic. In this situation, the Government is unable to make much needed investments in areas which are being increasingly threatened by a host of challenges including climate change. The analysis for the updated NDCs has noted the need for climate finance and investments to ensure the transition towards a wide use of sustainable, climate-resilient and low-emission agricultural practices.[135]

81. During 2014–2017, public debt nearly doubled as a share of GDP, from 27.7% to 50.3%, while total external debt (public and private) jumped from 45.4% of GDP to 72.0%—more than twice the average for lower-middle income countries. Bank recapitalization in 2016 and the issuance of a $500 million sovereign Eurobond in 2017 to support the Rogun project were the main reasons for the rise in debt ratios. The latest debt sustainability analysis (2021 Article IV report) by the International Monetary Fund (IMF) highlights that Tajikistan's debt is currently assessed as sustainable, but there is a high risk of debt distress in the context of limited fiscal space. The debt-to-GDP ratio is projected to decline to 40.0 percent by 2026. However, under the baseline, the external debt service-to-exports ratio breaches its threshold at Eurobond payment due dates (2025-27), contributing to a higher external risk rating.

82. Climate change is one of the main challenges to Tajikistan's agricultural development and food security both in the medium and longer term. It is considered one of the key obstacles to achieving the country's strategic objectives as defined in the National Development Strategy for 2016–2030, which includes ensuring food security and access to quality nutrition by 2030. Many models, including IFAD's Climate Adaptation in Rural Development (CARD)[136] assessment tool shows that climate change affects both irrigated and rain-fed systems, and under the pessimistic risk setting shows that all crop yields are projected to decrease (**Annex 2**). Extreme climate events are shown to have negative impacts on managed grasslands, in line with what is already seen in certain areas of the country under high temperature and drought. IFPRI's International Model for Policy Analysis of Agricultural Commodities and Trade (IMPACT)[137] show that yields of major crops will decline significantly and projects an overall negative effect of climate change on the agriculture sector in the country. The model asserts that climate change will be one of the main challenges for food security, leading to increasing risk of hunger, malnourishment, especially among children and other vulnerable groups, and insufficient per capita calorie intake.

83. The threats posed by climate change also impact the natural resource base, particularly the water sector, pastures and forests (**Annex 2**). Chapter 1). Most of the forest and pasture resources are owned by the State. Dekhan farms, agriculture enterprises and state farms and Individuals can obtain use rights (including poor vulnerable communities targeted by the project), however, the regulations on the use of these public goods provide little incentives for the private sector to invest in them. Community members who

use these resources tend to overuse them because of the current production practices and limited other options. This leads to over-grazing and degradation of the pasture resources of the country on which many communities rely. Some Conflicts of interest also emerge between forest and pastureland users as the two are sometimes in competition with each other. The public sector tries to regulate use rights but does not have strong enforcement mechanisms. Markets do not generate an efficient allocation of the forest or pasture resources as property rights are not well defined or fully transferable and do not lead to an efficient allocation of resources. Thus***, the ownership, use and management of these resources represents a failure of governance and the failure of markets to make efficient allocative decisions.*** Given that individual household level and private sector financing is unlikely to be available for investments in the natural resource sectors, it is the public sector that has to take the lead in making investments to secure the natural resource base for sustainable use and protection against climate and other risks. Government support to rural households and producer groups is essential to assist them in adapting to the changing climate conditions and to guide further climate adaptation investments in rural areas.

84. The project envisages the use of both grants and senior loans. The total loan for the project from GCF and IFAD is USD 15.75 million, and the grant amount is USD 61.10 million. ***The loan amount therefore represents 20% of the total financing.*** Alternative funding options are limited due to the high level of debt sustainability stress of the country (IMF, 2023).[138] In agreement with the Government, specifically the indication of the Ministry of Finance and the technical line ministries (CEP, MOA), the loan and grant portion of the external financing from IFAD and GCF are used as follows: **(a) grant-financed portion of the project** is allocated to technical assistance and capacity development, including policy and institutional development, helping communities to defray the costs of planning and implementing climate sensitive community action plans, as well as to subsidize part of the cost of individual investments at the household and group level. These investments are needed to ensure that the community, groups and individuals have the capacity to make these investments; **(b) the senior loan-financed portion of the project** is allocated to part of the investments in implementing the community plans in component 2 (both IFAD and GCF loans) as well as in investments for livelihood strengthening in component 3 (only IFAD loan).

85. ***GCF funds have been able to leverage third party financing from external and internal sources in a ratio of 1:1.04.*** Complementary in-kind co-financing is envisaged from the Government (from MoA, CEP and SFA) and FAO (**Annex 13**). IFAD will be providing the larger co-financing (an amount of 37.85m USD,[139] of which 17 percent loan). The Government co-financing (for about 2.68m USD) represents a commitment to the project's objective and is an indicator of national ownership in achieving the desired paradigm shift. Similarly, rural communities' contributions to the project investments will also be a demonstration of ownership, commitment and their expectation of the benefits in helping them enhance their capacity for adaptation. FAO's envisaged co-financing (in the amount of 0.16 m USD) will cover complementary technical assistance. IFAD co-financing will be managed by the MOA and CEP. The envisaged co-financing from Government and FAO will be directly managed by the agencies providing it. Overall CASP+ co-financing is 51.1% (with IFAD @ 93.0% of total co-financing coming from total country allocations under IFAD11 and IFAD 12 replenishment processes). The design has estimated total project needs, developed the proposal, assessing the funds available from IFAD based upon a system called performance-based allocation system (PBAS) with allocation at country level approved by IFAD Board every three years and the government put together with request for having $39.0m financing from GCF.

86. The high level of concessional financing requested to GCF (including a loan of USD 9 million and a grant of USD 30 million) is motivated by the difficulty of Tajikistan in maintaining its debt sustainability, currently at high distress level (IMF, March 2023)[140] under a reasonable threshold. The level of income and indebtedness is a key factor in determining the level of concession being requested for the country. Under the high risk of debt distress, the major IFIs (World Bank, Asian Development Bank) have been providing the country with grant financing (IFAD has also moved to full concessionality since its IFAD 12 financing cycle, from 2022). ***The overall concessionality leverage for the project after taking into account GCF, IFAD and FAO resources is low at 25% (GCF at 30%; IFAD funds at 21%).***[141] The level of concessionality in this project has been very carefully balanced in order to allow the project to be affordable to the Government of Tajikistan taking into consideration the prevailing socio-economic and climate vulnerability levels (annex 2.1, annex 16), and to allow it to introduce innovative investment for climate resilience (at

community level, in component 2, and through market driven approaches in component 3) that incur additional costs while ensuring the long-term financial sustainability of the investment. ***This is the minimum level of concessionality required to make the investments feasible as these investments have longer repayment period and the recovery period is expected to be much longer than in a business-as usual project.*** The Government does not have the resources to invest in institutional strengthening, capacity building and policy reform or provide the funds needed by vulnerable communities and households for financing climate resilient action plans, infrastructure, assets, equipment and training to help them deal with climate risks. The primary beneficiaries of the grant-financed part of the cost will be vulnerable communities and households impacted by climate change in the selected project districts most vulnerable to climate risks (**Annex 3**) and government institutions striving to assist the country adopt more climate resilient pathways towards sustainable development. Financing will be tailored to cover the additional costs of the investment necessary to make the project viable.

87. The grant elements are being allocated for incremental costs and will not displace any investments that would otherwise have occurred. At the level of the households and common interest groups, the grants will defray part of the household investment and will cover the risk premium required to make the investment viable. ***More than 70% of the funds mobilized for the project will be passed on to vulnerable communities threatened by climate risks and households to diversify their livelihoods.*** Given the nature of community action plans with their public good nature focused on improving management of pastures and forests, and the long gestation period that this entail, with low returns to individual households spread over a much longer period, these investments would simply not be made without the project. The matching grants for investments at the household level in building the individual household assets are a necessary incentive because these households do not have the capital to cover the full cost of the investments. Moreover, the households do not have access to commercial loan financing because of the high cost of borrowing and the collateral and guarantee requirements from the commercial sector or through MFIs, and the general lack of adequate financial services for agriculture and in rural areas.

88. One of Tajikistan's biggest challenges in diversifying its economy has been its inability to increase private investment levels in the country.[142] Domestic credit to the private Sector was reported at 10.6% in 2022.[143] ***There are no alternative funding options for the activities that the project will implement and as such the financing and the concessional level requested are critical to make the investment.*** GCF financing will provide investment support for the most climate vulnerable communities. The private sector is reluctant to invest in the development of pasture or forest resources due to the lack of incentives for them and lack of title to them. **GCF additionality is therefore paramount to a successful result while alternative sources of funding have been considered and not deemed viable**. Private sector investments are limited by the remoteness of the areas targeted by the project, as well as by the inadequacy of the financial system to support the required climate resilience investments needed by rural mountainous communities targeted by the project. Models for public-private producer business plans will be explored to finance business plans jointly submitted by private companies and producers' groups in which they propose to enter in a partnership agreement where both parties take risks, invest and share the benefits. For these Productive Alliances business plans, CASP+ funding will focus on the delivery of public or semi-public goods that will not be funded by the private sector company otherwise, and that will be necessary to fill the financing gap of viable business plans. ***GCF and IFAD funding is justified to address a "market failure" where the perceived high risks and transaction costs of working with small producers are preventing private companies from starting market-based business relationships.*** Thus, private sector financing will be partially secured for complementary investments in enterprises that can support small-holder households and community interest groups aggregate their produce for markets in PP partnerships. Investments in productive alliances with the private sector are envisaged under the project. However, these partnerships are likely to be limited given the nascent stage of development of the private sector.

B.6. Exit strategy (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

89. There are several approaches for ensuring the project exit strategy at various levels. These include (i) undertaking all investments with a counterpart at the national and local level; (ii) emphasis on capacity building of institutions and individuals; (iii) strengthening of policy and regulatory frameworks in a manner that adds to sustainability of natural resource through improved management and governance; (iv)

introduction of modern tools and technologies to strengthen institutional capacity; (v) use of participatory approaches to ensure beneficiary ownership and (v) a clear plan for operation and maintenance of all infrastructure, assets and equipment provided under the project, etc. The approach at the national and local level for the improvements to the enabling environment (component 1), climate sensitive community investments (component 2), and the focus on strengthening and diversifying livelihoods, focusing on key constraints within selected value chains and involving private partners whenever possible aiming at increasing the beneficiaries' return through improved market linkages (component 3).

90. At the national level, all the investments are expected to continue beyond the project period because of the nature of the investments. The project will invest in very specific areas of institutional strengthening for a range of public sector institutions dealing with natural resources such as the Ministry of Economic Development and Trade, the State Forestry Agency, the State Enterprise for Animal Breeding and Artificial Insemination, the Land and Geodesy Department, the Pasture Meliorative Trust (PMT), several national livestock institutions dealing with public animal health and production services. The project is also introducing modern and efficient techniques and technologies such as remote sensing and carbon accounting tools such as the use of Ex-ACT and GLEAM-i that will enhance the capacity of the institutions for managing and monitoring the resources. These institutions are all supported by the public budget and care will be taken to invest in only those activities which either have no implications for increase in their budgets, and where incremental budget is required, a commitment has been secured to increase the annual budget allocations for sustaining the investments beyond the project period. The specific staff members trained in the project are long-term public servants and even though they are not expected to be retained in their current positions for long, they can be expected to contribute within the institution during their service.

91. The expertise for understanding climate risks will be strengthened by supporting research and training of public sector decision-makers and developing academic institutions capacity to train professionals on the subject. The institutions involved like the Tajik Agrarian University, Tajik Academy of Agricultural Science and Forest Research Institute will all be expected to offer upgraded courses as part of their regular curricula, and these courses will continue beyond the project period. By supporting private veterinarians as well as their associations and the gradual shift towards private service provision, the project will contribute to the creation of a sustainable cadre of veterinary services paid for by the private users. This will promote sustainable development of the national veterinary system, ensuring access to adequate services.

92. The project will assist with the review of policy in a participatory and inclusive manner and suggest refinements with regards to pasture use and rehabilitation, joint forest management and livestock related regulatory frameworks. These refinements and regulations will be enacted into the legal framework of the country and implemented through the established agencies responsible for their implementation and enforcement. The policy measures proposed will be selected based on their potential for enhancing the sustainability of the nature resource base. Tajikistan's national development policy framework and its commitments as part of its NDC will further mainstream climate change adaptation into national and sectoral development plans. The GCF Readiness for the NAP is expected to lay the foundation on which the current project will further consolidate ensuring synergy between the two projects that will add to the overall sustainability of investments. At the district level, the capacity of district and Jamoat governments to better appreciate and prepare for climate risk analysis and adaptation in district level planning will be strengthened.

93. At the community level, the strengthening of community institutions particularly the use of the broad base Village Organizations and within that the formation of Pasture User Unions (PUU) that consist of interested households and Joint Forest Management arrangements where required, will enhance the chance of sustaining the investments. Many agencies have been investing in these institutions as well as the Mohallah Committees. There are also plans to identify policy refinements that can make these local institutions more sustainable by providing them powers for generating revenue by collecting user fees through changes in the existing regulation and trying to emulate those in other regional countries of the region like Kyrgyzstan. Furthermore, all investments that are included in the climate sensitive action plans (CsCAPs) will be identified through participation of the local governments, local stakeholders and community members to ensure ownership with a clear plan for operation and maintenance after completion. All investment in physical infrastructure and assets will be provided within the capacity of the local government

or community to operating and maintaining them after hand-over. The experience with previous IFAD projects has shown that communities are generally able to operate and maintain infrastructure investments well beyond project completion. The physical investment on the ground at community level in pasture, forestry, and agriculture productivity gains will generate capacity for the communities to adapt to climate risks and challenges that they currently face and add to the sustainability of their livelihoods.

94. For investments at the household level, the project places strong emphasis on making livelihoods more sustainable through providing matching grants for investments that will be sustained by the households. The environmental sustainability of the investments will be ensured since only green investments that enhance climate resilience will be financed. In addition, the project will have a strong private sector orientation and will work backwards from the markets in trying to identify opportunities in which the private sector is interested. The brokering of productive alliances between the private sector (dairy processors, feed lots of operators, poultry processors) and groups of farmers for increased access to markets will strengthen their linkages. The underlying mutual interest of the smallholder producers and the private sector will ensure the sustainability of the arrangements beyond the project period.

C. FINANCING INFORMATION

C.1. Total financing

(a) Requested GCF funding (i + ii + iii + iv + v + vi + vii)	Total amount	Currency
	39.00	million USD ($)

GCF financial instrument	Amount	Tenor	Grace period	Pricing
(i) Senior loans	9.00	40 years	10 years	0.00 %
(ii) Subordinated loans	0	0 years	0 years	0 %
(iii) Equity	0			0 % equity return
(iv) Guarantees	0	0 years		
(v) Reimbursable grants	0			
(vi) Grants	30.00			
(vii) Results-based payments	Enter amount			

(b) Co-financing information	Total amount	Currency
	40.690370	million USD ($)

Name of institution	Financial instrument	Amount	Currency	Tenor & grace	Pricing	Seniority
IFAD	Grant	31.099000	million USD ($)	7 years N/A years	0%	Options
IFAD	Senior Loans	6.750000	million USD ($)	40 years and 10 years. *Loan principle repayment*: (i) 4.5%from years 11 to 30; and ii)1% from years 31 to 40	Fixed service charge 1.48%	senior
MoA	In kind	0.901370	million USD ($)	7 years N/A years	0%	Options
CEP	In kind	0.890000	million USD ($)	7 years N/A years	0%	Options
SFA	In kind	0.890000	million USD ($)	7 years N/A years	0%	Options
FAO	In kind	0.160000	million USD ($)	7 years N/A years	0%	Options

(c) Total financing (c) = (a)+(b)	Amount	
	79.690370	

(d) Other financing arrangements and contributions (max. 250 words, approximately 0.5 page)	
	IFAD is the Accredited Entity and the main co-financing partner. The Government will be providing in-kind incremental contributions (including dedicated staff, the use of its premises, facilities and equipment), financed by own resources. This will include financing from the Ministry of Agriculture (MoA), the Committee on Environmental Protection (CEP), and the State Forest Agency (SFA). FAO will provide additional co-financing (a dedicated Technical Cooperation Project, TCP) to complement with technical assistance according to its comparative advantages. Project beneficiaries and private sector partners will contribute with parallel financing to activities in which they participate, for an estimated amount of USD 4.6 million. Their contribution is expected to be as follows: (a) Output 2.2: targeted communities will contribute with 5% of all CsCAPs investments, 10% for agricultural equipment investment; (b) Output 3.2: Smallholders producers members of the Productive Alliances will be complemented with 10% of the financing by beneficiaries and 10% by private sector partners; (c) Output 3.3: the members of the Common Interest Groups (CiGs) will provide a contribution of 10% of all matching grants financing under Window 1, and 20% for the matching grants under window 2.

	According to the Financing Agreement signed between IFAD and the Government of Tajikistan on CASP+, the Government will provide counterpart financing in the form of exemption of value added taxes and custom duties related to civil works, goods, equipment and services,[144, 145] for an estimated amount of about USD 15.18 million[146].

C.2. Financing by component

Component	Output	Indicative cost million USD ($)	GCF financing		Co-financing		
			Amount million USD ($)	Financial Instrument	Amount million USD ($)	Financial Instrument	Name of Institutions
Component 1: Strengthening public sector capacity for transformative climate-resilient management of natural resources	Output 1.1. By year 7, capacities of relevant national institutions for climate-resilient natural resources management are strengthened	2.074596	1.373850	Grants	0.700746	Grants	IFAD
	Output 1.2. By year 7, enabling environment for climate adaptive, inclusive and integrated management of pasture, forestry and livestock resources is enhanced	0.409600	0.136600	Grants	0.139000	Grants	IFAD
					0.083600	Grants	FAO
					0.050400	In-kind	SFA
Component 2: Investments in community capacity for adaption and resilience to climate change	Output 2.1. By year 3, 400 Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAP) based on 21 District level Climate Resilience Diagnostics are developed	8.053046	1.095475	Grants	5.581171	Grants	IFAD
					0.372000	In-kind	MoA
					0.610000	In-kind	CEP
					0.394400	In-kind	SFA
	Output 2.2. By year 7, 400 Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAP) implemented in 21 districts benefitting at least 100,000 rural households	46.616093	24.536414	Grants	12.109479	Grants	IFAD
			9.000000	Senior loans	0.525000	Senior loans	IFAD
					0.445200	In-kind	SFA
Component 3: Strengthening livelihoods for enhanced resilience through market-based approaches	Output 3.1. By end of year 7, 105,600 smallholder livestock farmers receive AI, animal health or training services to increase productivity of their livestock	5.424928	1.723508	Grants	3.625020	Grants	IFAD
					0.076400	Grants	FAO
	Output 3.2. By end of year 4, 9 productive alliances between livestock producers' groups and private aggregators established and operational	0.664100	0.090300	Grants	0.573800	Grants	IFAD
	Output 3.3. By end of year 7, 12,400 smallholders have strengthened climate resilient production practices and private sector market linkages	12.684840	0.406300	Grants	5.824700	Grants	IFAD
					6.225000	Senior Loans	IFAD
					0.228840	In-kind	MoA
Project Management Component	Project Management	3.763167	0.637553	Grants	2.545084	Grants	IFAD
					0.280000	In-kind	CEP
					0.300530	In-kind	MoA
Indicative total cost (USD)		79.690370	39.000000		40.690370		

C.3 Capacity building and technology development/transfer (max. 250 words, approximately 0.5 page)

C.3.1 Does GCF funding finance capacity building activities?	Yes ☒ No ☐
C.3.2. Does GCF funding finance technology development/transfer?	Yes ☒ No ☐

95. It is expected that USD 61.5 million of project cost from all sources will be used for capacity building and technology transfer under the CASP+ activities. The total GCF funding amount requested for capacity-building and technology transfers is estimated to be USD 3.3 million and USD 34.2 million, respectively, which is USD 37.5 million or 95% of GCF financing. The capacity building activities include institutional capacity-building; the enhancement of an enabling environment for natural resources; technical knowledge

transfer; capacity-building for the implementation of adaptation, resilience-building and mitigation measures; research and education, training and public awareness, provision of scholarships, study tours.

96. The type of climate technology proposed includes field equipment for adapting to climate risks such as farming machinery, equipping of veterinarians with tool kits, demonstrating new climate adaptive crop varieties, technology for more efficient manure and fodder management, improved production techniques and water efficient techniques and equipment. **Table 3** below identifies the volume of financing in each component that is allocated for capacity building and technology transfer from the GCF funding.

Table 3. Financing for Capacity Building and Technology Transfer from the GCF funding

GCF financing	Total Amount (USD)	Capacity Building USD)	%	Technology Transfer (USD)	%
Component 1	$ 1,510,450	$ 1,116,450	73.9	$ 250,500	16.6
Component 2	$ 34,631,889	$ 788,625	2.2	$ 33,271,414	96.0
Component 3	$ 2,220,108	$ 1,422,908	64.1	$ 681,000	30.6
PMC	$ 637,553	-	-	-	-
Total	$ 39,000,000	$ 3,327,983	8.5	$ 34,202,914	87.7

D. EXPECTED PERFORMANCE AGAINST INVESTMENT CRITERIA

This section refers to the performance of the project/programme against the investment criteria as set out in the GCF's Initial Investment Framework.

D.1. Impact potential (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

97. The project is expected to have an impact on both mitigation and adaptation and lead to reduced emissions and increased resilience. With respect to mitigation, the project is expected to help in a shift to low emission sustainable development pathways. The project will lead to reduced net emissions from land use, reforestation, reduced deforestation, and through sustainable management, conservation and enhancement of forest carbon stocks **or Core Indicator 1 [CI1]**: GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed/sequestered according to the new Integrated Results Management Framework. Overall results show a positive environmental impact due to the implementation of the project's activities, quantified **at a total carbon balance of -6,854,822 tCO_2-eq over 27 years**,[147] or -253,882 tCO_2-eq per year (**Annex 23** – which presents also a disaggregation of greenhouse net incremental sequestration and emission reduction, including for methane[148]). The average GHG sequestration cost is about US$11.68 per tonne of CO2e (or US$5.79 when considering GCF financing). The net incremental contribution to carbon sequestration has been estimated by use of Ex-ACT and GLEAM - i,[149] two FAO-designed carbon accounting tools adapted to land use, land use change and forestry and livestock production systems. The outcome associated with this impact in the GCF Results Management Framework "Improved management of land or forest areas contributing to emissions reductions." The outcome will be measured through tracking the hectares of land or forests under improved and effective management that contributes to CO_2 emission reductions. Specifically, the project will improve the status of 3,650 ha of forests, 6,190 ha under perennial crops and 180,000 ha of improved pasture. The result will be monitored via the georeferenced remote sensing plus ground truthing system developed by the project. Training on the use of carbon accounting tools will be provided to the institutions involved in NRM, to encourage the tracking of the CO_2-eq reduction.

98. The project will have an overall outreach to 2,918,426 individuals including both direct and indirect beneficiaries at the national level, i.e. **Core Indicator 2** in the newly approved Integrated Results Management Framework (IRMF).[150] The project also contributes to **Core Indicator 3**: Value of improved physical assets made more adaptable to the effects of climate change and/or able to reduce GHG emissions, and **Core Indicator 4**: Hectares of natural resource areas brought under improved low-emission and/or climate-resilient management practices.[151] The project is expected to reach an estimated 650,000 individuals or about 100,000 rural households in 21 climate vulnerable districts of the country. The numbers have been calculated to avoid double counting from the direct beneficiaries. It is expected that women will

constitute 51.5% of the total beneficiaries. The proportion of direct households reached corresponds to 7% of the total population of the country and the indirect beneficiaries expected to be reached is 24% of the country population. Specifically, investments at the national, community and household level will help to make the targeted areas much more resilient to climate risks. At the national level, the project will strengthen institutional capacity in order to diversify and support livelihoods. At the community level, the project will invest in a range of infrastructure, assets and equipment that will assist communities in reducing climate risks and increasing their resilience. At the household level, the project will help to diversify livelihoods, remove value chain constraints and build sustainable market linkages in collaboration with the private sector. The increased resilience and reduced vulnerability will be assessed via specific household surveys carried out at project inception, mid-term and project completion.[152]

D.2. Paradigm shift potential (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

99. The proposed activities planned under the project are expected to lead to a paradigm shift in important policy areas, implementation mechanisms and in household-based production decisions. CASP+ is focused on interventions that focus on pastures, livestock, livelihood diversification and the increased role for the private sector. Farm modelling has shown that improving pasture quality and livestock efficiency can improve productivity and lower emission intensity per unit of product.[153] The evaluation reports of previous IFAD investments show that livestock farmers in the treatment group are more likely to use pastures to feed their livestock especially PUU managed pastures compared to the control group and are more likely to follow rotational plans.[154] Furthermore, breeding for improved feed conversion efficiency (lower net feed intake) is likely to reduce methane emissions and the greenhouse gas intensity of animal products. Reducing the number of unproductive animals on a farm can potentially improve profitability and reduce greenhouse gas emissions. If productivity increases through nutritional and breeding strategies, the number of livestock can be reduced without losing the quantity of meat that is currently produced. With more efficient strategies for raising beef cattle, slaughter weights can be reached at a younger age, with reduced lifetime emissions per animal and proportionately fewer animals producing methane.[155]

100. Experience from previous IFAD projects has demonstrated the transformational nature of some of the proposed activities in Tajikistan such as the LPDP-II. Focus on improved animal health and productivity led to increased weight of animals (30%), increased milk productivity (120%) and yet it led to a reduction in the size of their herds by 29%. The impact assessment shows an increase in livestock income associated with rise in the productivity of cattle among LPDP II beneficiaries.[156] This was attributed to meat and milk production. Notably, the average weight of cattle per animal in the treatment group increased by 30 per cent compared to the control group, which is equivalent to around 44 kg per animal. Similarly, cattle kept by households in the treatment group had more total milk production and productivity than households in the control group.[157] The results of the impact assessment also suggest that the project succeeded in enhancing livestock productivity and livestock income partly through increased access to preventive treatment, feeding, housing, and water points. These were all activities promoted by both phases of the project.[158] The current project is also expected to achieve increase in productivity and reduction in livestock herds with significant impact on reduction in GHG emissions. The results of the Gleam-i analysis undertaken for CASP+ shows that emissions intensity of all systems are likely to reduce by 12% in the With Project (WP) scenario compared to the Without Project (WOP) scenario and the baseline.[159] This reduction is likely even if the reduction in herd size in evidence in LPDP-II is not realized.

101. CASP+ is expected to assist in diversifying rural livelihoods which is a slow process given that Tajikistan's transition from a centrally planned to a market economy after the dissolution of the Soviet Union in 1991 has been one of the slowest among the Commonwealth of Independent States countries. Private investment was estimated at 5% of GDP in 2013, one of the lowest levels in the world that limits economic growth and job creation.[160] Family incomes today are strongly dependent on a single source, with 50–70% deriving from agriculture. The risks associated with this income strategy can be reduced through diversification of income sources, which requires strengthening nonfarm occupations, wage employment, and entrepreneurial activities.[161] CASP+ is expected to diversify rural livelihoods through its provision of matching grants, establishment of CIGs and building links with the private sector along key value chains.

D

The project will strengthen links with the private sector engaged in the food production system especially those enterprises which are involved in dairy and meat production.

102. The recent analysis of the agriculture sector for the update of the NDCs noted that adaptation and mitigation were not currently explicitly integrated into agriculture sector planning in Tajikistan.[162] The project is designed to integrate climate change risks, vulnerabilities and adaptation measures in state policies and programmes at the national and local level to target resources to regions and production systems where they are most relevant. At the national level, the project will assist investment plans adopt a green economy orientation in close collaboration with MEDT, CEP, MoA, SFA and other national level institutions. At the district level, the project will help in the incorporation of climate vulnerabilities in development planning by promoting an approach that focus on catchments and protecting downstream areas through a range of green investments such as shelterbelt plantations, riverbank protection, use of protective gabions, improved pasture governance, increasing bio-diversity and plantation of forest trees and orchards and more efficient use of technologies, etc. Some of the more important investments that are expected to lead to a paradigm shift have been identified below. Each of these is expected to make an overall contribution to the climate-resilient development pathways which are consistent with the national climate change adaptation strategies and plans being developed by the Government.

103. Some of the key measures for improving the country capacity for transformative in adaptation include the following: (i) introducing climate risk awareness and analysis as a part of the curriculum of academic and public administration agencies that will lead to long-term expertise and facilitate the incorporation of climate risk assessment in allocative, design and planning decisions in key sectors by experts and in the public sector; (ii) introducing a green economy orientation, including potential to introduce carbon markets, in investment planning through technical capacity building of MEDT and other national level institutions; (iii) improve institutional collaboration and facilitate interaction and decision making between the agencies through policy and knowledge sharing platforms; (iv) use of improved technology for decision-making such as surveillance and remote sensing of pastures and forest management; (v) shift livestock production to more productive pathways and encourage reduction in low productivity animals and retain only more efficient livestock and to help farmers embark on a low emissions trajectory; (vi) strengthen the provision of private veterinary services to assist smallholders enhance access to services to reduce livestock morbidity and mortality; (vii) establish and strengthen pasture user unions for improved pasture governance and introduction of more sustainable patterns of management through levying user fees, rotational grazing and closures, etc.; (viii) applying participatory management models of joint forest management that entail leasing forest land to slow down the rate of forest degradation and promote the rehabilitation of existing forests;[163] (ix) shift away from the centralized system of resource allocation and scale up the participatory community approach which entails mobilization of local communities and identification by them of their priority needs with respect to climate sensitive actions to build resilience and ensuring ownership; (x) linking private sector with financial instruments suitable to finance the required climate-sensitive equipment, technologies and innovations.

104. At the household level, the project will also instil a paradigm shift in agriculture production practices by assisting with investments in improving irrigation practices; water efficient irrigation technologies; planting high yielding and drought and pest resilient plant varieties; promoting suitable crop rotations and intercropping; soil management measures (e.g., cover crops); promoting agroforestry in croplands and pastures, use of shelterbelts and river bank protection. For livestock production, the priority measures that will be encouraged will include improved pasture management, improving animal health breeds and feeding of dairy cattle, and improved market linkages. The project will focus on strengthening links with the private sector. Typically, farmers tend to first produce and then look for markets which is not an effective or efficient strategy particularly for small vulnerable households dealing with the added pressures of climate change which adds another dimension of risk to their livelihoods. A key paradigm shift that will be facilitated will be to work backwards from the market by forming productive alliances with the private sector and understanding the market demand and to make production decisions based on the volumes and specifications of the produce demanded.

105. The current project will have the potential for scalability, replicability and generating co-benefits through the combined impact of its investments at the national, district and household level and through facilitating interaction and alliances with the private sector which will sustain beyond the project period. The centrality of the District Climate Diagnostics to define priority interventions with the communities represents a change in paradigm for the planning at district and river basin level, and with the growing importance given by the Government to watershed management it has a potential repercussion also for planning at watershed level. The analyses carried out at design stage assessed that the project will have a medium to high impact on the degree to which it can influence replication, scaling up and generating co-benefits and the participation of women. The proposal provides for assessments of the extent to which the project could lead towards the paradigm shift and sustainable development potential. This assessment will be undertaken twice during its lifespan by applying the three assessment dimensions of scalability, replicability, and co-benefits.

D.3. Sustainable development (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

106. While the main justification for the investments selected under the project is on the basis of their potential for mitigation and adaptation to climate change, the investments are expected to contribute to several Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) namely **SDG 1** (no poverty), **SDG 2** (zero hunger), **SDG 5** (gender equality), **SDG 8** (economic growth), **SDG 13** (Climate action), **SDG 15** (life on land) and **SDG 17** (partnerships). An estimation of the impact in terms of environmental, social and economic co-benefits and gender sensitive development impact of the project is outlined below;

107. **Environmental co-benefits.** The main environmental benefit of the project is expected to be from carbon sequestration as a result of the project investments on rangelands and forestry and reduced CO_2 emissions due to improved animal husbandry practices that help to improve animal diets and digestibility and increase their productivity. Also, Improved animal health service provision will lead to improved resilience to climate shocks and improved animal health and diets will in turn reduce GHG emissions from enteric fermentation (FAO, 2022).[164] However, additional environmental co-benefits are expected in terms of increase in biodiversity in pastures and forest areas. The degradation of pastures is threatening biodiversity of adjacent ecosystems. The project will help to strengthen pasture management through working closely with Village Organizations and Pasture User Unions which are expected to prepare pasture management plans, joint forest management plans and direct forest plantations and orchards, shelterbelts, etc. The temporary closure of pastures is expected to lead to their regeneration and increase plant diversity and foster nectar for pollinators and beneficial insects.[165] The National Biodiversity and Biosafety Centre (NBBC) in Tajikistan is responsible for biological diversity in the country and it will be a key stakeholder in helping to protect threatened species in the pastures and forests. Joint Forest management also performs an essential function in regulating the water balance, improving slope stability and providing protection against soil erosion. At the farm level, the project will introduce crop and livestock production practices through farmer field schools that result in additional co-benefits such as improving soil fertility, increase in water retention, improved pollination potential, and landscape restoration, etc.

108. CASP+ is piloting the new biodiversity assessment tool developed by FAO called B-INTACT[166]. A preliminary analysis based on a number of assumptions has been undertaken on four watersheds in Rudaki, Mastchoh, Sh. Shohin and Dangara to assess the impact the project interventions will have on biodiversity. As information on specific land use changes resulting from project interventions become available, the analysis will be updated and refined. During project implementation, B-INTACT can be used as a participatory decision-making tool to identify areas where the positive impact on biodiversity would be greatest. Overall, the preliminary analysis has shown that the impact on biodiversity in the four watersheds identified is positive with the level of biodiversity intactness increasing in all case studies. Detailed results are presented in the Annex 16.

109. **Social co-benefits:** There are several social co-benefits expected from the project as a result of the participatory village based approach that will be adopted and the strengthening of Pasture User Unions and joint forest management committees. The facilitation of local people in resolving land use conflicts and managing the pastures and forests sustainably in pilot districts where this approach has been implemented by GIZ earlier has shown that it has helped to slow the rate of forest degradation and promote the

rehabilitation of existing forests. Communities were also encouraged to work out agreements designed to prevent conflicts of interest between forest and pastureland users.[167] Another social benefit that the project may generate on account of enhanced climate resilience is reduction in migration. A study in the project area in the country found that international migration was the most common strategy adopted by households to cope with shocks and climate risks. Remittances account for 43% of Tajikistan's GDP. Half of households who experienced a wage reduction or job loss resorted to migration as a coping strategy. Migration was also most frequent in response to economic shocks and loss of assets through livestock disease. More than a third of drought events triggered migration by at least one household member in the project area.[168] While migration has many positive economic impacts some of its negative impacts include difficulties for women in managing the household work and in child rearing in the absence of fathers and the impact on children's education and the negative effects of labour migration on expanding child labour in the Tajik society, particularly in early ages and, negative psychological effects of labour migration on migrants' wives.[169] Thus, a positive social co-benefit of investments that make livelihoods more sustainable and resilient would be the avoidance of the negative effects of labour migration on family cohesion and psych-sociological well-being and the reduction of burden it places on women and its positive impact on education and child labour.

110. **Economic-Co-benefits:** While the project will generate direct economic benefits from many of the activities that it will finance in order to enhance the resilience of communities and households to climate risks, it is also expected to generate economic co-benefits as a result of many of its activities in the implementation of Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAPs) and the support that will be provided to farming households in making the farming practices more resilient through FFS, provision of modern technology, assets and the links with the private sector. There are several ways in which the project is expected to generate economic co-benefits through the multiplier affects it will generate. With the twofold approach envisaged in component 3 of strengthening the link between rural producers form the project area (organized in CIGs) and private entrepreneurs and linking the latter with existing supply of financial instruments[170] the project will also contribute to increase financial inclusion as well as the enabling environment.[171] In addition, the infrastructure investments and the mechanization will lead to use of these services for a range of productive purposes. The construction of the schemes and the operation and maintenance the equipment provided will generate jobs for the young people. It is estimated that the labour generated from infrastructure investments will lead to an increase in over 2,100 full-time equivalent jobs[172] and that the forest plantations will lead to an additional 2,280 jobs (Annex 2). The management and protection of forests is likely to increase access to a range of timber products and non-timber products such as fodder, tree seedlings, medicinal plants, fruit and nuts which can be sold locally and may also open up opportunities for eco-tourism. The approach of the project to enhance links with the private sector in the provision of inputs and technologies for building climate adaptive practices and for increased off-take of farm produce will lead to strengthening the overall farm orientation for commercial production. It will build productive alliances with the private sector and contribute to reduction in wastage especially of perishable produce particularly dairy and fruits and vegetables that is likely to extend beyond the value chains that the project will be directly engaged in.

111. **Gender Sensitive Development Impact:** CASP+ builds on a number of lessons and evidence accrued in the various IFAD-financed projects in the country, including on the improved livelihoods and role of women in their communities and institutions. Similar approaches in the country (Annex 18e) have shown significant improvements for women headed households' agricultural income (from crop, milk, value of livestock sales). Overall, CASP+ includes several provisions to address the relevant gender-based barriers detected in the gender assessment (**Annex 8**), such as insufficient leadership/ participation in policy, access to resources, to financial / non-financial services and economic opportunities. Indicators at output level for each component measure access to products and services with disaggregation by sex and respective targets. Project's outcome surveys will measure behavioural changes at higher result level. Specifically, CASP+ has placed significant emphasis on women inclusion, including at community level, to improve women empowerment and their participation in institutions decision making processes. The activities supported under the project will address the needs of women to correct prevailing inequalities in climate change vulnerability and risks. One of the key challenges that women face is because migration has become an adaptation strategy for many, as 30 to 40 percent of households in Tajikistan have at least one member working abroad.[173] This leaves women facing additional challenges, including dealing with a disproportionate

burden of the adverse impacts of disasters such as increasing drought and floods on their households and communities. In order to redress this, the project will prioritize technical support to women by developing gender-sensitive training and extension services which would better prepare their households to manage risks from drought, floods and other hazards. Women's participation in the dialogues to identify the priorities of the CsCAPs and the joint forest management plans will be ensured. The project will encourage the access for women to improved natural resources (forests and rangelands) to ensure equitable distribution of benefits such as processing and marketing of non-wood forest products. Special quotas will be fixed for women and youth for their inclusion in project activities. Assessment of impact of similar IFAD's projects in the country[174] confirms that woman and women headed households can benefit from community action plans investment (grounding the CsCAPs), in terms of livestock-related income as well as participation in the decision-making process at village and Pasture User Union Level. CASP+ target for women inclusion is not only limited to the women share of beneficiaries target (40%) but also on the governance of the CsCAPs. Moreover, quantitative and qualitative analysis of past IFAD experience showed also positive results of Community Action Plan's on children school attendance.[175] In project implementation, particular attention will be paid to promote women and youth engagement in business opportunities in the project supported value chains (**Annex 8**).

D.4. Needs of recipient (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

112. Tajikistan is a transition country with a per-capita gross national income oscillating between low-income and lower-middle-income. It is one of the poorest countries in Central Asia (confirmed for the recent years as low-middle income country – WB, 2021) and one of the highest ranked among the countries of Europe and Central Asia in terms of the of vulnerability to climate change, being a particularly sensitive country due to its low adaptive capacity.[176] Climate-induced extreme weather events recurrently destroy land, crops, infrastructures, and livelihoods. Agriculture is the second largest sector of the economy, accounting for 19% of the country's GDP and 51% of its employment in 2018.[177] Of the permanent cropland, only 68% is irrigated which makes Tajikistan the Central Asian country with the lowest irrigated land to population ratio.[178] Cotton, the country's most important cash crop, as well as other primary agricultural products such as fruits and vegetables are all water-intensive crops. This situation partially accounts for Tajikistan's high susceptibility to the effects of climate change. This vulnerability is further enhanced as remittances, primarily from migrants working in Russia, accounted for approximately 31% of Tajikistan's GDP in 2018.[179] These remittances make Tajikistan one of the countries most economically dependent on external factors and vulnerable to global market fluctuations. Another factor which makes Tajikistan vulnerable is its dependence on hydropower for energy generation which is also vulnerable to climatic and hydrologic variability and the effects of climate change. Extreme weather and climate risks in Tajikistan have led to frequent damages to houses, roads, bridges, riverbank enforcement structures, and other infrastructure such as irrigation channels and electric lines. A study from 2019 identified mudflows, droughts, high temperatures, and strong winds as main climate-related risks that cause damages and losses to many types of infrastructure.[180] It is estimated that the cost of environmental degradation and climate change will reduce the GDP per capita by up to 15% by 2100.[181]

113. Tajikistan is the poorest countries in Central Asia, and has a low private sector presence. According to World Bank and Asian Development Bank analyses, public investment has been the principal form of capital formation, as the share of private investment has been extremely low. Private investment is estimated to have averaged only about 4% of GDP since 2000, well below the 21% of GDP average for the Commonwealth of Independent States during this period. This partly reflects the private sector's small share of economic activity as state-owned enterprises, accounting for about 17% of GDP and employing about 24% of the labour force as of 2018, dominate many economic sectors (IMF, 2021)[182]. The presence of a formal private sector is limited in the remote mountainous areas targeted by the project, while private and community institutions are active. The entry point of the project are Village Organizations and other member based organizations such as Pasture Users Unions that pre-exist and facilitate the outreach to reach climate vulnerable population with appropriate instruments. The financial system has a limited penetration in the project areas. Active IFIs such as ADB have recently integrated in the country strategy the need to enhance financial system in the country[183], and to bring a wide set of reforms to "enhance resource allocation and mobilization, improving labour productivity through human capital development, and fostering better

livelihoods by investing in the land-linked economy".[184] In order to strengthen the link between project stakeholders and financial service providers, the project will work through common interest groups, facilitating liaisons with existing climate-sensitive credit lines. This represents a promising innovation to ensure the progressive commercialization of on- and off-farm rural economic activities in the target areas.

114. Tajikistan's relatively low level of socio-economic development, its inadequate infrastructure, as well as its high dependency on climate-sensitive sectors make the country extremely vulnerable to the risks associated with climate change and related climate-induced extreme weather events. Climate change, environment shocks and stressors affect the agriculture sector and the rural poor who have limited resources and capacities to adapt. It is estimated that by 2050, the population living in climatically vulnerable areas will increase by 77%, and that some parts of Tajikistan may experience a fall in agricultural yields by 30% by the end of this century[185] (**Annex 2.1**). The Climate Adaptation in Rural Development (CARD)[186] tool predicts that without irrigation, yields are more volatile and rely entirely on climatic variability and hazards. Climate change affects both systems - with and without irrigation - and under the pessimistic risk setting all crops' yield are projected to decrease. The main factors for decreasing yields are expected to include reduced runoff during the critical growing season and heat stress negatively impacting yields of key crops like wheat. There is an accelerated rate of soil erosion caused by extreme weather events, deteriorating water availability and quality due to increasing glacial melt and the loss of biodiversity, among other factors. The increasing frequency and intensity of extreme weather events, as well as the change in the hydrological cycle, is leading to land degradation, erosion of fertile top soil and reducing agro-pastoral productivity which impacts the food and nutrition security[187] and contributes to biodiversity loss.

115. The climate change vulnerability analyses suggest higher adaptation needs in rural mountainous area, with predominance of agroforestry and livestock related livelihoods.[188,189] Livestock is being impacted, through increasing pressure on pastures which are already subject to overgrazing and degradation as well as by effects on animal productivity from higher temperatures and increased livestock morbidity and mortality. Rather than reduce herd size, farmers tend to increase herd size of low quality animals in order to diversify their risk. In order to adapt to the increasing challenges, rural communities require support for a more sustainable use of their pasture and forests on which there is significant reliance. The higher temperatures combined with higher levels of flood-related water contamination are projected to also impact human health and increase the incidence of infectious disease outbreaks and increase the risks of water and foodborne diseases such as gastrointestinal infections. At the same time, the country's health care infrastructure is in a precarious state and unable to deal with these growing threats.

116. The ongoing conflict between Russia and Ukraine is expected to have consequences on Tajik economy, especially for the poorest segments of the rural and urban populations. This impact is even stronger as compounding to the recessional effects of the covid-19 pandemic. The restricted access to grain (wheat in particular) and fertilizers is expected to have a negative impact on the indebted economy of Tajikistan[190], [191]. In such context, CASP+ approach will not have the potential to restore the economic disruption nor the negative impact on purchasing power over food. Nonetheless, through its investment, it has a significant potential to absorb major negative impacts due to its investment in rural livelihoods, especially agriculture ones, and with smallholder farmers. The highest share of project investment is directed to support climate resilience in remote rural communities targeted by the project. These areas have been often origin of migration (especially male and youth). Such investments will allow to enhance the economic activities and absorb the expected increased labour supply deriving from the return if migrant workers. Specific interventions such as the support to Common Interest Groups (CIGs) is expected to generate a positive spin to the economy.

117. **Economic and social development level of the country and the affected population**. Over the past decade, Tajikistan has made steady progress in reducing poverty and growing its economy. Between 2000 and 2022, the poverty rate fell from 83 percent of the population to 22.5 percent (World Bank), while the economy grew at an average rate of 7 percent per year. There is substantial spatial and seasonal variation in poverty. Most rural areas are poorer than urban ones, and poverty and income insecurity are higher during winter and spring.[192] The poor are concentrated in rural areas (81%) with some areas showing

much higher rates than others. Non-monetary poverty indicators in rural areas remain high, and, only 36 percent of the population in rural regions has access to safe drinking water.[193] While the official literacy rate in Tajikistan is 98%, the poor quality of education since 1991 has reduced the skill level of younger people. Although education is compulsory, many children fail to attend because of economic needs and security concerns in some regions. Even those who have graduated find it difficult to secure employment. The rate of job creation has not kept pace with the growing population. A large number of people have to seek employment outside the country, leaving the economy vulnerable to external shocks. The private sector's role in the economy remains limited, contributing to only 13 percent of formal employment and 15 percent of total investments.

118. **Absence of alternative sources of financing.** The Government does not have the resources to make investments in many areas that are critical for its long-term development. In addition, the fiscal space of the country is limited, and IFIs already investing in rural areas are addressing rural development and related infrastructure, but none is addressing the climate vulnerability of mountainous rural population. GCF financing represents a unique opportunity to complement to any other external (or domestic) financing to address climate-vulnerable rural communities in mountainous areas. The COVID-19 pandemic has had a significant adverse impact on the Tajik economy. Real GDP growth slowed to 4.2 percent in the first nine months of 2020, compared to 7.2 percent a year earlier. The external current account has faced a deterioration due to weak exports and remittances and increased imports and the risk of debt distress for Tajikistan remains high.[194] A growing share of the population reported reducing their food intake and overall consumption in order to cope with the changed circumstances. In an effort to ameliorate the economic fallout, the authorities deferred tax collections, boosted health and social spending, and eased monetary policy. In Tajikistan, gross financing needs are expected to increase from 3.8% of GDP in 2019 to 7.7% by the end of 2020.[195] The general reduction of the fiscal capacity of the country has put considerable pressure on the Government which is, on the one hand, reluctant to take additional loans and on the other hand, needs additional financial support to meet the challenge posed by the pandemic. In this situation, the Government is unable to make much needed investments in areas which are being increasingly threatened by a host of challenges including climate change. In addition, the major IFIs (and since 2022 also IFAD) are providing the country with grant financing only, including ADB and the World Bank (the latter financing the RESILAND project which targets rural population with similar profile to CASP+).

119. The public debt nearly doubled as a share of GDP, from 27.7% to 50.3%, while total external debt (public and private) jumped from 45.4% of GDP to 72.0%—more than twice the average for lower-middle income countries. Bank recapitalization in 2016 and the issuance of a $500 million sovereign Eurobond in 2017 to support the Rogun project were the main reasons for the rise in debt ratios. The latest debt sustainability analysis (2023 Article IV report) by the International Monetary Fund (IMF) highlights that Tajikistan's debt is currently assessed as sustainable, but there is a high risk of debt distress in the context of limited fiscal space. The debt-to-GDP ratio is projected to decline to 40.0 percent by 2026. However, under the baseline, the external debt service-to-exports ratio breaches its threshold at Eurobond payment due dates (2025-27), contributing to a higher external risk rating. This highlights also the reason for a higher grant over loan financing, to face debt distress risks as well as to ensure feasibility of the required investment, typically long payback periods.

120. **Need for strengthening institutions and implementation capacity.** Tajikistan still lacks an efficient climate-related policy and a legal framework that could incentivise authorities to pursue climate adaptation-related initiatives. In addition, as part of the development of the National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy, a capacity assessment was conducted, which identified the following challenges: i) limited awareness of adaptation benefits among the public and experts; ii) insufficient institutional flexibility and technical capacity of sector experts to implement innovative adaptation projects and programmes; iii) limited sectoral access and institutional capacity to collect, process and disseminate hydrological and meteorological data and information; iv) limited knowledge and skills of government employees who work on climate change issues; and v) limited national funding to implement and monitor adaptation projects and programmes.[196] The GoT has received assistance from UNDP and has developed an initial roadmap of the NAP process which is being supported by a GCF Readiness grant. This project is helping to strengthen some of the institutions at the national level for enhanced coordination for the management of natural

resources. In addition, the current CASP+ is also designed to further strengthen the coordination among institutions at the national and district level as well as identify areas for policy refinement and build the technical capacity for understanding and planning for adaptation to climate risks and implementing mitigation measures and green economy initiatives. There is also a need to strengthen the capacity of district and Jamoat governments to better integrate climate vulnerability into their development planning.

121. The above elements require a steady process of inclusive involvement, engagement, monitoring and learning that reaches its highest potential with a continuous and long lasting accompaniment. In addition, some of the project specific investment, e.g., joint forest management as element to involve private sector on mechanisms that restore ecosystem resilience to climate change, require time and have a typical long-term path to unfold their full potential (see **Annex 5** and **Annex 21**).

D.5. Country ownership (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

Existing national climate strategy

122. Tajikistan has been active in submitting in submitting its Intended National Determined Contributions (INDC), following the 2015 Paris Agreement,[197] and has submitted in 2021 the updated NDC. The country has submitted three National Communications under the UNFCCC in 2002, 2008 and in 2014. The fourth National Communication is under development. The preparatory documents include inventories of greenhouse gas emissions and sinks, a vulnerability analysis of ecosystems and the economy, preliminary adaptation recommendations, and mitigation analysis. The National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy (NCCAS),[198] which was approved in October 2019 by Tajikistan's cabinet, articulates the country's vision over the next decade for adaptation and developing projects that address the country's adaptation needs. Tajikistan's NCCAS highlight's agriculture, water, energy, and transport as priority areas for implementing adaptation practices in light of climate change. The Government of the Republic of Tajikistan is also finalising an update of its 2010 National Strategy on Disaster Risk Management (NDSRR). This document voices the government's need to align climate change adaptation with its disaster risk reduction and management policies. The government is in the process of developing a National Adaptation Plan (NAP) with UNDP assistance with GCF readiness support to complete the NAP.

Ongoing and upcoming Climate Finance projects in the country (including GCF, GEF, IFIs)

123. CASP+ presents a number of synergies with existing climate finance portfolio in the country. in this context, CASP+ addresses a specific segment of climate vulnerability, notably rural mountainous communities (as shown in **Annex 2.1** and **Annex 16**, both on climate scenarios), largely suffering from lack of funding by major donors and by the government. Here below a summary of the major relevant interventions, while detailed information is provided in **Annex 27** (Synergies with Climate Finance in Tajikistan).

124. ***Synergies with GCF portfolio***. There are currently five approved GCF funded projects under implementation in Tajikistan as well as three relevant readiness grants approved – including one for strengthening the NDA, one for developing a NAP and a recently approved on to support the country capacity to access and deploy climate finance - and several international Accredited Entities active in the country. CASP+ has been designed in close coordination with all institutions implementing the GCF-funded projects. Detailed information on CASP+ complements to these interventions is provided in Annex 27. Synergies with Climate Finance in Tajikistan. Here below a short summary of all relevant ongoing investment.

- FP014, "*Climate Adaptation and Mitigation Program For the Aral Sea Basin (CAMP4ASB)*" a World Bank Group programme active in Uzbekistan and Tajikistan, targeting the poorest and most climate-vulnerable rural communities.
- FP025, "*GCF-EBRD Sustainable Energy and Climate Resilience Financing Facility (SEFF)*", a cross-cutting multi-country program providing credit lines to local Partner Financial Institutions (PFIs) in 13 countries across Southern and Eastern Europe, the Middle East and North Africa, Western Asia, and Central Asia. This programme will support MSMEs investment, with special focus on companies and households' energy efficiency and renewable energy.

- FP040, titled "*Scaling Up Hydropower Sector Climate Resilience*", is an EBRD adaptation project supporting to cope with new climate conditions, including increased severe floodings.
- FP067, titled "*Building climate resilience of vulnerable and food insecure communities through capacity strengthening and livelihood diversification in mountainous regions of Tajikistan*" is an adaptation project focused on food insecurity run by WFP. The project will focus on the most vulnerable and food insecure communities in the Rasht valley, Khatlon and Gorno-Badakhshan Autonomous Region (GBAO) regions.
- FP075, titled "*Institutional Development of the State Agency for Hydrometeorology of Tajikistan*", a programme implemented by ADB to support capacity building and development of hydrological and meteorological data and information in Tajikistan.

125. ***Synergies with GEF portfolio***. Key asset for CASP+ is the pivotal role played by the CEP as NDA as well as Executing Entity. CEP is currently supervising and implementing projects co-financed by GEF, including: **a.** under **GEF 7** regional "*Integrated natural resources management in drought-prone and salt-affected agricultural production landscapes in Central Asia and Turkey (CACILM-II)*" (the central role of CEP and FAO in this project (both CASP+ EE) is an asset to generate synergies and build on CACILM-II results in Tajikistan), and **b.** under **GEF 8** allocation, IFAD is currently developing the *"Tajikistan Ecosystem Restoration and Resilient Agriculture (TERRA)"*, expected to contribute to the NDCs in line with the ones of CASP+, specifically on climate resilience diagnostics (CASP+ output 2.1), and the community climate resilience investment (output 2.2). Detailed information on CASP+ complements to these interventions is provided in **Annex 27**.

126. ***Synergies with other IFIs' portfolios***. The World Bank and ADB are implementing and planning additional climate finance projects (additional details in **Annex 27**). These include: **ADB**'s "*Resilient Livelihoods and Empowerment of Rural Women Project"*[199], aiming to increase resilience and improve livelihoods of rural women in the Khatlon province; "*Enhancing climate resilience in the Pyanj River Basin",* aimed to support job creation and entrepreneurship for women in the agriculture sector. Coordination will be ensured to avoid overlapping at village level, and to create synergies with similar activities envisaged in CASP+ component 3. **the World Bank**'s *Resilient Landscape Restoration Project –RESILAND* (2022-2027, US$ 45.0m), aiming to sustainable landscape management, and *"Tajikistan Strengthening Water and Irrigation Management"* (2022-2027, US$ US$ 47.3m), on water resources planning and irrigation management . In addition to the above, **IFAD**-funded projects such as "*Livestock and Pasture Development Programme – phase II"* in particular (2017-2024, US$40.6m), showed how community investment and improvement in livestock breeds, feed and husbandry practices jointly with pasture improvement can lead to increased income (+15 percent), improved rangeland (through improved infrastructure and rotational grazing), and reduced the livestock inventories (-29 percent).[200]

127. For all climate finance interventions, **the coordination at country level** through the NDA and the other CASP+ executing entities will ensure synergies and complementarities. Moreover, the village selection criteria of CASP+ (detailed in **Annex 21**, CASP+ Project implementation manual) include complementarity with other financed interventions, and this principle applies also to ADB and World Bank, as well as other development partners.

Alignment with existing policies such as NDCs, NAMAs, and NAPs

128. The current project is aligned with the existing policies and priorities of the country given that the GoT prioritises of reducing the country's vulnerability to climate change via adaptation and increased resilience. The NDC (2021)[201] identifies agriculture and forestry among the vehicles to ensure a progressive reduction of climate change vulnerability as well as to enhance the carbon sequestration potential of the country, and soil protection, grazing management, and tree plantation as needed investments for adaptation and disaster risk reduction. Tajikistan has developed a National Development Strategy, which defines socio-economic development priorities for the country until 2030. This strategy integrates climate change needs, disaster risk reduction, and social inclusiveness, specifically focusing on gender-based development. CEP has also prepared a Country Programme for the GCF (2019 – 2021)[202] in order to define short-term and long-term investment priorities for the GCF in Tajikistan. There are five Strategic Pillars defined by the Country Programme where GCF investments are needed: I) Agriculture and Forests; II) Transport; III)

Energy; IV) Water resources; V) Cross-sectoral areas of activity (Education, Public Health Services, and Migration). CASP+ focuses on the first pillar and indirectly on the water resources. The project will focus on the pasture and forestry sectors where development has lagged behind. While the country has a pasture law, it needs assistance in building technical capacity at the national level for green investments, enhanced adaptation policy and planning, improved capacity for disaster risk reduction and improved pasture and forestry development and management. The Government is committed to forest renewal, conservation and sustainable management, contributing to climate change mitigation. However, while there is an up-to-date forestry legislation it is not being implemented because of lack of capacity and financial resources. Its other objectives are to maintain biodiversity, improve the livelihoods of local people and leverage public and private finance.

129. CASP+ investments provide incentives for the government to take action and implement a range of policies and strategies designed to reform and strengthen natural resource management. Responding to country and stakeholders needs, **CASP+ builds on successful ongoing and past practices** and is designed to mobilize climate finance (GCF and IFAD) to **address the national climate change adaptation and mitigation goals** in line with the national commitments and strategic framework on climate change, natural resources management, disaster risk reduction and SDGs.[203] Besides supporting the **Intended Nationally Determined Contribution**,[204] the **National Disaster Risk Reduction Strategy** (2019-2030), and the **National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy 2030,** the project will contribute to operationalize and strengthen the execution of key government priorities outlined below.

- The **National Development Strategy 2015-2030**, in its efforts jointly with the **Mid-Term Development** Programme **(2016-2020)** to promote increased access to resources and ensuring rational and sustainable use of agricultural land and water. With technical support from FAO, MoA has recently formulated the **National Agricultural Investment Plan (NIP) for Sustainable Agriculture Development and Food Security 2021-2030.** The NIP defines investment priorities for public and development partners, as well as measures to unlock private sector investments for food and nutrition security and sustainable agriculture. These include investments in forestry, pasture, livestock intensification.
- The **Water Sector Reform Programme (2016-2025)**. Building on the ongoing efforts of the relevant national, basin and sub-basin level institutions,[205] CASP+ will support the adoption of the principles of Integrated Water Resources Management (IWRM),[206] which take into account social, economic and environmental interests through sustainable and balanced management and development of water resources.
- The **Strategy for the Development of the Forestry Sector (2016-2030)**, currently under final revision, outlines efforts for sustainable forest management and integrated development of the forest sector via afforestation and reforestation,[207] together with measures to limit pressures associated with unsustainable livestock grazing. CASP+ will provide support in enhancing natural forest regeneration potential.
- The **Comprehensive Program for the Development of the Livestock Sector (2018-2022), in its efforts to promote** pasture improvement, productivity enhancement and rational use of pastures as key factors identified for improving the livestock sector,[208] and essential to contribute to the country's food security due to the importance of pasture for livestock feeding. In the same domain, CASP+ is also relevant to the **Pasture Development Programme (2016-2020** – ongoing). This Programme aims at supporting the rolling out of the institutional mechanisms of the Pasture Law regarding the Pasture User Unions (PUUs), Pasture Commissions and Pasture Management Plans.

Capacity of Accredited Entities or Executing Entities to deliver

130. **IFAD**, the AE for the project has global experience in designing and supervising rural development investments and is mainstreaming climate change throughout its portfolio. IFAD has considerable experience in Tajikistan in designing and supervising investments in rural areas. The Fund has invested in four projects in the country valued at USD 180 million. These include the Khatlon Livelihoods Support Project (KLSP, USD 12.3m), the Livestock and Pasture Development Project (LPDP -I, USD 15.8m, LPDP-II, USD 24.2m) and the Community-Based Agriculture Support Programme (CASP, USD 39.3m). IFAD has

been entrusted to manage the climate funds of a large number of agencies such as the Adaptation for Smallholder Agriculture Programme (ASAP), the Global Environmental Facility (GEF) and GCF. ASAP is the largest global climate adaptation programme for smallholder farmers. Through this mechanisms, IFAD channels climate and environmental finance to smallholder farmers, helping them to reduce poverty, enhance biodiversity, increase yields and lower greenhouse gas emissions. IFAD and GCF signed an Accreditation Master Agreement (AMA) in September 2018 (renewed in October 2023). Since then IFAD has successfully submitted the following proposals: (i) FP101, Belize: Resilient Rural Belize (Feb 2019); (ii) SAP012, Niger: Inclusive Green Financing for Climate Resilient and Low Emission Smallholder Agriculture (Nov 2020); (iii) FP143, Brazil: Planting Climate Resilience in Rural Communities of the Northeast (Nov 2020); (iv) FP162, West Africa: The Africa Integrated Climate Risk Management Programme: Building resilience of smallholder farmers to climate change impacts in 7 Sahelian Great Green Wall Countries (Mar 2021); (v) FP183, West Africa: Inclusive Green Financing Initiative, IGREENFIN (March 2022); and (vi) FP220, East Africa: Africa Rural Climate Adaptation Finance Mechanism, ARCAFIM (Oct 2023).

131. **CEP** is the NDA and an Executing Entity for the project. Its Center for Implementation of Investment Projects (CEP-CIIP) is currently the executing entity for the implementation of the GCF-funded Climate Adaptation and Mitigation Program for the Aral Sea Basin (CAMP4ASB).[209] CEP also coordinates with WFP for the GCF-funded "Building climate resilience of vulnerable and food insecure communities" (USD10.0 m).[210] With ADB it is implementing the "Institutional Development of the State Agency for Hydrometeorology" (USD10.0m),[211] and has close collaboration with UNDP and FAO on the GCF Readiness projects as well as with all relevant development partners engaged in climate finance. CEP is also the implementing agency for all forestry management projects of UNDP, WB, and WFP. CEP is a key executing entity for CASP+ and will coordinate the implementation of the project at the national level and will provide its technical expertise for identifying priority villages based on climate vulnerability analysis. CEP has district units with permanent staff in each district of Tajikistan. CEP also has departments at the provincial level. The total staffing levels at CEP are approximately 400, with approximately 40 people working at the central office in Dushanbe. At the **provincial** and **district** level the departments conduct monitoring and oversight of the policies adopted at the central level while coordinating with authorities at the province, district, and sub-district levels. At the **sub-district** level regulate and monitor environmentally damaging activities with the approval of the national CEP office in Dushanbe.

132. The **PMU** was established within the MoA in 2012 to support the implementation of investment projects in the agriculture sector. PMU has been managing IFAD-financed investment projects valued at USD 91.6 million. The PMU has successfully implemented LPDP-I and KLSP, and is implementing LPDP-II and CASP. It has solid experience in rural areas where the population face challenges similar to those of CASP+ target groups. It has a team of 33 specialists, covering a wide range of expertise in project management, financial, procurement functions as well as technical expertise in pasture, animal husbandry and health, agriculture, climate change adaptation, community mobilization, gender and social inclusion. It has technical experts and civil engineers, business development, GIS and M&E specialists. Its capacity will be further strengthened for the implementation of CASP+.

133. **FAO** has a solid record of technical assistance in the country on climate change, including on policy support as well as mitigation and adaptation interventions. Its assistance has evolved from providing emergency assistance to deal with locust attacks to a more comprehensive approach to build a sustainable and competitive agriculture sector, including improved food security and nutrition, and resilience to climate change. Currently, FAO is engaged with CEP on the Readiness Programme, including the update of the NDC and other climate change focused projects. FAO is currently supervising and executing a large climate finance portfolio, including GCF-funded **FP 116**, Kyrgyzstan: Carbon-sequestration through climate investment in Forests and Rangelands (USD 49.9 m) and **SAP 014**, Armenia: Forest resilience of Armenia, enhancing adaptation and rural green growth via mitigation (USD 18.7m).

Role of National Designated Authority

134. In 2014, the GoT appointed CEP as the NDA for issues related to the GCF. In its capacity as the NDA, CEP has demonstrated good capacity to lead the climate investment programming in the country. It

has coordinated the policy and investment framework on climate investments. CEP was established in 2008 as a specialized agency overseeing the use of natural resources and environmental protection and serves as the central government authority responsible for implementation of public policy in the area of environmental conservation, hydrometeorology, and rational use of natural resources. The NAP support project is further strengthening the capacity of CEP.

Engagement with civil society organizations and other relevant stakeholders, including indigenous peoples, women and other vulnerable groups

135. **Civil society** in Tajikistan represents a wide spectrum of organizations, ranging from communal and neighbourhood councils to more formal, officially registered public associations. Civil society organizations (CSOs) in Tajikistan are engaged in a wide range of activities. The impact of civil society on Tajikistan has increased as the number, scope and reach of CSOs has grown steadily. The Government also recognizes the role of these organizations in mobilizing communities. Civil society has become a crucial bridge between the people and the public sector in many initiatives.[212] According to the Ministry of Justice (MoJ), as of January 2015, there were 2,685 public associations registered in the country. There were also 1,400 legally registered Village Organizations (VOs), some of which have formed higher level organization such as Social Unions for the Development of VOs (SUDVOs). In addition, there are also very specific purpose organizations made up of community members with roles and responsibilities specified by legislation which include over seventy Water Users Associations (WUAs)[213] and around 54 PUUs. The civil society organizations and community-based organizations will play a key role in the mobilization of the communities through the well tested Village organization approach and through them identify climate sensitive community action plans. The inclusion of women in the current project will be facilitated through an approach that will both mainstream women and youth as well as through project staff and specialist agencies such as the Committee for Women's and Family Affairs. The project will also be aligned with the National Strategy for Enhancing the Role of women in the Republic and the Law on the State Guarantees of Equal Rights and Opportunities for Men and Women. Section G.2 below outlines the gender strategy of the project and Annex 8 outlines a more detailed Gender Action Plan.

D.6. Efficiency and effectiveness (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

136. The financial structure of the project has been designed to ensure that the proposal's objectives are achieved and that the key constraints at the national community and household level are addressed in a manner which reduces CO2 equivalent emissions and assists in climate risk adaptation in an effective manner. The level of income and indebtedness is a key factor in determining the level of concession being requested for the country (Section B.5). GCF funds have been able to leverage third party financing from external and internal sources in a ratio of 1:1.04[214]. The grant elements are being allocated for incremental costs and will not displace any investments that would otherwise have occurred. At the level of the households and common interest groups, the grants will defray part of the household investment and will cover the risk premium required to make the investment viable. Due to the common property nature of the resources that are being developed (pastures, forests, agricultural land), and ecosystem services (bio-diversity, CO2e sequestration) there is market failure and limited incentive for the private sector to work with smallholders to help them enhance their adaptive capacity due to the high risks and transaction costs of working with small producers. The investments are designed to bridge these constraints.

137. An analysis of the Value for Money Metrics of the Project shows that the project investment is highly justified based on both financial and economic analysis (**Annex 3**). CASP+ builds on a broader portfolio of IFAD-funded projects in the country (as referred to in Section **B3**, **para 38**), and by using the district climate resilience diagnostics as entry point to define investment priorities, the project is expected to complement efficiency and effectiveness under intermediate and worst-case climate scenarios (RCP 8.5). A financial analysis was carried out to present the with- and without-project intervention scenarios using the indicative investment models that would be most likely supported by the project (see **Annex 3**) – using both RCP 8.5 as basis and RCP 4.5 to test sensitivity. The key-indicators to assess the performance of the project include the net present values (NPVs) discounted at 11.0%[215], financial and economic internal rate of return (FIRR – EIRR), benefit-cost ratio (B/C) and return to family labour. All models demonstrate a financial viability (results presented in **Table 4** and **Table 5**, below) and compared to a scenario without concessional financing (using own resources for Component 2 investments and accessing loans for Component 3

investments). In addition, the project shows overall efficiency in the achievement of its mitigation targets, with a cost of about 11.68 USD/tCO2e in line with similar operations in the country[216].

138. **Economic analysis.** The illustrative models used in the financial analysis were used for the calculation of the overall benefit stream, on the basis of economic prices applying conversion factors and removing taxes and subsidies. The overall benefit stream has been generated based on the phasing of CsCAPs implementation in 400 villages over the 7-year project period and provision of grants aimed at strengthening livelihoods and enhanced resilience through market-based approaches (1020 grants through Window 1 and 110 grants through Window 2); and promotion of Productive Alliances (support of 9 models). The economic costs extracted from COSTAB application were used for the analysis. The economic analysis resulted in ENPV of US$178.3 million (discounted at 6%) and EIRR of 23.08%. Economic returns were tested against changes in benefits and costs, different adoption and discount rates scenarios, and for various lags in the realization of benefits. In relative terms, the EIRR is equally sensitive to changes in costs and in benefits. The results are presented in **Table 6**.

139. **Additional sensitivity analysis**. The sensitivity of project investment was also tested against different levels of concessionality and in a more moderate climate scenario (RCP 4.5). As a result, the concessionality of project funded investment for communities and groups was set to the minimum level to a. help beneficiaries to overcome the lack of adapted and accessible financial products; b. help them in carrying out the required resilience investments; c. ensure that beneficiaries can afford the required investment (provided in-kind, as labour or local material), as well as d. maximize their ownership on community investment[217]. The project models were also tested also under an intermediate climate scenario (RCP 4.5), which presented more solid results, showing adequacy of the project to strengthen resilience even under a worst-case scenario, which was used as basis (**Annex 3**).

Table 4. *Component 2. Financial Analysis Summary.*

Summary table. Component 2 financial models																
				With grants (consessional financing)									Without grants (no consessional financing)			
CATEGORY	Estimated Investment Costs (US$)			Annual Net Benefits (US$)			Annual Inc. net benefits per 1US$ of Inv.	IRR (%)	NPV (US$)	Benefit-to-cost ratio	Payback period (years)	Return to family labour (US$/day)	IRR (%)	NPV (US$)	Benefit-to-cost ratio	Payback period (years)
	CASP+	Beneficiary Contrib.	Total	Without Project	W. Project - Full Dvt	Incremental										
CsCAP adaptation investments (typical village)																
1. CsCAP adaptation investments (typical village) *	78,495	8,722	87,216	60,371	91,679	31,308	0.4	63.75%	147,540	2.29	10.93	11.9	18.81%	66,470	1.58	14.93
CsCAP forestry investments (1ha models)																
2. Riparian forest plantation (1ha JFM model)	1,427	75	1,502	0	235	235	0.16	29.70%	850	1.67	9.0	2.1	8.70%	(412)	0.93	20.0
3. Riparian forest plantation (1ha LH model)	1,465	77	1,542	0	238	238	0.15	13.46%	290	1.18	20.0	0.0	-0.51%	(1,418)	(0.61)	20.0
4. Fruit and nut plantation (1ha JFM model)	764	40	804	0	680	680	0.85	43.11%	3,903	5.63	6.5	15.9	25.12%	3,225	3.57	9.6
5. Fruit and nut plantation (1ha LH model)	1,926	101	2,027	0	456	456	0.22	38.12%	2,421	2.36	6.7	0.0	11.86%	631	2.15	11.1
6. Pistachio plantation (1ha JFM model)	1,086	57	1,143	0	179	179	0.16	37.47%	1,274	2.15	5.7	25.7	10.95%	261	1.24	17.8
7. Pistachio plantation (1ha LH model)	1,048	55	1,103	0	156	156	0.14	35.03%	1,070	2.01	5.9	0.0	9.79%	94	1.09	18.6
8. Juniper forest plantation (1ha JFM model)	755	40	795	0	71	71	0.09	19.51%	315	1.35	9.2	27.6	3.73%	(397)	0.56	16.5
9. Juniper forest plantation (1ha LH model)	755	40	795	0	74	74	0.09	14.98%	230	1.26	9.9	0.0	3.02%	(482)	0.46	17.6
10. Juniper nat. reg-n plantation (1ha JFM model)	607	32	639	0	26	26	0.04	24.15%	705	1.89	8.0	5.5	9.69%	129	1.16	12.0
11. Juniper nat. reg-n plantation (1ha LH model)	607	32	639	0	30	30	0.05	24.98%	729	1.92	7.9	0.0	9.96%	154	1.19	11.9
12. Saxaul plantation (1ha JFM model)	1,859	98	1,957	0	236	236	0.12	24.51%	322	1.17	5.7	44.3	-0.09%	(1,422)	0.25	9.0
13. Saxaul plantation (1ha LH model)	1,859	98	1,957	0	239	239	0.12	25.63%	347	1.18	5.6	0.0	0.11%	(1,397)	0.26	19.8
14. Agroforestry model (1ha JFM model)	1,589	98	1,686	0	249	249	0.15	32.19%	1,285	1.91	7.9	4.4	10.17%	(184)	0.87	20.0
15. Agroforestry model (1ha LH model)	1,465	77	1,542	0	252	252	0.16	32.87%	1,307	1.91	7.8	0.0	10.70%	(58)	0.96	20.0

Table 5. *Component 3. Financial Analysis Summary.*

Summary table. Component 3 financial models																
				With grants (consessional financing)									With commercial loan (no grant)			
CATEGORY	Estimated Investment Costs (US$)			Annual Net Benefits (US$)			Annual Inc. net benefits per 1US$ of Inv.	FIRR (%)	FNPV (US$)	Benefit-to-cost ratio	Payback period (years)	Return to family labour (US$/day)	FIRR (%)	FNPV (US$)	Benefit-to-cost ratio	Payback period (years)
	CASP+	Beneficiary Contrib.	Total	Without Project	W. Project - Full Dvt	Incremental										
Window 1 indicative grant models (max. grant @$8,000)																
16. Bee-keeping model	7,151	795	7,945	0	1,083	1,083	0.14	14.90%	2,064	1.26	7.21	26.7	11.80%	389	1.05	10.23
17. Greenhouse model	7,771	863	8,635	0	1,403	1,403	0.16	18.46%	3,331	1.39	6.01	9.4	14.92%	1,751	1.20	8.27
18. Drip irrigation model	7,799	867	8,666	22,589	25,551	2,962	0.34	11.89%	1,419	1.07	2.51	151.5	9.63%	-1,562	0.93	5.73
Window 2 indicative grant models (max. grant @$30,000)																
19. Cold storage model	40,137	10,034	50,172	0	16,261	16,261	0.32	44.48%	81,682	2.15	2.18	0.0	43.14%	71,820	2.01	9.87
20. Vacuum dryer model	31,839	7,960	39,798	0	10,916	10,916	0.27	52.33%	64,685	2.44	3.17	0.0	55.15%	57,000	2.27	8.33
21. Milk processing model	26,625	6,656	33,282	0	13,415	13,415	0.40	42.42%	70,012	2.30	1.65	0.0	41.45%	65,085	2.21	6.69
Productive Alliances (max. grant @$50,000)																
22. Milk collection center model **	45,046	11,261	56,307	0	18,640	18,640	0.33	60.94%	111,005	2.45	2.93	0.0	58.60%	104,551	2.37	7.07

Table 6. *Sensitivity Analysis*

Sensitivity Analysis

	Δ%	Risk	EIRR	NPV @6% (million US$)	NPV @4% (million US$)	NPV @8% (million US$)
Base scenario			23.08%	178.3	255.4	124.7
Benefits	-10%	Combined risks on sale prices, yields, climate effect (droughts, floods, etc.)	21.36%	154.1	223.1	106.4
	-20%		19.53%	130.0	190.7	88.1
	-70%	Severe climate risks	7.39%	9.5	29.2	- 3.4
Costs	10%	Increase in expenses, input prices and unit costs	21.52%	172.0	248.6	118.9
	20%		20.15%	165.7	241.8	113.0
Adoption rates	-10%	Decrease in adoption rate from 80% to 70% and 60%, respectively	11.39%	51.9	90.3	26.1
	-20%		10.53%	42.0	76.7	18.8
Delay 1yr in Benefits		Delays	20.08%	159.7	234.5	108.2
Delay 2yr in Benefits			17.81%	141.8	213.9	92.8
Carbon price (US$10/tCO2)		Decrease in shadow price of carbon from US$40/tCO2 to US$10/tCO2 and US$5/tCO2, respectively	14.94%	90.9	141.7	56.3
Carbon price (US$5/tCO2)			13.58%	76.4	122.8	44.9
Climate Shock every 3 yr	20% Benefits	Repeating climate shocks	22.83%	170.4	244.7	119.0
Climate Shock every 5 yr	20% Benefits		23.09%	167.6	240.0	117.3
Mixed Scenarios	**Costs** 10%	**Benefits** -10%	19.87%	147.9	216.3	100.6
	Costs 10%	**Benefits** -20%	18.11%	123.8	184.0	82.3
	Costs 20%	**Benefits** -20%	16.87%	117.5	177.2	76.4
	Costs 20%	**Benefits** -30%	16.23%	99.7	151.6	64.0
	Costs 20%	**Benefits** -10%	18.56%	141.6	209.5	94.7

GREEN CLIMATE FUND

E

E. LOGICAL FRAMEWORK

E.1. Project/Programme Focus

☒ Reduced emissions (mitigation)

☒ Increased resilience (adaptation)

E.2. GCF Impact level: Paradigm shift potential (max 600 words, approximately 1-2 pages)

Assessment Dimension	Current state (baseline)		Potential target scenario (Description)	How the project/programme will contribute (Description)
	Description	Rating		
Scale	The country lacks a supportive policy and regulatory framework and technical capacity to integrate climate risks in its planning at the national, district and village level. Households have limited capacity, resources and organizational ability for investing in measures that can mitigate climate change and enable adaptation to climate risks.	Low	The paradigm shift would be scaled up through a supportive policy environment that encourages improved management of pastures by PUUs and protection of forests through community participation. The project will transform local government and community capacity for climate resilient planning and implementation which will be scaled up in additional villages through systemic changes in the planning process. While building on the successful experience of previous IFAD-funded projects in the country (Section B3, Annex 29), its scope was substantially refocused on climate adaptation and mitigation potential.	The policy instruments and enhanced technical capacity of public sector institutions will generate changes at scale for the country as a whole. The project will implement village level CsCAPs in 400 villages which local government agencies will emulate in other areas. The successful experiences of engaging communities accrued within other IFAD-funded and other donors projects are scaled up by CASP+ with a climate-sensitive angle, and complemented by additional features. The private sector is expected to scale up successful experiences from its productive alliances to include other value chains and include additional producers.
Replicability	The CASP+ approach and the paradigm shift that it promotes is based on the experience of several of previous projects (above all the Livestock and Pasture Development Project LPDP Phase I and II). Key elements of the approach have been replicated in other vulnerable pastures by PUUs and by households that rely primarily on livestock. The village level planning approach has not been widely replicated yet as due to lack of its proper integration in local development systems.	Low	The paradigm shift in village level planning and management is expected to be replicated through support of agencies at the Governorate level based on the positive experience in the selected villages but will require advocacy and dissemination of positive experiences. The approaches regarding pasture management and forest protection are expected to be replicated by the PUUs in other parts of the country, as done in the past following the leading example of LPDP I and II. The private sector is expected to take the lead in replicating the productive alliance approaches as confirmed in consultations with enterprises operating in the agrifood sector and as there is substantial demand for domestic agrifood products.	The project will contribute to replicating systemic change in other areas of the country through the supportive policy on pastures, the improved technical capacity of institutions dealing with making livestock production practices more climate resilient, the work of the private sector veterinarians and through the demonstration of the behaviour change of smallholder livestock producers and the PUUs in pasture management. The private sector is expected to introduce successful experience and systems gleaned from the productive alliances to other Governorates.
Sustainability	There is evidence that some of the investments made through earlier IFAD projects in livestock and pasture management have sustained beyond the project period such as the PUUs established for pasture use and rehabilitation, the joint forest management groups introduced by GIZ and that the livestock production practices introduced previously have sustained beyond the project period.	Medium	The paradigm shift promises to sustain beyond the project period as it will introduce systemic changes in institutional arrangements, build capacity at the national and community level and introduce production practices that reduce production costs and losses, increase productivity and incomes thereby providing strong incentives to continue the use of the new practices.	The strengthening of policy frameworks, stimulating women's leadership in the local institutions and int eh policy dialogue, develop institutional capacity at various tiers including community to manage common property natural resources is expected to sustain the paradigm shifts that the project is expected to encourage in terms of the management of natural resources, use of common property resources and effective, equitable and sustainable management of productive household assets, production practices and virtuous market inclusion dynamics.

E.3. GCF Outcome level: Reduced emissions and increased resilience (IRMF core indicators 1-4, quantitative indicators)

GCF Result Area	IRMF Indicator	Means of Verification (MoV)	Baseline	Target		Assumptions / Note
				Mid-term	Final[218]	
MRA4 Forestry and land use	Core 1: GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed/sequestered	Georeferenced Carbon accounting (Ex-ACT and GLEAM-i) based on mid-term and completion surveys	**0 t CO2e**	**- 939,984 tonnes CO2e** (ex-ACT and GLEAM-i)	**- 6,854,822 tonnes CO2e** (ex-ACT and GLEAM-i) over 27 years[219]	Communities and farmers adopt the practices that are expected to lead to the reduction or sequestration of emissions.
ARA1 Most vulnerable people and communities	Core 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached	Project M&E system at CEP and PMU as well as mid-term and end line surveys	**Direct**: **Men**: 0 **Women**: 0 **Indirect**: **Men**: 0 **Women**: 0	**Direct**: **Men**: 157,625 **Women**: 167,375 **Indirect**: **Men**: 570,058 **Women**: 605,319	**Direct**: **Men**: 315,250 **Women**: 334,750 **Indirect**: **Men**: 1,100,187 **Women**: 1,168,239	The covid-19 pandemic has eased and allows field activities. Timely approval of project and adherence to implementation plan. The detailed set of assumptions regarding HH size, participants, adoption rates are given in Annex 24.[220]
ARA1 Most vulnerable people and communities	Supplementary 2.1: Beneficiaries (female/male) adopting improved and/or new climate-resilient livelihood options	Project M&E system at CEP and PMU as well as mid-term and end line surveys	**Men**: 0 **Women**: 0	**Men**: 157,625 **Women**: 167,375	**Men**: 315,250 **Women**: 334,750[221]	Timely approval of project and adherence to implementation plan.
ARA2 Health, well-being, food and water security	Supplementary indicator 2.2: Beneficiaries (female/male) with improved food security	Project M&E system at CEP and PMU as well as mid-term and end line surveys	**Men**: 0 **Women**: 0	**Men**: 22,698 **Women** 24,102.	**Men**: 45,396 **Women** 48,204	Improved infrastructure for enhanced food production through FFS, grants and infrastructure and improved mechanization. Annex 24
ARA2 Health, well-being, food and water security	Supplementary 2.5: Beneficiaries (female/male) adopting innovations that stregthen climate change resilience	Project M&E system at CEP and PMU as well as mid-term and end line surveys	**Men**: 0 **Women**: 0	**Men**: 24,968 **Women**: 26,512	**Men**:166,452 **Women**: 176,748	The beneficiaries include those reached by dissemination of technical packages, breeding strategy, infrastructure, field days and FFS. (Annex 24)
ARA3 Infrastructure and built environment	Core 3: Value of physical assets made more resilient to the effects of climate change and/or more able to reduce GHG emissions	Baseline, Mid-Term and End line surveys			USD 194,591,000 (Annex 24, Sheet CR.3)	The covid-19 pandemic has eased and allows field activities. Timely approval of project and adherence to implementation plan.
ARA4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services	Core 4: Hectares of natural resources brought under improved low-emission and/or climate-resilient management practice	Project M&E system at CEP and PMU as well as mid-term and end line surveys.	**Pasture**: 0 ha **Forests**: 0 ha **Cropland**: 0 ha	**Pasture:** 50,000 ha **Forests:** 1,500ha **Cropland:** 500 ha	**Pasture:** 180,000 ha **Forests:** 8,641ha **Cropland:** 1,416.5 ha	The farming communities are given access and use rights to manage these resources and they see a long term interest in doing so.

ARA4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services	Supplementary 4.1: Hectares of terrestrial forest, terrestrial non-forest, freshwater and coastal marine areas brought under resoration and/or improved ecosystems	Project M&E system at CEP and PMU as well as mid-term and end line surveys.	**Pasture**: 0 ha **Forests**: 0 ha **Cropland**: 0 ha	Forests: 1500 ha	Forests: 8641 hectare	There are sufficient incentives for local communities to engage in Joint Forest Management and they are willing to undertake the responsibilities of the associated contracts.
ARA4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services	Supplementary 4.2: Number of livestock brought under sustainable management practices	Project M&E system at CEP and PMU as well as mid-term and end line surveys.	0 small and large ruminants	300,000 small and large ruminants	604,800 small and large ruminants	Farmers adopt the practices that are expected to lead to reduced emissions.

E.4. GCF Outcome level: Enabling environment (IRMF core indicators 5-8 as applicable)

Core Indicator	Baseline context (description)	Rating for current state (baseline)	Target scenario (description)	How the project will contribute	Coverage
Core Indicator 5: Degree to which GCF investments contribute to strengthening institutional and regulatory frameworks for low emission climate-resilient development pathways in a country-driven manner	There is lack of coordination among key sector institutions and gaps in the policy regarding the management of common pastures and forests which does not encourage mitigation or adaptation to climate change.	low	*Well-coordinated mechanisms with a supportive policy environment that incentivizes behavior to mitigate climate change, empowers women, ensures their participation, and encourages the adoption of adaptive practices and technologies.*	*Improve the coordination among sector institutions and bring about policy change in the management of pastures and production practices for livestock in a manger which mitigates climate change, includes women and increases overall productivity and resilience.*	National level (one country)
Core Indicator 6: Degree to which GCF investments contribute to technology deployment, dissemination, development or transfer and innovation	There is limited awareness and understanding about climate risks and how to build resilience in the face of droughts, temperature increase and variability through use of technology transfer and innovation.	low	*Increased mainstreaming of climate risks in local level planning and allocation of funds. Strong PUUs which promote the more efficient system of pasture management.* *A strong team of private veterinarians at the village level who introduce new feeding, breeding and more efficient livestock management practices.* *Stronger links with the private sector in the introduction of new innovations and technologies.*	*A new mechanism for planning through CsCAPs which integrates climate risks in the allocation of funds and village level plans and pasture management. Introduction of transfer of technology and innovation through establishing cadre of village level veterinarians and links with the private sector for scaling up of technologies available in the market and Support adoption of climate resilient innovative technologies.*	National level (one country)
Core indicator 7: Degree to which GCF Investments contribute to market development/transformation at the sectoral, local, or national level	Weak links with the private sector and the weak presence of private sector in rural areas	low	*A growing and active role by the private sector in helping women and men smallholders' access the inputs that builds their resilience to climate risks and presence of markets that promote efficient use of resources thereby helping to avoid loss and waste of scarce resources.*	*The project is helping to forger productive alliance in selected value chains.* *CASP+ will facilitate identification and contracting of business partnerships between groups of small holder farmers and aggregators, to facilitate access to market and services, including for vulnerable women.* *Provision of matching grants to CIGs.*	Multiple sub-national areas within a country

Core indicator 8: Degree to which GCF investments contribute to effective knowledge generation and learning processes, and use of good practices, methodologies and standards	Climate change risks have not been fully integrated into local planning systems and farmers who rely on natural resources are not fully aware of the detrimental impact of practices that increase GHGs.	low	*Integration of climate risks in local planning and allocation of resources at village level and ensure women and men headed households' understanding and adoption of practices to mitigate climate change impacts and adapt to climate risks.*	*The project will train local authorities at the Jamoat level in understanding and integrating climate risks in local level planning, strengthen VOs/PUUs, including women's role in their governance, forest management committees and individual women and men producers in better understanding climate risks and modifying their production practices.*	Multiple sub-national areas within a country

E.5. Project/programme specific indicators (project outcomes and outputs)

Project/programme results (outcomes/ outputs)	Project/programme specific Indicator	Means of Verification (MoV)	Baseline	Target		Assumptions / Note
				Mid-term	Final	
Outcome 1 (Component 1): Strengthened institutional and regulatory systems for climate-responsive planning and development	*Number of national policies integrating climate-responsive planning and development*	*Technical reports by the project – mid-term and final surveys*	*0*	*3*	*4: (1) Pasture law; (2) breeding strategy; (3) policy on private veterinary services and (4) Green Economy Concept*	*Ministries and institutions maintain interest in climate-resilient and evidence based policy making.* *Competent Agencies collaborate on exchanging information and making it available to the project*
	No of Agencies collaborating for an active exchange of data and information related to remote and participatory NRM	*MoUs signed. Data made available by the different institutions to the project*	*0*	*2*	*6*	*MoU signed between Agency for Land Management and CEP in the first year of the project. Further competent institutions (e.g. MoA) are willing to join data exchange platforms*
	No of Academic and training institutions integrate climate change in curricula	*Review of course curricula and promotional material publicizing the course content in publications and websites by the selected institutions.*	*0*	*2*	*4*	*No of Academic and training institutions integrate climate change in curricula*
Output 1.1: By year 7, Capacities of relevant national institutions for climate-resilient natural resources management are strengthened.	*Number of staff trained in climate change management planning*	*Attendances sheets of training activities and records of PIU.*	*0*	*Men = 100* *Women = 50*	*Men = 195* *Women = 95*	*The staff see sufficient value in the training to make themselves available for capacity training activities.*
	No of hectares of pastures monitored with the use of the integrated, holistic and participatory management approach	*Technical reports by the project Photographic and remote sensing documentation*	*0*	*1,400*	*3,500*	*Local communities are interested in the project and in sharing information*
	No. of participants of the course for foresters.	*Attendances sheets of training activities and records of PIU and*	*0*	*Men = 21* *Women = 9*	*Men = 49* *Women = 21*	*There is sufficient interest and demand for the training.*

		the Leskhoz and the Adult Education Center.				
	No of youth from the project districts and number of public servants attending the climate courses.	*Records of participating institutions.*	*0*	*Men = 10* *Women = 10*	*Men = 24* *Women = 26*	*Universities have the capacity to modify the course content and are interested in offering the courses and students interested in participation.*
Output 1.2: By year 7, the enabling environment for climate adaptive, inclusive and integrated management of pasture, forestry and livestock resources is enhanced	*No state agencies influenced by CASP+ insights and knowledge products*	*Interviews with key stakeholders from participating agencies*	*0*	*3*	*9*	*No rapid turn-over of personnel in the participating agencies.*
	No of sectoral regulatory frameworks reviewed	*The revised frameworks and policy pronouncements.*	*0*	*1*	*4*	*Strong commitment for reform.*
	Strengthened capacity of MEDT to facilitate development of Green Economy plans.	*MEDT*	*0*	*1*	*1*	*Strong MEDT commitment to prepare the concept note and action plan.*
Outcome 2 (Component 2): Increased CO2e sequestration through improved pasture, forests and livestock management	N/A[222]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Outcome 3 (Component 2): Improved management of land or forest areas contributing to emissions reductions	*Hectares of land or forests under improved and effective management that contributes to CO2 emission reductions (pasture, forests, and cropland)*	*Baseline/MTR/Completion surveys (including Ex-ACT analyses)*	*Pasture: 0 ha* *Forests: 0 ha* *Cropland: 0 ha*	*Pasture: 180,000 ha* *Forests: 8,641ha* *Cropland: 1,416.5 ha*	*Pasture: 180,000 ha* *Forests: 8,641ha* *Cropland: 1,416.5 ha*	*Availability and interest of local communities and commitment to the investments in improved NR; climate sensitive planning and local level partnerships created will continues after project closure.* *Willingness of rural communities, availability of suitable service providers and commitment of local institutions to support rural communities' investment and planning even beyond project end.*
	Number of Households reporting adoption of environmentally sustainable and climate-resilient technologies and practices	*Baseline/MTR/Completion surveys*	*0 Households*	*40,000 households*	*100,000 households*	
Output 2.1: By year 3, 400 Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAP) based on 21 district level climate diagnostics are developed	*District Climate Resilience Diagnostic (DCRD) prepared*	*CEP monitoring reports*	*0*	*21*	*21*	*The diagnostic is able to present good analysis of climate trends and risks and adaptation measures.*
	Women representatives trained in leadership skills	*Interviews with women representatives*		*1200*	*2400*	*The women courses are designed and delivered in a manner which encourages women participation in these forums.*

	Number of VO's established	*Report from community facilitator based on municipal records*	*TBD*	*400*	*400*	*Jamoat support*
	Number of operational PUU or PUG in the project area	*Report from community facilitator. Reports from PMT*	*TBD*	*400*	*400*	*Community facilitators recruited in Y1*
	Number of PUA in the project area	*Reports from PMT*	*TBD*	*15*	*21*	*PUU willing to establish PUAs*
	Number of Forest User Groups in the project area	*Report from community facilitator.*	*0*	*200*	*200*	*JFM participants willing to form FUG*
	Number of Common Interest Groups in the project area	*Report from community facilitator.*	*0*	*400*	*1020*	*Demand for two CIGs per village*
	Number of CsCAPs approved	*Report from community facilitator.*	*0*	*400*	*400*	*Approval process does not suffer delays*
Output 2.2: By year 7, 400 CsCAPs are implemented in 21 districts by local institutions in timely and effective manner	*Area of pasture under Pasture Management Plan*	*Pasture Management Plans. Reports from PMT*		*100,000*	*180,000*	*The project will be able to secure pasture use rights for PUUs.*
	Number of hectares of land under JFM contracts	*Evidence of contracts signed from PMT.*	*0*	*1794*	*7073*	*JFM participation, Leskhoz land rights can be established*
	Number of hectares of land reforested directly (in Leskhoz or other lands)	*Reports from Project Forestry Specialists*	*0*	*405*	*1350*	*Leskhoz have timely access to materials, labour and equipment*
	Number of hectares reforested in buffer zones	*Evidence of JFM contracts in buffer zone signed with PMT.*	*0*	*50*	*218*	*There is sufficient interest based on the rights assigned for JFM.*
Component 3 - Outcome 4: Strengthened communities and individuals adaptive capacity and reduced exposure to climate risks	*Rural producers accessing production inputs and/or technological packages*	*Annual outcome surveys, Baseline/MTR/Completion surveys (including Ex-ACT analyses)*	*Women: 0* *Men: 0* *Young:0*	*Women: 12,880* *Men: 12,880* *Young:7,728*	*Women: 32,200* *Men: 32,200* *Young: 19,320*	*Agribusiness enterprises willing to engage with smallholders in the project area* *The technologies are affordable and disseminated for wider use and replication.*
	Number of farmers accessing market and services through productive alliances facilitated by the project	*Project reports / annual outcome surveys* *Reports from Productive Alliance facilitator*	*0*	*1 200*	*4 000*	
	Persons trained in income-generating activities or business management	*Annual outcome surveys, Baseline/MTR/Completion surveys (including Ex-ACT analyses)*	*Women: 0* *Men: 0* *Young: 0*	*Women: 2,880* *Men: 2,880* *Young: 1,728*	*Women: 7,200* *Men: 7,200* *Young: 4,320*	
Output 3.1: by year 7, 105,600[223] smallholder livestock farmers receive AI, animal health or training services to increase productivity of their livestock.	*Number of Artificial Inseminations conducted in the project area*	*Reports from SE for Breeding and AI Project reports*	*0*	*63 360*	*105 600*	*MoU with SE for breeding and AI signed in Y1* *Capacities of SE for breeding and AI for implementation are adequate*

	Number of farmers accessing demonstration plots on climate resilient technologies	*Reports from SE for Capacity Development* *Project reports*	*0*	*16 000*	*40 000*	*MoU with SE for Capacity Development signed in Y1.* *Capacities of SE Capacity Development implementation are adequate.* *Farmers, including women, are willing to attend FFS classes*
	Number of private vets (trained and equipped) involved in project activities.	*Reports from TVA* *Project reports*	*0*	*264*	*396*[224]	*MoU with TVA signed in Y1.* *Number of private vets are increased*
	Number of farmers enrolled in FFS	*Reports from SE for Capacity Development* *Project reports*	*0*	*2000*	*2000*	*Availability and interest of local communities and commitment to the investments in production practices*
Output 3.2: By the end of year 4, 9 productive alliances between livestock producers' groups and private aggregators established and operational	*Number of active and operational productive alliances for marketing of livestock commodities*	*Reports from PA facilitator* *Project reports*	*0*	*3 (3 on dairy)*	*9 (8 on dairy, 1 on beef)*	*Private sector actors are willing to enter and invest in productive alliances arrangements.* *Market demand for livestock commodities keeps increasing at the same pace*
Output 3.3: by year 7, 12,400[225] smallholders have strengthened climate resilient production practices and private sector market linkages.	*Number of Common Interest groups' (Window 1) proposals approved (% women led groups proposal approved and youth - led approved)*	*Reports from service providers* *Reports from district officers* *Report from Grant manager* *Project reports*	*0*	*350 CIG groups under Window 1*	*1020 CIG groups under Window 1*	*Market linkages established, primary production increased using climate resilient technologies quality improved, value addition, climate resilient technologies scaled-up* *Women/youth increase their incomes from diversified agriculture activities*
	Number of Common Interest groups' (Window 2) proposals approved (% women led groups proposal approved and youth - led approved			*50 CIG groups under Window 2*	*110 CIG groups under Window 2*	
E.5 Project/programme co-benefit indicators						
Co-benefit 1: increase in biodiversity in pastures and forest area	*Type and quantity of the species in the pastures and forest areas.*	Through Third party surveys and indexing of the inventories.	tbd	tbd	tbd	No major natural or climate change induced disaster occurs in the project target area.
Co-Benefit 2: Enhanced Gender Equity	*Percent of women beneficiaries reporting increased participation in decision-making and increased access to productive assets.*	Perception Survey – Annual outcome surveys – MTR and Completion surveys	0	+5%	+20%	The overall Tajik economy remains stable or recover from the compounded impact of Covid and of the disruption of international trade caused by the Russia-Ukraine conflict.
Co-benefit 3: Smallholders have increased access to financial services and markets	*Percentage of increased volume of agricultural products from the target districts on the total agricultural products in the domestic market*	National statistics	0	+2.5	+10%	Local markets develop and transport and logistics infrastructure is maintained The trainers/facilitators are skilled in stimulating interests

	Increased volume of financial products to the project areas.	National Commercial Banks annual reports	tbd	tbd	tbd	and guiding the beneficiaries over time.

E.6. Project/programme activities and deliverables

Activities	Description	Sub-activities	Deliverables
Component 1: Strengthening public sector capacity for transformative climate-resilient management of natural resources.			
Activity 1.1.1: Capacity Development of public institutions on climate resilient ecosystem management	Develop capacities of public institutions to streamline climate sensitive, participatory and gender inclusive ecosystem management approaches such as landscape approach, integrated watershed management, joint forest management, community-based pasture management	1.1.1.1. Strengthen capacities of Pasture Meliorative Trust to roll out Pasture Law at community level and provide technical assistance to PUUs, PUAs and PCs	- Regional PMT Office in Kulob refurbished and equipped. - Recruitment of Pasture specialists seconded to PMT. - 2 vehicles for field missions delivered to PMT
		1.1.1.2. Rolling out and Strengthen capacities of Pasture Meliorative Trust to roll out Pasture Law at community level and provide technical assistance to PUUs, PUAs and PCs	- 2 Pasture specialists seconded to PMT
		1.1.1.3. Upgrade the technical skills of the Forestry Department	- 1 curriculum for foresters carried out in each of the 14 project leskhoz and service provider for training
Activity 1.1.2: Introduce combined remote and participatory Natural Resources monitoring and management	Establish remote and participatory management of natural resources as the basis for climate adaptive development and enable exchange of information between the different competent state agencies and communities	1.1.2.1. Kick-off Training on remote and participatory NRM	- Recruitment of International GIS expert (travel included) - Recruitment of International Expert for participatory NRM planning
		1.1.2.2. Roll-out Training on remote and participatory NRM	- Follow up support of technical assistance: International Expert for Participatory NRM planning and International Expert for participatory NRM planning
		1.1.2.3. Kick-off Field testing of NRM approaches	- Recruitment of National Botany Expert and National GIS specialist - Purchase of computer plotter and server (to store data) - Recruitment of M&E consultant for CEP (including social fund and travels) - Kick-off annual outcome survey
		1.1.2.4. Rolling-out Field testing of NRM approaches	- Follow up TA: National Botany Expert, National GIS specialist, NRM monitoring with bees, M&E consultant - Purchase of satellite images - Roll-out of annual outcome survey
Activity 1.1.3. Enhance technical capacities of national livestock institutions to ensure efficient provision of public animal health and production services to smallholder farmers through efficient partnership between public and private institutions.	Strengthen capacities of public agencies under the MoA and FSC in charge of animal health and breeding services to improve the outreach of their activities through provision of logistical support and technical assistance	1.1.3.1. Step up veterinary public health services of the National Veterinary Authority through provision of technical assistance and equipment.	- The organizational structure of the state veterinary management has been developed in line with OIE's recommendations - Veterinary surveillance system based on One Health approach has been established - A mini truck-refrigerator as well as a disinfection machine delivered to FSC - Interpreter/translator available
		1.1.3.2. Improve the outreach of breeding services provided by State Enterprise for Animal	- Kulob regional Center for AI and breeding refurbished and equipped (semen processing equipment, liquid nitrogen machine).

		Breeding and Artificial Insemination to areas and communities targeted by the Project	
Activity 1.1.4: Build capacities of research and academia institutions on climate resilient ecosystem management.	Streamline Climate Change and Ecosystem management approaches in the training curricula and research programmes of National and Research Institutions and academia	1.1.4.1. Integrate climate change issues in university and training institutions curricula:	- 1 new curriculum on CC developed and rolled out at TAU and TAAS - 1 CC module developed & include in curricula of agronomists, agricultural engineers, foresters, zootechnicians and veterinarians of TAU and TAAS, as well as in the training curriculum of public administrators at PAA - Training of diploma level trainers on CC
		1.1.4.2. Promote enrollment of male and female youth in training curricula on climate-resilient natural resources management	- 118 students from project area enrolled in newly developed curriculum on CC during project implementation
		1.1.4.3.Enable research institutes and the private sector to produce evidence on NRM and Climate Change for policy dialogue and climate sensitive technical innovations	- 2 research projects on climate sensitive innovations supported every 2 years (6 in total)
		1.1.4.3. Enable research institutes and the private sector to produce evidence on NRM and Climate Change for policy dialogue and climate sensitive technical innovations	- Provision of batches of grants for research projects
Activity 1.2.1: Promote an inclusive and integrated policy dialogue	Enhance the mainstreaming of climate adaptive management practices of natural resources in all national institutions and verification of the effectiveness of policies on the ground	1.2.1.1. Stock taking of policy development and mainstreaming of gender sensitive climate adaptive agricultural practices.	- 7 policy briefs elaborated and disseminated among institutional stakeholders - 7 reports on the effectiveness of national adaptation policies verified on the ground
		1.2.1.2. Training on the utilization of policy support tools e.g. SIPT, GLEAM, EXACT, B-INTACT.	- 45 representatives of governmental agencies trained on policy tools in the frame of 3 trainings
		1.2.1.3. Kick-off workshops for institutional networking	- One workshop promoting policy dialogue implemented. - Purchase communication material - Conduct two workshops on gender and CC
		1.2.1.4. Kick-off workshops for institutional networking (in-kind)	- SFA staff time to be involved in policy dialogues (in-kind)
		1.2.1.5. Roll-out workshops for institutional networking	- Roll-out workshops on policy dialogue, and gender and CC (one per year) - Purchase communication material for the annual workshops
Activity 1.2.2: Technical assistance for review of livestock related regulatory frameworks.	Review and update of animal health and breeding regulatory and strategic framework to ensure compliance with international guidelines and ensure streamlining of measures supporting climate resilience and environmental protection	1.2.2.1. Improvement of the Pasture Law	- Refined Pasture Law.
		1.2.2.2. Improvement of the Pasture Law	- Two consultative workshops on the refined pasture Law.
		1.2.2.3. Mobilizing technical assistance of the OIE	- OIE Mission on veterinary legislation has been conducted - An analysis of the legislation was carried out, gaps were identified
		1.2.2.4. Improvement of veterinary legislation	- Veterinary legislation improved in line with OIE recommendations (workshops, round tables, conferences, and TA)
		1.2.2.5. Review of the national breeding strategy	- Breeding strategy revised

Activity 1.2.3. Support government's capacity to coordinate and monitor Green investments	Review of the legislation and regulatory framework related the Green Economy for MoDT and provide training to government officials, and strengthen MoF to monitor projects and resource mobilization	1.2.3.1. Support Development of the Green Economy strategy	- 1 draft of the sectoral strategy elaborated. - 1 consultation workshop - 1 validation workshop
		1.2.3.2. Capacity Development of MEDT staff	- 1 training for MEDT staff - 1 Training of Trainer module developed for training MEDT staff at subnational level - 1 study tour (TBD)
		1.2.3.3. Capacity Development of Ministry of Finance staff	- 1 software for Monitoring and Analysis of Public Investment Projects - 10 participants in one study tour for selected MEDT officials.
Component 2: Investments in community capacity for adaption and resilience to climate change			
Activity 2.1.1: Diagnostic of Community needs	Elaboration of district diagnostic; dissemination of the diagnostic results to institutional stakeholders and schools; collection of qualitative village indicators by NGO Facilitators; selection of beneficiary villages and communication of outcome to districts.	2.1.1.1: Diagnostic - create a District Climate Resilience Diagnostic (DCRD) for each District	- 21 district diagnostics elaborated. - 21 communications packages for the diagnostic
		2.1.1.2: Dissemination of diagnostic	- 132 community meetings at Jamoat level to discuss diagnostic.
		2.1.1.3: Village selection[226]	- 400 beneficiary villages selected.
Activity 2.1.2: Establishing relevant local institutions	Institutional and community capacity gaps identified by NGO facilitator during village selection will be addressed by establishing or strengthening needed institutions.	2.1.2.1: Establishment VO's	- Equipment of VO or PUU or PUG - Recruit a local NGO to set baseline socio-economic status. - Training of VO executives by community facilitator - Recruitment of Community facilitator to establish VO
		2.1.2.2: Strengthening VO's	- 400 Village Organizations established or strengthened - Recruitment of National Pasture Specialist (PMU)
		2.1.2.3: Establishment and strengthening PUU or PUG	- 400 PUUs (or PUGs under VOs) established or strengthened - PUUS are registered. - 75% of PUUs/PUGs have registered pasture access rights
		2.1.2.4: Establishment and strengthening of PUA's	- 21 PUAs established or strengthened
		2.1.3.5: Establishment and strengthening of Pasture Commissions.	- 21 PCs established or strengthened
		2.1.2.6: Kick-off of the promotion of JFM and establishment of Forest User Groups	- Kick-off activities to establish Forest User groups (FUG)
		2.1.2.7: Rolling out of the Promotion of FM and establishment of Forest User Groups	- 200 JFM FUG's established - 1500 JFM contracts signed for JFM areas - 200 JFM contracts signed for Direct afforestation sites
		2.1.2.8: Kick-off the establishment of Common Interest Groups (CIGs)	- Training of CIGs by community facilitator
		2.1.2.9: Roll-out the establishment Common Interest Groups (CIGs)	- 1,120 Common Interest Groups established and trained

		2.1.2.10: Organize kick-off leadership training for women representatives in PUUs/VOs	- Kick-off leadership training for Women representatives
		2.1.2.11: Organize roll-out leadership training for women representatives in PUUs/VOs	- Trainings organized in 400 villages
Activity 2.1.3: CsCAP planning and design	Local authorities and community members will jointly assess their climate risks and make plans for pasture management, joint forest management and other key village level priorities.	2.1.3.1: CsCAP planning and design	- 400 PMPs developed - 400 PMPs approved by Local authorities - 200 JFM designs completed, and contracts signed - 400 infrastructure plans captured in CsCAP
Activity 2.1.4: Strengthening local institutions capacity to monitor and evaluate CsCAPs (400 villages)	The capacity of the organizations at the village level such as PMPs will be strengthened for monitoring the implemented activities.	2.1.4.1: Strengthening local institutions capacity to monitor and evaluate CsCAPs (400 villages)	- 100 Workshops on participatory and remote monitoring of CsCAP implementation - Purchase of Vehicles for monitoring
		2.1.4.2: Strengthening and follow-up local institutions capacity to monitor and evaluate CsCAPs	- Regular monitoring carried out in the 400 target villages, recruitment of gender and youth specialist
		2.1.4.3: Strengthening knowledge and capacities of local administration and institutions	- Baseline survey - Conduct mid-term survey and project final survey by a local NGO - Recruitment of TA (engineers, agronomist, community development specialist, M&E, etc.)
		2.1.4.4: Provision of PMU vehicles for monitoring	- Provision of PMU vehicles for the Project implementation
		2.1.4.5: Kick-off the Implementation of the Community Forest Investments	- Kick-off recruitment of project forestry specialist - Purchase of vehicles
		2.1.4.6: Rolling-out the Implementation of the Community Forest Investments	- 5 Project forestry specialists for forestry investment and travels
		2.1.4.7: Provision of CEP staff and field specialist for project monitoring	- CEP staff and field specialist for project monitoring
Activity 2.2.1: Implement Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAPs)	The actual implementation through designing, procuring and execution on the ground of the restoration activities on forests, forests, infrastructure and provision of equipment.	2.2.1.1. Kick off implementation of the Pasture Restoration Investment	- Kick off activities for the Implementation of Pasture Management Plan
		2.2.1.2. Roll-out of the Implementation of Pasture Restoration Investment	- 400 PMPs implemented - 400 PUUs receive technical backstopping for the implementation of their PMPs
		2.2.1.3. Implement cross-village Pasture Management Investments	- 21 District level pasture management investments implemented
		2.2.1.4: Kick-off the implementation of Joint Forest Management Investments	- Equipment package for forest establishment - Kick-off training for JFM beneficiaries
		2.2.1.5: Roll-out of the Implementation of the Joint Forest Management Investments	- 5801 Hectares JFM - 200 Villages with JFM received training in planting and aftercare - Recruitment of Communication specialist
		2.2.1.6: Provision of SFA staff and field specialist for Joint Forest management implementation" (CEP implemented and SFA financed)	- CEP forestry specialists for JFM implementation
		2.2.1.7: Kick-off of the implementation of Direct Leskhoz Forestry Investments	- Kick off equipment package for forest establishment,

		2.2.1.8: Roll-out of the Implementation of the Direct Leskhoz Forestry Investments	- 1350 Hectares Direct Afforestation - Roll-out equipment for forest establishment
		2.2.1.9: Provision of forestry specialists for Leskhoz forestry investment	- CEP forestry specialists for leskhoz forestry implementation
		2.2.1.10: Kick-off of the Implementation JFM in Protected Area buffer zones	- JFM Investment: Protected Area Buffer Zones
		2.2.1.11: Roll-out of the Implementation JFM in Protected Area buffer zones	- 179 hectares of land n buffer zones protected
		2.2.1.12. Implement Climate Resilient infrastructure investments	- Implement Climate Resilient infrastructure investments
		2.2.1.13. Community Agricultural equipment for productivity improvement	- 400 villages with improved access to agricultural equipment - Purchase of community-shared equipment
Component 3: Strengthening livelihoods for enhanced resilience through market based approaches			
Activity 3.1.1. Improving the genetic potential of smallholder farmers' livestock.	Provision of breeding services (AI and improved bulls) to farmers in the 400 targeted communities to improve productivity of cattle and support transition towards more intensive production systems involving a reduced number of animals	3.1.1.1. Training of youth in Artificial Insemination	- 50 youth from the beneficiary communities trained as AI technicians
		3.1.1.2. Organization of Artificial Insemination Campaigns	- 100,000 AI performed (20,000 per year) - Purchase of equipment and software - Refurbishment of office spaces
		3.1.1.3. Establish Off-Farm Mating stations	- 300 off-farm mating stations with improved bulls established
Activity 3.1.2. Support to delivery of private animal health services	Ensuring population's access to quality veterinary services through training and provision of veterinary instruments, motorcycles to private veterinarians and support of institutions responsible for the development of a private veterinary service	3.1.2.1. Institutional support to Tajik Veterinary Association (TVA)	- TVA's office and training rooms refurbished and equipped (office equipment, furniture, a car). - National Specialist on Continuous Veterinary Education recruited
		3.1.2.2. Training of private veterinarians	- 1,988 private vets have been trained (total project duration)
		3.1.2.3. Equipping private veterinarians	- 284 private vets have been provided with veterinary packages according to their needs
		3.1.2.4. Mobility of private veterinarians	- 284 private vets have been provided with motorbikes
Activity: 3.1.3: Support adoption of climate resilient innovative technologies	The project will support the dissemination of these technical innovations and their adoption by smallholder farmers through a combination of demonstrations and hands on training activities.	3.1.3.1. Promotion of technical climate smart innovations through kick-off demonstrations and exchange visits	- 11 demo plots of climate resilient agricultural practices (with focus on fodder cultivation) established - 200 fields days (gathering each participant from 2 villages) organized every year on demo plots
		3.1.3.2. Promotion of technical climate smart innovations through roll-out demonstrations and exchange visits	- Roll-out for the establishment of demo plots (1 demo plot by district) 21 demo-plots climate resilient agricultural practices
		3.1.3.3. Organization of Exchange visits to promote the use of technical climate smart innovations	- Exchange visits (1 visit per district per year)
		3.1.3.4. Development of FFS curricula and training of facilitators	- 3 master trainers trained. - 40 FFS facilitator trained. - FFS training curriculum developed
		3.1.3.5: Roll out of FFS	- 80 FFS established

			- 2000 farmers trained
Activity 3.2.1 Identification of market and business opportunities	Facilitate identification and contracting of business partnerships between groups of small holder farmers and aggregators, to facilitate access to market and services	3.2.1.1. Kick-off of the identification of the market and business opportunities	- 9 value chains (8 for dairy,1 for beef) stakeholder consultation meetings organized
		3.2.1.2. Rolling-out the Identification of market and business opportunities	- 14 feasibility/business plans for productive alliances in livestock value chains conducted
		3.2.1.3. Feasibility studies of proposed business arrangements including Productive Alliances	- Conduct of feasibility study (addressing technical, economic and market aspects)
Activity 3.2.2. Provision of financing and technical support to the business partnerships for selected livestock commodities.	The provision of grants and technical assistance to the productive alliances established with the private sector and local entrepreneurs.	3.2.2.1. Financing of business arrangements including Productive Alliances.	- Productive alliances formed.
		3.2.2.2. Technical and business assistance to business arrangements including Productive Alliances.	- Strengthened productive alliance exist on the ground.
Activity 3.3.1. Strengthening of CIGs capacity	The Project will facilitate establishment of two types of common interest groups (CIGs) to access support services to identify, analyse and adopt climate resilient production practices.	3.3.1.1: Support to production/diversification CIGs	- Identification and capacity building of 1020 CIGs in 400 villages
		3.3.1.2: Provision of rooms and halls for meetings, trainings	- Provision of MoA space for meetings, trainings
		Sub activity 3.3.1.3: Support to market-linked CIGs	- Service Provider identifies 110 groups - 110 groups in villages will be served trainings by service provider on business plan writing, business planning, and proposal writing and looking at farm as a business.
		3.3.1.4: Capacity building on climate smart resilient technologies for Window 1 and 2 beneficiaries.	- CIGs receive capacity building support.
Activity 3.3.2. Management of the CIG matching grant program	Matching grant facility will be established for implementation of matching grant program for Window 1 and Window 2	3.3.2.1: Matching grant manual developed	- Grant manual developed - Internal Review committee established
		3.3.2.2: Involvement of specialists from agricultural departments for matching grants implementation	- MOA extension agents and specialists available
		3.3.2.3: Launch of the MGF	- Communication campaign to be organized (distribution of leaflets, informing communities via radio and other media channels) in 21 districts.
		3.3.2.4: Launch of the MGF (Window 2)	- Provision of goods/equipment/inputs to grant beneficiaries under Window 2

E.7. Monitoring, reporting and evaluation arrangements (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

140. ***M&E Structure:*** A monitoring and evaluation system will be established for the CASP+ project in keeping with the guidelines of GCF to report on the integrated Results Management Framework (IRMF).[227] The logframe indicators will be monitored and coordinated by the MoA (via PMU) as lead implementing agency responsible for the major share of the work. Three M&E Units will be established, one in the PMU, one in CEP-CIIP, and one in FAO. M&E Specialists will be recruited to oversee the monitoring of all key components. FAO and CEP-CIIP will be responsible for monitoring and reporting on the sub-activities directly under their respective responsibilities (summarized in Table 2, above, and Annex 4). They will submit regular reports to the PMU which will consolidate these and send them on to IFAD and GCF for their review. As the AE of the GCF for the current project, IFAD will oversee the process and submit the reports to GCF.

141. ***Key M&E Responsibilities:*** All executing agencies will be responsible for ensuring that the agencies working under their supervision provide them quarterly progress reports. These reports will be consolidated into annual progress reports and sent by CEP and FAO to MoA (via PMU) who will submit an Annual Performance Report to IFAD and GCF. The responsibility for reporting on the progress under each component will be assumed by the agency responsible for ensuring its implementation in the field directly or through supervision by another implementing partner. All contracts or MOUs with implementing partners will specify their responsibility with respect to sex-disaggregated data collection and reporting. The implementing partners will submit reports to SEPMU, CEP or FAO depending upon which agency is overall responsible for overseeing the specific aspect on the ground. Specific implementation arrangements of all activities and sub-activities are described in the Project Implementation Manual, section 4 (**Annex 21**).

142. ***Types of Reports***: CEP, MoA (via PMU) and FAO will formulate an Annual Work Plan & Budget based on the annual physical targets based on the implementation plan (Annex 5) which will be approved by the PSC and approved by both IFAD and GCF. Consistent with the AWP&B, reporting formats will be developed for each of the reports namely the monthly statistical reports, the quarterly statistical and narrative reports and the Annual Performance Reports (APRs) by the M&E staff of each of the executing agencies and coordinated at the level of the MoA (via PMU) into one consolidated report. The Annual Performance Reports (APRs) will document the progress towards achieving the indicators (both cumulative and annual progress, respectively) in GCF's Performance Managed Framework and any additional project level indicators. APRs will also contain a narrative with updates on the progress of each output and outcome envisaged at the project level. The Logical Framework is composed of a combination of GCF-specific indicators and IFAD corporate core indicators. The two sets of indicators have been synergized as much as possible, when different, both reporting formats (i.e., GCF's and IFAD's Operational Results Management System - ORMS) will be respected and reported upon. The contracts with each implementing agency will specify their reporting responsibilities, the frequency of the reports to be produced and provide them with the formats to be used. All partners will be required to review the Gender Action Plan which is an integral part of the proposal and report on the implementation and indicators of specific aspects related to gender. All data will be disaggregated by sex to enable an assessment of the progress in inclusion of women in the project.

143. The key reports that will be submitted have been identified in the M&E Reporting Matrix given below together with their timelines and reporting responsibility. More details are provided in **Annex 11** and **Annex 21** (Table 12, Types of report, timeline and responsibility). MoA (via PMU), CEP and FAO as the main implementing partners will be responsible for maintaining records on all project activities on standard reporting formats. All implementing partners will be required to provide information on the core indicators, impact, outcome and output level indicators specified in the PMF. The APRs will include the status of each funded activity throughout the relevant reporting period, including a narrative report on implementation progress based on the logical framework attached to this Funding Proposal. The APR will be submitted to IFAD and the GCF Secretariat on an annual basis for the period ending on 31 December within sixty (60) days after the end of the relevant annual period, with the first APR required to be submitted following the end of the calendar year after the Parties have entered into the relevant FAA, and the last APR required to be submitted within six (6) months of the end of the relevant Reporting Period.

144. **MIS System**: An MIS system will be developed for the project to record key information of all beneficiary households. The M&E Unit in PMU will coordinate and produce a consolidated MIS report for the project as a whole. Within the first quarter of the second year, when activities have been initiated and sufficient outreach has been achieved and the M&E data base begins to get populated, thematic maps will be generated by the project and will be monitored through consolidated remote sensing practices or geospatial analysis. This is expected to yield a better understanding of trends and patterns and make the analysis more meaningful in understanding the relationship between climate parameters and the pattern of adoption and participation in project activities. The MIS system will geo-reference all activities using FAO's Remote Sensing application- Earth Map. The MIS system will also record beneficiary phone numbers for feedback from participants. The MIS system will also be used for tracking beneficiaries over time and assessing impact.

145. **CsCAP Monitoring**: innovative methods will be employed to engage and incentivise stakeholders, including youth, to use smartphones for field reporting and ground truthing of remote sensing. A bridge will be established between the diagnostic output and citizen reporting to provide a means of tracking the realisation of predictions made, and the effects of CsCAP implementation. The approach will be integrated into updated formats of the annual reports submitted by these bodies. These will also appear as geotagged report points on the mapping portal produced under Component 1, alongside the layers that report on the status of NRM. The project will also introduce and pilot test some innovative approaches to assessing bio-diversity in pastures by using apiculture techniques (see component 1).

146. ***Survey Methods:*** The project will commission a Baseline Survey by a third party in year one against which subsequent changes and impact will be measured. To measure attributable changes, the evaluations will draw on mixed-methods, using qualitative methods (e.g. participatory rural appraisal, focus group discussions, key informant interviews, etc.,) in combination with counterfactual analysis (e.g. quasi-experimental methods, depending on the existence of reliable control group data from the project's baseline and completion surveys, which will be confirmed during project inception). All surveys and impact assessments will be sex-disaggregated and key gender-sensitive indicators both quantitative and qualitative outlined in the Gender Action Plan will be captured in the initial and subsequent surveys and findings. In addition, all impact evaluations will be conducted by external parties to ensure independence.

147. ***Interim and final evaluations***. IFAD has a well-structured system for undertaking annual supervision missions, a mid-term review and a project completion report. The project will undertake surveys at mid-term and at completion to assess the performance of the project, draw important lessons and incorporate beneficiary feedback. The evaluator will assess the paradigm shift potential and sustainable development potential via a three-point scale scorecard that is being developed by the GCF Secretariat. The external surveys will feed into these review reports. The interim or mid-term survey will incorporate key aspects of impact on the targeted households up to that period and will be incorporated in IFAD's Mid-Term Review Report. At project completion, a final impact assessment will be undertaken to assess the overall impact of the project on the beneficiaries. The mid-term and final impact will compare project results with the expected outreach, adoption of climate adaptation practices and assess the overall impact on the paradigm shifts outlined in the project log-frame and the indicators of resilience outlined at the impact level. The project completion review will also assess the extent to which the intervention has contributed to the Fund's higher-level goal of achieving a paradigm shift in adaptation to climate change at the national level and in the selected project districts in Tajikistan. The AE will also hold participatory workshops at the interim and final evaluation stages as necessary.

148. ***Quality control and quality assurance measures***: Each agency will establish a system for a periodic audit of the quality of its reports by fact checking 5% to 10% of the reports submitted by its staff. In addition, the M&E Units of PMU and CEP will also depute its staff in the field to fact check and verify 5% to 10% of the reports submitted by the implementing agencies or its own staff. Regular field visits will be undertaken for the verification with a well specified approach to engaging the beneficiary group representatives in the process and recording how the process and consultations were conducted.

149. ***Beneficiary Feedback***: Each partner will also establish a mechanism for beneficiary feedback and demonstrate how they have incorporated the feedback in improving their implementation approach. A beneficiaryfeedback will also be prepared by each implementing partner on an annual basis and will form

part of the Annual Performance Report (APR). The implementing agency will ensure that the beneficiary feedback is organized so that the reports provide sex-disaggregated perspectives. The MoA (via PMU) and CEP-CIIP will also establish a grievance redress system which will be communicated by each implementing agency to the participants to enable them to directly access the system in a manner which guarantees their confidentiality. IFAD and GCF's procedures for complaints related to the Environmental and Social Standards will be adopted.

150. ***Learning and knowledge management***: KM is a key element of the project, as such the Project is endowed with a dedicated communication/KMofficer (in CEP). The project will synthesize the lessons learned, including on innovations and mainstreaming gender. These lessons will be shared with the NDA and the NCCC to enable them to incorporate them in the strategies and plans being developed by the country in its NAP and other key strategy documents. TAs working on specific topics and policy briefs will be required to develop these products. IFAD and FAO will also capitalize on their in-house experience to undertake the development of knowledge products for wider dissemination.. All innovations, approaches and processes will be documented, to generate lessons learned and policy briefs, including on fodder. This will ultimately enable policy makers to incorporate in national policies and strategies, as integral part of the paradigm shift.

151. ***Communication***: All the interventions, data and results generated by the project will be effectively communicated and disseminated to the different stakeholders and beneficiaries at the national and district level (in Russian and English as required). Specialized services will be contracted to implement gender-sensitive communications campaigns which will include the use of knowledge-sharing platforms and social-media networks to promote participation, awareness raising and to strengthen project´s partnerships.

F. RISK ASSESSMENT AND MANAGEMENT

F.1. Risk factors and mitigations measures (max. 3 pages)

Selected Risk Factor 1	**Lack of institutional Coordination and Capacity**	
Category	**Probability**	**Impact**
Governance	High	Medium
Description		
Lack of Institutional Coordination and Capacity: There is limited capacity and coordination at the inter-ministerial level between MOA, CEP, SFA, MEDT, MoEWR, Committee of Emergency situations and Civil defense (CES) and other relevant institutions in the country. There is also limited expertise in understanding and awareness about climate change and climate risks as well as how to bets plan and allocate resources for investment in the green economy at the national level. There is also limited coordination between institutions at the central level and those at lower tiers. Although there is widespread understanding at the upper levels of the national government as to the seriousness of the challenges associated with climate change there is no consensus on how to address these challenges. Capacity gaps and lack of institutional arrangements have hindered CEP's ability to fulfil its role. Currently, there are no procedures for ensuring that climate change adaptation and planning and implementation are inclusive processes that encourage active involvement of NGOs, private sector and result in adaptation measures that respond to the needs of the most vulnerable. Inability to integrate climate change adaptation considerations into the national development planning processes or in local level planning hinder the process of adaptation. There is also lack of coordination and synergy between disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation. Ineffective coordination and knowledge sharing decreases effectiveness and impact of NAP process.[228] CEP staff at local levels in general have limited knowledge of climate change and adaptation aspects, and they have no guidance or procedures on how to advise or monitor adaptation activities that take place at subnational levels, either on the part of NGOs, local governments, or individuals.		

Mitigation Measure(s)		
There are several GCF supported readiness grants and projects for strengthening the capacity of CEP and the overall institutional coordination in the country. One main result of the first GCF Readiness grant was the formulation of a draft decree to establish a Coordinating Council on the Green Climate Fund under the GoT. The decree has been submitted to the government for approval. The focus of this decree is to coordinate activities, interventions, and projects that are currently being funded by the GCF or will be funded in the future. However, the specific roles of the NDA and the Coordination Council are not clarified in the draft decree. The current NAP Readiness proposal is expected to address this issue. The NAP project also has a major capacity building component aimed at strengthening human resources in the CEP and priority sector agencies. These capacity building activities have been designed to respond to specific gaps and weaknesses. The NAP project is designed to focus on clearly delineating institutional relationships related to climate change adaptation to improve vertical and horizontal coordination, facilitate the integration of climate change adaptation into national development planning activities, and strengthen data and information capabilities, which support evidence-based policy-making and project design and strength the capacity for inclusion of green economy investments. The current CASP+ project will further strengthen the coordination and institutional capacity of some of the key agencies dealing with mitigation and adaptation measures. Further, CASP+ is designed to integrate climate adaptation and green economy initiatives into planning at the local level by initiating a participatory process which will involve all key agencies at the district level. This approach is expected to enhance coordination among the key agencies dealing with various key sectors most impacted by climate change such as water and agriculture and adopt a more inclusive approach involving women, youth, women headed households and integrate disaster risk reduction into the planning process.		
Selected Risk Factor 2 **Delay in project approval**		
Category	**Probability**	**Impact**
Governance	High	Medium
Description		
Delay in project approval: Overall, there have been significant delays in the approval of projects in Tajikistan including GCF proposals in the past. IFAD has also experienced delays in the approval of its projects in the country. The delay can be attributed to both the processes instituted by the financiers as well as the Government. The delays are further exacerbated during implementation as implementing agencies establish their implementation arrangements and then initiate procurement of goods and services.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		
IFAD and FAO have undertaken the design process for CASP+ in close coordination with key Government agencies particularly with Ministry of Finance, CEP, Ministry of Agriculture and key committees and agencies that are involved in the implementation of the project. The purpose of the close interaction was to ensure a high degree of ownership and commitment of the Government and ensure the approval of the project in a timely manner. IFAD's has a close working relationship with key Government agencies and has a rich history of implementation of projects in the country. The current project is patterned on an on-going project which is well regarded by the Government, and this will help expedite approval by Government. Implementation of the current project on the ground will be expedited given that the project will use the existing implementation arrangements of the on-going CASP project for which a Project Management Unit is already in place and will be strengthened.		
Selected Risk Factor 3 **Financial management and fiduciary risks**		
Category	**Probability**	**Impact**

Governance	Medium	Medium
Description		
Financial aspects are another factor which pose a risk and contribute to persistent delays in projects. Lack of strong procurement capacity is a key challenge as procurement plans are not developed in a timely manner and procedures are not always strictly followed. The lead time required for procurement is seldom predicted with accuracy. The inordinate delay has an impact on project allocation and efficiency due to the inflationary impact of the delay on market prices. The inexperience of implementing partners with the procurement processes of the financing agencies can often cause further delay as some of the procurement has to be retendered. The Government does not have strong systems for financial management and there is no well- defined system for internal or external audits. The country is assigned a score of high at the country level for financial risk.[229] Tajikistan ranks 162 out of 180 countries according to the Transparency International's Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) for 2023 with a score of 20/100. Tajikistan's score is one of the three scores that are at the bottom of the Eastern Europe and Central Asia region with an average score of 35 for the region.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		
At CEP, a dedicated CIIP has been established for implementation based on the successful experience of CEP implementing a large range of GCF proposals and its strengthening due to the UNDP readiness support as part of the NAP preparation process. Both CEP and MoA have strengthened their procurement experience because of their implementation of donor projects. In addition, strong procurement and financial management arrangements will be put in place with a detailed procurement plan for the seven-year project with an annual review and refinement of the overall plan. Since the effectiveness of IFAD-funded portion of CASP+ (April 2023), IFAD has started reinforcing the financial management system of CASP+ by hiring dedicated and qualified financial management and procurement staff for both CEP and MoA. The project will use a standardized accounting software and proper internal control measures including flow of funds and reporting channels for implementing partners. IFAD procurement rules will be adopted with strong implementation support provided by the Financial Management Services Division (FMD) within IFAD. A strong system of financial reporting has been put in place and all partners will be expected to adopt the reporting requirements that are clearly specified in the GCF and IFAD AMA.		
Selected Risk Factor 4 Limited engagement of the private sector		
Category	**Probability**	**Impact**
Technical and operational	Medium	Medium
Description		
Limited engagement of the private sector: Engaging the private sector in adaptation in Tajikistan is an on-going challenge. The private sector is small with limited capacity working in a relatively small market dependent on agriculture and government spending. In its Country Programme for Tajikistan, the NDA has limited ideas or proposals related to the private sector.[230] When looking at the project priority ideas in its country program, they focus on public provision of irrigation, energy, capacity building, or transport. Without private sector engagement, it will be difficult to establish sustainable climate resilient inputs and technologies provision. Lack of collection, transport, storage, and processing facilities infrastructure discourages productive partnerships between smallholders and the private sector. Lack of private sector involvement also limits the potential for innovation and technology transfer, a constraint noted by other GCF funded projects in Tajikistan as well.[231] There is a risk that the private sector may not fully participate due to the fragmented nature of production, i.e., many smallholders, who cannot guarantee production quality or quantity. The current CASP+ project will facilitate the participation of the private sector where possible.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		

Part of the NDA's NAP and readiness plan is to support the private sector by identifying potential partners. There are a few projects (Section D.5) that currently involve the private sector such as FP025 which is private sector focused and is already working in the country to engage local financial institutions. FP075 also intends to develop a fee-based service to provide Hydromet data and information to customers in the private sector. One of the key outcomes expected from the NAP readiness project is a suite of activities designed to foster robust private sector engagement and participation in advancing climate change adaptation in Tajikistan. The CASP+ includes several activities designed to engage the private sector in direct partnerships with small producers in the dairy, poultry and crop sector to help in removing constraints along the value chain. A strategy for building productive alliances is being relied upon to encourage the private sector to play a more active role and reduce losses, enhance efficiency and productivity and add value. The private sector will be encouraged through improved infrastructure, equipment and arrangements for storage, transport, processing and trade and providing grants to smallholders which will enable them to increase the quality and quantity of their produce for the market.		
Selected Risk Factor 5 COVID-19 pandemics and emerging influx of refugees		
Category	**Probability**	**Impact**
Other	High	Medium
Description		
COVID-19 pandemics and the influx of Afghan refugees into Tajikistan affects the operations: The COVID-19 pandemic has had a severe impact on the physical and psychological and economic well- being of people. Trade and transportation disruptions have led to a sharp drop in remittances and government revenues and created urgent balance of payments issues and fiscal financing needs. The authorities are concerned about debt sustainability and are preparing consolidation measures that can be implemented over the medium term. While the development of how the pandemic will continue to affect rural areas is unknown, the impact on rural economies has been significant and required substantial changes in the field-level operations. Tajikistan continues to maintain measures imposed to combat the spread of COVID-19, as of mid-April 2021. The world is currently seeing a third wave of the pandemic and it is not possible to predict at the moment how long the restrictions will continue and how they will impact project implementation. The influx of Afghan refugees that began in the immediate aftermath of the US troop withdrawal and the Taliban take over in Afghanistan is expected to exert additional pressure on the natural resources and public sector infrastructure in the country.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		
The overall implementation will factor-in procedures and protocols to proactively ensure high standards of minimization of health risks related to the on-going pandemic. Specifically, this will entail reducing movements in-country and keeping international travel to a minimum, ensuring social distancing measures are in place during any interaction among people during the process of community mobilization, trainings, implementation of physical activities and monitoring. The project will encourage the adoption and use of SOPS and turn to virtual and e-communications as far as possible. The design mission and the consultations for the current proposal were organized mostly virtually with some meetings physically where appropriate. The influx of Afghan refugees was reportedly lower than initial expectations. In case of emerging influx of refugees in the project target areas, the project will inform via Project Steering Committee the relevant authorities at regional and national level.		
Selected Risk Factor 6 Lack of policy engagement of Government on reduction of livestock inventories		
Category	**Probability**	**Impact**
Governance	Medium	Medium
Description		

CASP+ will provide positive incentives to targeted communities to reduce the size of their herds and flocks, through support to intensification (breeding, animal health and capacity building on feeding and milk hygiene), in the targeted communities. It will also ensure that governance mechanisms for sustainable use of pasture are in place, through PUUs, PUAs, PCs and PMPs. However, these measures will be fully efficient and will result in affective reduction of herd size, only if they are associated with regulatory measures that create disincentives for stock accumulation. These measures such as progressive pro-poor quotas and taxes, grazing permits related to carrying capacity of pasture, need to be framed in national laws and regulations to enable local governments and PUUs to enforce them. It is expected that the adoption and enforcement of such measures will not be welcomed by the larger livestock owners, who have good lobbying capacities and may prevent the policy process to go through.
Mitigation Measure(s)
This risk will be mitigated by involving a large variety of stakeholders in the consultation process that will be facilitated by the project for the review of the pasture law, under which these measures should be mainstreamed. PUUs and PUAs should play an active role in these consultations, but also academia and environmental organizations. This will allow building a position which is both evidence-based and pro-poor, and will counter negative lobbying of opponents of these reforms.

G. GCF POLICIES AND STANDARDS

G.1. Environmental and social risk assessment (max. 750 words, approximately 1.5 pages)

152. The project is categorized as a Category B based on an evaluation procedure and a standardized questionnaire that assessed the likelihood, frequency, intensity, manageability, duration and reversibility of a range of risks and the significance of potential impacts were low (or medium in few cases). An ESMP is given in Annex 6 and a detailed Social, Environmental and Climate Assessment Procedures (SECAP)232 review note showing the output from the environmental and social analysis is presented in Annex 2. The screening of the CASP+ was conducted on a preliminary basis at the project concept stage for consideration at the Operational Strategy and Policy Guidance Committee (OSC) review stage, and then finalized in advance of the quality enhancement review. The consultations that took place as part of the design process confirmed the initial screening. The assessment process involves a review and approval of project documentation by IFAD's Executive Board, the MOA (via PMU) and the CEP as part of the project cycle approval process. In all the steps, a number of internal and external evaluators provided inputs and peer review of the process.

153. CASP+ is designed to introduce a series of measures that will strengthen the development and governance of natural resource management. Pasture management and joint forestry management plans are expected to promote the restoration of degraded pastures through rotation and fencing, and improvement of vegetation cover and the reforestation of upstream degraded areas. The project will introduce remote and participatory monitoring to improve natural resource management. The project will enhance technical capacities of national livestock institutions to ensure efficient provision of public animal health and production services to smallholder farmers through efficient partnership between public and private institutions. The project will build capacities of research and academia institutions on climate resilient ecosystem management.

154. The design team carried out extensive stakeholder consultations- not only to assess the ESS risks and design mitigation measures to ensure compliance with GCF's ESS and IFAD's SECAP standards- but also to maximise the potential of environmental and social benefits. As outlined in Annex 7, the design team met with institutions such as CEP, NBBC, CAREC, Little Earth, WWF and Zan va Zamin to better understand environmental and social risks in the target areas and related to the planned activities. Focus group discussions with women have been held to better understand specific challenges facing women, girls and children. The project does not envisage any adverse social impact. Prior to implementation, a qualitative assessment of the aspirations of women and men of various age groups, especially the most vulnerable

(female head of households, youth- especially young girls), through focus group discussions, will take place to solicit feedback on the challenges being faced by them, their views on solutions and coping mechanisms, as well as feedback on the training programs and how they can be improved during all programme stage.

155. During the mobilisation process, the project will conduct public consultations at different levels on the programme objectives, eligibility criteria and selection process for specific activities directed to specific social categories, and available grievance redress mechanisms. This will be done in partnership with community leaders and will be executed by an independent Technical Assistance Agency. A complete set of activities, including a free and prior informed consultation (FPIC) plan and community participatory methods have been developed (Annex 6). Direct selection of beneficiaries will take place using pre-established guidelines and targeting criteria reflecting that they are among the most climate vulnerable in Tajikistan (Annex 21). This will ensure community's participation in project development and prevent any potential conflict during implementation. A well-functioning M&E system will allow to detect deviations from beneficiary satisfaction or potential discrimination (e.g. elite capture). Gender mainstreaming actions will be developed as part of a Gender Development Plan (GDP) to sensitize the IP, engage with a variety of stakeholders (political, cultural or religious leaders, health teams, local councils, social workers, women's organizations and groups), to have specific procedures for SEA/SH and to develop an agreed Code of Conduct to address behaviour and undertake regular M&E of progress on SEA/SH prevention and response activities.

156. **Grievance and Redress Mechanism (GRM)**: IFAD's GRM policies will be implemented and can be accessed by beneficiaries, if necessary, to manage project-related grievances that cannot be resolved by the project's Executing Entity. The outline for GRM procedures and guidelines have been developed based on IFAD's corporate complaints procedure to receive and facilitate resolution of concerns and complaints with respect to alleged noncompliance of its environmental and social policies and mandatory aspects of its Social, Environmental and Climate Assessment Procedures. During implementation they will be further fine-tuned and implemented accordingly. The complainants should first bring the matter to the attention of the government or executing entity. However, if the complainants feel they might be subject to retaliation, they may bring the matter straight to IFAD. Explanation of the GRM process will be included in the capacity-building program and the project will organize consultations to determine the most suitable channel for beneficiaries and stakeholders to communicate their concerns and ideas (see Annex 7). As part of the safeguard's performance monitoring, the project will also be responsible for documenting and reporting any grievances received and how they were addressed. The GCF independent Redress Mechanism will be available for assistance at any stage, including before a claim has been made.

G.2. Gender assessment and action plan (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

157. Women suffer disproportionately from the insecurity caused by climate change because they are the ones predominantly responsible for securing food and income from agriculture plots and providing for their families. Women, especially women-headed-households, are among the most vulnerable and account for 40% of those registered as extremely poor.[233] Women have limited access to decision making, productive assets, productive opportunities and services. According to the Labour Market Analysis (Tajstat, 2016) 46% of the total population is engaged in the agriculture sector, with women being 61% of the total. Despite the high proportion of women in the sector, they lack access to key resources and are under-represented in decision-making bodies: (i) only 52% of women headed HHs compared to 86% men headed HHs own land and they own small and less productive plots;[234] (ii) Women-headed dekhan farms account for 13% compared to 87% for men[235] and (iv) women face greater difficulties accessing knowledge, services and capital. According to FAO, 31% of women hold management position in Pastoral Users Unions (PUUs) but they are absent from Forest Management Committees. However, they have a critical role to play as practitioners, and agents of change in climate resilience and biodiversity conservation as reflected in key documents such as: (i) the National Strategy for Enhancing the Role of Women in the Republic of Tajikistan (2010); (ii) the National Development Strategy of the Republic of Tajikistan 2030; (iii) the Sixth National Report on the convention of Biological Diversity (2019).

158. In line with GCF's Gender policy, the project design is based on the understanding that gender relations, roles and responsibilities exercise important influences on women's and men's access to and control over decisions, assets and resources, information, and knowledge. This in turn influences their resilience and capacity to adapt to climate change risks. This was confirmed by the stakeholder consultation held in the project area. Physical and virtual dialogues were held with both women and men from the project districts. The design team also met remotely with staff from some of the key Ministries, agencies and civil society organizations working on gender issues such as the Committees for Women Affairs and the Ministry of Ministry of Health and Social Protection in Tajikistan.

159. Gender aspects are mainstreamed in each of the three main components of the project as well as the project management arrangements. In Component 1, the GAP ensures that (i) the gender dimension is included in evidence based studies and visibility of women's role, needs and priorities in CC adaptation is integrated into policy development (i.e. forest, pasture). In Component 2, the GAP ensures that women are involved as decision-makers in relevant committees; (ii) their view is captured in development of CsCAPs (iii) they are equipped with the knowledge, skills and resources they need to play that role. In Component 3, women will benefit equally from (i) training on climate smart agricultural practices (FFs) (iii) formation of Common Interest groups (CIG) and trainings on marketing and business skills (iii) financing of small investment projects aimed at strengthening household's resilience. Women and Women Headed Households will be given priority.

160. A Gender Assessment and a Gender Action Plan (GAP) has been developed for the project and is elaborated in Annex 8. The Gender Action Plan of the project aims to have a transformative impact on women's role in climate change through their engagement in climate smart agriculture practices and leadership in natural resource management. The GAP ensures that 50% of all direct and indirect beneficiaries of the project will be women and that they will hold at least 30% of all leadership positions. The GAP focusses on ensuring (i) strengthening the visibility of women's role, needs and priorities in climate change adaptation as part of the policy development process (ii) increasing women's voice and representation in local development planning process and decision making bodies (iii) increasing women's opportunities to adopt climate adaptive practices to reduce their vulnerability.

161. The responsibility for mainstreaming gender will be included in the ToR of the PMU Gender Expert. Data collected on project indicators will be sex and age-disaggregated and project reports will include sex-disaggregated findings, analysis and recommendations.

G.3. Financial management and procurement (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

162. **Financial Management:** IFAD will be responsible for the overall financial management of GCF funds. IFAD has a well-established system in place and has very well defined financial management and procurement procedures and guidelines which will be adopted. Disbursement, administration and processing of GCF proceeds by IFAD shall be in accordance with IFAD rules, policies and procedures applicable to the extent and scope of its Accreditation with GCF, in order to allow it to comply with its obligations under this Agreement. All financial management and procurement arrangements and responsibilities, including financial accounting, disbursement methods and auditing will be specified under the Funded Activity Agreement (FAA) and will be aligned with the process and method agreed in the Accreditation Master agreement (AMA) between GCF and IFAD. IFAD will ensure that a financial management system is maintained, with separate statements, accounts and records of its own and GCF proceeds in accordance with International Financial Reporting Standards. The financial information will be audited annually by independent external auditors selected in accordance with IFAD's policies and furnished to the Fund.

163. IFAD will provide to GCF the following financial information in the agreed form and means:

i. on a semi-annual basis within ninety (90) days after 30 June and 31 December of each year (or such other frequency agreed in the FAA): (i) the dates and amounts disbursed for Funded Activities, for the period reported and cumulative amounts up to the period, broken down by each Funded Activity, and compliance with financial covenants; (ii) the actual expenses for the Funded Activities for the period reported and cumulative amounts up to the period, broken down by each Funded Activity; (iii) (A) the date on which any Funded Activity is financially closed, (B) the final amount disbursed for such Funded Activity, (C) the amount of any unused funds from such Funded Activity, and (D) the amount of such unused funds paid to the Fund, for the period reported, broken down by each such Funded Activity; the dates and amounts of any Reflowed Funds received by the Accredited Entity from Funded Activities, as well as the amount of such Reflowed Funds paid to the Fund, for the period reported and cumulative amounts up to the period, broken down by each Funded Activity; and (v) a statement of Investment Income earned on GCF Proceeds, as well as the amount of such Investment Income paid to the Fund;

ii. within four (4) months after the end of the GCF Fiscal Year, an unaudited annual financial statement for each of the Funded Activities and the GCF Account containing the information required under Clauses 17.02(a)(i), 17.02(a)(ii) and 17.02(a)(v) with specific Funded Activities listed in a separate annex, and within six (6) months after the end of the GCF Fiscal Year, an audited annual financial statement for each of the Funded Activities and the GCF Account containing the same information;

iii. within three (3) months after expiration or termination of this Agreement, an unaudited final financial statement for the GCF Account, and within six (6) months after expiration or termination, and an audited final financial statement for the GCF Account, in each case regarding the period since the last period covered by the statements referred to in Clause 17.02(b) above; and (d) such other reports related to funds disbursed by the Fund to the Accredited Entity, as may reasonably be requested by the Fund from time to time.

164. **Procurement:** As part of the detailed design for the CASP+, mission assessed the public procurement systems and procuring institutions that would handle procurement under CASP+.[236] The Government of Tajikistan is currently in the process of strengthening its procurement regulations. However, the Public Procurement Law does not fully meet international standards. According to the World Bank and ADB's Country Procurement Status Review, the EBRD's procurement assessment, as well as the Public Expenditure and Financial Accountability Assessment, found weaknesses in Tajikistan's public procurement system, which have critical gaps in compatibility with IFAD's applicable Procurement Guidelines and procedures. Despite significant progress, there is lack of a clear strategy and sufficient technical skills to design and implement an e-procurement system or a broader public sector modernization agenda. Externally financed projects undertake their work based on their own procurement rules and guidelines. In view of the above, the procurement of Goods and Services for Funded Activities, by the Executing Entities or by a third party, shall be done in accordance with the rules, policies and procedures of IFAD to the extent and scope of its Accreditation and FAO where relevant. IFAD's Procurement Guidelines, its Procurement Handbooks and provisions stipulated in the Financing Agreement/Letter to the Borrower will be followed.

165. FAO will use its own procurement rules for those activities under its responsibility regardless of the source of financing. The procurement of goods, works and services to be financed from the proceeds of IFAD's financing which FAO receives would be in accordance with the FAO Procurement procedures and guidelines. This implementation arrangement is based on an assessment done by IFAD of the FAO Procurement system. During implementation, FAO shall observe the following specific principles: (a) procurement would be carried out in accordance with the Financing Agreement and any duly agreed amendments thereto; (b) it would be conducted within the project implementation period, except as provided in the financing agreement; (c) the cost of the procurement is not to exceed the availability of duly allocated funds as per financing agreement, and (d) the Revised IFAD Policy on Preventing Frauds and Corruption in its Activities and Operations are to be respected.

166. In order to mitigate any procurement risks, the project will undertake the following tasks: (1) Develop a PIM and PPM to mitigate the inconsistency with a national procurement manual; (2) Use and follow IFAD Procurement Guidelines and Procurement Handbook; (3) Build the capacity of the PIU Procurement consultant to fill any competency, skills and knowledge on IFAD procurement procedures; (4) Recruit additionally procurement consultant/assistance for both PMU and CEP-CIIP; (5) The PMU and PIU should apply the IFAD Guidelines in their activities and adopt procurement documentation in line with the standard forms agreed with IFAD.

167. Project start-up activities will include the following: (1) Development of a PIM; (2) Prepare and publish the General Procurement Notice on the UNDB website; (3) Build the capacity of the PIU Procurement consultant to fill any competency and knowledge on IFAD procurement procedures; (4) Recruit additionally procurement consultant/assistance for both PMU and PIU; (5) Make amendments to PPM, adapt to CASP+ and submit to IFAD; (6) Finalization of the Procurement Plan for the first 18 months.

168. An procurement plan (**Annex 10**) has been provided based on the project budget (**Annex 4**) and the expected timelines (**Annex 5**) using the IFAD procurement methods to be used, prior review thresholds and pre-qualification requirements for both goods and services. The MoA (via PMU), CEP-CIIP and FAO will prepare annual procurement plans and submit for IFAD's approval. The Letter to the Borrower (LTB) from IFAD to the GoT will specify the thresholds and Prior/Post review conditions. GCF will transfer funds to IFAD on the basis of an annual workplan from which an annual procurement and disbursement schedule will be developed by the three executing entities which will be responsible for procuring the goods and services needed to fulfil their area of responsibility. IFAD will ensure that all implementing agencies maintain documents adequately to record the progress of individual funded activities including records evidencing use of GCF Proceeds under each Funding Activity Agreement (FAA) are retained until at least five (5) years after the relevant Reporting Period.

169. All contracts executed by CEP-CIIP, MoA (via PMU) and FAO will be maintained in IFAD's Contract Register template. IFAD will undertake annual supervision missions that will review the tender process and related documents for all contracts executed by CEP-CIIP, MoA (via PMU) and FAO. An annual procurement review will be prepared and submitted to IFAD and GCF management. IFAD will stipulate that the executing entities will ensure that the representatives of the Fund are able to examine all records and are provided all such information concerning such records as they may from time-to-time reasonably request; and the information relating to Funded Activities required to be disclosed by the Accredited Entity pursuant to the Information Disclosure Policy is made publicly available in a timely fashion pursuant thereto.

170. **Audit:** There will be a system of regular internal and external audit in place. The internal audit system will be established as an integral part of the financial management system. An annual external audit will be undertaken by hiring an internal auditor consultant who reviews the controls for the operational and community activities.

G.4. Disclosure of funding proposal

☒ No confidential information: The accredited entity confirms that the funding proposal, including its annexes, may be disclosed in full by the GCF, as no information is being provided in confidence.

☐ With confidential information: The accredited entity declares that the funding proposal, including its annexes, may not be disclosed in full by the GCF, as certain information is being provided in confidence. Accordingly, the accredited entity is providing to the Secretariat the following two copies of the funding proposal, including all annexes:

- full copy for internal use of the GCF in which the confidential portions are marked accordingly, together with an explanatory note regarding the said portions and the corresponding reason for confidentiality under the accredited entity's disclosure policy, and
- redacted copy for disclosure on the GCF website.

The funding proposal can only be processed upon receipt of the two copies above, if containing confidential information.

H. ANNEXES

H.1. Mandatory annexes

☒	Annex 1	NDA no-objection letter(s) **(template provided)**
☒	Annex 2	Feasibility study - and a market study, if applicable
☒	Annex 3	Economic and/or financial analyses in spreadsheet format
☒	Annex 4	Detailed budget plan **(template provided)**
☒	Annex 5	Implementation timetable including key project/programme milestones **(template provided)**
☒	Annex 6	E&S document corresponding to the E&S category (A, B or C; or I1, I2 or I3): **(ESS disclosure form provided)** ☐ Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) or ☐ Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP) or ☐ Environmental and Social Management System (ESMS) ☒ Others (please specify): Social Environment and Climate Assessment (SECAP)
☒	Annex 7	Summary of consultations and stakeholder engagement plan
☒	Annex 8	Gender assessment and project/programme-level action plan **(template provided)**
☒	Annex 9	Legal due diligence (regulation, taxation and insurance)
☒	Annex 10	Procurement plan **(template provided)**
☒	Annex 11	Monitoring and evaluation plan **(template provided)**
☒	Annex 12	AE fee request **(template provided)**
☒	Annex 13	Co-financing commitment letter, if applicable **(template provided)**
☐	Annex 14	Term sheet including a detailed disbursement schedule and, if applicable, repayment schedule

H.2. Other annexes as applicable

☐	Annex 15	Evidence of internal approval **(template provided)**
☒	Annex 16	Map(s) indicating the location of proposed interventions
☐	Annex 17	Multi-country project/programme information **(template provided)**
☒	Annex 18	Completion Report and Impact Assessment of previous IFAD Projects
☐	Annex 19	Procedures for controlling procurement by third parties or executing entities undertaking projects financed by the entity
☐	Annex 20	First level AML/CFT (KYC) assessment
☒	Annex 21	Operations manual (Operations and maintenance)
☒	Annex 22	Theory of Change
☒	Annex 23	Assessment of GHG emission reductions and their monitoring and reporting[237]
☒	Annex 24	Beneficiaries Estimates
☒	Annex 25	Matrix on integrating agro-ecology into CASP+ investment
☒	Annex 26	Detailed project structure and component description (complementary to Section B.3)
☒	Annex 27	Synergies of CASP+ with Climate Finance in Tajikistan
☒	Annex 28	Detailed description of CASP+ Theory of Change
☒	Annex 29	Evolution of IFAD portfolio in Tajikistan and lessons learned
☒	Annex 30	Synoptic Table of IFAD-funded interventions in Tajikistan

** Please note that a funding proposal will be considered complete only upon receipt of all the applicable supporting documents.*

[1] Co-financer's contribution means the financial resources required, whether Public Finance or Private Finance, in addition to the GCF contribution (i.e. GCF financial resources requested by the Accredited Entity) to implement the project or programme described in the funding proposal.
[2] The target reported here in revised v5 reflects the increased capitalization period. The updated carbon accounting update is provided in Annex 23.
[3] Refer to the Policy of Co-financing of the GCF.
[4] ND-GAIN, 2018: https://gain.nd.edu/our-work/country-index/rankings/
[5] An assessment tool that enables easy access to modelling results for crop yields under various climate change scenarios. Developed by the West and Central Africa Division of the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) with funding from Phase II of the Adaptation for Smallholder Agriculture Programme (ASAP2).
[6] https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714170/41085512/Card_usermanual_W.pdf/e867a16c-e581-8038-aa6f-1767a10629a3
[7] Reference to Annex 23 and IFAD, 2022. Management of Livestock Using Rotational Grazing. A critical intervention to promote food security and environmental sustainability in Rural Tajikistan (link here: https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714170/46450319/management-livestock-using-rotational-grazing.pdf/19aae904-771c-f261-e187-4c87d808e839?t=1666781751627).
[8] The target reported here in revised v4 does not reflect the increased capitalization period; carbon accounting update is ongoing.
[9] The 2021 updated NDC covers the agriculture, energy, forestry and biodiversity, industry and construction, and transport and infrastructure sectors, as well as adaptation.
[10] ND-GAIN, 2018: https://gain.nd.edu/our-work/country-index/rankings/
[11] Aalto, J., Kämäräinen, M., Shodmonov, M., Rajabov, N. & Venäläinen, A. Features of Tajikistan's past and future climate. Int. J. Climatol. (2017).
[12] The Third National Communication of the Republic of Tajikistan under the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change, Dushanbe, 2014.
[13] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis – Historical and current climate, Precipitation.
[14] Source: Local weather station data from Pogodaiklimat & global data from Climatic Research Unit – University of East Anglia (CRU)
[15] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis – Historical and current climate, Precipitation, local weather stations analysis
[16] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis – Historical and current climate, Precipitation
[17] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis – Impacts of historical climate change, Snow Extent and water availability
[18] The Centre and North West of the country have an average of 700-900 mm per year compare to the North of the Sughd Region, the East of Gorno-Badakhshan Autonomous Region and the South of the Khatlon Region which receive around 100-300 mm per year for the 1981-2018 period.
[19] Source: Climatic Research Unit – University of East Anglia (CRU) and Climate Hazards Group InfraRed Precipitation with Station data (CHIRPS), respectively.
[20] UNDP. 2013. Human development report 2013. The rise of the South: human progress in a diverse world.
[21] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis – Historical and current climate - Vegetation and cropland: The combination of indexes to build the ASI is showing a negative trend for both grassland and cropland with variations geographically, in time and in intensity.
[22] Greˆt-Regamey A, Brunner SH, Kienast F. 2012. Mountain ecosystem services: Who cares? Mountain Research and Development 32(1):23–34.
[23] Ariza C, Maselli D, Kohler T. 2013. Mountains: Our Life, Our Future. Progress and Perspectives on Sustainable Mountain Development from Rio 1992 to Rio 2012 and Beyond. Bern, Switzerland: SDC [Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation], CDE [Centre for Development and Environment]
[24] Costs of Environmental Degradation in the Mountains of the Republic of Tajikistan Report, World Bank, 2020.
[25] Intended Nationally Determined Contribution (INDC) towards the achievement of the global goal of the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) by the Republic of Tajikistan, 2017.
[26] Climate risks and food security in Tajikistan. A Review of Evidence and Priorities for Adaptation Strategies. April 2017. WFP (RCP4.5 & RCP8.5).
[27] Tajikistan: Country situation assessment Working paper, 2015. CARECECO, PRISE (RCP8.5).
[28] The Climate Change Knowledge Portal: https://climateknowledgeportal.worldbank.org/ (RCP2.6, .RCP4.5, RCP6.0 & RCP8.5)
[29] An assessment tool that enables easy access to modelling results for crop yields under various climate change scenarios. Developed by the West and Central Africa Division of the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) with funding from Phase II of the Adaptation for Smallholder Agriculture Programme (ASAP2).
[30] https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714170/41085512/Card_usermanual_W.pdf/e867a16c-e581-8038-aa6f-1767a10629a3.
[31] Christensen, J. H. et al. Climate phenomena and their relevance for future regional climate change. in Climate Change 2013 the Physical Science Basis: Working Group I Contribution to the Fifth Assessment Report of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (2013).
[32] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis – Historical and current climate, Precipitation, local weather stations analysis.
[33] World Bank. REDUCING MULTI-HAZARD RISKS ACROSS TAJIKISTAN Protecting Communities Through Quality Infrastructure. (2017).
[34] Readiness Proposal. GCF. United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) for Republic of Tajikistan 18 May 2020 | Adaptation Planning.
[35] Climate risks and food security in Tajikistan. A Review of Evidence and Priorities for Adaptation Strategies. April 2017. WFP.
[36] SPECIAL REPORT, FAO/WFP CROP AND FOOD SUPPLY ASSESSMENT MISSION TO TAJIKISTAN, 7 August 2001.
[37] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis - Impacts of historical climate change, Impacts of Natural hazards
[38] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis - Impacts of historical climate change, Vegetation and cropland
[39] SPEI is a multi-scalar drought index based on climatic data (precipitation, evapotranspiration) allowing to account for the effect of temperature on drought development through a basic water balance calculation. SPEI has an intensity scale in which both positive and negative values (-5,5) are calculated, identifying wet and dry events. It can be calculated for time steps of as little as 1 month up to 48 months or more, with longer period deeper layer of soil can be analysed. Source: Copernicus Climate Change Service ERA5 reanalysis.
[40] Fourth National Communication of the Republic of Tajikistan under the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change. Dushanbe, 2022.
[41] Share of Agriculture Emission (AR5) – 2021 data, Source: FAOstat, consulted in March 2024.
[42] USAID. Tajikistan Factsheet, 2019.
[43] There are no specific estimates for this estimated for Tajikistan but globally these are estimated to be 24%. https://www.fao.org/3/i3461e/i3461e.pdf
[44] The climate science community sources a multitude of global climate models to help decision makers understand the projections of future climate change and related impacts, among the most widely used are the Coupled Model Intercomparison Project, Phase 6 (CMIP6) models produced in view of the IPCC's Sixth Assessment Report (AR6), defined by a set of climate model experiments. The analysis presents the CIMP6 ensemble modeling of 11 models, under two scenarios (RCP4.5, the intermediate emission scenario; and RCP8.5, the worse-case emission scenario). The exact values of change can be different between future climate models as they exhibit different sensitivities to the climate forcings. These differences between models are presented in the shaded ranges of figures in the Annex 2, SECAP.
[45] The Climate Change Knowledge Portal: https://climateknowledgeportal.worldbank.org/ (RCP4.5, RCP8.5)
[46] Ibid
[47] Less water available at the end of summer, beginning of autumn: Tajikistan's Third National Communication on Climate Change to the UNFCCC, 2014.
[48] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis - Impacts of historical climate change, Droughts.
[49] This is a climate change vulnerability index: including risks from increased climate variability (higher variance in values of climate variables) and also from changes in the mean values of climate variables.
[50] Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis - Climate Vulnerability analysis in Tajikistan for geographic targeting
[51] Groundnuts, Maize, Managed grass. Rapeseed, Rice, Sorghum, Sunflower, Wheat, Potato.
[52]Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis - Climate Change's impacts on agricultural systems using CARD
[53] IPCC, AR5, 2014.
[54] L. Lipper, N. McCarthy, D. Zilberman, S. Asfaw, G. Branca. 2018. Climate Smart Agriculture, Natural Resource Management and Policy 52, FAO
[55] See Annex 2 – Feasibility Study – Chapter III. Pasture management and animal husbandry.
[56] Abdela, N.; Jilo, K. Impact of climate change on livestock health: A review. Global Vet. 2016, 16, 419–424
[57] R. Hijmans. The effect of climate change on global potato production, July 2003. American Journal of Potato Research 80(4) Follow journal. DOI: 10.1007/BF02855363
[58] Tajikistan's Third National Communication on Climate Change to the UNFCCC, 2014.
[59] See Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis - Climate Vulnerability analysis in Tajikistan for geographic targeting

[60] Climate risks and food security in Tajikistan. A Review of Evidence and Priorities for Adaptation Strategies. April 2017. WFP.
[61] United Nations Development Program (UNDP). 2012. Capacity for climate resiliency in Tajikistan: Stocktaking and Institutional Assessment.
[62] Greˆt-Regamey A, Brunner SH, Kienast F. 2012. Mountain ecosystem services: Who cares? Mountain Research and Development 32(1):23–34.
[63] Ariza C, Maselli D, Kohler T. 2013. Mountains: Our Life, Our Future. Progress and Perspectives on Sustainable Mountain Development from Rio 1992 to Rio 2012 and Beyond. Bern, Switzerland: SDC [Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation], CDE [Centre for Development and Environment]
[64] Disparity of precipitation, higher temperature and more frequent extreme weather events is increasing erosion and disturbing soil structure – See Annex 2: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis – Historical and current climate, Precipitation,
[65] Except for medium risk setting with no irrigation, see details in Annex 16: Climate change impacts, climate vulnerability analysis - Climate Change's impacts on agricultural systems using CARD
[66] See Annex 2. Calvosa et al., 2009.
[67] Readiness Proposal. GCF. United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) for Republic of Tajikistan 18 May 2020 | Adaptation Planning
[68] ADB, Country Partnership Strategy – Tajikistan 2016-2020. https://www.adb.org/sites/default/files/institutional-document/190300/cps-taj-2016-2020.pdf.
[69] https://eca.unwomen.org/en/where-we-are/tajikistan
[70] M. Abdulloev. 2013. Gender Aspects of Agriculture. Dushanbe: State Statistics Agency.
[71] UNDP, socio-economic impact of COVID-19 on lives, livelihoods and micro, small and medium-sized enterprises (MSMEs) in Tajikistan. HYPERLINK "https://www.tj.undp.org/content/tajikistan/en/home/library/impact-of-covid-19-on-lives--livelihoods-and-micro--small-and-me.html" https://www.tj.undp.org/content/tajikistan/en/home/library/impact-of-covid-19-on-lives--livelihoods-and-micro--small-and-me.html
[72]UNDP, socio-economic impact of COVID-19 on lives, livelihoods and micro, small and medium-sized enterprises (MSMEs) in Tajikistan. HYPERLINK "https://www.tj.undp.org/content/tajikistan/en/home/library/impact-of-covid-19-on-lives--livelihoods-and-micro--small-and-me.html" https://www.tj.undp.org/content/tajikistan/en/home/library/impact-of-covid-19-on-lives--livelihoods-and-micro--small-and-me.html
[73] Within the selected districts (as specified in Annex 21, PIM, section 2.3, para 28-onwards): the necessary criteria for Village eligibility and ranking include: a/ Exclusion of villages with less than 80HH and no more than 700 HH; **b/ Exclusion of villages with previous/ongoing meaningful intervention providing the community with similar community investments**; c/ Exclusion of villages with less than 1,000 Sheep Units (SU). 1 sheep/goat = 1 Sheep Unit; 1 cow = 0.2 Sheep Unit); **d/** Exclusion of villages with less than 100ha pasture for their livelihoods; and Ranking criteria to select 400 villages will depend on Sub-catchments vulnerability, based on Climate Vulnerability Index for sub-catchments mapped at design stage.
Climate vulnerability index of Tajikistan, IFAD 2021.
Standardized Precipitation Evapotranspiration Index (SPEI) on 18 months. Climate vulnerability index of Tajikistan, IFAD 2021.
[76] This project is closed, mentioned as its experience is relevant. No village targeted by this project will be targeted by CASP+.
[77] The project builds on government experience including the Environmental Land Management and Rural Livelihoods (ELMARL) Project and CAMP4ASB and other World Bank- and donor-funded projects on agriculture, forestry, pasture, and protected areas in the country. Lessons from ELMARL including that that communities recognized the value of environmental protection for their livelihoods, which served as a motivation to adopt and maintain sustainable land management practices that are now viewed as a viable alternative to 'business-as-usual' agricultural practices.
[78] https://projects.worldbank.org/en/projects-operations/project-detail/P151363 Climate Adaptation and Mitigation Program for Aral Sea Basin (CAMP4ASB).
[79] To the extent that the Coordinating Council on the Green Climate Fund is functioning.
[80] LPDP I and II, KLSP and CASP, referred to later in the Concept Note. Impact assessment Report on the Livestock and Pasture Development Programme LPDP, 2018. https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714170/41114919/TJ_LPDP_IA+report.pdf/46a3c493-b024-e1b2-3f3a-786255cdc035.
[81] DAIMA project under preparation (GCF financing), will cover 4 countries in East Africa (Uganda, Kenya, Tanzania, Rwanda). It will be mutually co-financing and implemented in parallel with IFAD funded national projects in Rwanda, Uganda and Tanzania. The project is cross referred in ¶21 of the FP due to the potential synergies in cross learning and lessons sharing with CASP+. CASP+ and DAIMA have several commonalities, including objectives of transformation/intensification of production systems, environmental protection and GHG reduction, market access, and policy strengthening. Lessons from the dairy value chains in the IFAD-funded projects in Rwanda, Uganda and Tanzania have been useful for CASP+, as the dairy sectors in the EA region are well structured (referred to in **Annex 29**). These lessons include in particular those on the cooperative led Milk Collecting Center Model, which is a key element of the value chain structure, on productive alliances between cooperatives and milk aggregators, on FFS for innovation adoption, on energy efficiency along milk value chain, among others. On the other hand, lessons from Tajikistan on community based pasture management will be extremely useful in East Africa where rangeland degradation has reached a critical point.
[82] Formerly Office International des Epizooties
[83] GCF. Readiness Support with United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) for Republic of Tajikistan. 18 May 2020 | Adaptation Planning.
[84] The Ministry of Economic Development and Trade (MEDT) and the Ministry of Finance (MoF) have specifically requested IFAD to provide technical assistance for the development of the Green economy strategy and building capacity for improving public projects and their green dimension.
[85] IFAD, 2022. LPDP II Impact assessment. https://www.ifad.org/ifad-impact-assessment-report-2021/assets/pdf/impact/Tajikistan/BAR_TAJIKISTAN_RI_REPORT.pdf
[86] CASP+ **Annex 18f**. Rapid assessment of pasture conditions in IFAD-funded project in Khatlon region, showing a/ generalized lower degradation patterns; b/ no change or slight degradation on autumn pastures; and c/ Isolated cases of degradation in spring pasture.
[87] "Declined by 29 per cent as a result of participation in LPDP II for beneficiaries compared to the comparison group." (ibid)
[88] SECAP's Appendix 6: Integrating Agro-Ecological Principles in CASP+.
[89] Strategy to Adapt and Mitigate Potential Impacts of Climate Change on Livestock Production Systems in Tajikistan. MSU and Tajik Academy of Agriculture Sciences. 2011
[90] Ibid.
[91] IFAD's Independent Office of Evaluation has conducted an evaluation of KLSP, published in 2021 – available here https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714182/42864434/tajikistan_1100001408_ppe.pdf/ec8d562b-9646-a384-00c7-bb3d2429c649?t=1623402705705. Annex 18 includes also the Project Completion Report of the LPDP, and the evaluation of LPDP II.
[92] IFAD, 2021 - " https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714182/42864434/tajikistan_1100001408_ppe.pdf/ec8d562b-9646-a384-00c7-bb3d2429c649?t=1623402705705, reported in Annex 18.
[93] GIZ, 2020. Adaptation to climate change through sustainable forest management
[94] Public institutions targeted by the project activities (including on monitoring NR, GHG accounting, and related fields), academia, as well as private financial institutions involved in green economy development (these include Eskhata Bank, Arvand bank, Humo and Imon International are providing credit lines sensitive to GHG reduction activities).
[95] Agency on Statistics under the President of Tajikistan. "Agriculture of Tajikistan". 2020 & Tajikistan in figures. 2020
[96] Gerber, P.J., Steinfeld, H., Henderson, B., Mottet, A., Opio, C., Dijkman, J., Falcucci, A. & Tempio, G. 2013. Tackling climate change through livestock – A global assessment of emissions and mitigation opportunities, FAO, Rome.
[97] Climate change and animal health Juan Lubroth Animal Health Service, FAO, Rome
[98] The KLSP was the first IFAD-funded project in the country, and promoted an innovative, community-driven approach to poverty reduction.
[99] IFAD's Independent Office of Evaluation has conducted an evaluation of KLSP, published in 2021 – available here https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714182/42864434/tajikistan_1100001408_ppe.pdf/ec8d562b-9646-a384-00c7-bb3d2429c649?t=1623402705705. Annex 18 includes also the Project Completion Report of the LPDP, and the evaluation of LPDP II.
[100] LPDP is an IFAD-funded project whose rangeland improvement efforts in Tajikistan focused on improved grazing management for 130,000 ha of rangeland in order to increase sustainable livestock production, using rotational grazing as the principal tool.
[101] Compared to other IFAD portfolio, the CASP 2017-2024 has a higher emphasis on crop-related livelihoods, aiming to stimulate inclusive economic growth and poverty reduction in poor rural communities by improving access to productive infrastructure and services.
[102] Documented in the recently issued "Management of Livestock using rotational grazing. A Critical Intervention to Promote Food Security and Environmental Sustainability in Rural Tajikistan. Brien Norton, IFAD, 2022. Available at: https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714170/46450319/management-livestock-using-rotational-grazing.pdf/19aae904-771c-f261-e187-4c87d808e839?t=1666781751627.

[103] In 2013, during LPDP implementation, the country approved the Pasture Law that decentralized rangeland and livestock management. It authorized the creation of Pasture Users' Unions (PUUs) with an elected Board, giving them authority to manage common rangeland and to exercise fiscal responsibility for improvement of rangeland pastures and fodder crop production. LPDP supported the PUUs' purchase of agricultural equipment and the cost of local infrastructure development efforts.
[104] IFAD executive board has approved CASP+ financing in December 2022, ensuring project effectiveness in April 2023. CASP+ activities have started, with IFAD and other co-financiers frontloading their financing. GCF proceeds will complement activities will provide the required additionality to address climate related challenges and to achieve the relevant climate objectives.
[105] CASP+ disbursement of GCF proceeds is estimated to start in Year 3 (Annex 4).
[106] for the Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use (AFOLU) sector
[107] which uses geo-referenced maps and tools to increase accuracy and account for the ecological value and biodiversity sensitivity of project sites
[108] https://www.greenclimate.fund/document/strengthening-tajikistans-capacity-access-and-deploy-climate-finance. Activity 1.2.3 will build in particular on the recent FAO-implemented Readiness project, as well as on the recent ADB's "Tajikistan: Monitoring, Reporting and Verification System Framework and Design (Feb 2024).
[109] Activity 1.2.3 is focusing on support to government's capacity to stimulate Green economy investments.
[110] The village ranking criteria will include village population, climate vulnerability, district poverty ranking and Earth Observation indicators (erosion potential, vegetation indices, etc.).
[111] CsCAPs will be thoroughly screened against social and environmental safeguards and an environmental and social impact assessment will be carried out.
[112] In JFM, all materials and labour are paid for by the project although labour may be cheaper if provided as part of in-kind contribution by beneficiaries. Typically a large plot is created and fenced with the sub-divisions inside being assigned to different contracts and a lot of emphasis is put on fruit and nut species that will quickly yield benefits for the participants.
[113] Direct forestry works are usually about 10-20% of the scale of the JFM works in a given Leskhoz. The project will only support direct leskhoz forestry in areas suitable for JFM.
[114] Incremental net benefits of the JFM business model is shown in the economic and financial analysis.
[115] Several mechanisms have been set up to avoid any type of maladaptation: Each CsCAP will be developed based on the district level diagnostic. The activities will be pre-selected in line with the climate change impacts in the area as measures to adapt to it and increase the resilience of the ecosystem and the population. Furthermore, as a second mechanism to avoid maladaptation, ESMPs (and ESIAs when required) will be developed at the level of the CsCAP to ensure the adequacy of the activities and to include risk mitigation measures where needed. Finally, CASP+ district officers will be trained in the development of ESMPs and ESIAs and in their implementation and monitoring throughout the project.
[116] The list of community equipment eligible under this window would include: Mowers, Hay rakes, Balers, Forager / Silage machine, Silage/haylage wrappers, Manure spreader (not only for fodder but contributes to improve soil fertility), Hay trailers (flatbed).
[117] 105,600 unique AH beneficiaries (264 private vets x 400 Hhs), beneficiaries receive (i) AI services (20,000 once per year for 5 years, (ii) bull mating services (20,000 once per year for 5 years) and training via FFS (4000).
[118] One important lesson from LPDP II mid-term review is that genetic improvement through crossbreeding or distribution of improved stock has proven to trigger a transformation from a traditional subsistence production systems into semi intensive, market oriented, sometimes zero grazing or partially, and more integrated with crops.
[119] 8 for dairy, 1 for beef
[120] Limited to large ruminants as CASP+ aims to valorize the effects of AI as well (ie, not only for dairy, but also as farmers will produce better quality carcasses, and need a good market to sell them).
[121] 1020 production and diversification CIGs of 10 members and 110 market-led CIGs of 20 people
[122] These practices span agriculture, horticulture, and other agrifood subsectors that have proven to be adapted to the climate conditions and challenges in the areas, as well as suitable for markets. During project design, a rapid analysis of the growth potential and climate risks was undertaken, and assumptions on potential horticulture and agriculture sub-sectors was discussed with private sector actors. Based on the issues raised during the stakeholder meetings in relation with prevailing agriculture practices and climate related concerns, a selection of models and investment options was proposed for the CIGs (Window 1 and window 2). A summary is described in the PIM and in the Feasibility Study. CIG members will receive capacity development on farming as a business, entrepreneurial skills and business plan development, so they can link to profitable value chains (e.g., small-scale poultry, horticulture, beekeeping, processing, etc.).
[123] The term is defined in IFAD's General Conditions for Agricultural Development Financing
[124] The definition of executing entities in this FP is consistent with the one provided in the GCF programming manual.
[125] Through its central and decentralized offices, IFAD has a mechanism in place to ensure mitigating fiduciary risks throughout its projects. At design, IFAD assess the financial management (FM) risk and identify mitigations actions. Some of the mitigation actions are included in the agreement with the Executing Entities as conditions precedent to the first disbursement to ensure that project starts its implementation at lowest FM risk possible. CASP+ inherent FM risk was assessed as "Moderate" at design, whereas the residual FM was assessed to be low after implementing mitigation actions. Specifically in Tajikistan, all recent IFAD-financed projects implemented by the PMU were systematically rated at least satisfactory in financial management and procurement. The current PMU has been working on IFAD projects since 2008 and has invested a lot in establishing robust financial management system.
[126] IFAD provided financing worth US$77.3 million to a total of four loan-financed projects/programmes with an overall cost of US$91.6 million. SEPMU has been implementing all IFAD funded projects in Tajikistan as a centralized management unit for years. It has remained adequately staffed and managed pro-actively with excellent track record in terms of administrative and financial management in addition to sound project implementation (https://webapps.ifad.org/members/ec/118/docs/EC-2022-118-W-P-5-Add-1.pdf, and https://ioe.ifad.org/it/web/knowledge/-/publication/investing-in-rural-people-in-tajikistan?p_l_back_url=%2Fit%2Fweb%2Fknowledge%2Fpublications%3Fdelta%3D4%26start%3D143).
[127] To the extent that the Coordinating Council on the Green Climate Fund is functioning.
[128] Via the State Enterprise Project Management Unit (SEPMU, or PMU).
[129] With part of CEP financing under CEP management.
[130] With part of MoA financing under PMU management.
[131] NDC, October 2021. https://unfccc.int/sites/default/files/NDC/2022-06/NDC_TAJIKISTAN_ENG.pdf
[132] For the current 2021 fiscal year, low-income economies are defined as those with a GNI per capita, calculated using the World Bank Atlas method, of $1,035 or less in 2019. World Bank 2021.
[133] IMF, Staff Report for the 2022 Article IV Consultation, Debt Sustainability Analysis (2022).
[134] Tajikistan and the Kyrgyz Republic Post-COVID-19: Debt Sustainability, Financing Needs, and Resilience to Shocks E. Vinokurov, N. Lavrova and V. Petrenko. Eurasian Development Bank. June 2020.
[135] Analysis of the agricultural sector for the NDC revision in Tajikistan. Draft Report. GIZ.UNIQUE forestry and land use GmbH. February, 2021
[136] https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714170/41085512/Card_usermanual_W.pdf/e867a16c-e581-8038-aa6f-1767a10629a3
[137] https://www.ifpri.org/publication/climate-change-effects-agriculture-and-food-security-tajikistan International Food Policy Research Institute, 2020.
[138] According to the IMF Country Staff Report (September 2021), Tajikistan's risk of debt distress is foreseen to remain high with public and publicly guaranteed debt on an unsustainable path under current policies. This was confirmed in IMF, March 2023.
[139] Approved at IFAD executive board in December 2022.
[140] Since 2020, the joint World Bank/ IMF Debt Sustainability Analysis reports that Tajikistan's overall risk of debt distress remains high (IMF, March 2023). The estimated public debt was above 50 percent of GDP in 2020 in reaction to the outbreak of the COVID19 pandemic.
[141] Concessionality Leverage = Non-grant element / Grant element based on GCF guidelines. https://www.greenclimate.fund/sites/default/files/document/gcf-b19-12-rev01.pdf - Concessionality: potential approaches for further guidance. February, 2018.
[142] https://www.adb.org/sites/default/files/linked-documents/45229-001-taj-oth-03.pdf Private Sector Development Road Map. 2019. Asian Development Bank.
[143] World Bank 2022.
[144] The VAT in 2021 was 18%, while custom duties range was 15-20% depending on product.
[145] Only the Social security for consultancies and technical assistance is covered by the project.
[146] Reported in IFAD COSTAB (December 2021).
[147] The target reported here in revised v4 does not reflect the increased capitalization period; carbon accounting update is ongoing.
[148] Specific assessment of methane is in Annex 23 - reference

[149]EX-Ante Carbon balance Tool (http://www.fao.org/tc/exact/ex-act-home/en/) and Global Livestock Environmental Assessment Model (http://www.fao.org/gleam/resources/en/).
[150] The current proposal reports on both the indicators in the old RMF and the new IRMF for ease of reference until GCF transitions to the new system.
[151] As indicated for indicator M9.1: 3,650ha of forests, 6,190ha under perennial crops and 180,000 ha of improved pasture
[152]The FAO developed Resilience index measurement approach (RIMA-II), represents a possible option to measure climate change resilience (http://www.fao.org/3/a-i5665e.pdf).
[153] Reducing livestock greenhouse gas emissions. Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development. October 2021
[154] Cavatassi, S. Gemessa. 2022. Impact Assessment Report. Livestock and Pasture Development Project II (LPDP II). Pages. Rome: IFAD
[155] Reducing livestock greenhouse gas emissions. Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development. October 2021
[156] Cavatassi, S. Gemessa. 2022. Impact Assessment Report. Livestock and Pasture Development Project II (LPDP II). Rome: IFAD.
[157] Cavatassi, S. Gemessa. 2022. Impact Assessment Report. Livestock and Pasture Development Project II (LPDP II). Rome: IFAD.
[158] Cavatassi, S. Gemessa. 2022. Impact Assessment Report. Livestock and Pasture Development Project II (LPDP II). Rome: IFAD.
[159] Cavatassi, S. Gemessa. 2022. Impact Assessment Report. Livestock and Pasture Development Project II (LPDP II). Rome: IFAD.
[160] Country Partnership Strategy: Tajikistan, 2016–2020
[161] Zvi Lerman. Rural Livelihoods in Tajikistan: What Factors and Policies Influence the Income and Well-Being of Rural Families? June 2012
[162] Analysis of the agricultural sector for the NDC revision in Tajikistan. Draft Report. GIZ.UNIQUE forestry and land use GmbH. February, 2021.
[163] GIZ, 2020.
[164] FAO, 2022. The role of animal health in national climate commitments. Reference, among others to Figure 4 (https://www.fao.org/3/cc0431en/cc0431en.pdf).
[165] https://www.landuse-ca.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/12/4.-191208-Pasture-in-TJK-EN.pdf Pasture Management in Tajikistan for Integrative Land Use Management Approaches. GIZ. 2019.
[166] http://www.fao.org/policy-support/tools-and-publications/resources-details/en/c/1305482/
[167] https://www.giz.de/en/worldwide/29916.html GIZ, 2020.
[168] https://openknowledge.worldbank.org/bitstream/handle/10986/20038/855970WP00P1450385264B00PUBLIC00ACS.pdf?sequence=1&isAllowed=y Autonomous adaptation to climate change: economic opportunities and institutional constraints for farming households. World Bank. Report No. 85597-TJ. May 2014.
[169] Social and economic impacts of labor migration on migrants' households in Tajikistan: working out policy recommendations to address its negative effects " Gulchekhra Khuseynova University of Massachusetts - Amherst. 2013
[170] Currently Financial institutions such as Eskhata Bank, Arvand bank, Humo and Imon International are providing credit lines sensitive to GHG reduction activities. Reference to lines under https://ebrdgeff.com/tajikistan-agri/
[171] This will include collaboration with the regional ADB-funded project on improved financial system (https://www.adb.org/projects/56136-001/main).
[172] Estimated based on 30% of the cost of civil works will be for labour employed at an annual wage rate of TJS 140,000 leading to 2160 full time jobs for 12 months.
[173] Dependent on Remittances, Tajikistan's Long-Term Prospects for Economic Growth and Poverty Reduction Remain Dim. Edward Lemon. November, 2019.
[174] Reference to LPDP Impact brief, IFAD, 2017(link).
[175] Ibid. "(the project) freed children's time on water harvesting and livestock management and increased families' income enough to allow them to send their children to school. Quantitative and qualitative analysis showed that children in beneficiary households were 6 per cent more likely to attend school compared to children in non-beneficiary households."
[176] Proposal to GCF. Building climate resilience of vulnerable and food insecure communities through capacity strengthening and livelihood diversification in mountainous regions of Tajikistan. World Food Programme. World Food Programme. March 2018.
[177] World Bank. (2019). Open Data Platform. Tajikistan Data Set. Retrieved from: https://data.worldbank.org/country/tajikistan.
[178] USAID (2016). Tajikistan-Property Rights and Resource Governance Profile. Retrieved from: https://www.land-links.org/wp-content/uploads/2016/09/USAID_Land_Tenure_Tajikistan_Profile.pdf
[179] World Bank (2019). Migration and Remittances: Recent Developments and Outlook. Retrieved from: https://www.knomad.org/publication/migration-and-development-brief-31
[180] Abdurasulova, G.; Demenge J.; Mohidinov, N.; Renner, K.; Yodalieva, M.; Zebisch, M. (2019). Climate Risk and Vulnerability Assessment (CRVA) in Jabbor Rasulov district, Tajikistan a pilot study. Retrieved from: https://www.unique-landuse.de/en/publications/climate/735-climate-risk-and-vulnerability-assessment-crva-in-jabbor-rasulov-district,- tajikistan-a-pilot-study
[181] Burke, Marshall & Hsiang, Solomon (2015). Global non-linear effect of temperature on economic production. Retrieved from: HYPERLINK "https://www.nature.com/articles/nature15725" https://www.nature.com/articles/nature15725
[182] IMF, 2021. Republic of Tajikistan, Selected Issues. https://www.elibrary.imf.org/downloadpdf/journals/002/2021/201/article-A001-en.xml
[183] https://www.adb.org/news/50-million-adb-grant-strengthen-finance-sector-and-fiscal-management-tajikistan
[184] ADB's 2021–2025 country partnership strategy for Tajikistan. https://www.adb.org/documents/tajikistan-country-partnership-strategy-2021-2025
[185] Tajikistan's 2019 National Strategy of Adaptation to Climate Change of the Republic of Tajikistan for the Period Until 2030
[186] https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714170/41085512/Card_usermanual_W.pdf/e867a16c-e581-8038-aa6f-1767a10629a3 https://www.ifad.org/documents/38714170/41085512/Card_usermanual_W.pdf/e867a16c-e581-8038-aa6f-1767a10629a3
[187] WHO (2009). Protecting health from climate change – Tajikistan. Retrieved from: http://www.euro.who.int/__data/assets/pdf_file/0003/132951/Protecting_health_TJK.pdf
[188] Greˆt-Regamey A, Brunner SH, Kienast F. 2012. Mountain ecosystem services: Who cares? Mountain Research and Development 32(1):23–34.
[189] Ariza C, Maselli D, Kohler T. 2013. Mountains: Our Life, Our Future. Progress and Perspectives on Sustainable Mountain Development from Rio 1992 to Rio 2012 and Beyond. Bern, Switzerland: SDC [Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation], CDE [Centre for Development and Environment]
[190] Special report: 2020 FAP/WFP Crop and Food Security Assessment Mission (CFSAM) to the Republic of Tajikistan, https://doi.org/10.4060/cb3847en
[191] Tajik domestic wheat production covers about half of the local demand of bread and the rest is imported mainly from Kazakhstan (which is also restricted, currently). Kazakhstan imposed restriction of wheat and wheat flour in April 2022, which might be extended to September 2022, https://www.gov.kz/memleket/entities/moa/press/news/details/359468?lang=ru.
[192] TajStat 2015
[193] HYPERLINK "https://www.worldbank.org/en/country/tajikistan/overview" World Bank. 2021
[194] IMF, March 2023.
[195] Tajikistan and the Kyrgyz Republic Post-COVID-19: Debt Sustainability, Financing Needs, and Resilience to Shocks E. Vinokurov, N. Lavrova and V. Petrenko. Eurasian Development Bank. June 2020.
[196] National Adaptation Plans in focus: Lessons from Tajikistan.
[197] https://www4.unfccc.int/sites/ndcstaging/PublishedDocuments/Tajikistan%20First/INDC-TJK%20final%20ENG.pdf f
[198] https://leap.unep.org/countries/tj/national-legislation/national-strategy-adaptation-climate-change-republic-tajikistan#:~:text=Policy.
[199] Project reference (54111-008): https://www.adb.org/projects/54111-008/main
[200] IFAD, 2022. LPDP II Impact assessment. https://www.ifad.org/ifad-impact-assessment-report-2021/assets/pdf/impact/Tajikistan/BAR_TAJIKISTAN_RI_REPORT.pdf.
[201] Updated Nationally Determined Contribution (INDC) towards the achievement of the global goal of the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) by the Republic of Tajikistan, 2021.
[202] Tajikistan Country Program for Green Climate Fund – (GCF) 2019-2021. June 2019.
[203] SDG 1, SDG 2, SDG 5, SDG 12, SDG 13, SDG 15
[204] Being updated during the Concept Note design.
[205] Government of the Republic of Tajikistan. 2015. Water Sector Reforms Programme of the Republic of Tajikistan for 2016-2025.

[206] IWRM aims at promoting coordinated development and management of water, land, and related resources in order to maximize the resultant economic and social welfare in an equitable manner without compromising the sustainability of vital eco-systems. It is flexible, meaning its application can and must adapt to the local conditions, and it is dynamic, meaning that it is intended to evolve with time rather than being a one shot approach.
[207] FAO and UNECE. 2019. Overview of the State of Forests and Forest Management in Tajikistan.
[208] Government of the Republic of Tajikistan Resolution dated March 27, 2018, No. 160 On the Comprehensive Program for the Development of the Livestock Industry in the Republic of Tajikistan for 2018-2022.
[209] FP014 - https://www.greenclimate.fund/project/fp014
[210] Building climate resilience of vulnerable and food insecure communities through capacity strengthening and livelihood diversification in mountainous regions of Tajikistan, FP067 - https://www.greenclimate.fund/project/fp067
[211] Institutional Development of the State Agency for Hydrometeorology in Tajikistan, FP075 - https://www.greenclimate.fund/project/fp075
[212] https://www.saferworld.org.uk/resources/news-and-analysis/post/861-the-evolving-role-of-civil-society-in-peace-and-security-in-tajikistan-challenges-and-opportunities
[213] Affinity Group of National Associations (AGNA). Civics. June 2015.
[214] US$ 45.33 (co-financing) / US$ 39.45 (GCF financing).
[215] Re-financing rate in Tajikistan as of April 2023. National Bank of Tajikistan, https://www.nbt.tj/en/
[216] For example, the World Bank-funded RESILAND project presents similar results (with an estimated cost of 9.1USD/tCO2e), but a larger coverage in forestry. In its portfolio of investment in support of vulnerable population, CASP+ places a stronger emphasis on resilience investment, with higher cost per tonne of CO2e sequestered.
[217] The concessionality levels selected for the project represent the usual practice for IFAD- as well as World Bank- funded operations in similar contexts of Tajikistan (eg, WB RESILAND project).
[218] The final target means the target at the end of project/programme implementation period. However, for core indicator 1 (GHG emission reduction), please also provide the target value at the end of the total lifespan period which is defined as the maximum number of years over which the impacts of the investment are expected to be effective.
[219] The figure presented in the logframe refers to result at the end of the increased capitalization period (i.e. 27 years), consistent with Annex 23.
[220] It is assumed that 80% of the households in the 400 targeted villages will benefit from pasture management plans, forest plans and the common interest groups. It t is assumed that 60% of the people in the 21 districts will benefit through the diagnostic on climate vulnerability through increased awareness and improved planned at district level.
[221] It is assumed that 80% of the households in the 400 targeted villages will benefit from pasture management plans, forest plans and the common interest groups. It t is assumed that 60% of the people in the 21 districts will benefit through the diagnostic on climate vulnerability through increased awareness and improved planned at district level. All assumptions indicated in Annex 24. t is assumed that an average grant of USD 8,000 (per hh 800) would be given to 1,020 groups each of which have a membership of 10 households. A matching grant of an average of USD 30,000 will be given to 110 Market linked CIGs with minimum membership of 20 individual entrepreneurs
[222] This outcome is measured by the core indicator 1 “GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed/sequestered” reported to in Section E.3, above.
[223] 105,600 unique AH beneficiaries (264 vets x 400 HHs), same beneficiaries receive (i) AI services (20,000 once per year for 5 years, (ii) bull mating services (20,000 once per year for 5 years) and training via FFS (4000)
[224] Private veterinarians will be encouraged to come into the field by the TVA as a result of project support thereby increasing the number by another 50% by the end of the project.
[225] 1020 production and diversification CIGs of 10 members and 110 market-led CIGs of 20 people
[226] No budget because a part of PMU operations
[227] Integrated Results Management Framework. GCF/B.29/12 .25 June 2021
[228] Readiness Proposal. GCF. United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) for Republic of Tajikistan 18 May 2020 | Adaptation Planning
[229] IFAD, financial management Issue Summary for CASP+, October 2020.
[230] Independent Evaluation of the GCF’s Adaptation Portfolio. Virtual Country Mission to Tajikistan. Independent Evaluation Unit (IEU) of the Green Climate Fund (GCF) in association with Steward Redqueen. October 2020.
[231] Independent Evaluation of the GCF’s Adaptation Portfolio. Virtual Country Mission to Tajikistan. In association with Steward Redqueen. October 2020.
[232] The Social, Environmental and Climate Assessment Procedures (SECAP) is IFAD’s main safeguard instrument to enhance the sustainability of results-based country strategic opportunities programmes, country strategy notes, programmes and projects. The risk assessment process recognizes the heterogeneity of responses, given the widely different country and community circumstances. All IFAD projects are required to perform a SECAP.
[233] Mapping registered extreme poverty in rural Tajikistan (UNDP, 2015)
[234] National Gender Profile of agriculture and Rural Livelihood Tajikistan (FAO, 2016).
[235] State Statistics Agency. Gender Statistics Database (TajStat, 2013).
[236] The public procurement law of the Republic of Tajikistan (RT) and procurement through the government electronic are still in draft form and not yet ready for implementation.
[237] Mandatory for mitigation and cross-cutting projects.

No-objection letter issued by the national designated authority(ies) or focal point(s)

КУМИТАИ
ҲИФЗИ МУҲИТИ ЗИСТИ
НАЗДИ ҲУКУМАТИ
ҶУМҲУРИИ ТОҶИКИСТОН
734003, шаҳри Душанбе, кӯчаи Шамсӣ 5/1
Тел./факс: (992 37) 236-40-59, 236-13-53
Веб-сайт: www.tajnature.tj
Почтаи электронӣ: info@tajnature.tj

КОМИТЕТ
ОХРАНЫ ОКРУЖАЮЩЕЙ СРЕДЫ
ПРИ ПРАВИТЕЛЬСТВЕ
РЕСПУБЛИКИ ТАДЖИКИСТАН
734003, город Душанбе, улица Шамсӣ 5/1
Тел./факс: (992 37) 236-40-59, 236-13-53
Веб-сайт: www.tajnature.tj
Электронная почта: info@tajnature.tj

COMMITTEE OF ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION
UNDER THE GOVERNMENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF TAJIKISTAN
5/1 Shamsi str., 734003, Dushanbe city, tel./fax: (992 37)236-40-59, 236-13-53 web-site: www.tajnature.tj, e-mail: info@tajnature.tj

№ 1/17-03-286 аз «02» 02 соли 2024

Ба ____________________ аз «_____»______соли 2024

To: The Green Climate Fund ("GCF")

Re: Funding proposal for the GCF by the International Fund for Agriculture Development regarding the "Community-based Agriculture Support Project 'plus'" (CASP+)

Dear Madam, Sir,

We refer to the project titled "Community-based Agriculture Support Project 'plus'" (CASP+) in the Republic of Tajikistan as included in the funding proposal submitted by the International Fund for Agriculture Development to us on January 6, 2022.

The undersigned is the duly authorized representative of Committee for Environmental Protection under the Government of the Republic of Tajikistan, the National Designated Authority of the Republic of Tajikistan.

Pursuant to GCF decision B.08/10, the content of which we acknowledge to have reviewed, we hereby communicate our no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal.

By communicating our no-objection, it is implied that:

(a) The Government of the Republic of Tajikistan has no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal;

(b) The project as included in the funding proposal is in conformity with Republic of Tajikistan national priorities, strategies and plans;

(c) In accordance with the GCF's environmental and social safeguards, the project as included in the funding proposal is in conformity with relevant national laws and regulations.

We also confirm that our national process for ascertaining no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal has been duly followed.

We acknowledge that this letter will be made publicly available on the GCF website.

Kind regards,

Mr. Bahodur Sheralizoda

Chairman,
National Designated Authority to the Green Climate Fund

Environmental and social safeguards report form pursuant to para. 17 of the IDP

Basic project or programme information	
Project or programme title	Community-based Agriculture Support Programme 'plus' (CASP+)
Existence of subproject(s) to be identified after GCF Board approval	Yes
Sector (public or private)	Public
Accredited entity	International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)
Environmental and social safeguards (ESS) category	Category B
Location – specific location(s) of project or target country or location(s) of programme	Republic of Tajikistan – The districts of Sh. Shohin; Kulob; Khovaling; Baljuvon; Khuroson; Shakhrinav; Temurmalik; A. Jomi; Yovon; Rudaki; Gissor; Dangara; Vose; Mastchoh; J. Balkhi; Hamadoni; Farkhor; Kushoniyon; Panj; Vakhsh; and Zafarobod.
Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) (if applicable)	
Date of disclosure on accredited entity's website	Tuesday, June 11, 2024
Language(s) of disclosure	English and Tajik
Explanation on language	Tajik is the official language of Tajikistan.
Link to disclosure	English: https://www.ifad.org/documents/d/guest/secap-esia-casp_eng Tajik: https://www.ifad.org/documents/d/guest/secap-esia-casp_tajik
Other link(s)	Committee for Environmental Protection under the Government of the Republic of Tajikistan (CEP): http://tajnature.tj/articles/ozmunho/?ELEMENT_ID=6619 Ministry of Agriculture of the Republic of Tajikistan: https://moa.tj/news/292-loiai-dastgirii-soai-kishovarz-dar-zaminai-omea-pljus-zamimai-6-arzebii-muiti-itimo-va-ilim-amii.html State Enterprise "Project Management Unit" Livestock and Pasture Development Project (SEPMU LPDP): https://rural.tj/cdn/documents/e944539c-1c44-4ec1-957c-c5ce3a796ee2.pdf
Remarks	An ESIA consistent with the requirements for a Category B project is contained in the "Social Environment and Climate Assessment - SECAP".
Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP) (if applicable)	
Date of disclosure on accredited entity's website	Tuesday, June 11, 2024
Language(s) of disclosure	English and Tajik
Explanation on language	Tajik is the official language of Tajikistan.
Link to disclosure	English: https://www.ifad.org/documents/d/guest/secap-esia-casp_eng

	Tajik: https://www.ifad.org/documents/d/guest/secap-esia-casp_tajik
Other link(s)	Committee for Environmental Protection under the Government of the Republic of Tajikistan (CEP): http://tajnature.tj/articles/ozmunho/?ELEMENT_ID=6619 Ministry of Agriculture of the Republic of Tajikistan: https://moa.tj/news/292-loiai-dastgirii-soai-kishovarz-dar-zaminai-omea-pljus-zamimai-6-arzebii-muiti-itimo-va-ilim-amii.html State Enterprise "Project Management Unit" Livestock and Pasture Development Project (SEPMU LPDP): https://rural.tj/cdn/documents/e944539c-1c44-4ec1-957c-c5ce3a796ee2.pdf
Remarks	An ESMP consistent with the requirements for a Category B project is contained in the "Social Environment and Climate Assessment - SECAP".
Environmental and Social Management System (ESMS) (if applicable)	
Date of disclosure on accredited entity's website	N/A
Language(s) of disclosure	N/A
Explanation on language	N/A
Link to disclosure	N/A
Other link(s)	N/A
Remarks	N/A
Any other relevant ESS reports, e.g. Resettlement Action Plan (RAP), Resettlement Policy Framework (RPF), Indigenous Peoples Plan (IPP), Indigenous Peoples Planning Framework (IPPF) (if applicable)	
Description of report/disclosure on accredited entity's website	N/A
Language(s) of disclosure	N/A
Explanation on language	N/A
Link to disclosure	N/A
Other link(s)	N/A
Remarks	N/A
Disclosure in locations convenient to affected peoples (stakeholders)	
Date	Tuesday, June 11, 2024
Place	**Name and locations of the 21 District Offices** 23, I. Somoni street, Abdurrahmani Jami town, A. Jomi district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan Baljuvon village, Baljuvon district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 92, A. Sino street, Ismoili Somoni town, Kushoniyon district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan

	56, Centralniy street, Dangara town, Dangara district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 1, S. Safarov street, Farkhor town, Farkhor district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 18, I. Somoni street, Moskovsky town, Hamadoni district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 6, Kugaling street, Balkh town, J. Balkhi district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 2, I. Somoni street, Khovaling village, Khovaling district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan I. Somoni street, Obikiik town, Khuroson district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 36, I. Somoni street, Kulob city, Kulob district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan A. Rudaki street, Panj town, Panj district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 1, I. Somoni street, Shuroabod town, Sh. Shohin district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan Bahmanrud town, Temurmalik district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 63, I. Somoni street, Vakhsh village, Vakhsh district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan Hulbuk town, Vose district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 1, M. Tursunzode street, Yovon town, Yovon district, Khatlon region, Republic of Tajikistan 23, S. Sharapov street, Buston village, Mastchoh district, Sugd region, Republic of Tajikistan 2, I. Somoni street, Zafarobod town, Zafarobod district, Sugd region, Republic of Tajikistan 53, I. Somoni street, Gissor city, Gissor district, RRS region, Republic of Tajikistan 16, I. Somoni street, Somoniyon town, Rudaki district, RRS region, Republic of Tajikistan Bakaev street, Shakhrinav village, Shakhrinav district, RRS region, Republic of Tajikistan

	CEP CIIP office 5/1 Shamsi str., Dushanbe, Tajikistan SEPMU office - 3rd floor, 21 Tehron str., Dushanbe, Tajikistan SE PMU office (temporary located at 41 Ayni str., Dushanbe)
Date of Board meeting in which the FP is intended to be considered	
Date of accredited entity's Board meeting	N/A
Date of GCF's Board meeting	Monday, July 15, 2024

Note: This form was prepared by the accredited entity stated above.

Secretariat's assessment of FP233

Proposal name:	Community-based Agriculture Support Programme 'plus' (CASP+)
Accredited entity:	International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)
Country:	Tajikistan
Project/programme size:	Medium

I. Overall assessment of the Secretariat

1. The funding proposal is presented to the Board for consideration with the following remarks:

Strengths	Points of caution
Locally led adaptation: CASP+ supports locally led adaptation by building capacities of local agencies to assess climate risks and implement locally appropriate solutions, thereby building a long-term legacy of local capacity for climate change adaptation.	**Gender**: The recent livestock project undertaken by IFAD had scope to make greater efforts in relation to gender. CASP+ incorporates this lesson learned from the IFAD project by implementing various measures, including more and diverse gender-sensitization activities and gender-specific results targets. Nevertheless, regular supervision of the project's progress in gender is required.
Enabling environment for green economic development and national capacity for emissions accounting: CASP+ will support refining existing laws, enhancing technical capacity for climate change adaptation, and providing policy monitoring tools like georeferencing and remote sensing to facilitate evidence-based decision-making, and natural resources and agriculture management. In addition, the project will enhance capacities for national emissions accounting by providing support for the adoption of carbon accounting tools such as those developed by the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) – EX-Ante Carbon Balance Tool (EX-ACT), the Global Livestock Environmental Assessment	**Fiduciary capacity**: The fiduciary risk rating of Tajikistan was upgraded to high in 2023. In response, CASP+ now considers a number of risk mitigation measures, including adoption of a unified financial accounting system, capacity-building of the fiduciary team of the State Enterprise Project Management Unit prior to the project starting and significant handholding from the Financial Management Division of IFAD during project implementation. Nevertheless, regular monitoring of fiduciary compliance and re-assessment of risk with adequate mitigation measures are critical.

Model – interactive (GLEAM-i) and the Biodiversity Integrated Assessment and Computational Tool (B-INTACT). It will also pilot B-INTACT.	
Innovation: CASP+ promotes the adoption of innovative technologies and solutions (digital, technical, technological and policy) to manage natural resources and livestock at both policy and user levels. It also supports research institutions to generate and disseminate knowledge.	
Cross-learning and knowledge exchange: CASP+ has a provision to support cross-learning with another IFAD-led project named "Dairy Interventions for Adaptation and Mitigation" that promotes low-carbon and climate-resilient livestock in East Africa through exchange visits, including through China–IFAD South–South and triangular cooperation.	
Green credit line: CASP+ does not consider the provision of credit lines to beneficiaries. However, it will facilitate access to existing credit lines that support **green** investments.	

2. The Board may wish to consider approving this funding proposal in accordance with the term sheet agreed between the Secretariat and the accredited entity, and, if considered appropriate, subject to the conditions set out in Annex II of document GCF/B.39/02.

II. Summary of the Secretariat's assessment

2.1 Project background

3. Tajikistan faces increasing climate risks, including rising temperatures, shifting precipitation patterns and frequent natural disasters, particularly in rural mountainous areas, posing threats to agriculture, pasture productivity and livelihoods. To address these challenges, the interventions proposed by the project aim to enhance climate resilience by leveraging successful projects and focusing on carbon sequestration, improved livestock management and diversification of livelihoods.

4. Building upon the lessons learned from the Community-based Agriculture Support Programme initiative in Tajikistan, the proposed project, Community-based Agriculture Support Programme 'plus' (CASP+), intends to catalyse a transformative shift towards climate-adaptive, inclusive and integrated agriculture and forestry management in 21 vulnerable districts. The project is incorporated into both the country programme of Tajikistan and the entity work programme of IFAD.

5. The project's goals will be achieved through three main components:

(a) Strengthening public sector capacity for transformative climate-resilient management of natural resources;

(b) Investing in community capacity for adaptation and resilience to climate change; and

(c) Strengthening livelihoods for enhanced resilience through market-based approaches.

6. Financing for the project amounts to USD 79,690,370 (of which USD 39,000,000 will be from GCF and multiple co-financiers) over seven years. The project aims to prompt a paradigm shift in the Tajik Government's national approach to climate change, bolster local capacity for climate adaptation and improve agriculture production practices at the household level.

7. CASP+ also envisions a pivotal role for the private sector, reducing its transaction costs in rural community engagement, possibly through carbon markets which the project intends to explore during project implementation. Rather than directly providing credit lines, the project will facilitate access to financial resources for targeted beneficiaries by linking them with existing financial services providers and emerging finance opportunities.

8. The project is projected to have significant impacts on both adaptation and mitigation, with an estimated total mitigation impact of 253,882 tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent (t CO_2 eq) per year and 6,854,822 t CO_2 eq over 27 years.

9. The project is expected to benefit 650,000 people and indirectly reach over 2.9 million people, encompassing 24 per cent of the country's total population in vulnerable areas. Furthermore, the project will improve 3,650 hectares (ha) of forests, 6,190 ha of arable lands under perennial crops and 180,000 ha of pasturelands.

2.2 Component-by-component analysis

Component 1: Strengthening public sector capacity for transformative climate-resilient management of natural resources (total cost: USD 2.5 million; GCF cost: USD 1.5 million)

10. Component 1 focuses on bolstering the public sector's ability to manage natural resources in the face of climate change. Despite advancements in water and disaster management strategies, the country lacks integration of climate perspectives in agriculture and natural resource governance, thereby hindering sustainable development. This component addresses these gaps through two main objectives: capacity-building and policy enhancement.

11. Output 1.1 concentrates on strengthening national institutions' capacity to oversee climate-resilient resource management. Efforts include empowering agencies such as the State Forestry Agency and improving coordination among stakeholders. In addition, innovative methods such as using beehives for pasture monitoring will be introduced. Financing from GCF will support activities that will enhance monitoring mechanisms and upgrade university curricula in relation to climate-resilient resource management.

12. Output 1.2 focuses on creating an environment conducive to climate-adaptive management of natural resources. Policy engagement will prioritize areas such as animal husbandry and the green economy. Regular workshops will facilitate stakeholder coordination, while efforts to integrate critical aspects into pasture laws will be undertaken. GCF funding will support activities related to policy development, gender-sensitive practices and green investment coordination.

13. To address existing challenges owing to limited integration of measures to combat climate change, lack of technical capacity and tools, and fragmented governance of natural resources, component 1 will strengthen social inclusion, particularly involving women and youth in decision-making processes. Activities under output 1.2 will promote inclusive policy dialogues and provide technical assistance for reviewing livestock-related regulations. Additionally, support will be provided to enhance the government's capacity to coordinate and

monitor the implementation of the country's green economy strategy. Through these efforts, component 1 aims to bolster Tajikistan's capacity for mainstreaming climate resilience in the management of natural resources and sustainable development.

Component 2: Investments in community capacity for adaptation and resilience to climate change (total cost: USD 55 million; GCF cost: USD 35 million)

14. Component 2 focuses on building community capacity for adaptation and resilience to climate change through the development and implementation of 400 climate-sensitive community action plans (CSCAPs) in selected districts. These plans aim to address the challenges related to climate change through investment in ecosystem improvements and agricultural system and infrastructure resilience, including improved pasture management, afforestation and climate-resilient infrastructure. Additionally, social inclusion measures ensure the active participation of women and youth in the planning and implementation process, with targeted training and employment opportunities provided to enhance their involvement and leadership roles.

15. Output 2.1 will support the development of CSCAPs based on district-level climate diagnostics, ensuring a comprehensive understanding of climate risks and vulnerabilities. This includes mapping community needs through geospatial analysis and creating a profile for each district to guide investment strategies. Activities under this output include conducting diagnostic analyses, establishing relevant local institutions, designing CSCAPs, and strengthening local capacities for monitoring and evaluation.

16. Output 2.2 will implement the CSCAPs in the selected districts, benefiting 100,000 rural households. These plans include a range of investment activities, such as pasture management, forestry, climate-resilient infrastructure, and agricultural productivity improvement. Monitoring and evaluation are integral components of this output, utilizing smartphone tools and citizen reporting to track progress and outcomes. Funding for CSCAPs comes from GCF and IFAD, targeting investments with high potential for carbon sequestration and climate adaptation and resilience-building.

17. The CSCAPs will feature ecosystem-based solutions and a balanced investment mix, covering adaptation, mitigation, and disaster risk reduction, bolstering rural community resilience. However, capacity gaps, including technical skills and infrastructure maintenance challenges, pose significant weaknesses. To address these, targeted capacity-building, technical assistance, partnership strengthening, community engagement, and innovative monitoring are proposed to be further strengthened as remedial measures, aiming to enhance project success and sustainability.

Component 3: Strengthening livelihoods for enhanced resilience through market-based approaches (total cost: USD 19 million; GCF cost: USD 2 million)

18. Component 3 aims to empower smallholders to invest in climate-resilient and diversified production systems connected to local and national value chains. It will address the current limitations of production systems, which are not adapted to climate change impacts and lack integration with market opportunities. Through three key outputs, the project promotes social inclusion by actively involving women and youth.

19. Output 3.1 focuses on enhancing livestock productivity through artificial insemination services, animal health interventions and training, aiming to improve breeding practices and dissemination of technical innovations. Output 3.2 facilitates business partnerships between smallholder farmers and private sector actors in dairy and beef value chains, promoting secure market access and reduced environmental degradation. Output 3.3 supports the establishment of common interest groups to strengthen climate-resilient production practices and market linkages, with a focus on capacity-building and financial support.

20. To address challenges such as capacity gaps, infrastructure maintenance issues and coordination challenges among stakeholders, component 3 will foster economic inclusion, reduce environmental impact and enhance resilience through market-based approaches. The targeted capacity-building, technical assistance, partnership strengthening, community engagement and innovative monitoring tools will be improved with a view to enhancing project effectiveness and sustainability.

III. Assessment against investment criteria

3.1 Impact potential *Scale: High*

21. The project holds significant potential for both mitigation and adaptation efforts, aiming to shift towards low-emission sustainable development pathways while increasing resilience to climate change. Through sustainable land-use management, reforestation and conservation efforts, it is anticipated to result in a reduction of net emissions from land use, contributing to a positive environmental impact.

22. The estimated carbon balance suggests a net reduction of 6,854,822 t CO_2 eq over 27 years, indicating a substantial decrease in emissions. This impact will be tracked through improved land and forest management practices, covering 3,650 hectares of forests, 6,190 hectares of perennial crops and 180,000 hectares of improved pasture, monitored using remote sensing and by comparing remote sensing images with the reality on the ground through ground truthing methods.

23. Additionally, the project aims to reach over 2.9 million individuals, both direct and indirect beneficiaries (see the table below), with a focus on enhancing the adaptability of physical assets to climate change effects and promoting climate-resilient management practices in natural resource areas. At the national, community and household levels, investments will bolster resilience and livelihood diversification, with targeted interventions aimed at reducing vulnerability to climate risks. Through household surveys conducted at various project stages, the project's impact on increased resilience and reduced vulnerability will be assessed, ensuring effective outcomes.

Number of beneficiaries of the Community-based Agriculture Support Programme 'plus' (CASP+) **International Fund for Agricultural Development Tajikistan project proposal**

	Women	Men	Total	Percentage of total population
Direct beneficiaries	334,750	315,250	650,000	7% (31% of the target area population)
Indirect beneficiaries	1,168,239	1,100,186	2,268,426	24%

3.2 Paradigm shift potential *Scale: High*

24. The proposed activities outlined in the project have a high potential to catalyse a significant paradigm shift across various policy areas, implementation mechanisms and household-based production decisions in Tajikistan. With a focus on pastures, livestock and livelihood diversification, coupled with increased private sector involvement, the project aims to enhance productivity and reduce emissions per unit of product. Previous experience, such as that from the Livestock and Pasture Development II project, has demonstrated the transformative impact of similar interventions, showcasing increased livestock productivity and

income alongside reductions in herd sizes and emissions. By leveraging improved animal health, breeding strategies and private sector partnerships, the project seeks to foster sustainable agricultural practices and market-oriented production decisions.

25. Moreover, the project is expected to address the slow pace of rural livelihood diversification in Tajikistan by providing matching grants, establishing common interest groups and fostering links with the private sector along key value chains. This shift is crucial considering the heavy reliance of family incomes on agriculture, which exposes households to significant risks. By encouraging income diversification and strengthening non-farm occupations, the project aims to enhance resilience and reduce vulnerability among rural households. Furthermore, the project's integration of climate change risks and adaptation measures into national and local policies signifies a fundamental shift towards climate-resilient development pathways, supported by improved institutional capacity and collaboration.

26. At the household level, the project will promote sustainable agriculture practices, including water-efficient irrigation, resilient crop varieties and improved livestock management, while emphasizing market-driven production decisions. By instilling a paradigm shift towards proactive market engagement and sustainable production practices, the project presents huge potential to enhance scalability, replicability and co-benefits beyond its lifespan. Through ongoing assessments and engagements with stakeholders, the project will ensure the fostering of sustainable development pathways that align with national climate change adaptation strategies and contribute to long-term resilience and prosperity in Tajikistan.

3.3 Sustainable development potential *Scale: High*

27. The project aims to address climate change challenges while contributing to key Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), namely SDG 1 (No poverty), SDG 2 (Zero hunger), SDG 5 (Gender equality), SDG 8 (Decent work and economic growth), SDG 13 (Climate action), SDG 15 (Life on land), and SDG 17 (Partnerships for the goals).

28. It anticipates a number of environmental, social and economic co-benefits. The environmental co-benefits include substantial carbon sequestration and biodiversity enhancement in pastures and forests. It also seeks to resolve land-use conflicts, reduce migration, and empower women and youth through inclusive decision-making and business opportunities to bring about social co-benefits. Economically, the project anticipates job creation, enhanced market access and increased productivity in agriculture and livestock practices, fostering sustainable economic growth and resilience. Additionally, it places significant emphasis on the inclusion of women, including at the community level, to improve the empowerment of women and their participation in the decision-making processes of institutions.

29. Overall, it presents extensive sustainable development impact by conserving the environment, promoting social inclusion, empowering communities and advancing gender equality in Tajikistan.

3.4 Needs of the recipient *Scale: Medium to high*

30. Tajikistan, a country vulnerable to climate change, faces significant socioeconomic challenges, including poverty, limited private sector presence and inadequate infrastructure. The country's heavy reliance on agriculture, coupled with water-intensive crops and limited irrigation, exacerbates its vulnerability to climate impacts.

31. Additionally, reliance on remittances and external factors such as an influx of refugees from Afghanistan and pandemics further strain its economy. To address these challenges, Tajikistan requires investments in climate-resilient infrastructure and sustainable agriculture,

but its fiscal space is limited. International financing, particularly from organizations like GCF, is crucial to address climate vulnerabilities and promote sustainable development. Strengthening institutions and building implementation capacity are also essential for effective climate adaptation and long-term resilience in Tajikistan.

3.5 Country ownership *Scale: High*

32. Tajikistan has actively engaged in climate action by submitting intended national determined contributions and national communications under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, with ongoing efforts to update strategies and plans. The national climate change adaptation strategy and forthcoming national adaptation plan highlight priority areas such as agriculture and water. The current project has been considered as responding to priorities, and it is solidly placed in Tajikistan's country programme, which is in the final stages of formulation (i.e. at the review phase by the Secretariat). In terms of design, it carries a strong potential for replication in the Eastern Europe Central Asia region, and, specifically, in the Central Asia subregion.

33. Several climate finance projects, including those funded by GCF and the Global Environment Facility, complement Tajikistan's climate efforts, focusing on areas such as sustainable energy, hydropower and community resilience. These projects align with Tajikistan's existing policies, including its national development strategy and sectoral strategies for agriculture, water and forestry.

34. The CASP+ project also creates synergies with existing climate initiatives in Tajikistan by coordinating with institutions implementing GCF-funded projects, leveraging the expertise and ongoing efforts of the Global Environment Facility, the Asian Development Bank and World Bank projects, and ensuring complementarity to maximize the impact of climate finance interventions. In addition, civil society organizations, including women's groups and community-based organizations, will play a crucial role in mobilizing communities and ensuring inclusive participation in climate initiatives.

35. To strengthen further national preparedness for key GCF investments, the Government of Tajikistan nominated the Center for Implementation of Investment Projects (CIIP) to pursue the institutional accreditation track for direct access entity status within the small-scope project category and increase direct access entity programming via GCF climate investments in the future. Currently, The CIIP is the only nominated national entity from Tajikistan.

3.6 Efficiency and effectiveness *Scale: Medium to high*

36. The overall assessment of this project's efficiency and effectiveness is medium to high. The accredited entity (AE) developed a detailed and robust economic and financial analysis with clear and well-referenced assumptions as well as a clear definition of the scope and counterfactual scenarios. Limited public investment and financial options in rural areas are identified by the AE as financial barriers to forestry, livestock and rangeland management. In 2021, 8.5 per cent of firms in Tajikistan were using banks to finance the purchase of fixed assets.[1] The project includes activities which will focus specifically on access to finance and the private sector market, including through matching grant windows. By addressing market failure and incentivizing private sector engagement with smallholders, the project fosters productive alliances to overcome constraints. Value-for-money metrics analysis demonstrates the project's

[1] World Bank Global Financial Development Database. Available at: www.worldbank.org/en/publication/gfdr/data/global-financial-development-database.

justification financially and economically, with favourable indicators like net present values, internal rates of return, and benefit–cost ratios.

37. The financial analysis shows profitability results for adaptation interventions with and without the project. For all the interventions, including forest plantation, agroforestry and various activities under the matching grant windows, the without-the-project cases generate returns above the financial discount rate (11 per cent), justifying the financial viability of the project. The financial model was also used to conduct scenario analysis with a commercial loan with a 25 per cent interest rate and three years of tenor. The analysis shows mixed results in which some cases generate a positive internal rate of return and net present values, while others, such as drip irrigation, bear negative results. Nonetheless, the payback period goes beyond the project implementation period of seven years, and it is not feasible for beneficiaries to pay back during the project. Therefore, request for concessional finance from GCF is justified. The financial analysis did not specifically model the GCF high concessional loan, given that it is a sovereign loan to be used by the government for financing the participatory management plan across 400 villages, and will not be passed down to beneficiaries for repayment.

38. Economic analysis confirms the project's viability and sensitivity to different scenarios, with robust returns even under moderate and worst-case climate scenarios. The economic returns of the project are around 22 per cent, significantly above the 6 per cent discount rate used in the economic analysis. Sensitivity analysis further supports the project's resilience-building potential, ensuring affordability and ownership among beneficiaries while maximizing community investment.

39. The project's adaptation cost is USD 27/direct beneficiary and its mitigation cost is USD 3.31/t CO_2 eq. Both costs are on the lower range of the GCF portfolio for climate resilience in agriculture and forestry. The co-financing ratio is 1:0.4. Through the matching grant windows, there is the potential to leverage further parallel financing which is confirmed in the funding proposal, with an estimated amount of USD 4.6 million.

IV. Assessment of consistency with GCF safeguards and policies

4.1 Environmental and social safeguards

40. Programme brief. The programme intends to strengthen the public sector capacity for transformative climate-resilient management of natural resources, provide investments in community capacity for adaption and resilience to climate change, and strengthen livelihoods for enhanced resilience through market-based approaches. Among the environmental and social co-benefits include improved biodiversity in pastures and forest areas given that the programme will support the strengthening of pasture and forest management in the target areas. The programme is also expected to improve slope stability, minimize soil erosion, improve soil quality, and increase water retention, among others. Social co-benefits include more sustainable and resilient households able to better manage effects of labor migration on family cohesion and their psychosocial well-being.

41. Environmental and social (E&S) risk category and safeguards instrument. The AE has categorized the programme as Category B based on a comprehensive screening questionnaire. The programme's activities on the ground include land use changes, agricultural production, construction and operation of support infrastructure, and processing facilities, which are small scale and scattered over a wide geographic area. These activities are expected to only have localized environmental and social risks and/or impacts which are reversible and can be managed through standard mitigation measures. The Secretariat confirms the categorization and is within the AE's E&S risk accreditation level. Since the types, scale, locations, and host communities and the specific interventions will only be identified and developed with the

beneficiary communities during the programme implementation phase, a framework instrument titled "Social Environment and Climate Assessment (SECAP) was prepared for this programme.

42. Compliance with GCF's Environmental and Social Safeguards (ESS) standards. The following paragraphs describe the programme's compliance with GCF's interim ESS standards.

43. **ESS1: Assessment and Management of Environmental and Social Risks and Impacts**. The SECAP described and analyzed the programme activities in terms of their potential E&S risks and/or impacts. It described the baseline information on the environmental and social conditions of the programme areas and the key regulatory frameworks in the country. The instrument also provided procedures for the screening, assessment and management of E&S impacts and risks of the subprojects. The SECAP also provided an environmental and social management plan (ESMP) matrix which discusses the features of the programme which could have potential risks and impacts and their recommended mitigation measures. A Terms of Reference for the conduct of an Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) and the development of an ESMP is also provided.

44. **ESS2: Labor and Working Conditions**. The labor code of the country regulates the labor and other relations directly aimed at workers, providing protection for their rights and freedoms including securing guarantees on these rights, among others. The SECAP indicated that the programme works will neither entail temporary and/or permanent resident workers nor require migrant workforce or seasonal workers. The AE and EE, however, should ensure that if there is a need for workers in the implementation of the activities of the programme, labor and working condition aspects including occupational health and safety issues should be fully addressed and adequately mitigated.

45. **ESS3: Resource Efficiency and Pollution Prevention**. Based on the description of the programme activities, subprojects to be supported may include small-scale infrastructure (roads, water harvesting, small irrigation systems), livestock production and veterinary services, and agricultural production, and small-scale processing facility which may entail release of small amounts of wastes. Road and irrigation construction may cause temporary sedimentation of rivers and streams. Landslides and erosions may occur due to the mountainous terrain requiring appropriate engineering design measures. Livestock and agricultural production may entail generation of waste and release of agrochemicals into the environment which may contaminate surface water, soil, and groundwater. Veterinary services may involve health care waste that needs to be addressed. The SECAP discusses management measures such as manure management, water management, and composting, remote sensing on erosion and pollution monitoring, and avoidance of use of agrochemicals in forest plantations. More detailed assessment and management of potential impacts or risks on pollution, water use, and waste generation will be undertaken at subproject identification during implementation.

46. **ESS4: Community Health, Safety and Security.** Community health and safety issues for this programme will be mainly on the hazards related to infrastructure such as on road safety, agricultural and livestock production, health care waste hazards for veterinary services, forest and rangeland rehabilitation, and small-scale processing. The SECAP indicated the conduct of road safety assessment to be done for each of these activities and will monitor incidents and accidents related to such and implement measures to address them. Measures such as ensuring national standard design speed for rural roads are complied with and providing speed bumps (with accompanying warning signs) in highly populated areas such as villages, schools, markets and other centers will be implemented. Food hygiene and quality and food safety management will also be part of the capacity building intervention under the programme.

47. **ESS5: Land Acquisition and Involuntary Resettlement.** The SECAP indicated that "No physical resettlement or economic displacement will be expected." As far as road rehabilitation

is concerned, the programme foresees a "consultative design of road sites using local knowledge, and safety measures will be included in the design of road rehabilitation activities according to national law." While it recognizes that if road alignments are not carefully planned, the activity may lead to economic displacement or physical resettlement or potential loss of agricultural land, the SECAP indicates it will consider alternatives with "least direct and indirect negative impacts" and employ "participatory approach" in this undertaking.

48. **ESS6: Biodiversity Conservation and Sustainable Management of Living Natural Resources**. The activities under the programme are expected to positively contribute to biodiversity conservation and sustainable pasture and agroforestry management. It is expected that the pasture plans will support practices such as: increasing capacities for rangeland rehabilitation and management including the management of water points; rehabilitation of degraded rangelands with native and local grasses, shrubs and trees through assisted natural regeneration; maintaining sustainable grazelands by avoiding overcrowding and keeping adequate stock density; and increasing water availability through rainwater harvesting and other soil water storage techniques, among others. The programme will also promote participatory biodiversity monitoring by the Pasture Users Unions and build community capacities in the protection of forests from illegal activities. Nevertheless, subprojects will be further subjected to identification and assessment of potential direct and indirect impacts and ensure that biodiversity issues are adequately managed.

49. **GCF Indigenous Peoples Policy and ESS7 (Indigenous Peoples).** The AE confirmed that there are no Indigenous Peoples in the project area, and no Indigenous Peoples will be affected by the project's activities.

50. **ESS8: Cultural heritage.** The Social, Environmental and Climate Assessment Procedures indicates that the programme activities will not lead to the conversion and/or loss of physical cultural resources.

51. **Sexual exploitation, sexual abuse and sexual harassment (SEAH).** The SEAH safeguarding approach proposed by the AE is considered by the Secretariat to be compliant with the SEAH provisions pursuant to the GCF Environmental and Social Policy. The project includes specific measures to prevent, mitigate and address potential SEAH risks and impacts as part of the SECAP. The AE has identified the project's potential SEAH risks with regards to the increasing mobilization of women to participate in the project activities. The AE has incorporated SEAH risk mitigation measures into the Environment and Social Management Plan matrix and the code of conduct to be followed by the project staff and contractors to ensure compliance with SEAH-related policies and regulations. The AE will conduct regular monitoring and evaluation on the progress regarding SEAH prevention and response activities. It will also reassess SEAH risks during project implementation as appropriate. The AE and the executing entities (EEs) will work collaboratively and with local authorities to provide SEAH-related training and sensitization campaigns to ensure that the project stakeholders and communities are informed about the project's SEAH safeguarding measures and the SEAH grievance redress procedures. In the case of SEAH complaints, the project team will follow the AE's institutional policy on SEAH prevention and response to ensure that grievances related to SEAH and gender-based violence will be addressed in an inclusive, survivor-centred and gender-responsive manner.

52. Implementation arrangements. A project steering committee will be constituted at the national level with the AE having the supervisory function and undertaking regular supervision and implementation support missions. There will be three EEs: the State Enterprise "Project Management Unit" Livestock and Pasture Development (SEPMU) which will have overall responsibility for implementation, coordination, oversight and reporting to IFAD and the government including liaising closely with the other EEs and parties; the Committee on Environment Protection (CEP), which will have technical support from its Project Implementation Group and the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO),

which will provide specific technical support and execution of their defined activities. The SEPMU, which will engage environmental and social inclusion experts, will have responsibility for overseeing the development, implementation, enforcement, monitoring and reporting of environmental and social management measures and performance of the subprojects. It will also be responsible for building capacity in terms of safeguards, setting up the grievance redress mechanism (GRM) and implementing the stakeholder engagement plan for the project.

53. Stakeholder engagement and GRM. The project went through extensive consultations with stakeholders during the conceptualization and proposal preparation. The results of these consultations were incorporated in the project design. A stakeholder engagement plan has been prepared, which includes mapping of the project's stakeholders based on their interests and roles in the various components. SEPMU has identified key programme stakeholders at the national, district and village levels. Stakeholder groups include government agencies, water users' associations, forest enterprises, River Basins Councils, local administrations, and vulnerable sector groups. SEPMU will also be responsible for a plan for ongoing stakeholder engagement throughout the project implementation phase. The GRM is described in the SECAP, which reflects a three-tiered approach whereby communities submit their grievance at the project level, following the AE's complaints procedure, which is designed to receive and facilitate resolution of concerns and complaints in relation to non-compliance with its environmental and social policies. Grievances can be lodged and resolved at the field level, which can be further escalated to the EE (e.g. SEPMU and/or CEP). If resolution is not achieved at the EE level, the grievance can be formally submitted to IFAD. The findings of the grievance redress process will be disseminated in the implementation of the project's capacity-building initiatives. The GCF Independent Redress Mechanism will also be available for assistance at any stage of the programme cycle.

4.2 Gender policy

54. The AE has provided a gender assessment and gender action plan therefore complies with the requirements of the gender policy of the fund.

55. The gender assessment indicates the need for the project to address various aspects of gender inequalities in Tajikistan. It also acknowledges and demonstrates the role of women as agents of change. With a view to addressing gender inequality, and in alignment with the priorities for the country and for women, the assessment explored the multiple dimensions of inequality in relation to the climate change impacts policy, institutional arrangements/representation and implementation, and at the community level.

56. The barriers to equality are embedded in prohibitive sociocultural norms, unequal reproductive responsibilities and pay gaps between women and men. Access to land is a significant challenge to women despite their role and contribution. Even when women have access to land, it is mostly infertile, with limited access to inputs and far away from their homes. The disadvantaged position of youth and women-headed households is also noted, with targeted interventions and actions to address this problem. The gender assessment has also identified the additional disadvantages faced by women-headed households and youth, but also recognizes their role as agents of change.

57. The project's interventions will address the underlying causes of the gender inequality experienced by women, women-headed households, youth and people with disabilities through awareness-raising and sensitization activities. It will address barriers that prevent women taking part in decision-making and will also respond to their practical needs by providing access to necessary inputs and resources. The interventions proposed are targeted towards the agriculture sector and natural resource management, with the aim of increasing women's participation in and access to benefits from improved homestead and backyard livestock related interventions as well as their engagement in forestry, biodiversity and natural resource

management. Skills gaps among women will be addressed to increase their employability, enhance their technical capacity, and increase their decision-making capacity and roles. Intervention will also focus on increasing women's access to resources such as grants, finance, inputs and the market while consistently raising awareness of the reality of women's unrecognized but significant roles and contribution in these sectors. The gender action plan includes budgets for the various interventions, as well as for coordination with the committee of women and family affairs, and those responsible for youth. It has designated a gender specialist to ensure the mainstreaming of gender and implementation of the gender action plan, monitoring targets and achieving improvements in the lives of women, youth, women-headed households and people with disabilities engagement.

4.3 Risks

4.3.1. Overall project assessment (medium risk)

58. This funding proposal is a cross-cutting project (57 per cent adaptation and 43 per cent mitigation) to strengthen the capacity of the public sector for the climate-resilient management of natural resources, investment in communities for resilience to climate change, and enhancing the climate resilience of livelihoods using a market-based approach. GCF is requested to provide a senior loan of USD 9.0 million and a grant of USD 30.0 million. Co-financing is expected from IFAD of USD 31.01 million as a grant and USD 6.75 million as a senior loan, and there will also be USD 2.84 million of in-kind contribution from the Tajik Government and from United Nations agencies. The co-financing ratio is at 1:1.04, which accounts for 51 per cent of total financing.

4.3.2. Accredited entity/executing entity capability to execute the current project (medium risk)

59. IFAD is an international AE with a mission to improve global agriculture and food security. To date, IFAD has provided over USD 23 billion in grants and low interest rate loans to fund livelihoods in fragile and developing countries. Since its accreditation in 2016, IFAD has had a total of eight funding proposals approved by the Board with a value of close to USD 400 million. Furthermore, IFAD has designed and implemented several agricultural projects in Tajikistan, including a USD 39.3 million CASP investment. In addition, FAO as one of the EEs is a known international organization which has been an AE of GCF since 2016. Since accreditation, FAO has had 20 funding proposals approved by the Board worth over USD 600 million.

60. The other project EEs are SEPMU, under the country's Ministry of Agriculture, CEP–CIIP (also referred to as CEP) and FAO. Both SEPMU and CEP have project implementation experience with GCF and other development financial institutions. CEP partnered with GCF for the "Climate Adaptation and Mitigation Program for the Aral Sea Basin" project in Tajikistan and Uzbekistan, and worked with other development institutions such as the World Food Programme, Asian Development Bank and the United Nations Development Programme on their forest management projects. As a unit of the Ministry of Agriculture, SEPMU has been supporting the implementation of agriculture investment projects since 2012 and has staffing expertise for agricultural subsectors and community engagement. While both government agencies have years of project implementation experience, there is concern with the general lack of coordination and capacity among institutions in the country.

4.3.3. Project-specific execution risks (medium risk)

61. The funding proposal shows high credit risk given the B-country rating of Tajikistan. The low country rating is due to challenges related to its low per capita income, narrowly diversified economy, weak institutions and governance, and exposure to foreign currency risk.

Even with a considerably young population profile, the lack of employment opportunities and low wages have contributed to the economy's reliance on overseas remittances. Tajikistan also ranks low according to the worldwide governance indicators on government effectiveness, rule of law and control of corruption. Debt burden is moderate for Tajikistan but is being weighed down by contingent liability from state-owned enterprises. To help manage credit risk resulting from the low country rating, the funding proposal's loan portion is being made with highly concessional loan terms of a 40-year maturity period, 10-year grace period and 0 per cent interest rate.

62. The weak institutions and governance in Tajikistan also lead to a risk of poor institutional coordination and capacity. Among different ministries and institutions in the country, there is limited coordination and understanding about climate change and climate risk. Even at the national government level, a consensus on how to address the challenges of climate change is lacking. As such, the project risks experiencing delays in approval and implementation. To help mitigate the country's weak institutions and governance, GCF has provided several grants under the Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme and implemented projects that focus on coordination and intervention. The government will also benefit from a national adaptation plan which is being developed with the assistance of the United Nations Development Programme.

4.3.4. Project viability and concessionality

63. The CASP+ plans to work through national institutions and at the community level. At the national level, it intends to strengthen capacity for natural resources management and to enhance climate adaptive and integrated management of agri/forestry resources. The project team will contact 21 districts to consult on the development and implementation of community action plans and strengthen livelihoods through a market-based approach. All these initiatives are within the expertise of the AE given its track record in this space, and project viability is expected to be manageable.

64. The requested participation from GCF will represent approximately 49 per cent of the total project size in a project funded partly by loan and partly by grant. The level of concessionality in terms of funding share between GCF and the AE is evenly distributed. Funding terms are concessional given the large portion of grant and a lesser amount of loan on highly concessional terms. The concessional funding is justified by the weak country rating and low per-capita income of Tajikistan. Government and private sector funding tends to be limited and the concessional terms will help achieve climate impact without affecting the country's high risk of debt distress.

4.3.5. Compliance risk (medium risk)

65. The compliance risk assessment reveals a medium level of risk associated with the project. Key processes such as an anti-money-laundering and countering the financing of terrorism programme, sanctions compliance and counterparty due diligence are in place, reflecting adherence to international standards.

66. However, it is important to note potential vulnerabilities, such as the project's reliance on automated screening and ongoing monitoring for identifying entities subject to integrity due diligence. While these automated processes offer efficiency, there is a risk that they may not capture nuanced or emerging risks that require human judgment or deeper investigation. Ensuring a balance between automated processes and human oversight, along with periodic reviews, could fortify the project's resilience against compliance vulnerabilities.

67. Additionally, while the project has outlined robust internal controls and grievance redress mechanisms, ensuring their effective implementation will be critical in mitigating any

potential compliance challenges. Overall, continued vigilance and proactive measures will be essential to maintain compliance throughout the project life cycle.

68. In summary, the Secretariat has conducted a review of the proposal in accordance with relevant Board-approved policies and does not find any material issue or deviation with respect to compliance issues. Based on available information for this funding proposal, the Secretariat has determined a risk rating of medium and has no objection to this proposal proceeding.

4.3.6. GCF portfolio concentration risk (low risk)

69. In case of approval, the impact of this proposal on the GCF portfolio concentration in terms of results area and single proposal is not material.

4.3.7. Recommendation

70. It is recommended that the Board consider the above factors in its decision.

Summary risk assessment	
Overall programme	Medium
Accredited entity (AE)/executing entity (EE) capability	Medium
Project-specific execution	Medium
GCF portfolio concentration	Low
Compliance	Medium

4.4 Fiduciary

71. As the AE, IFAD will oversee CASP+, managing agreements with GCF and the EEs. Responsibilities, including fund management and quarterly disbursements, are delineated, with IFAD ensuring project quality, adherence to safeguards and evaluation. CASP+ execution involves the CEP, PMU and FAO, aligned with the project's theory of change and addressing climate vulnerability.

72. Financial management, governed by the established procedures of IFAD, includes disbursement, administration and auditing of GCF funds. Alignment with GCF agreements and adherence to financial standards ensures transparency and compliance. IFAD monitors and disburses GCF funds to implementing entities through the PMU and CEP. All financial management arrangements are specified under the funded activity agreement aligning with the accreditation master agreement (AMA) between GCF and IFAD.

73. The robust financial management system of IFAD maintains separate statements, accounts and records for IFAD and GCF proceeds, adhering to international financial reporting standards. Annual audits by independent external auditors further ensure financial transparency and accountability.

74. Internal and external audits strengthen financial oversight and control. Regular progress reports by IFAD to GCF track project performance, including physical achievements and financial aspects. District governments and jamoats (administrative divisions) play a vital role in coordinating local engagement and raising awareness about the project among stakeholders.

75. The project procures services from local non-governmental organizations, service providers and partner agencies for on-the-ground implementation. Encouraging private sector engagement ensures market-based solutions and sustainable project investments. Overall,

leadership by IFAD and collaboration with various stakeholders will ensure effective project execution and impactful climate adaptation outcomes.

4.5 Results monitoring and reporting

76. The funding proposal is for a cross-cutting project focusing on five results areas – four adaptation results areas and one mitigation results area of the Integrated Results Management Framework: (i) Most vulnerable people and communities; (ii) Health and well-being, and food and water security; (iii) Infrastructure and built environment; (iv) Ecosystems and ecosystem services; and (v) Forest and land use. The project aims to benefit a total of over 2.9 million beneficiaries with 0.65 million direct and 2.27 million indirect beneficiaries and deliver 6.85 Mt CO_2 eq of emission reductions over its lifetime.

77. The funding proposal uses the templates and provide contents in line with the requirements of the Integrated Results Management Framework. The sections on theory of change and logical framework (logframe) have been aligned with the suggested structure and format.

78. The proposal also contains all the elements of the logframe in terms of identification of results areas, indicators, means of verification, targets, assumptions, etc. These are adequate and are expected to allow smooth monitoring and reporting of project results. The information provided in different sections of the logframe is clearly stated, and the proper implementation of the logframe will help the communities concerned adopt the adaptation and mitigation mechanisms to deliver climate impact on the ground.

79. The assessment of adaptation benefits and beneficiaries as well as the mitigation impact is a strength of the funding proposal. Following the Secretariat’s guidance, separate annexes on the methodologies for estimating the adaptation impacts and beneficiaries and the mitigation impact have been prepared. The adaptation impact estimation methodology provides a description of the vulnerability context, and identification of adaptation benefits and related beneficiaries. Similarly, the annex on mitigation impact provides assumptions and methodological approaches used for estimating the emission reduction. These methodologies have allowed a systematic estimation of expected adaptation and mitigation impact which will help in devising approaches to achieve them during implementation, as well as monitoring and reporting.

80. **Implementation timetable:** The implementation timetable has been provided in the required structure and format. The milestones and deliverables at different stages of project implementation are identified. Adherence to the implementation timetable will facilitate the smooth implementation of the project as well as the timely delivery of the results at planned intervals.

4.6 Legal assessment

81. The Accreditation Master Agreement was signed with the Accredited Entity on 24 September 2018 (the “AMA”), and it became effective on 9 November 2018. The Accredited Entity’s five-year accreditation term lapsed on 8 November 2023 but was extended by Decision B.37/18, paragraph (q) until the earlier of three years from the date of lapse of the five-year accreditation term or the date on which a revised accreditation framework is adopted by the Board. The Board approved the re-accreditation of the Accredited Entity pursuant to Decision B.37/18, and negotiation of the Amended and Restated Accreditation Master Agreement is ongoing.

82. The Accredited Entity has not provided a legal opinion or certificate confirming that it has obtained all internal approvals and it has the capacity and authority to implement the project.

83. The proposed project will be implemented in the Republic of Tajikistan, a country in which GCF is not provided with privileges and immunities. This means that, amongst other things, GCF is not protected against litigation or expropriation in this country, which risks need to be further assessed. The GCF Secretariat delivered a hard copy of the draft agreement on privileges and immunities to the Minister of Finance of Tajikistan on 31 March 2016. The latest communication was sent by the GCF Secretariat to the National Designated Authority of Tajikistan on 20 May 2024. Negotiations on the agreement are ongoing.

84. The Heads of the Independent Redress Mechanism (IRM) and Independent Integrity Unit (IIU) have both expressed that it would not be legally feasible to undertake their redress activities and/or investigations, as appropriate, in countries where the GCF is not provided with relevant privileges and immunities. Therefore, it is recommended that disbursements by the GCF are made only after the GCF has obtained satisfactory protection against litigation and expropriation in the country, or has been provided with appropriate privileges and immunities.

85. The Accredited Entity has proposed that it will enter into a Subsidiary Agreement with the Republic of Tajikistan ("RoT"), acting through its Ministry of Finance ("MoF") and Ministry of Agriculture ("MoA"). The RoT acting through the MoA subsequently enters into an agreement with the Committee for Environmental Protection ("CEP"). Although it has been agreed that the RoT and CEP are Executing Entities for this project, under the Accredited Entity's proposed contractual structure, the Accredited Entity will not have a direct contractual relationship with CEP which is responsible for project implementation. For the Accredited Entity to pass down and enforce the relevant requirements of the AMA and funded activity agreement ("FAA") on CEP, the Accredited Entity has agreed in the term sheet that it will ensure that RoT passes down, monitors, supervises and enforces such requirements against CEP in a manner that allows the Accredited Entity to comply with the AMA and FAA requirements as if it had a direct contractual relationship with CEP.

86. To address the matters raised in this section, it is recommended that any approval by the Board is made subject to the following conditions:

(i) Submission by the Accredited Entity to the Fund of a certificate or legal opinion, in form and substance satisfactory to the GCF Secretariat, within 120 days after Board approval, confirming that the Accredited Entity has obtained all final internal approvals needed by it and has the capacity and authority to implement the proposed project;

(ii) Signature of the FAA in a form and substance satisfactory to the GCF Secretariat within 180 days from the date of Board approval, or the date the Accredited Entity has provided a certificate or legal opinion confirming that it has obtained all final internal approvals, whichever is later; and

(iii) Completion of the legal due diligence to the satisfaction of the GCF Secretariat.

Independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment of FP233

Proposal name:	Community-based Agriculture Support Programme 'plus' (CASP+)
Accredited entity:	International Fund for Agricultural Development
Country:	Tajikistan
Project/programme size:	Medium

I. Assessment of the independent Technical Advisory Panel

1.1 Overview

1. The funding proposal is for an investment in adaptation (57 per cent) and mitigation (43 per cent) targeting the public sector in support of its capacity needs to strengthen climate resilience management of natural resources, investment in communities to strengthen resilience to climate change and enhancing the climate resilience of livelihoods using a market-based approach.

2. The geographic selection approach starts from the identification of water sub catchment basins to identify the most vulnerable villages. This approach facilitates the grouping of villages into clusters within each basin. Following the identification of sub-catchment basins, district and village selection is based on the Climate Vulnerability Index (at the district and village level) that rely on multivariable data sets, including as variables, inter alia, a simple formula for measuring vulnerability (vulnerability = exposure + sensitivity – adaptive capacity), considering the climate vulnerability index with socioeconomic variables such as poverty incidence. Moreover, the selection takes into consideration the presence of natural resources such as rangelands and forests, the proximity of urban markets for agrifood value chain activities and the adjacency of selected districts so as to facilitate project implementation. The selection of villages is defined at the implementation stage,[1] and will ensure that no village with other relevant interventions is selected by the Community-based Agriculture Support Programme 'plus' (CASP+). While professing to be objective and fair, using the Climate Vulnerability Index for village selection might also obscure the actual criteria, for example, the adjacency and/or presence of other projects, used for selection or deselection.

1.2 Impact potential *Scale: Medium to high*

3. The project estimates reaching 2.8 million beneficiaries, with 0.650 million direct (approximately 7 per cent of the total population, or 31 per cent of the project area population) and 2.3 million indirect beneficiaries (approximately 24 per cent of the total population).[2] Over 7 million smallholder livestock farmers are targeted to receive artificial insemination, animal health or training services to increase the productivity of their livestock.[3]

[1] See funding proposal annex 21, para. 28, page 13.
[2] See funding proposal annex 24 on breakdown of project beneficiaries.
[3] See funding proposal on output 3.1 by end of year 7.

4. The total lifespan of the project is 20 years, in which a total of 6,854,822 tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent (t CO_2 eq) (annual average of 340,000 t CO_2 eq) will be mitigated from pasture and forest management, afforestation and improved herd management across 3,650 ha forests, 6,190 ha perennial crops and 180,000 ha improved pasture. Mitigation components will also arise along the agricultural production and business value chains, including the use of energy saving and easy maintenance and replication (i.e. the thermo-isolation of shelters and stabling structures using straw, which was successfully tested in previous projects, use of solar and energy efficiencies in the drip irrigation and drying systems or reduced use of fertilizers).

5. **Impact on the fiscal resilience of the Tajikistan Government**. Another potential climate impact of the project is the increased fiscal resilience of local governments or agencies. The introduction of district climate resilience diagnostics (DCRD) should lead to the integration of climate measures in the local development and investment plans of the government and the private sector; essentially, fiscal resilience of the Tajikistan Government could be achieved through efficient and effective planning and budgeting of expenditures based on priority climate-informed development plans, as well as the reduction of unplanned social and rehabilitation expenditures due to impacts of climate change in the project areas. This will potentially alleviate fiscal pressures on the Tajikistan Government.

6. Risks to potential climate impact. Effecting behavioural change among the targeted livestock farmers will be a challenge. It may be difficult to convince the targeted farmer beneficiaries to switch from the traditional practice of livestock herd management (e.g. increasing herd and flock size, pasture grazing, buying good-quality bulls) to the new methods of artificial insemination and improved animal care and feeding; the farmers' traditional ways of livestock farming have enabled them to survive through the years, and letting this go overnight to a new scheme will demand a lot of trust and confidence in the new system. Thus, the need for increased awareness and understanding of the new approaches to herd management will be crucial. Moreover, consideration of the level of risk to which farmers are exposed, and possible compensation for farmers who do not become better off, is recommended.

7. Genetic improvement[4] is expected to encourage commercial farmers and smallholders to switch from low-yielding animals to higher-yielding and more efficient stock, thereby encouraging a reduction in herd size and helping to reduce greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions. Indeed, the funding proposal states that livestock productivity is currently low and limited by the poor genetic potential of animals.[5] However, the risks or potential adverse effects from changing the genetic pool also need to be discussed. Similarly, risks and knock-on effects of a transition from natural pastures to fodder feeding would also need to be critically examined.

8. The monitoring and reporting of GHG emissions post project implementation needs to be assured. Such monitoring and reporting are clear during project implementation but not assured during the lifespan of the project where the bulk of the GHG emissions will occur.

9. The funding proposal's impact potential is assessed as medium to high.

1.3 Paradigm shift potential *Scale: Medium to high*

10. The funding proposal's multi-pronged approach to mainstreaming climate is laudable as this is likely to trigger the potential paradigm shift.

11. **Mainstreaming in higher education**. The funding proposal will streamline climate change and ecosystem management approaches in the training curricula and research

[4] See funding proposal para. 29.
[5] See funding proposal para. 57.

programmes of national research institutions and academia.[6] The integration of climate change issues into the curricula of universities and training institutions will establish best practice for potential scaling up and replication across educational institutions in the country, targeting agronomists, agricultural engineers, foresters, zootechnicians and veterinarians of Tajik Agrarian University and Tajik Academy of Agricultural Sciences. Climate change will also be mainstreamed in the training curriculum of public administrators at the Academy for Public Administration. These students, especially public administrators, will eventually work for, or with, the government planners and decision makers, and influence government programmes, projects and other activities with respect to integrating climate change mitigation and/or adaptation elements.

12. The enabling of research institutes and the private sector to produce evidence on natural resource management and climate change for policy dialogue and climate-sensitive technical innovations[7] will also contribute to a new body of knowledge that can be used by planners and decision makers in pursuit of local development and investment opportunities along a low-carbon and climate-resilient pathway.

13. **Mainstreaming in government institutions**. There are many interwoven activities in this area that contribute to potential paradigm shift. These include enhancing the mainstreaming of climate adaptive management practices of natural resources in all national institutions and verification of the effectiveness of policies on the ground;[8] review of the legislation and regulatory framework related to the Strategy for the Development of the Green Economy for 2023–2037 of the Ministry of Economic Development and Trade; provision of training to government officials and strengthening of the Ministry of Finance to enable it to monitor projects and resource mobilization;[9] stocktaking of policy development and mainstreaming of gender-sensitive climate adaptive agricultural practices; training on the utilization of policy support tools such as Global Livestock Environmental Assessment Model, Ex-Ante Carbon balance Tool, and Biodiversity Integrated Assessment and Computation Tool, which directly capacitates the government decision makers and planners;[10] and the development of the above-mentioned Green Economy Strategy as well as the capacity-building of the Ministry of Economic Development and Trade and the Ministry of Finance.[11] These activities will equip and guide the institutions, especially the Ministry of Economic Development and Trade and Ministry of Finance staff, on how to potentially integrate climate change into the performance of public financial management duties as the need arises.

14. **Mainstreaming in policy**. The funding proposal indicates that the animal health and breeding regulatory and strategic framework is to be reviewed and updated to ensure compliance with international guidelines and enable streamlining of measures supporting climate resilience and environmental protection. A learning by doing approach would ensure that climate is enshrined, fully or partially, as a policy, regulation or framework in the animal husbandry and livestock management subsector. This initiative can potentially lead to either voluntary or regulatory compliance by the farmer stakeholders concerned. This intervention has a huge potential for replication across other agriculture subsectors in interventions that will eventually lead to mainstreaming climate in public finance management (i.e. planning, budgeting, expenditures).

15. The very ambitious component on strengthening public sector capacity for transformative climate-resilient management of natural resources[12] is reinforced by the proposed project's choice to work principally through the Ministry of Agriculture and the Center

[6] See funding proposal activity 1.1.4.
[7] See funding proposal activity 1.1.4.3.
[8] See funding proposal activity 1.2.1.
[9] See funding proposal activity 1.2.3.
[10] See funding proposal activity 1.2.1.
[11] See funding proposal activity 1.2.3.
[12] See funding proposal component 1.

for Implementation of Investment Projects of the Committee for Environmental Protection under the Government of Tajikistan. This is also important in ensuring that the strengthened capacity and climate-resilient management remains after the project implementation period.

16. **Mainstreaming in community-level planning.**[13] DCRD, based on the risks and opportunities emerging in each district, will provide the basis for the subsequent community planning in 400 CASP+ target villages. Ultimately, it will form the basis for defining the climate-sensitive community action plans and the potential adaptation investments for (i) pasture improvement/restoration (pasture management plans); (ii) climate-resilient infrastructures strengthening/rehabilitation; (iii) procurement of agricultural machinery; and (iv) forestry investments.

17. **Partnerships or productive alliances**. The intervention on setting up nine productive alliances between livestock producers groups and private aggregators[14] is akin to introducing localized public–private partnership models, distinct from the typical national flagship public–private partnership modalities. The business partnership formed between the private sector and farmers, funded by the government via grants facilities from windows 1 and 2 with some co-financing (in kind or productive agriculture asset) by the private sector is a potential paradigm shift in the way investors, local farmers associations and the government could come together to address the much-needed local economic development.

18. **Introduction of climate technology product and services solutions**. The deployment of modern technologies to address traditional issues and challenges in livestock care,[15] breeding,[16] natural resources management,[17,18,19] community planning,[20] monitoring and reporting of developmental activities[21] and linkages with the wider agriculture business value chains[22] enables the local communities to transition into more low-carbon and climate-resilient development pathways.

19. Overall the mainstreaming of climate in both public and private sector planning is the main potential paradigm shift. From the government perspective, the mainstreaming of climate will eventually lead to greening of the components of the public financial management systems, the effect of which is to enhance the fiscal resilience and sustainability of the government. From the private sector's viewpoint, this enables the stakeholders along the agribusiness value chain to manage their potential losses and damage due to the impacts of climate change.

20. **Risk to paradigm shift.** Given the diversified approaches on mainstreaming climate in the policy, planning and investment activities at the community, district and central level, weak buy-in from the other activities may delay but will not stop the integration of climate into the decision-making processes.

21. Overall, the paradigm shift potential is high.

1.4 Sustainable development potential *Scale: High*

[13] See funding proposal activity 2.1.1.1.
[14] See funding proposal output 3.2.
[15] See funding proposal activity1.1.3 on provision of technical capacities of national livestock institutions to ensure efficient provision of public animal health and production services.
[16] See funding proposal activity 3.1.3 on supporting adoption of climate-resilient innovative technologies.
[17] See funding proposal activity 1.1.4 on building capacities of research and academic institutions on climate-resilient ecosystem management.
[18] See funding proposal activity 1.2.1 on training on SIPT, GLEAM, EXACT and B-INTACT.
[19] See funding proposal activity 1.2.3 on use of software for monitoring and analysis of public investment projects.
[20] See funding proposal activity 2.1.1 on diagnostic of community needs.
[21] See funding proposal activity 1.1.2 on introduction of combined remote and participatory natural resources monitoring and management.
[22] See funding proposal component 3.

22. **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**. The funding proposal cuts across several SDGs. CASP+ will contribute to the achievement of SDG 13 (Climate action), which is "intrinsically linked to all 16 of the other Goals of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development".[23] CASP+ will also contribute to achieving SDG 1 (No poverty), SDG 2 (Zero hunger), SDG 5 (Gender equality), SDG 8 (Decent work and economic growth) and SDG 17 (Partnerships for the goals).

23. **Economic co-benefits**. The local public–private partnership approach[24] will foster entrepreneurship, business partnerships and commercial or trading activities along the agribusiness value chains. The formation of productive alliances, common interest groups and the matching grant facilities will enhance the inflow of private sector investments in the target sectors, boosting jobs and livelihoods. The infrastructure facilities (e.g. off-farm mating stations) and services (e.g. artificial insemination)[25] will provide long-term confidence among entrepreneurs and investors in carrying out more local business activities.

24. **Environmental co-benefits**. Carbon sequestration is the main co-benefit due to the initiatives on management of forests and pasturelands. Another is the potential increase in biodiversity, including plant diversity and production of nectar for pollinators and beneficial insects. The proposed project will also lead to improvements in soil fertility and increased water retention.[26]

25. **Social co-benefits**. The potential social co-benefits, enhancing the socioeconomic conditions of the communities involved, are as follows: (i) employment generation via labour in forest plantations, nursery plantations, introduction of modern agriculture equipment, climate proofing of agricultural infrastructures and animal care services; (ii) enhanced community resilience via improved erosion and flood control measures versus extreme climate events; (iii) training on artificial insemination, veterinary/farm animal care services and manning of off-farm mating stations for the youth and veterinary practitioners; (iv) climate-smart agricultural practices via use of modern and efficient farm technologies, learning in farmer field schools on improved livestock and agriculture production techniques and adapting practices to changing climate conditions;[27] and (v) access to finance and markets via common interest groups and productive alliances.

26. **Gender-sensitive development impact**. Women and female-headed households are active agents of change under this funding proposal. Women's capacity will be enhanced through increased access to climate knowledge and technology solutions to manage communities and ecosystems,[28] as well as economic assets and micro-enterprises in the mountainous regions.[29] Gender is also taken into consideration in the mainstreaming in climate-smart agriculture.

27. The risk to sustainable development is low given the multi-pronged, integrated and holistic approach of CASP+.

28. Overall, the sustainable development potential is assessed as high.

1.5 Needs of the recipient *Scale: High*

[23] See https://www.un.org/sustainabledevelopment/climate-action/.
[24] See funding proposal activities 3.2 and 3.3.
[25] See funding proposal activity 3.1.
[26] See funding proposal para. 104 for more details.
[27] See funding proposal annex 21, para. 98.
[28] See funding proposal output 2.2.
[29] See funding proposal output 3.2.

29. The funding proposal endeavours to address the needs of the people, community, critical ecosystems, investors and entrepreneurs, and government stakeholders through several interventions, as discussed in paragraphs below.

30. **Need for bottom-up approach in community planning**. The use of DCRD in developing climate-sensitive community action plans shows a strong bottom-up approach and community linkages. DCRD is based on the assessment of risks and opportunities emerging in each district, and this will provide the basis for the subsequent community planning in the 400 targeted CASP+ villages. DCRD will form the basis for defining the climate-sensitive community action plans and the potential adaptation investment for pasture improvement and restoration (pasture management plans), strengthening and rehabilitation of climate-resilient infrastructures, procurement of agricultural machinery and forestry and agriculture business value chain investments.

31. **Need for climate-related technical capacity and knowledge of government stakeholders**. The proposed project will provide the technical capacity to manage natural resources such as pastures, forests and agricultural land, as well as optimize ecosystem services (biodiversity, carbon sequestration). It will also provide technical capacity in support of the planned Green Economy Program, and the implementation of DCRD, which is the main intervention that will enhance the capacities of village communities and at the district level to formulate development and investment plans that are framed within the climate context.

32. **Need for farmers' sustainable livelihoods and investments**. The proposed project will address the needs of the whole agriculture value chain from production and post production to access to markets. On production, it will provide improved pasture management schemes, climate-resilient infrastructure, agriculture assets, a grant window facility for bee farming/keeping greenhouses and modern drip irrigation systems for eligible farmers. On the post-production side, the interventions will open a grant window facility for the set-up of cold storage facilities, vacuum dryers and milk processing centres.[30] To enhance access to markets, the project will help to set up alliances such as the productive alliances and common interest groups,[31] which will facilitate the agribusiness trade between the farmers and buyers along the agriculture business value chain.[32] It will also facilitate access to investors via the Platform for Remittances, Investments and Migrants' Entrepreneurship (PRIME) Central Asia to increase access to formal remittances and expand the digital financial inclusion of migrants and remittance recipient families and returnees, with a focus on women and youth in rural areas.

33. Overall, the needs of the recipient are assessed as high.

1.6 Country ownership *Scale: High*

34. **Alignment with national climate strategy and priorities**. CASP+ is aligned with climate initiatives as envisioned under Tajikistan's intended nationally determined contribution, the National Disaster Risk Reduction Strategy (2019–2030) and the National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy 2030. It will also support the national development plans, such as the National Development Strategy 2015–2030 (sustainable use of agricultural land and water) the National Agricultural Investment Plan for Sustainable Agriculture Development and Food Security 2021–2030 (investments for food and nutrition security and sustainable agriculture, including investments in forestry, pasture and livestock intensification), the Water Sector Reform Programme (2016–2025) (water resources) and the Strategy for the Development of the Forestry Sector (2016–2030) (forest, livestock grazing).

[30] See funding proposal output 3.1.
[31] See funding proposal activities 3.3.1 and 3.3.2.
[32] See funding proposal output 3.3.

35. **Strong bottom-up approach**. DCRD is possibly the main anchor of the funding proposal in that it will ensure that there is strong country ownership in the project interventions and deliverables under this programme. The DCRD bottom-up approach will feed into and inform the formulation and development and investment plans and policies.

36. Country ownership is assessed as high.

1.7 Efficiency and effectiveness *Scale: Medium to high*

37. **Strong project foundation**. The proposed interventions build on the successful experiences of four projects funded by the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) over the last 15 years (2008–2024) in vulnerable mountainous areas of the Khatlon region in Tajikistan, specifically on the livestock and pasture development projects (phases I and II).[33] This provides strong confidence that CASP+ will be relying on the robust evidence-based data and information, best practices (e.g. community action plans, common interest groups, women's empowerment, pasture users associations and unions, joint forest management) and lessons learned when it comes to implementing and overseeing this project during its lifetime.

38. **Strong technical and institutional partners for project implementation**. The choice of accredited entity and executing entities presents capable project managers who will guide the effective and efficient implementation of the proposed project. IFAD, as accredited entity, has strong experience in Tajikistan (e.g. Khatlon Livelihoods Support Project, Livestock and Pasture Development Project and Community-Based Agriculture Support Programme). IFAD has substantial global experience in designing and supervising rural development investments, with a strong focus on integrating climate change across its portfolio. Key highlights of IFAD experience include climate fund management, climate and environmental finance and GCF climate project management (i.e. FP101, Belize; SAP012, Niger; FP143, Brazil; FP162, West Africa; FP183, West Africa; and FP220, East Africa).[34]

39. The Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations, as executing entity, has extensive experience and active involvement in significant climate finance projects, which shows its capability in providing comprehensive climate change assistance and support. The relevant GCF climate projects it has been involved in include FP116, Kyrgyzstan, and SAP014, Armenia.[35]

40. **Concessionality of GCF funds**. Tajikistan has B minus country rating which signifies its high credit risk.[36] This is compounded by the high vulnerability of the country given its low capacity[37].

41. If the funding proposal is approved, GCF will provide USD 39.0 million in the form of grants (USD 30.0 million) and loans (USD 9.0 million). The co-financing commitment from IFAD is in the form of grant (USD 31.01 million) and senior loans (USD 6.75 million), and there will also be in-kind contributions (USD 2.84 million) from government and United Nations agencies. The co-financing ratio is at 1:1.04 and accounts for 51 per cent of total financing.

42. The requested participation from GCF will represent approximately 49 per cent of total programme size in a partly loan- and grant-funded project. The level of concessionality in terms of funding share between GCF and the accredited entity is evenly distributed. For component 1, the GCF share of 61 per cent is allocated to strengthening public sector capacity on transformative climate-resilient natural resource management ; this is co-financed by IFAD, the

[33] See funding proposal para. 38 and annexes 29 and 30 for more details of IFAD projects.
[34] See funding proposal para. 127 for more details.
[35] See funding proposal para. 130 for more details.
[36] S&P Global. 2024. Tajikistan 'B-/B' Ratings Affirmed; Outlook Stable. Accessed on June 2024.
[37] See ND Gains Ranking of Tajikistan.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations and State Forest Agency For component 2, the climate-sensitive community action plans will be developed and financed by IFAD (86 per cent) along with the other partners (i.e. the Ministry of Agriculture, State Forest Agency and the Committee for Environmental Protection).[38] Then GCF will allocate 72 per cent of the funding for the roll-out of 400 climate-sensitive community action plans developed for the 21 districts benefiting 100,000 rural households. Component 3 will be funded mainly by IFAD and the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations with GCF co-financing around 12 per cent of these activities.

43. The project's adaptation cost is USD 27 per direct beneficiary and mitigation cost is USD 3.31 per t CO_2 eq. Both costs are in the lower range of the GCF portfolio for climate resilience in agriculture and forestry. The co-financing ratio is 1:0.4. Through the matching grant windows, there is a potential to leverage further parallel financing, which is confirmed in the funding proposal, with an estimated amount of USD 4.6 million.

44. If implemented as planned, the assessment of efficiency and effectiveness is medium to high.

II. Overall remarks from the independent Technical Advisory Panel

45. The iTAP recommends that the Board approve this funding proposal.

46. To strengthen further the submitted funding proposal, the following recommendations are presented:

(a) Develop a plan to incorporate the potential future distribution of species into a revised version of the biodiversity management plan;

(b) The iTAP recommends further that the following be made part of the Project Implementation Manual, specifically:

(i) a plan by which to transfer to the community or district level government at the end of the implementation phase, and provide budget for the monitoring – reporting and verification plan for the CO_2 sequestered from the forest management components, and GHGs from livestock and pastureland management; and

(ii) a disclosure statement for the target farmer beneficiaries covering (i) the potential risks associated with the adoption of new agricultural and livestock management methods (e.g. risks or potential adverse effects from changing the genetic pool, knock-on effects of the transition from natural pastures to fodder feeding); (ii) a caveat that the proposed interventions need to be undertaken as a whole programme to ensure higher chances of improving their livelihoods and incomes; (iii) an indication that selecting interventions according to the farmers' preference will not guarantee expected changes; and (iv) provision of a safety net for farmers that do not become better off even after following the programme in its totality. [39]

[38] See funding proposal output 2.1.

[39] The risk of failure to improve the farmer's lives and livelihoods even after the farmer's consistent adherence to the programme will adversely impact future projects being proposed by GCF and other development partners.

Response from the accredited entity to the independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment (FP233)

Proposal name:	Community-based Agriculture Support Programme ‘plus’ (CASP+)
Accredited entity:	International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)
Country:	Tajikistan
Project/programme size:	Medium

Impact potential
IFAD takes note of the positive assessment and thanks iTAP for identifying the risks and challenges associated to the proposed changes introduced by the project. The challenge of a drastic behavioural change in livestock management patterns is a key pre-identified risk in the project TOC, whereby in addition to awareness pull factors such as improved genetics, feeding, and health services will improve productivity and parallel measures to diversify from unproductive practices. In addition, Annex 2.3a details Pasture Users Unions-managed specific triggers to virtuous behaviours in this sense. IFAD also takes note of the need to assure the monitoring and reporting of GHG emissions post project implementation. Training to CEP and other related entities will be provided in order to ensure uptake from national entities and mainstreaming GHG sequestration monitoring in government institutions.
Paradigm shift potential
IFAD takes note of the high paradigm shift potential and equally thanks iTAP for stressing the high potential for replication across other agriculture subsectors leading to mainstreaming climate in public finance management, by recommending a learning by doing approach for the review and update of the regulatory and strategic framework.
Sustainable development potential
IFAD takes note of the positive assessment.
Needs of the recipient
IFAD takes note of the positive assessment.
Country ownership

IFAD takes note of the positive assessment.
Efficiency and effectiveness
IFAD takes note of the positive assessment.
Overall remarks from the independent Technical Advisory Panel: IFAD thanks the iTAP for its positive review of the funding proposal and the recommendations provided. IFAD appreciates the importance of a disclosure statement for target farmers beneficiaries during implementation, which will also be informed by the demonstrated uptake of improved practices and technologies in similar investment in the country.[1]

[1] Reference: impact assessment of Livestock and Pasture Development Project – phase II (Annex 18.c).

ANNEX 8 Gender Analysis/Assessment and Gender and Social Inclusion Action Plan

Community-based Agricultural Support Project 'Plus' (CASP+)

June 6, 2021
(updated in March 2024)

CASP+ Abbreviations and acronyms

ADB	Asian Development Bank
AI	Artificial insemination
CASP	Community-based Agricultural Support Project (phase I)
CASP+	Community-based Agricultural Support Project ‘Plus’ (phase II)
CIG	Common Interest Group
CsCAP	Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
FFS	Farmers Field Schools
FHH	Female Headed Households
GII	Gender Inequality Index
GoT	Government of Tajikistan
HDI	Human Development Index
HH	Household
IFAD	International Fund for Agricultural Development
IGA	Income generating activities
INRM	Integrated Natural Resource Management
JFM	Joint Forest Management
MoA	Ministry of Agriculture
NIP	National Agricultural Investment Plan 2021-2030
NGO	Non-governmental organization
NRM	Natural Resources Management
PMP	Pasture Management Plans
PMU	Project Management Unit
PUU	Pasture Users Union
PUA	Pasture Users Associations
TAJSTAT	Agency on statistics
UNDP	UN Development Programme
UNFCCC	UN Framework Convention on Climate Change
UN Women	UN Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women
VO	Village Organization
WB	World Bank
WFP	World Food Programme
WG	Women group
WHH	Women Head of Households
WUA	Water Users Associations

Part I: Gender Analysis and Assessment

Demography

1. According to the National Statistical Agency, the total population of Tajikistan accounts for 9.3 Million. As of July 2020, the regional population distribution was the following, showing higher percentage in Khatlon Region (3,3 Million) followed by Sughd (2,7Million)[1]:

	Population number as of 01.07.2020, thsd.persons	*in % to the corresponding period of the previous year*
Republic of Tajikistan	**9391.7**	**101.9**
GBAO	230.0	100.9
Sogd oblast	2726.0	101.8
Khatlon oblast	3380.8	102.1
Dushanbe	867.4	101.9
RRS	2187.5	102.0

Figure 1: Population by region. Source: Food Security and Poverty, Statistical Agency under the President of the Republic of Tajikistan, 2020.

2. Women account for 51.5% of the population. Households are larger on average in rural areas (6.5 persons) than urban areas (4.8 persons). Overall men head the majority of households (79%), with only 21% headed by women (being 84% male headed and 16% female headed in rural areas). More than half (55%) of the population is under age 25, and 38% are younger than 15. Four percent of the population is age 65 and older (TajDHS, 2017)[2].

Poverty

3. Extreme poverty, measured by the international poverty line of US$1.90 per day (WB data from 2003 to 2014)[3], fell markedly from 27 percent in 2003 to 4 percent in 2014. According to the Government's own calculations, using a national poverty line, poverty declined, over the same time horizon from 81 percent to 32 percent in 2014 (Tajstat, 2015)[4].

4. The most recent poverty data available at national level (2019) register a further decline to 26.3 with extreme poverty at 10.7 (Tajstat, 2020)[5].The thresholds of the national poverty line (2009) on monthly consumption are calculated as follows: less than TJS162 for poor, less than TJS230 for vulnerable, and less than TJS294 for middle class[6].

---

[1] Food Security and Poverty, Statistical Agency under President of the Republic of Tajikistan, 2020 Available at: https://stat.ww.tj/posts/February2021/2-2020_angl..pdf

[2] Tajikistan, Demographic and health Survey, 2 Statistical Agency under President of the Republic of Tajikistan, 2017 Available at: https://dhsprogram.com/publications/publication-fr341-dhs-final-reports.cfm

[3] Data available at: https://data.worldbank.org/topic/11

[4] Official figures indicate that the poverty rate dropped from 81% in 2000 to 30.3% in 2016. Source: "Dynamics of poverty reduction in Tajikistan," Statistical Agency under President of the Republic of Tajikistan. The extreme poverty rate (measured by food poverty line at 2,250 Kcal per person a day) dropped from 20%in 2012 to 16.8%in 2014, Available at: http://www.stat.tj/ru/news/307/
https://stat.ww.tj/files/metodologia_bednosti_anglisi.pdf

[5] 2019 poverty rate according to national Agency of statistics: Food Security and Poverty, Statistical Agency under President of the Republic of Tajikistan, 2020 (matrix pp144).
https://stat.ww.tj/posts/February2021/2-2020_angl..pdf

[6] Poverty measurement in tajikistan: methodological note, Tajstat 2015.
Available at: https://stat.ww.tj/files/metodologia_bednosti_anglisi.pdf

5. Comparing the per-capita monthly consumption aggregate to the poverty lines yields a national extreme (food) poverty rate of 16.8 percent and a total poverty rate of 32 percent (as official 2014 data). Poverty in Tajikistan (2014 data) is higher in RRS, Khatlon and GBAO and to a lesser degree in Sughd. Poverty is also higher in rural areas (36.1 percent) than in urban households (23.5 percent). Extreme Poverty in rural areas is 19.7 percent[7].

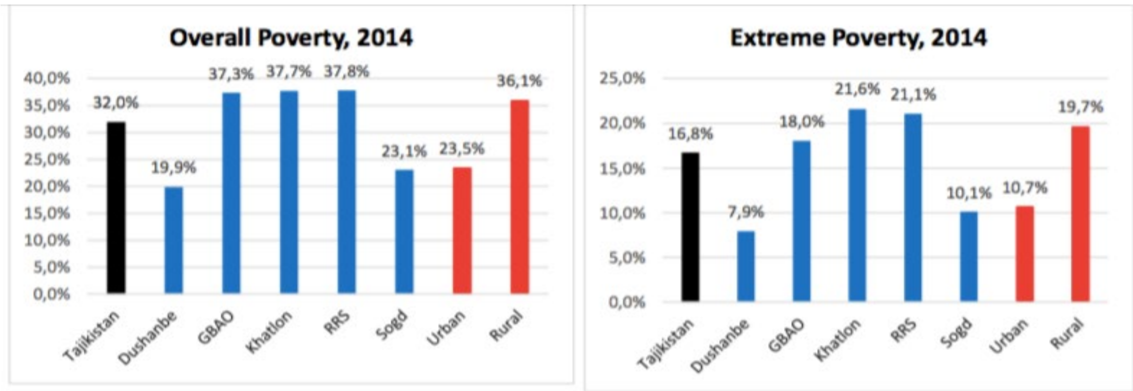


Figure 2: Overall poverty and extreme poverty in Tajikistan in 2014. Source: Agency on Statistics, Poverty measurement in Tajikistan, 2015

6. In 2014 Khatlon accounted for highest percentage of extreme poverty at 21% followed by RRS with 21,1%, GBAO with 18% and then Sughd with 10%. The poor are concentrated in rural Tajikistan (81 %) and in three regions of Khatlon, GBAO and RRS. Indeed, almost four out of five poor persons lives in rural households. Also, as of 2014 statistics, almost 2/3 of the poor are in the regions of Sughd (30,2%) and Khatlon (36,7%).

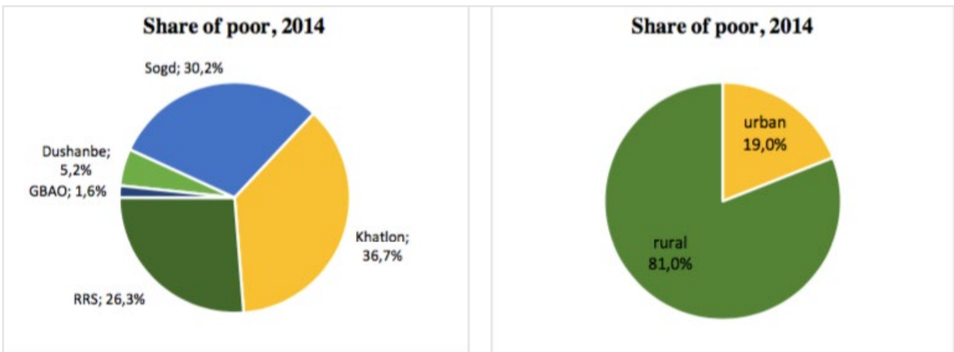


Figure 3: Share of poor in Tajikistan in 2014. Source: Agency on Statistics, Poverty measurement in Tajikistan, 2015

7. There is substantial spatial and seasonal variation in poverty. Most rural areas are poorer than urban ones, and poverty and income insecurity are higher during winter and spring[8].

Extreme Poverty and Gender

[7] *Ibidem*
[8] *Ibidem*

8. In 2015 UNDP conducted a survey on: "*mapping registered extreme poverty in rural Tajikistan* (2016)"[9]. The analysis is based on poverty information for the 427 rural and township jamoats where around 79% of the country's population lives. It emerged that the total number of extreme poor registered by jamoats was 163,617. Women accounted for 40% of this figure.

Region	Population	Poor	Female Poor	Poor households	Female-led poor households
Gorno-Badakhshan Autonomous Region (Badakh)	192,136	4,364	1,722	803	257
Districts of Republican Jurisdiction (Center)	1,842,253	45,758	18,505	8,668	3,076
Khatlon	2,723,180	65,354	25,395	11,796	4,315
Sughd	1,977,271	48,141	19,352	9,137	3,365
Total	**6,734,840**	**163,617**	**64,974**	**30,404**	**11,013**

Figure 4: Extreme poverty in Tajikistan by region in 2015. Sources: JAMBI dataset, based on records of jamoat social assistance commissions

9. The data collected by jamoats allows for an exploration of gender differences in terms of extreme poverty. As the numbers reported indicate, there were 64,974 women, or 39.7% of all extreme poor registered in rural and township jamoats in 2015. Of the 30,404 extremely poor households listed in the same table, 11,013 were headed by women, which translates into a 36.2 % share of female-headed households (FHHs) among all extreme poor households. (UNDP, 2016).

Human Development Index (HDI)

10. Tajikistan's 2019 HDI of 0.668 is above the average of 0.631 for countries in the medium human development group and below the average of 0.791 for countries in Europe and Central Asia. From Europe and Central Asia, Tajikistan is compared with Kyrgyzstan and Uzbekistan, which have HDIs ranked 120 and 106, respectively (UNDP, 2020)[10].

	HDI value	HDI rank	Life expectancy at birth	Expected years of schooling	Mean years of schooling	GNI per capita (2017 PPP US$)
Tajikistan	0.668	125	71.1	11.7	10.7	3,954
Kyrgyzstan	0.697	120	71.5	13.0	11.1	4,864
Uzbekistan	0.720	106	71.7	12.1	11.8	7,142
Europe and Central Asia	0.791	—	74.4	14.7	10.4	17,939
Medium HDI	0.631	—	69.3	11.5	6.3	6,153

Figure 5: Tajikistan Human Development Index (HDI). Source: UNDP Human Development Report, 2020

Gender Development Index (GDI)

11. The 2019 female HDI value for Tajikistan is 0.586 in contrast with 0.712 for males, resulting in a GDI value of 0.823, placing it into Group 5. 2 In

[9] UNDP, mapping registered extreme poverty in rural Tajikistan, 2016
Document available at: http://untj.org/jambi-project/images/Extreme-Poverty_ENG.pdf
[10] UNDP, Human Development Report, 2020
Document available at: http://hdr.undp.org/sites/all/themes/hdr_theme/country-notes/TJK.pdf

comparison, GDI values for Kyrgyzstan and Uzbekistan are 0.957 and 0.939, respectively (UNDP,2020).

	F-M ratio	HDI values		Life expectancy at birth		Expected years of schooling		Mean years of schooling		GNI per capita	
	GDI value	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male
Tajikistan	0.823	0.586	0.712	73.4	68.9	10.7	12.6	10.2	11.3	1,440	6,427
Kyrgyzstan	0.957	0.677	0.707	75.6	67.4	13.2	12.7	11.2	11.0	2,971	6,798
Uzbekistan	0.939	0.695	0.740	73.8	69.6	11.9	12.2	11.6	12.0	5,064	9,230
Europe and Central Asia	0.953	0.768	0.806	77.7	71.1	14.5	14.8	9.9	10.7	12,373	23,801
Medium HDI	0.835	0.567	0.679	70.8	67.9	11.7	11.4	5.3	8.1	2,530	9,598

Figure 6: Tajikistan Gender Development Index (HDI). Source: UNDP Human Development Report, 2020

12. In Tajikistan, 20.0 percent of parliamentary seats are held by women. Life expectancy at birth for the total population (both sex) is 70. It is higher for women at 70 compared to men at 67.9 The median number of years of schooling among women is 10.2 compared with 11,3 years for men (UNDP,2020)[11].

Maternal Mortality rate

13. According to the Demographic and Health Survey (DHS, 2017) for every 100,000 live births, 32.0 women die from pregnancy related causes; and the adolescent birth rate is 57.1 births per 1,000 women of ages 15-19. According to WHO, Maternal mortality is conditioned by poor quality of services in antenatal, intrapartum and postnatal care the lack of a functioning referral system, the lack of means of transport especially in rural areas, and inadequate access to emergency obstetric care (EOC). While home deliveries decreased in all regions of Tajikistan between 2012 and 2017, the most substantive reductions were observed in Khatlon (from 31% to 15%), GBAO (from 34% to 24%), and DRS (from 29% to 21%). Notable decreases in home deliveries also occurred among women at lower levels of education and wealth (TjDHS, 2017)[12].

Child Mortality

14. Overall, under-5 mortality declined between the 2012 and 2017. The TjDHS surveys from 43 deaths per 1,000 live births to 33 deaths per 1,000 live births. Infant mortality decreased from 34 to 27 deaths per 1,000 live births over the same period, while neonatal mortality fell from 19 to 13 deaths per 1,000 live births (TjDHS, 2017).The risk of dying in early childhood is much greater for children in rural areas (37 deaths per 1,000 live births) than for those in urban areas (20 deaths per 1,000 live births). Khatlon generally has the highest mortality rates (40 percent) and Dushanbe the lowest (11percent). The percentage for other regions is 30 per cent DRS, same for GBAO, and 33 per cent Sughd (TjDHS, 2017)[13].

Education

[11] *ibidem*

[12] Tajikistan Demographic and Health Survey, 2017. The survey is implemented by the Statistical Agency under the President of the Republic of Tajikistan (SA) in collaboration with the Ministry of Health and Social Protection of Population (MOHSP). Document available at: https://dhsprogram.com/publications/publication-fr341-dhs-final-reports.cfm

[13] I*bidem*

15. Eighty percent of the female population and 79% of the male population age 6 and older have at least some secondary education. Males are more likely than females to have post-secondary education (25% versus 13%). Only 7% of women and men never attended school. Urban women (52%) and men (61%) are more likely than rural women (45%) and men (53%) to have a secondary or higher education. The percentage of women with a secondary or higher education is lowest in DRS (34%). Men are least likely to have a secondary or higher education in Khatlon (51%) and DRS (52%). GBAO has highest percentage of both women (69%) and men (67%) with a secondary education or higher education.

16. Comparing socio economic level and education, it emerged that 37% of women and 45% of men in the lowest quintile have at least a secondary education compared with 56% of women and 63% of men in the highest wealth quintile(TjDHS, 2017)[14].

Sector of enrolment

17. Regarding percentage by sector in higher education, an assessment conducted by Asian Development Bank, (2015) indicates the following rate: agriculture accounts for 6.5%, Low and Economics 28.8, Industry 11.9 and education 43.7 (ADB, 2015).[15]

School attendance for boys and girls

18. The primary school Net Attendance Rate (NAR) indicates that 83% of children age 7-10 who should be attending the primary level are doing so. The secondary school NAR shows that 87% of children age 11-17 who should be attending the secondary level are doing so. The NAR for primary school is virtually the same for girls and boys (83%), while the secondary school NAR is slightly higher among boys (89%) than girls (85%). The NAR for primary school is almost the same in urban and rural areas (84% versus 83%). There also is little difference by residence in the secondary school NAR (86% in urban areas and 87% in rural areas). The lowest primary school NAR is in Sughd (78%) while the secondary school NAR is lowest in DRS (85%). GBAO has the highest NARs (88% for primary school and 96% for secondary school) (TjDHS, 2017)[16].

Labor Force Employment and Unemployment

19. According to national statistics, as reported in the Labor Market Survey, female employment rate (40.5 percent) is significantly lower than men (59.5 percent) and the unemployment percentage stands at 31,6 for women against 68,4 for male. The unemployment rate in rural areas amount to 59 percent while in urban areas it equaled to 41 percent (TajStat, 2016)[17].

---

[14] *Ibidem*

[15] Assessment of Higher Education in Tajikistan, ADB, 2015. Gender disaggregation is not available. https://www.adb.org/documents/assessment-higher-education-tajikistan

[16] *Ibidem*

[17] Situation in the labour market in the republic of Tajikistan, Tajstat, 2016.
Document available at: http://oldstat.ww.tj/en/img/de8558ce74dda7d9d14c5f7b0cdea0a2_1518005366.pdf

Indicators	Total (%)	Men (%)	Women (%)
Working-age population (15-75 years)	100	49,2	51,8
Labor force participation rate	42,2	52,9	32,6
- Employed	100	59,5	40,5
Employed in the informal sector	100	79,7	20,3
Excessive working hours	100	78,6	21,4
Occupational segregation index	0.62 (Men/ women)		
- Unemployed	100	68,4	31,6
Unemployment rate	6,9	7,9	5,5
- Potential labor force	100	53,3	46,7

Figure 7: Labor force participation, disaggregated data.
Source: Labour Force Market, Tajstat, 2016.

20. It is also observed that employment status varies widely by region. At the time of the survey, the highest employment rate registered was in Sughd (31%), the lowest in DRS (14%) and ranges from 24% to 30% in other regions of Tajikistan. The current employment rate generally increases with increasing education.

21. For women, employment varies depending on the socio-economic status. According to the Demographic and Health Survey (DHS) women who are currently married or who were previously married are more likely to be employed than those who have never been married. Half of women who are divorced, separated, or widowed (51%) are currently working, as compared with one-quarter of married women (24%) and 19% of never-married women (TjDHS, 2017)[18].

22. Women with a higher education are three times more likely to be currently employed as women with no education or only a primary education (54% versus 18%). Women who were employed in the 12 months preceding the survey were most likely to work in agriculture (33%); 30% were employed in professional, technical, or managerial positions, while 13% worked in sales and services, 13% in skilled manual labor, 11% in unskilled manual labor, and 1% in clerical jobs. The survey reports that involvement in agricultural work has tripled among women in the past 5 years, from 10% in 2012 to 33% in 2017. In contrast, involvement in unskilled manual labor has decreased, from 45% to 11% (TjDHS, 2017)[19].

Youth

23. The youth unemployment rate (aged 15-29 years old) amounted to 10.6 percent, followed by youth 20-24 at 19.5 and 25-29 accounting for 19.1 percent Unemployment rate for those aged 30-75 years accounts for 50,8%. (Tajstat, 2016). The employment rate, according to age brackets, is the following: 7% for youth 15 –19 years, 10,2 % for youth 20 - 24 years, 13, 8 for youth 25 -29 years and finally 68.9 for population age 30-75 years (Tajstat, 2016)[20].

[18] Demographic and Health Survey (DHS), Tajstat, 2017.
[19] *ibidem*
[20] Situation in the labour market in the republic of Tajikistan, Tajstat 2016. Document available at: http://oldstat.ww.tj/en/img/de8558ce74dda7d9d14c5f7b0cdea0a2_1518005366.pdf

Women employment in agriculture

24. According to FAO Gender Profile (2016), women's formal employment in agriculture presents only a narrow view of women's engagement in this sector because their participation in agriculture is typically informal. Women are commonly hired as *mardikor* workers and organized into informal groups, or brigades. Women's tasks are largely restricted to field labour, such as weeding, sowing, transplanting, and harvesting, which do not require decision-making, whereas the selection of seeds, fertilizers, and plant protection materials is controlled by men. Notably, a large proportion of women working as *hectarchi* or *mardikor* do not have formal contracts, and while this type of labour offers flexibility, women generally receive very low pay or only in-kind payments (FAO, 2016)[21].

25. Women's labour is concentrated at peak times, such as the harvest season, and during the winter months their income-earning opportunities are more restricted. Most rural women undertake agricultural work as second and third occupations, typically on household plots and presidential lands (cotton farms) to earn extra income for the household (FAO, 2016)[22].

26. According to the Demographic and Health Survey (TjDHS, 2017)[23] women age 15-19 were more likely to have worked in agriculture (64%) than women in older age groups and less likely to have worked in professional/technical/managerial occupations. Women in rural areas results to be much more likely involved in agricultural occupations than women in urban areas (44% versus 2%). Agricultural employment is also far more common among women in Khatlon (51%) and Sughd (30%) than among women in other regions (13% or less).

27. Approximately half of employed women who have a general basic education or less (52%-53%) and are in the lowest two wealth quintiles (49%-54%) are working in agriculture, as compared with 2% of women who have a higher education and are in the highest wealth quintile.

28. Results show that three-quarters (75%) of women are paid in cash only and 9% are paid in cash and in-kind. Around 1 in 7 women are not paid (13%), and 3% receive only in-kind payments. Over half of women are employed by a non-relative (56%), one-quarter work for a family member, and 19% are self-employed. The percentage of employed women who were paid in cash only increased from 53% in 2012 to 75% in 2017. The percentage of women engaged in agriculture who received cash only has also increased since 2012, from 5% to 47% (TjDHS, 2017)[24].

Division of Labour

29. The Labour Market Analisis (Tajstat, 2016)[25] shows that men and women are engaged in different sector of employment. In 2016, those who were engaged in numerous types of occupations were unskilled workers. About 309,213 persons

[21] National Gender profile of agriculture and rural livelihood, FAO, 2016.
Document available at: http://www.fao.org/3/i5766e/i5766e.pdf
[22] Ibidem
[23] Demographic and Health Survey (DHS), Tajstat, 2017.
[24] *ibidem*
[25] *See footnote 17*

were engaged in this type of work out of which the absolute majority was women, representing 63.5%.

30. Women’s generally lower level of education (especially vocational education), lack of professional qualifications, and high fertility rate combine with the absence of childcare facilities and gender stereotypes to place women in a weak employment position. Even among the working population, women are more commonly found as unskilled laborer’s, as compared to men who generally work as employers or are self-employed. According to the Survey, 45,8 of total population is engaged in the sector of agriculture, forestry and fisheries.

	Work for hire	Employer, owner of own enterprise or own business	Member of the production cooperative	Self- employed, working at their own expense, in their personal farm for sale	Helping family members
Agriculture, forestry and fisheries	15,5	16,3	1,1	49,3	17,8

Figure 8: Type of Employment by agriculture sector. Source: Labour Market Analisis, Tajstat, 2016.

31. Women represent the majority involved in the agriculture sector, at 60,8 per cent (almost double the percentage of men at 35,5). Their presence in occupational sector is followed by education, 10,7, health and social services 7 , while 6.7 are in trade and retail while manufacturing (processing Industry) stands at 6,4. For men the major occupations are agriculture (35,5) followed by construction (14.4) wholesale and retail trade (13,2) and transportation and storage of goods (8,1). (Tajstat, 2016).

Sector	Sex		Total
	Men	Women	
Agriculture, forestry and fisheries	35,5	60,8	45,8
Manufacturing (Processing industry)	4,7	6,4	5,4
Construction	14,4	0,2	8,6
Wholesale and retail trade; repair of vehicles and motorcycles	13,2	6,7	10,6
Transportation and storage of goods	8,1	0,3	5
Public administration and defence; compulsory social security	5,6	3,2	4,6
Education	6,3	10,7	8,1
Health and social services of population	2	7	4,1

Figure 9: Gender disaggregation by occupational sector. Source: Situation in the labour market in the republic of Tajikistan, Tajstat, 2016.

Formal and Informal Sector (outside agriculture)

32. According to the National Labour Survey (Tajstat, 2016), there were 133,359 persons employed in the informal sector in Tajikistan which amounted to 15.7 per cent of the total number of people employed in the non-agricultural sector. At the same time there were more men (106,354 persons) who worked in the informal sector, than women (27,005 persons). Out of the total number of persons employed in the informal sector, 30.9 percent were self-employed, 29.3

percent were employed, 19.1 percent were employers, 11.3 percent worked as home workers in private households, 5.8 percent were unpaid workers who helped family members (TajStat,2016).

	Formal sector			Informal sector		
	men	women	total	men	women	total
Total employed, persons	464407	251047	715453	106354	27005	133359
%	65%	35%		80%	20%	
Employee for wages or compensation in cash or in kind, or for monetary allowance	308280	216133	524413	31365	7666	39030
Employer, owner of own enterprise, own business or farm business	67726	10468	78194	21297	4185	25482
Working for own account	62391	16979	79371	34493	6671	41164
Member of the production cooperative (work association)	3136	1214	4350	263	1280	1543
Homeworker working in a private household	6690	1732	8422	11592	3478	15070
Unpaid worker supporting at the enterprise, own business or an farm which belong to any of the family members	-	-	-	4646	3145	7791
Other	16184	4520	20704	2698	580	3278

Figure 10: Gender disaggregated data on formal and informal sector (outside agriculture). Source: Situation in the labour market in the republic of Tajikistan, Tajstat 2016.

Informal Employment (outside agriculture)

33. At the time of the Survey mentioned above (Tajstat, 2016) in Tajikistan, 249,536 persons were in informal employment at the main work, including 189,289 men and 60,247 women. Thus, in the percentage ratio, men accounted for the majority of people in informal employment (33.2) percent) outside agriculture (versus women at 21,7 per cent).

	Total Employed Outside Agriculture			Formal Sector	
	Total	Formal employment	Informal employment	Formal employment	Informal employment
Total	100	70,6	29,4	70,6	13,7
Urban	100	74,3	25,7	74,3	15,2
Rural	100	68,1	31,9	68,1	12,6
Men	100	66,8	33,2	66,8	14,5
Women	100	78,3	21,7	78,3	12,0

GBAO	100	86,6	13,4	86,6	5,7
Sughd	100	68,3	31,7	68,3	9,5
Khatlon	100	65,0	35,0	65,0	16,5
Dushanbe	100	77,8	22,2	77,8	17,3
RRS	100	74,9	25,1	74,9	13,9

Figure 11: Gender disaggregated data for formal and informal employment (outside agriculture). Source: Situation in the labour market in the republic of Tajikistan, Tajstat 2016.

34. This flexible and informal labor supply seems to suit many production businesses that need low-paid workers, such as agriculture. The outmigration of males in the agriculture sector has led to increased involvement of female labor. The result is, as in other transition countries, feminization of agriculture "an increase in women's participation rates in the agriculture sector, either as self-employed or as agricultural wage workers; in other words, an increase in the percentage of women who are economically active in rural areas (Tajstat, 2016).

Women's employment and engagement in the Forestry Sector

35. Official statistics generally combine several categories of related work: agriculture, forestry and fisheries / aquaculture. As already reported, women represent 60.8% of the sector, no further disaggregation is provided by subsector in the latest survey. Labour market data from 2012 (the most recent available reported in the FAO Gender assessment conducted in 2016), indicates that few men, and almost no women, are contractually employed in forestry or aquaculture / fisheries. Women in the forestry sector account for 0.05 and even less in fisheries (0.01), (FAO, 2016)[26].

36. The draft Strategy on Forest Sector Development identifies a gender imbalance in employment within the forestry industry, with men representing 92 percent of employees. According to data submitted to the FAO forest resources assessment in 2008, there were only 23 women (two percent) out of a total of 1002 staff working in public forest institutions. Labour market statistics for 2010 indicate that the total number of people employed in "forestry" was 1,700, of whom 200 (or 12 percent) were female employees (FAO, 2016).

37. According to FAO, the fact that staff are required to carry out patrol functions on foot (covering several thousand hectares of forest land can take a number of days), suggests that this type of work is unlikely to be considered suitable for, or accessible to, women. However, according to the same source, women's almost invisible role in forestry enterprises and research institutions does not mean that they are not engaged in forest activities in other ways (FAO, 2016).

38. Rural women spend a significant amount of time collecting firewood for domestic fuel. In comparison, male household heads are usually responsible for buying firewood. Ecological organizations have noted that widespread deforestation has resulted in women and children spending more time collecting wood. As a general rule, women in forest villages engage in the informal collection of non-timber forest products, for home consumption and for sale, and this pattern is likely to be replicated across Tajikistan. In 2013, the sale of non-timber forest

[26] National Gender Profile of agriculture and Rural Livelihood Tajikistan (FAO, 2016).
See footnote 21 for link to document on line.

products, combined with ecosystem services, was estimated to value almost six million somoni (FAO,2016)[27].

39. The design mission of CASP+ (April 2021) collected also information about women in joint forest management (JFM). It is found that women account for 7.3% beneficiaries of Joint Forest Management group (JFMG) as showed in the table below:

JFM overview						
Region	SFE	JFM users	JFM area (ha)	FUG	Male	Female
Sughd	Sughd	95	203,72		95	
	Ayni	181	158,38		158	23
	Panjakent	153	225,42	1	111	42
	Shahrizton	4	14020		4	
	Devashtij	49	55300		49	
	Istaravshan	14	88,9		14	
	Kuhistoni Mastchoh	22	46,29	0	18	4
		518	**70042,71**	**1**	**449**	**69**
Khatlon	Danghara	470	6359		470	
	Farkhor	121	5907	3	102	19
	Khovaling	198	2862,57	5	198	10
	Baljuvon	55	257,6	6	51	4
	Sari Khosor	21	119,1	3	19	3
		865	**15505,27**	**17**	**840**	**36**
DRS	Romit, shahri Vahdat	33	92,5	5	33	0
	Tojikobod	1	127		1	0
		34	**219,5**	**5**	**34**	**0**
GBAO	GBAO	671	2945	37	612	59
	Vanj	220	1022	7	214	6
		891	**3967**	**44**	**826**	**65**
TOTAL		**2308**	**89734,48**	**67**	**2149**	**170**

40. The FAO gender assessment points out that women and men can play important roles in conserving forest areas by eliminating harmful agricultural practices (cropping and grazing) and by identifying the types of indigenous plants that can be used in the long term for reforestation. Both women and men have specific knowledge about trees and non-timber forest products that should be taken into consideration by forest management. However, because women are largely absent in the formal forestry sector (in employment and in policy positions), special efforts are needed to ensure that they can also contribute their knowledge.

41. A similar view was also shared by the representatives from Bioversity International met by CASP+ Design Mission (April 2021). It was explained the relevance to increase awareness, and participation of women and children in forest management and conservation practices.

42. Recommendations from analytical papers and discussion with stakeholders during the design mission suggest that the strategy on Forest Sector Development for 2016-2030 and the national Action Plan should play a key role

[27] Reference is made to the draft Strategy on Forest Sector Development for 2016-2030.

in increasing gender-specific information about the forestry sector, including awareness events about gender and climate change.

43. The strategy foresees the establishment of a national supervisory board on forestry that will include the participation of the Committee on Women and Family Affairs and gender experts (FAO, 2016). Continuous actions and follow up from responsible entities are required to ensure that gender related constraints are captured into the forestry policy agenda and policy dialogues events dedicate space and time to discuss the gender and climate change issues.

Women's role in conservation of biodiversity

44. The Sixth National Report on the Convention of Biological Diversity (CBD, 2019)[28] strongly highlights that gender-balanced forest communities are more effective in performing all their functions (plant protection, forest regeneration, maintenance of biodiversity and distribution of forest use) than communities consisting mainly of men. Studies show that, compared to men, women are on average able to determine a greater number of plant species (trees, shrubs, grasses, vegetable crops, etc.) and used parts of plants (fruits, leaves, bark, seeds, roots).

45. The report highlights that women have extensive experience in traditional knowledge and practices that are effectively used in the conservation of biodiversity. Leased forest areas and dekhkan farms have organized mini-nurseries to grow seedlings and other plant species, where women do most of the work. The most significant initiative implemented by women and benefiting both women themselves and contributing to sustainable environmental management is the organization of nurseries to breed and expand the distribution of local varieties in the Hamadoni district of the Khatlon region (CBD, 2019)[29].

46. The report stresses that despite women's prominent role in conservation of biodiversity, their participation in the design, planning and implementation of environmental policies is still low. Action is needed to ensure their participation (CBD, 2019)[30].

Smallholder farming in Tajikistan

47. Tajikistan is a landlocked low-middle-income country located in Central Asia. Given the country's mountainous geography, the total arable land area is limited to only 5 percent. The FAO publication, Small family farms country factsheet, (FAO, 2018) highlights that ddespite this natural restriction, agriculture remains the key source of the population's income as well as for Tajikistan's economy. Agriculture accounts for 53 percent of total employment (45.8 based on national labour survey), but due to high out-migration rates of work-abled men the agricultural labour has become increasingly feminized. Yet, 68.5 percent of women are employed in the agricultural sector, compared to 41 percent of men (FAO, 2018)[31].

---

[28] The Sixth National Report on the Convention of Biological Diversity
Full report is available at: https://chm.cbd.int/database/record?documentID=247273
[29] *Ibidem*
[30] I*bidem*
[31]Small family farms country factsheet, FAO, 2018.

48. Smallholders in Tajikistan live on marginalised farmland, resulting in an average farm size of only 0.2 hectare. The head of a smallholder household in Tajikistan can take advantage of 10 years of education on average and leads households that commonly consists of 7 persons. A significant number of households is headed by women, yet, representing 16 percent of small family farms in Tajikistan. The number of livestock owned by small family farms in Tajikistan is increasing and centres around 1.5 Tropical Livestock Unit (TLU), with poultry, small cattle and horses as the most common owned livestock. However, pasture resources are exploited and feed is often unaffordable, leading to a consistent over-grazing of pastures. More than half of the small family farms in the country remain below the national poverty line. (FAO, 2018)[32].

Women's role in agricultural activities

49. According to the Tajikistan Country Gender Assessment conducted by the Asian Development Bank (ADB, 2016)[33] women are heavily engaged throughout the entire crop production process. Women's involvement (owners, users, or workers) in agriculture formally counts only when they are registered as legal entities or farm workers. Women are also heavily involved in unpaid family labor—they take care of a multigenerational family and are responsible for the home garden and securing water and food. Although the agriculture output of kitchen gardens significantly contributes to production and food security, it is presented without sex attribution in statistics and national reports (ADB, 2016).

50. There is little evidence that women have become empowered through agriculture. Gender experts point to the agricultural sector as one of the most exploitative. As explained above, women's agricultural work is characterized by seasonal, low-wage, and low-paid or unpaid positions, job insecurity, back-breaking conditions, lack of access to and control over productive resources, limited participation in decision-making activities and low technical and specialized knowledge (ADB, 2016)[34].

51. Women are often described as lacking the appropriate skills and knowledge required, whether as farmers or farm managers, influencing their ability to take on these roles. Their continued participation as informal, seasonal laborers reinforce the perception that women have no experience or knowledge of farming. This is further strengthened by the widespread belief that men, as breadwinners and heads of households, are farm managers regardless of whether or not they are active in the sector. Due to this, women's tasks are largely restricted to field labor, such as weeding, sowing, transplanting, and harvesting, which do not require decision-making, whereas the selection of seeds, fertilizers, and plant protection materials is controlled by men. Further, although both men and women are involved in livestock-raising, it is men who decide on the purchase, sale and other operations linked to its management (ADB, 2016)[35].

Document available at: http://www.fao.org/3/I8348EN/i8348en.pdf

[32] *Ibidem*

[33] Tajikistan Country Gender Assessment, ADB, 2016.
Document available at: https://www.adb.org/sites/default/files/institutional-document/185615/tajikistan-cga.pdf

[34] *Ibidem*

[35] *ibidem*

52. A study developed by Oxfam: *Climate Change, beyond coping, women smallholder farmers in Tajikistan* (2011)[36] highlights regional differences in women involvement in agriculture activities. Depending on the region, rural women typically work two harvests in the Dehkan farms and two harvests in their family plots. In the Sughd region, women can sow, up to three times a year in their family plots. The family plot is almost entirely the woman's domain. Below is provided a detailed example on the specific tasks of men and women in agriculture activities by season. This is based on Oxfam study from the region of Sughd:

Season/ months		What men typically do	What women typically do
Winter	December	Ploughing /tillage/turning up the soil, and watering the lands/or wheat	Gathering the harvest, usually cotton stocks; preparing natural fertilizer/compost
	January	Applying natural fertilizer/manure to the lands	House work; looking after the cattle
	February	Digging/making ditches, planting the young trees, plants	Preparing for farming according to the weather conditions
Spring	March	Preparing the lands for sowing	Planting fruit and decorative trees; cleaning and maintaining the irrigation canals/ditches
	April	We begin to plant/sow crops; applying fertilizer to the new planted	Bleaching/whitening the trees trunks; planting different kinds of vegetables
	May	If the rain makes lands surface solid, loosen the soil	Plant cotton
Summer	June	Harvesting wheat; Preparing the land for the second crop	Caring for the cotton plants, loosening the soil, weeding etc
	July	To plant the second crop and to fight with plant-illnesses by bio methods	Grain harvest time
	August	Organizing the harvesting	Preparing for the second crop
Autumn	September	Cotton harvest time	help pick the cotton
	October	harvest any other grain yield	Harvest of vegetables
	November	harvest cotton and prepare land for ploughing	prepare for family events like weddings

Figure 12: specific tasks of men and women in agriculture activities by season, Sughd Region, Source: Climate Change, beyond coping, Oxfam 2011.

Livestock, dairy and poultry

53. Animal husbandry is a major agricultural activity, and raising livestock is the norm for rural households (73 percent of households have livestock, including cattle, horses, donkeys, mules, pigs, sheep, goats and poultry). There are gender differences in the extent to which households are engaged in raising livestock. Households headed by men are more likely than female-headed households to keep livestock and to have a larger number of animals across all categories of animal ownership. When FHH do have livestock, they tend to have cattle and poultry, possibly because dairy farming is traditionally seen as "female" work or because selling extra milk and eggs is a relatively low intensity means of supplementing household income (FAO, 2016)[37].

[36] Climate Change, beyond coping, women smallholder farmers in Tajikistan, Oxfam 2011, Document available at: https://networkedintelligence.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/02/rr-climate-change-beyond-coping-women-smallholder-farmers-tajikistan-020611-en.pdf
[37] National Gender Profile of agriculture and Rural Livelihood Tajikistan (FAO, 2016).

54. The pattern of livestock ownership is generally the same for women and men; the majority of household own cattle (54 percent and 66 percent of FHH and MHH, respectively). Poultry are the next most commonly-owned form of livestock (owned by around a third of rural households).

	FHH	MHH
Any livestock (cattle, horses, donkeys, mules, pigs, sheep, goats) - ownership by household (%)	59.5	71.4
Any livestock (as above and poultry) - ownership by household (%)	63.8	74.6
Cattle - ownership by household (%)	54.0	65.7
- average number per 1000 households	1 314.1	1 996.8
Horses, donkeys, mules - ownership by household (%)	14.4	22.6
- average number per 1000 households	200.4	880.9
Pigs, sheep, goats - ownership by household (%)	20.3	29.8
- average number per 1000 households	1 172.8	2 647.1
Poultry - ownership by household (%)	33.4	37.7
- average number per 1000 households	2 462.4	3 921.0

Figure 13: Livestock Ownership in Rural Locations by Female- and Male-Headed Households. Source: Country Gender Assessment FAO (2016)

55. According to FAO gender assessment, gender differences in the ownership of livestock is both a reflection of differential access to the resources needed to buy or keep animals, and it also indicates the presence of gendered roles in livestock management. For instance, feed preparation, household dairy production (tending cows and milking) and poultry farming are generally perceived as women's responsibilities.

56. Men have greater involvement in grazing, feed production and the purchasing and sale of livestock. Women and men also have differing roles in the processing of livestock products: men are more often involved in activities such as sheep shearing, transporting products to market and butchering, women are involved in dairy production (FAO, 2016)[38].

57. Furthermore, women play a prominent role in managing backyard poultry farming. The USAID report: agriculture technology and commercialization assessment, estimates that roughly one third of all households in Khatlon province keep poultry and an estimated one-third of households headed by women also have poultry. The scale of these household operations is small-often fewer than 20 birds and with few that are laying regularly. Backyard egg production is largely used to satisfy household needs, although some may be traded or sold to neighbors or in local markets. It is reported that income from eggs and poultry meat operations at the household level is mostly controlled by women (USAID, 2012)[39].

58. As it is the case in other areas of farming, women's success in raising livestock is dependent on their access to information and level of knowledge about running a farming enterprise, and their access to finance and to other key resources, such as veterinary and extension services and training (FAO, 2016).

See footnote 21 for link to document on line.
[38] Ibidem
[39] Tajkistan Agriculture Technology and Commercialization Assessment, USAID, 2012
Document available at: https://culturalpractice.com/wp-content/uploads/2014/08/EAT_AgTCA_Tajikistan_Report.pdf

Women's access to Land

59. Access to land, and tenure security, remains a severe constraint for women. Although the land reforms legally guaranteed equal rights to men and women to use land (and be conferred shares or certificates), the reality presents a different situation.

60. Women's lack of access to land is underpinned by several forms of inequality. They often lack information about their rights to land as members of collective farms or about the process of land registration. Other women do not have the means, either financial or in terms of time resources, to undertake the registration process. Even when women make attempts to assert their rights to land, many are "... effectively excluded from the process of obtaining dekhan or household land-use rights because administrators are often dismissive of women's farming capabilities and knowledge". As a result, women are more likely to hold lesser shares of the land that they work and are less likely to report tenure security" (FAO, 2016)[40].

61. According to data reported by FAO, the majority of rural households possessed land (86 percent. Male-headed households were also more likely than female-headed households to own land (70 percent of MHH, compared with 52 percent of FHH), and they tended to own larger plots of land. The average size of land plots belonging to MHH was 15.2 sotka, and the average size of FHH land plots was 9 sotka. Therefore, on average, men's plots were about 70 percent larger than women's plots (FAO, 2016).

62. Considering average land areas in rural locations only, data below show that when land owned by households is combined with rented land and land rented out, MHH have on average almost double the land area of FHH (39 sotka for MHH compared with 20 sotka for FHH). Both households headed by women and by men use most of their land plots for farming, and very few rural households, regardless of the sex of the head, have land that they rent out (FAO, 2016)[41].

Land areas (in sotka per household)	FHH	MHH
Average own land area	13.6	19.2
Average own land area used for farming	13.6	19.0
Average rented land area	3.4	9.9
Average own and / or rented land area used for farming	17.0	28.9
Average own / rented and / or rented out land area	20.4	38.8

Figure 14: Average Land Areas in Rural Locations, by Household. Source: *Country Gender Assessment FAO (2016)*

63. In terms of the characteristics of the land plots that are registered to women, they are less likely to have rights to use "presidential lands" and more likely to have rights to household plots. Furthermore, women's land plots are generally further away from their homes. Women also report that during processes to re-register their land rights (after divorce or the death of a spouse), they received "the worst land plots", at a considerable distance from irrigation facilities or with

[40] National Gender Profile of agriculture and Rural Livelihood Tajikistan (FAO, 2016).
See footnote 21 for link to document on line.
[41] *Ibidem*

poor quality soil. This observation is substantiated by their smaller harvests and lower yields (FAO, 2016)[42].

Women *dekhan* farms

64. A particular concern is the serious underrepresentation of women either as agricultural title owners or decision makers. Dekhan farms are the most common type of agricultural enterprise in Tajikistan. They are privately-owned commercial farms that function as legal enterprises and can be based on the work of an individual (a sole entrepreneur), a family or a group of people (a collective). Family and collective dekhan farms are managed by a head who officially holds the farm's land registration certificate and represents the legal interests of the farm. The number of dekhan farms has increased annually, from a total of 30,842 in 2008 to 108,035 in 2014 (FAO, 2016)[43].

65. Looking specifically at *dekhan* farms, the number managed by women has been rising alongside their general growth. In 2014, women headed 13% of dekhan farms (up from 8% the previous year)[44]. The growth in women-led dekhan farms from 2013 to 2014 is attributed to state and donor efforts to increase women's involvement in dekhan farming and to register individuals who once worked on collective farms as individual farmers (FAO, 2016).

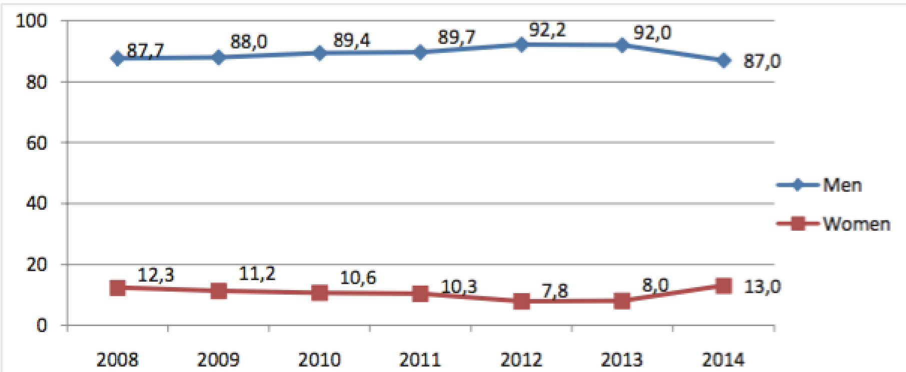


Figure 15: Trends in Dekhan Farm Management by Women and Men, 2008-2014 (%) Source: FAO Gender Assessment, 2016

66. However, the average size of female-headed farms is smaller than those managed by men, and in 2014, women managed only 6.4% of all planted crop land on *dekhan* farms[45]. *Dekhan* farms headed by females also have fewer shareholders (but more female shareholders) than farms headed by males. Customarily, family plots and presidential lands are registered to the household head, most often a male. Furthermore, documents that stipulate the right to use collective *dekhan* farm lands are generally not issued to all members, most of whom are women, but instead are issued in the name of the male head, most often the husband, brother, or, if a woman is widowed, her eldest son (ADB, 2016).[46]

[42] Ibidem
[43] Ibidem
[44] State Statistics Agency. Gender Statistics Database, 2013
http://oldstat.ww.tj/img/en/seling.pdf
[45] *Ibidem*
[46] Gender Assessment, ADB, 2016,
Document avallabile at: https://www.adb.org/documents/tajikistan-country-gender-assessment-2016

67. The low level of leadership, suggests women face gender-based barriers to assuming the responsibility of *dekhan* farms. Although few women are legal heads of *dekhan* farms, women are assuming the de facto leadership on some *dekhan* farms because of male migration.

68. According to National Statistical Data (2013): *Gender aspects of agriculture* [47], there has been increased production and crop yields in dekhan farms headed by women in 2008-2012 (ton; hundredweight from 1 hectare). The volume of crop production, except raw cotton and wheat in 2012 compared to 2008 increased in average from 15.2 to 32.6 percent.

Production and crop yields in dekhan farms headed by women in 2008-2012						
Name of products	Year					
	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2012 in % increased compared to 2008
Cereals: -production	31183	65152	57196	36647	31396	107
-productivity	21,2	25,5	24,4	23,6	24,7	116,5
Wheat: -production	26245	55929	41325	31395	26057	99,3
-productivity	18,3	26,5	24,9	24,8	28,1	153,6
Raw cotton: -production	23088	24840	23774	20958	17800	77,1
-productivity	16,9	18,4	19,8	20	22	130,2
Potatoes: -production	6322	5905	3081	8339	8381	132,6
-productivity	212	154	179,2	187,8	204,4	96,4
Vegetables: -production	12865	20855	13768	22119	22115	171,9
-productivity	167	184	177	177,4	192,4	115,2
Fruits: -production	2655	2416	8646	3378	3292	124
-productivity	18,8	12,5	7,7	11,3	28,5	151,6
Grapes: -production	2910	2662	3562	2334	3441	118,2
-productivity	28,2	27,4	10,7	25,7	38,6	136,9

Source: Tajstat 2013, gender aspects of agriculture

69. However, despite the positive growth trend, specific data (2015) about harvests on dekhan farms indicates that dekhan farms headed by women have smaller harvests than men's farms in every category of crop. Smaller harvests can be explained by the fact that female-managed farms are smaller on average, but female farms also have lower yields for every crop, with the exception of corn and cotton (which are almost equal to the yields of male-managed farms).

70. According to FAO, lower yields could be related to the poorer quality of the land, a lack of irrigation, fertilizers and pesticides, women's more limited knowledge of farming practices to help them increase yields (for example, seed selection, planting practices and hybrids) and a lack of access to extension services (FAO, 2016).

[47] State Statistics Agency. Gender Statistics Database, 2013

Categories of crops	Female- headed dekhan farms		Male-headed dekhan farms	
	Harvest (tonnes)	Yield (centner[87] per hectare)	Harvest (tonnes)	Yield (centner per hectare)
Grain	47 333	26.3	694 927	31.1
Wheat	39 117	28.1	479 956	30.3
Corn	2 381	48.5	75 536	47.9
Cotton	19 890	21.6	292 077	21.5
Potatoes	9 518	165.5	333 932	247.1
Vegetables	21 566	243.1	604 374	307.8
Melons and gourds	4 538	170.6	349 140	270.1
Fruit trees	7 369	12.8	102 581	14.7
Vineyards	3 188	21.0	63 287	34.4

Figure 15: Harvest and Yields of Female- and Male-Managed Dekhan Farms (2014)
Source: FAO Gender Assessment, 2016

71. This indicates that mechanisms to move women into leadership positions by addressing the real and perceived lack of leadership qualifications or gain access to their land shares would improve production and productivity. Range of associations or groups exist in the agricultural space, from formal groups of *dekhan* farms, like the National Association of *Dekhan* Farms (NADF), to common interest groups (CIGs). These serve as a vehicle to deliver extension and training, and in some cases credit. Below a brief description of the NADF and main functions.

The National Association of *Dekhan* Farms (NADF)

72. The National Association of *Dekhan* Farms (NADF) is non-governmental, non-profit membership organization, established at the national conference of farmers in 2005, that joins dehkans and farmers on a voluntary basis. The main purpose of NADF is to consolidate the Dehkan farm associations and farming individual in rural areas. It counts more than 10,900 members – entrepreneurs, individual dehkan farmers, association of dehkan farmers (15% women).

73. The association represent and protect their rights and interests for the aim of achieving stable and balanced food security, reducing the poverty level through a dynamic and sustainable development of agriculture sector due to intensive growth factors and the development of science and modern technology, management and marketing. Main services include:

- supporting, protecting the rights, and promote the interests of dehkans and farmers;
- conducting educational and awareness trainings for dehkans farmers, including from a gender perspective and women’s rights;
- providing advisory and consulting services, including focus on women
- conducting market researches on agricultural products for agricultural suppliers, and buyers;
- publishing and disseminating information on the development of dehkans farmers improvement activities;
- establishing an effective data bank to support dehkans farmers associations;

Women access to Agriculture inputs

74. There are no sex disaggregated data on the availability of key agricultural inputs to rural men and women, therefore conclusions can only be drawn from other

available information. In general, a lack of key inputs prevents many people, both women and men, from taking up farming as a business. FAO reports that on a survey conducted in Sughd, Khatlon and RRS, between 73 percent and 78 percent of respondents (dekhan farm members and leaders) cited a "lack of machinery, seeds, fertilizers, chemicals or water" as the main impediments to founding a dekhan farm (FAO, 2016)[48].

75. Data about ownership and use of farm equipment, as well as the average number of farming machines, for male and female farmers is lacking. However, it is known that the majority of small-scale farmers have very limited access to agricultural equipment. Many use obsolete equipment or rely on labour-intensive practices, such as harvesting by hand and use of traditional tools.

76. According to the Tajikistan Living Standards Survey administered in 2003, small numbers of rural households were using machinery, but it was mainly male-headed households that were likely to have access to such resources (3.6 percent of MHH used machinery compared with 2.9 percent of FHH). According to a survey of a relatively small number of dekhan farmers, female farmers experienced greater difficulties than men in "accessing agricultural equipment, having it repaired, and seeing agricultural specialists" (FAO, 2016)[49].

77. When female-headed households do not own farming equipment, they are able to either borrow it from other farmers or lease it if funds are available. Another coping mechanism for female farmers is to "work their land less intensively," meaning that they use smaller amounts of fertilizer and improved seeds than their male counterparts. In 2003, 43 percent of MHH used fertilizers, compared with 38 percent of FHH (FAO, 2016)[50].

Women's access to Extension Services

78. The lack of agricultural extension and advisory services is another major problem encountered by all smallholder farmers in Tajikistan and it is of particular concern for women. Women's ability to access extension services is also constrained by factors such as more limited mobility, fewer networks and a lower level of education than men. Research conducted in Tajikistan on sustainable farming practices to mitigate climate-related shocks, found that "within villages, female-headed households do not seem to benefit from the knowledge-sharing networks that male farm heads enjoy". This lack of knowledge is a key factor in reducing opportunities for women farmers to adopt sustainable practices for climate change adaptation (FAO, 2016)[51].

Women access to Pasture and representation and decision-making in Pasture Users Union/Associations (PUUs)

79. In the livestock sector, one of the most significant issues facing women is the limited recognition of the roles that they play in raising livestock, or the ways in which roles are divided along gender lines. Because women have more limited access to land generally, it stands to reason that they are also more constrained in accessing pastures. While women are well represented in PUAs (46.7 percent of all members), they are less visible in management roles. Fewer than a third of PUA management positions are held by women (31.4 percent) (FAO, 2016)[52].

---

[48] Tajikistan Gender Profile of Agriculture and Rural Livelihood, FAO, 2016
[49] *Ibidem*
[50] *Ibidem*
[51] *Ibidem*
[52] *Ibidem*

80. Similar estimate for women participation is also registered in the IFAD funded Livestock and Pasture Development Project II (LPDPII) Mid Term Review Report (September 2019). As reported in the LogFrame, all PUUs boards have maintained on average a minimum of 30% women. The MTR mission verified the same during the field visits and acknowledged the need for some action to strengthen the role of women and their leadership[53].

81. Similar findings emerged from Focus Group Discussion (FGDs) held with women groups during Concept Note and Project Design (October 2020 and April 2021 respectively) where women interviewed (some of them members and representatives of PUUs) confirmed the 30% presence of women as board representatives and recognized the need to receive leadership trainings. This has been well noted by the CASP+ design mission and integrated into the Gender Action Plan (GAP).[54]

Women's access to water and representation in Water Users Association (WUAs)

82. A recent study of Women's role in irrigated agriculture conducted in the lower Vaksh River Basin (ADB, 2020)[55] indicates that females comprise only 8.3% of total dehkan members of WUAs in the study area. Despite national statics/data is not available, the gender disaggregated data for the Khatlon province (study area) indicate that of a total cropping area of 281,424 hectares used by dehkan farms, only 8% was used by female-led dehkan.

83. According to ADB study, women as decision makers are in the minority or absent among *dehkan* farm managers, and therefore are less visible members of WUAs. Water institutions do not have gender-disaggregated statistics about their members and users (ADB, 2020)[56]. The study revealed that nearly 80% of male respondents said that there are no problems in production. However, over 50% of female respondents stated problems, including lack of water, bad condition of canals, users at the head of the canal taking a major portion of water, natural drought, and unsatisfactory work by WUAs. Around 20% of female respondents experienced verbal or physical abuse when asking for water.

84. About half the women reported the main factor facilitating productivity was supply of irrigation water. Availability of good quality seeds was also important. Particularly for female respondents, access to information, credit, and machinery services were important factors. About 20% of respondents (men and women) cited climate change as a serious issue (ADB, 2020)[57] .

85. The report concludes that women face gender disparities and inequalities not experienced by males. Clearly, the expanded role of women needs recognition and support in practice as well as in legislation. The role of women in irrigation management remains weak. Despite the fact that women dominate the crop production process but they may not receive training in participatory irrigation management. Involvement of women in WUA and farm management is important for achieving gender equality and sustainable farming. The study

[53] Livestock and Pasture Development Project II (LPDPII) Mid Term Review Report, September 2019
[54] Greater information are available in the stakeholder consultation report, section on women FGDs
[55] Women's role in irrigated agriculture in the lower Vaksh River Basin, ADB, 2020
Document available at:https://www.adb.org/sites/default/files/publication/663141/womens-role-irrigated-agriculture-tajikistan.pdf
[56] *Ibidem*
[57] *Ibidem*

conclude that it t is paradoxical to consider the reality that women are leading agricultural activities, yet lack access to knowledge and skills training (ADB, 2020)[58].

Main challenges expressed by women from FGD and proposed solutions

86. During the remote CASP+ Design Mission (April 2021) and also during project Concept Note Formulation (October 2020), the mission team met with women's groups to discuss about key issues in relation to: (i) economic activities, (ii) livelihoods, (iii) climate change (iv) presence in decision making bodies, (v) access to key agriculture inputs and NRM among others.

87. The mission interacted with a total of 31 women through six FGD: four FGDs involving 26 women were held in April 2021 in the district of Hamadoni, Sh.Sholin, Maschoh, Sharitus; two FGDs were held during CN development (October 2020) they involved 5 women from Vose and Hamdoni, Farkor, Muninobod districts . Women FGD participants included: women producers, including women headed households, women leading dehhkan farms, women members/representatives of PUUs and also women in CIG formed under LPDPII. Below is reported a schematic summary with main challenges faced by women and solutions proposed which have been taken into account during the design.

Districts	Production	Main challenges related to economic activities	Solutions proposed by women interviewed
Hamadoni	Crop	• Low fodder availability; • Low quality of seeds (potato, alfa alfa, barley); • Lack of access to pasture land; • Lack of processing equipment; • Lack of trainings (climate smart practices, Business orientation)	• Exchange visits; • Trainings (technologies and business). • Tomato making equipment; • Baking equipment; • Processing equipment; • Time saving technologies (milk machines); • Green houses
	Livestock/dairy	• Local breed is low productive; • Women produce milk, they sell it to local markets/neighbours but cannot access better markets.	• Introduction of improved breed ; • Improve access to market to sell milk. • Business skills trainings
Sh. Sholin	Crop	• Shortage of water during rainy season, resulting in reduced production/losses; • Limited knowledge about use of pesticide;	• Provision of water (irrigation) for the orchads; • Training on the use of pesticides; • Purchase of quality seeds; • New trees.

[58] *Ibidem*

		• Old trees which require replacement with new trees; • Manual labou very hard, especially harvesting, lack of technologies for women	• Introduction of time saving technologies for women to reduce workload.
	Livestock	• Local breed is not productive; • Disease of animals and low availability of vaccines; • Shortage of fodder; • Shortage of pasture land; • Shortage of water; • Poor conditions of roads to pasture areas. • Women low representation in PUUs	• Access to improved breeds and methods to improve breeds naturally; • Automatic milking equipment; • Shops and equipment for dairy products, including refrigerators; • Availability of vaccines for animals; • Access to pasture land and improved infrastructures. • Women access to pasture land and representation in PUUs
Sh. Sholin	Representation/Decision making	• Low leadership skills for women in local committees	• Increase the number of women members in the board (more than 30% as it is set at the moment); • Leadership trainings for women in CBOs
Maschoh	Crop	• Lack of quality seeds of potatoes; • Lack of machinery; • Orchards trees very old; • Heavy workload for women to do manual labour.	• Irrigation; • Local nursery for seeds to produce seeds locally; • Use of greenhouses; • New seedling for orchards; • Bee-keeping; • Time saving technologies for agriculture activities: Small size automatic equipment (cultivation/ collection/ especially for fodder, cutters);
	Forestry	• Women are in charge to collect fire-wood for cooking, hitting. They also collect forest products but limited to village selling.	• Improve /expand this activity for marketing of forest products (NTFP).
	Livestock	• Women are in charge of livestock keeping and they also attend animals in the higher pasture areas (4 months) with very poor living	• Women believe that they would benefit from having a PUU (as they observed in another village where it was established as part of a development project).

		conditions (living in camps). • Use of rangeland areas is based on traditional practices across villages/private persons (village head man) which is not sustainable and women are excluded.	• Women to participate in PUUs as representatives • Processing machines for dairy products.
Sharitus	Crop	• Seasonal greenhouse not enough; • Restricted access to markets; • They cannot sale all the items in the markets during the peak season They need to process it. • Lack of machinery, lack of processing equipment is an issue.	• Introduction of green houses for the whole year; • Better access to market • Business skills • Processing equipment
FGD with women during CN development (October 2020)			
Districts	**Production**	**Main challenges related to economic activities**	**Solutions proposed by women interviewed**
Vose	Milk	• Competition for marketing during pick season and low income from milk; • Lack of Additional trainings related to milk production and selling; • Lack of processing equipment	• Introduction of poultry, because production is all year around and there is request from locals (local markets); • Having processing unit, so we can produce cheese and other products with added value; • food processing /bakery/ off-farms for young women.
Muminobod Farkhor Hamadoni	Representation and Decision making	• No leadership training was provided by project (LPDP) • Women needed it, especially at the beginning; • Women are member of PUU but need more leadership skills; • Women lack business and organisational skills	• Leadership skills development through leadership trainings; • Business development/ entrepreneurial skills to be developed.

Legal status of Women

88. In the last decade, the social gender equality framework has been expanded and strengthened through the adoption of new laws, amendment of existing laws, development of national programs, and incorporation of objectives within general policy documents. For the most part, however, such developments have focused on raising the status of women and girls and eliminating barriers to the realization of their rights, rather than on equalizing responsibilities and opportunities for women and men or addressing gender stereotypes.

Laws and Policies on Gender Equality

89. The Constitution of the Republic of Tajikistan recognizes international law as a component part of the national legal system[59], and Tajikistan is a State Party to the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW) and to other fundamental human rights treaties. In 2014, the parliament ratified the Optional Protocol to CEDAW, which allows individual women in Tajikistan to submit complaints to the CEDAW Committee and gives them an additional remedy for violations of the convention. Important steps have also been taken to implement UN Security Council resolutions on women, peace, and security (1325 and 2122) with the drafting of a national action plan. The Constitution guarantees equal rights on the basis of sex (Article 17), and principles of non-discrimination are enshrined in basic legislation, for example, the Family Code, the Labor Code, the Land Code, the Criminal Code, the Law on Education, and the Law on Public Health.

90. In 2005, Tajikistan adopted the Law on State Guarantees of Equal Rights and Opportunities for Men and Women, which is the only law to define the concepts of gender and sex-based discrimination. The law prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex, while distinguishing special measures to protect pregnancy and the health of women and men, and it guarantees equal rights in public authorities, civil service, education, labor, and the family.

91. Other legislative reforms are aimed at greater protection of women's rights, for example, laws combating human trafficking (2008), and domestic violence (2013), and protection of breastfeeding (2006). In 2010, the Family Code was amended to raise the legal marital age to 18 (for both women and men), which brought it in line with CEDAW.

92. Since 2006, Tajikistan has adopted several policy documents, national programs, and strategies that support gender equality goals. Some were intended to implement specific laws, for instance the Comprehensive Program to Combat Trafficking in Persons for 2006–2010, and the State Program for the Prevention of Domestic Violence for 2014– 2023, the State Program for the Education, Selection and Placement of Capable Women and Girls in Leadership Positions for 2007–2016 (adopted in 2006) aims to mitigate the barriers that prevent women from entering senior management.

93. The stand-alone policy, adopted in 2010, the National Strategy on Enhancing the Role of Women in the Republic of Tajikistan for 2011–2020, recognizes a lack of public gender equality understanding and gender policy support, the role of stereotypes, and the need to implement the formal equality that exists, but it

[59] Article 10, Constitution of the Republic of Tajikistan.

nevertheless covers areas in which women encounter barriers: political participation, the labor market, entrepreneurship, and education. The strategy lists concrete actions for each sector, but does not establish the responsible agencies, a timeframe with milestones, sources of funding, or a monitoring plan.

94. The government has made significant progress in mainstreaming gender into national socioeconomic development strategies, beginning with the adoption of the Poverty Reduction Strategies for the Republic of Tajikistan for 2007–2009 and 2010–2012.These strategies and the current Living Standards Improvement Strategy for 2013–2015 and National Development Strategy for 2015 all dedicate chapters to gender equality as a component of developing the country's human potential. Inclusion of gender equality targets in these strategic documents ensures that indicators, implementing agencies, and financing are also delineated.

95. Despite a solid legal and policy framework for protecting the rights of women and, to a lesser extent, advancing gender equality, many planned measures are never realized due to insufficient implementation mechanisms, weak monitoring and evaluation, and lack of dedicated finances. The concluding observations on the sixth periodic report of Tajikistan from the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW,2018) report the following key recommendations[60].

- Accelerate, with a view to its adoption, the drafting of anti-discrimination legislation and ensure that it contains a comprehensive legal definition of discrimination against women in line with article 1 of the Convention, covering both direct and indirect discrimination, and that such legislation prohibits all forms of discrimination, including intersecting forms of discrimination;

- Strengthen capacity-building for members of the judiciary and legal professionals on how to invoke or directly apply the Convention, or interpret national legislation in the light thereof, in court proceedings;
- Apply a gender-sensitive approach in the implementation of its legislation, policies and programmes to ensure that they sufficiently address pre-existing gender inequalities and disparities and the needs of vulnerable groups of women and girls;

- Intensify existing awareness-raising initiatives and provide training to enhance knowledge on women's rights and gender equality among relevant stakeholders, including government and law enforcement officials, parliamentarians, judges, lawyers, education and health-care professionals and religious and community leaders.

National mechanisms

96. The Committee for Women's and Family Affairs (the Women's Committee) was established in 1991, and its authority was increased in 2006, making it the central authority carrying out state policy on protecting women's interests and rights. The Women's Committee has a broad mandate that includes cultivating

[60] Document available at: https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/treatybodyexternal/Download.aspx?symbolno=CEDAW/C/TJK/CO/6&Lang=En

women’s rights, addressing women’s socioeconomic participation, and delivering public services[61].

97. The Women’s Committee operates regional information-consultation and crisis centers throughout the country (110 in total) and funded locally. The Chair of the Women’s Committee is a government appointee, with 22 central offices as of 2014. Women’s Committee activities are diverse, ranging from research to considering citizen complaints, promoting women’s rights through the media, monitoring international standard compliance, coordinating government and nongovernment gender equality activities, and training. The Women’s Committee work plan, which supports the branch offices, covers, among other items, climate change, support for labor migrants’ wives, and peace and security issues.

98. The Committee is also part of the coordinating council on Prevention of Violence against Women, which consists of representatives from the Ministry of Justice, Ministry of Labour and Social Security, Ministry of Health, Ministry of Internal Affairs, court officials, representatives of the General Prosecutor’s Office and NGOs.

Gender-based domestic violence (GBV)

99. According to the Demographic and Health Survey Tajikistan (TjDHS 2017)[62], 24% of women age 15-49 have experienced physical violence since age 15, and 17% experienced physical violence in the 12 months preceding the survey. Only two percent of women have ever experienced sexual violence. In terms of spousal violence, it is reported that 31% of ever-married women have experienced physical, sexual, or emotional violence by their current or most recent husband. The prevalence of spousal violence has increased by 7 percentage points in the 5 years since the 2012 TjDHS. Among ever-married women who have experienced spousal physical or sexual violence, 23% have sustained some form of injury, one in 10 women sought help to stop the violence they had experienced. Three in four women neither sought help nor told anyone about the violence.

100. In general, women’s experience of spousal physical, sexual, or emotional violence by their current or most recent husband increases with age and number of children. Women who are divorced, separated, or widowed are more likely to have experienced spousal violence (47%) than those who are currently married (30%). The proportion of women who have experienced spousal violence varies greatly by region, from 16% in Dushanbe to 43% in Khatlon (TjDHS, 2017)[63].

101. According to the Government of Tajikistan’s sixth periodic report to the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW) on October 2018, covering the period 2013-2017, a total of 1,296 complaints of domestic abuse were made to police, of which 1,036 were investigated by district police inspectors, and 260 by specially-appointed and trained inspectors for the prevention of domestic violence. 996 of those filed were complaints against men, compared with 296 made against women. Only 65 criminal prosecutions were initiated under various articles of the Criminal Code. The commission reviewing the report stressed that there is a great need to increase to domestic violence

[61] Approved by Government Decision No. 608, 9 December 2006.
[62] Demographic and Health Survey Tajikistan(DHS) Tajstat 2017.
Document available at: https://dhsprogram.com/pubs/pdf/FR341/FR341.pdf
[63] *Ibidem*

awareness in both the population and law enforcement staff on the National Law on the Prevention of Violence in the Family (adopted in 2013) and the corresponding State Programme (CEDAW Report, October 2018) [64].

Vulnerability to Climate Change from a gender perspective

102. Tajikistan is at significant risk from disasters triggered by natural hazards. Food security is highly susceptible to drought and transportation links are vulnerable to flooding. Climate change threatens the food security especially for those who depend on small-scale subsistence farming. Women suffer disproportionately from this insecurity because they are often responsible for securing income from agriculture plots and providing for their families; however, they have limited access to information and support. Female farmers and female-headed households are frequently among the most vulnerable in rural areas, and often have very limited capacity to cope with or recover from weather-related losses. This clearly emerged from consultation with women's groups through Focus Group Discussion (FGDs) held during CASP+ design Mission (April, 2021). Key notes from the consultations held in Hamadoni, Sh.Sholin, Sharitus and Maschoh districts are available stakeholder consultation report.

103. According to the Tajikistan Country Gender Assessment (ADB, 2016) the main indicators of climate change in Tajikistan are rising temperatures, uneven rainfall, and melting glaciers; these changes, in turn, can cause natural disasters such as flooding and mudslides or droughts. Rural populations are especially vulnerable to climate change given their dependence on small-scale farming and natural resources. According to the ADB survey conducted to prepare the gender assessment, women who participated in Focus Group Discussions (FGDs), particularly women farmers, described unseasonably warm weather followed by heavy rains that ruined crops (ADB, 2016). Similar findings were confirmed by women interviewed through Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) by the project design mission[65].

104. Households headed by females are among the poorest and "often have very limited capacity to cope with or recover from weather-related losses"; further, they will also be disproportionately impacted by staple goods scarcity. In addition to increased physical burdens associated with collecting scarce resources, women and children are at risk for illness from substandard drinking water and unclean fuel (Oxfam, 2011) [66].

105. Women's lower educational levels, lack of technical knowledge, and limited participation in decision making also impact their climate change adaptability. According to Oxfam, households headed by females that operate small farms exhibit fewer sustainable land management processes than households headed by males, which may be due to lack of technical knowledge or insufficient finances. Further more, in the same report, it is mentioned that water-related changes have noticeable and immediate effects on women's options for collecting water. When water sources become scarce, those farmers who are situated furthest from irrigation systems or who do not have the ability to negotiate their

[64] United Nations Human Rights: Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women, Tajikistan's sixth report (31 October 2018) https://www.ohchr.org/EN/NewsEvents/Pages/DisplayNews.aspx?NewsID=23807&LangID=E Full report available at: https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/treatybodyexternal/Download.aspx?symbolno=CEDAW/C/TJK/6&Lang=en
[65] Details are reported in the stakeholder consultation report on separate FGDs with women (CASP+ Design Mission, April 2021).
[66] Climate Change: Beyond Coping. Women smallholder farmers in Tajikistan, Oxfam, 2011

water rights, or who are unable to protect their water access, will lose out first (Oxfam, 2011)[67].

106. Similarly, as women are responsible for combustible fuel in poor households, their search for wood and brush is affected when there is drought. If harvests are damaged or lost a household's food supply for the entire year could be threatened. A summary from the Oxfam study of climate related impacts from perspective of women interviewed is summarized below:

Natural Disaster/shocks	Impacts from the perspective of women (Oxfam survey)
Drought	- Water springs dried up - the wheat were damaged, not a good harvest - all winter saving (food) were damaged - couldn`t plough the land - because of the drought many livestock suffer from disease - fruit tree fell off - not enough fruits - having problems with food security meant that many people had problems with their health
Heavy rains and hail storms	- had to replant seeds because plants were destroyed (economic cost) - wheat with too many weeds - bad harvest (very little) - bad quality wheat (low in calories).
Unpredictable cold weather	- vegetables damaged - food saving (for winter) was damaged - usual ploughing of the land in autumn could not be done
Lack of irrigation water	- arable lands were damaged: as were vegetables, wheat, potato
Landslide	- total damage of homes with properties (5hhs, in each 7 family members)
Flood	- damaged kitchen gardens - damaged cattle sheds

107. As explained above (para 86 and 87) a total of 4 Focus Group Discussions (FGD) were held with 26 women during the design mission of CASP+ in April 2021. Key questions asked included climate change: (i) Over the last couple of years, did you observe any changes in your agriculture work? (ii) Have you experienced natural disasters (drought, Heavy rains and hail storms Unpredictable cold weather, floods, landslides?). If yes, (i) which negative impact did you experience in your production and (ii) how do you think a negative impact could be mitigated? Did your workload increase or decrease due to effects of climate change?

108. Below is a summary of the main challenges related to climate change in the target areas from a gender perspective as expressed by women interviewed:

Districts	Main challenges related to climate change in CASP+ Target areas
Hamadoni	• Snow in spring season (no yield in fruits); • Increase in precipitation, land salinity; • Loss of potato harvest; • Floods; • Hot summer season, negatively affected land and yield;

[67] ibidem

	• Workload increase, income decrease.
Sh. Sholin	• Shortage of water during rainy season, resulting in reduced production/losses; • Limited knowledge about use of pesticide; • Old trees which require replacement with new trees. • Workload increased, income decreased.
Maschoh	• Cold spring and loss of fruits; • Change in the raining patters; • Reduced yields and losses. • Workload increase, income decreased.
Sharitus	• Warm winters/cold springs and loss of fruits; • Winds increased due to deforestation; • Roots of the trees are freezing; • Workload increase, income decreased.

109. According to FAO Gender Assessment (2016) research conducted in Tajikistan on sustainable farming practices to mitigate climate-related shocks, knowledge about such practices is low among all farmers, but there are also gender differences with women suffering access to information. Farmers mainly obtain information about sustainable practices from other farmers, but, "within villages, female-headed households do not seem to benefit from the knowledge-sharing networks that male farm heads enjoy". This lack of knowledge is a key factor in reducing opportunities for women farmers to adopt sustainable practices. Women do report that they call upon local agronomists when they need assistance or advice about their household plots, but they also turn to neighbors or other family members (FAO, 2016).

110. Despite the evident gender inequalities in the agriculture sector, the ADB gender assessment points out that women have great potential as agents of change. Rural women are quick to "grasp the holistic nature of farming and offer examples and solutions that they are already engaging in to adapt to climate change." The report highlights women involvement in renewable energy and environmentally safe practices.

111. **Lessons learned**: A case study conducted by CARE international of a small climate adaptation project in a mountain community in Tajikistan, demonstrated that simple technologies that women can implement can also have a positive effect on food security. In this case, poor households received frames that enabled them to start herb and vegetable seedlings in cold weather and increase the growing season. Women also learned about food preservation[68].

112. The Farmer Advisory Services in Tajikistan programme (FAST), for example, has a component on training and disseminating good practices among women who farm at household level and on commercial dekhan farms. Through jamoat agricultural extension teams and farmer learning groups, women gain knowledge of new farming practices (for example, selection of high-quality seeds, pest and weed management, and improved practices to reduce crop loss and enhance storage and food preservation), which has led to increased crop yields for women.

[68] Care International. 2010. Climate Change Brief: Adaptation, Gender and Women's Empowerment. Document available at: https://www.care.org/wp-content/uploads/2020/05/CC-2010-CARE_Gender_Brief.pdf

113. **Recommendations:** The ADB country gender assessment, highlights that household-level interventions targeting women are crucial in order to improve their awareness of climate change adaptability. But efforts are also needed at the local and national level to share best practices on "natural resource management, on adaptive and mitigative farming," and to increase information about women's rights with support through investment, credit, and technology. Furthermore, training and awareness-raising campaigns for women on climate change impacts and decision-making processes on climate resilience and livelihoods (e.g., introducing and using alternative crops) need to be considered (ADB, 2016).

Policy Review: Gender and Climate Change

114. The National Strategy for Enhancing the Role of Women in the Republic of Tajikistan for 2011–2020 proposes several adaptation measures, which also aim at reducing the impact of climate change on women. The National Action Plan under the National Strategy on Activization of Women's Role in Tajikistan for 2011-2020 includes gender and climate change issues, especially on trainings and rising awareness between Tajik women on climate change that is jointly implementing by the Committee on Women & the Family, Committee of the Emergency Situation & Civil Defence and local regional bodies.

115. In response for a Decision 23/CP.18 "Promoting gender balance and improving the participation of women in UNFCCC negotiations and in the representation of Parties in bodies established pursuant to the Convention or the Kyoto Protocol" it is reported that state financial resources in Tajikistan are not always available or quite limited for supporting these activities (gender and climate change). It is reiterated that that further funding consideration should be given to adaptation programmes and rising awareness on climate change between women and men in rural areas in order to reduce the adverse effects of climate change on vulnerable communities. It is also assessed the need to address gender and climate change awareness trainings; assistance for gender capacity building within government; and strengthen the capacity of NGOs working on gender [69].

116. In the **National Development Strategy of the Republic of Tajikistan for the period until 2030**, issues of gender equality and climate change are discussed in Chapter 4, "Developing Human Capital" [70].The strategy notes that the main problems for Tajikistan in recent years have been a high level of risk of natural disasters, including due to climate change, from which, first, women and children suffer.

117. To create incentives for reduction impact of climate change considering gender aspects, it is suggested to develop and implement mechanisms for reducing social vulnerability due to natural disasters, the formation and implementation of gender-sensitive system information support and training of the population in proactive protective and restorative actions on natural disasters. It is proposed to develop a system for implementing climate change issues, disaster prevention in strategic regional documents, and strengthening local disaster risk management capabilities.

118. **In the draft National Strategy for Adaptation to Climate Change of Tajikistan until 2030** (NACC) gender issues are addressed in a cross-sectoral

---

[69] Full Report available at: https://unfccc.int/files/documentation/submissions_and_statements/application/pdf/cop_gender_tajikistan_04092013.pdf

[70] Document available at: https://nafaka.tj/images/zakoni/new/strategiya_2030_en.pdf

area. The draft of NACC lists gaps that need to be overcome to ensure that the risks and impacts of climate change capture the gender dimension. The Strategy highlights that the main gender gap in climate change, first, is the low level of women's access to information on climate change, lack of decision-making power to take adaptation measures[71].

119. Gender aspect of climate change are also found in the **National Communications of the Republic of Tajikistan on the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change**. So far, Tajikistan has prepared three National Communications of the Republic of Tajikistan under the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change. The first National Communication was prepared in 2002, the second in 2008, and the third in 2014. In the third communication, gender aspects of climate change were considered in more detail in assessments of women's reproductive health vulnerability to climate change[72].

120. It is reported that the impact of climate change does not only threaten lives and deprive livelihoods, but also widens the gap between the rich and poor and increases the inequalities between women and men. Gender equality and opportunities in the context of climate change are among the key issues of concern covered by the UNFCCC. It is stressed that strategies on climate change and risk mitigation cannot be successful without the participation of women. Therefore negotiation processes and documentary outcomes need to reflect gender equality issues in all areas including adaptation, risk mitigation, knowledge transfer, and so on.

Project details

Access to information and opportunities under CASP+

121. Gender mainstreaming in the project will be done with a focus on gender responsive and equitable participation for development planning and implementation, as well as ensuring participation of women and other vulnerable groups in project implementation and community representation and decision-making. This includes training and awareness raising in (i) gender responsive participatory approach in identification of development needs with specific focus on social inclusion of women and other vulnerable groups in the community decision making process such as PUUs committees, village organisations (VOs) committees, etc., (ii) gender responsive monitoring and evaluation of project implementation and progress, (iii) training in community mobilization, management and leadership skills, including training in economic diversification business advisory services and business plan formulation.

122. One of the Project’s objectives is to ensure that all project targets groups (men, women, young people, including vulnerable groups such as women headed households and the elders) have equal access to opportunities resulting from the Project, especially in terms of information. For this reason, there is a plan to organize a strong communication campaign to inform about project opportunities, including awareness raising sessions with community leaders and men, on the role of women in the development process through their

[71] Document available at: https://unfccc.int/resource/docs/nap/tainap01e.pdf
[72] Full report available at: https://unfccc.int/sites/default/files/resource/tjknc3_eng.pdf

representation in grassroots community organizations. Their awareness will also be raised on the benefits the community can derive from the involvement of women in these development processes.

123. The communication and mobilisation strategy will also be supported by a strong diagnostic process whose objective is to identify the main environmental challenges affecting the communities (including from a gender perspective) and properly inform communities to take decisions on the opportunities created under the project. This includes opportunities for Climate Sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAPs) as well as livelihood diversification through Common Interest Groups (CiGs) and access to climate smart technologies and practices trainings through participation in Farmers Field Schools (FFs).

124. Access to information by women at village level largely depends on the channel by which this information arrives. To account for this, the Project will conduct separate consultations with women, using existing formal/inform women groups at village level (if existing) or forming new ones. The separate consultation sessions will be conducted by community facilitators (CF) in every targeted village. They will also ensure involvement of women head of households and women from very poor households (below poverty line). The consultation will be in line with women's need to accommodate proper time and location. The ToRs of community facilitators are included in the PIM and reflect the tasks above.

125. A strong monitoring process during the information/mobilisation activities will be put in place to ensure that information reach the intended beneficiaries (including vulnerable socio-economic categories) and indicators will be gender disaggregated.

Women's access to education, technical knowledge, and skills

126. As reported in the gender assessment women have lower level of education, technical knowledge and skill to apply climate smart agriculture practices. Women often are not able to attend trainings and they account for small percentage of training recipients.

127. An example from ADB survey (as reported in the Country Gender Assessment, 2016) reveals that 1,800 farmers indicate that women are more likely to have no specialized training than men and specifically to lack vocational training (19.3% of men as compared to 7.9% of women) and higher education (5.1% of men and 2.2% of women) in agriculture.

128. CASP+ remote design Mission organized 4 separate Focus Groups Discussion (FGD) with women's participants (26) from the districts of Hamadoni, Mashcoh, Sharituz and S.Shohin (Khatlong). They drew attention to the need for: (i) increasing their knowledge about improved agriculture practices; (ii) marketing and (iii) how to expand their businesses and move from unskilled low income production to commercial agriculture. They also show interest to increase knowledge about diversification of economic activities. Rural women expressed their constrained by:(i) their limited agricultural technological knowledge, and (ii) lack of training relevant to areas where they could start businesses. They also highlighted the need to participate in exposure visits.

129. Most of the women interviewed, had rarely received training (on agricultural techniques, financial management of their operation and climate smart agriculture practices). For this reason the project aims to include training for women (50% beneficiaries) in Farmers Field Schools (FFs) and Common

Interests Groups (CIG) as well as trainings on climate smart resilient technologies and business trainings: farm as business, business planning, proposal writing. This is key to support preparation of business plans and access grant financing scheme.

Women's access to services and technologies provided by CASP+

130. The project has a strong focus on gender-equality. Access to services and technologies provided by the project will equally benefit men and women. Design of services and promotion of technologies are also taking into account the different needs of men and women and the different livelihood and economic activities they are engaged.

131. The assessment found that the productivity and resilience to climate change of traditional livestock production systems (where majority of women are engaged) is limited by the poor capacities of farmers on animal husbandry, in particular related to fodder cultivation, fodder conservation and stall feeding, and the availability of and awareness on technical innovations that could improve productivity, resilience to climate change, and reduce environmental impact. This is particularly relevant for women as emerged during the FGDs. The project will support the dissemination of these technical innovations and their adoption by smallholder farmers through a combination of demonstrations and hands on training activities.

132. As part of the activities planned under component 3: specifically, activity 3.2.3: Support adoption of climate smart innovations through demonstrations and FFS, women will account for 50% beneficiaries corresponding to about 2,000 women (20% will be women head of households) and they will able to access the main climate resilient technologies that will be disseminated:

   - New varieties and species of drought and heat resistant fodder;
   - Affordable and simple fodder conservation techniques, in order to reduce seasonality of production and dependance on pasture in winter;
   - Biogaz production (in order to reduce utilization of wood, dried cotton plants and cow dungs as fuel);
   - Composting and manure management;
   - Husbandry of alternative livestock species, not or less dependent of pasture resources, and resilient to climate change;
   - Prevention and management of animal diseases;
   - Reproductive management (detection of heats, calving and calf care, drying off management).

133. In communities where the project will support marketing and processing of milk, milk hygiene and milk quality/safety management will also be addressed under this activity. Based on the livelihood analisis and the role of women in agriculture, all the proposed technologies and trainings are suitable for women. It is also expected that their presence will be particularly prominent given their strong engagement in livestock related activities. The type of proposed training and technology introduction correspond to the need expressed by women during consultation through Focus Group Discussions (FGDs).

134. It is also suggested as a key recommendation in the Project Implementation manual (PIM) that training location and time take into account women's need. Furthermore, the mission acknowledges the need expressed by women during

consultation to have separate trainings groups (only women FFs/groups). In line, the project will form only women FFs (where needed) and time and location for schools will take into account women's needs. FFs facilitators, will be trained to provide gender-sensitive responsive services. The type of trainings, of interest for women, coupled with increased gender sensitiveness of FFs facilitators, will ensure women access to services, trainings and technologies promoted.

135. The thematic focus of FFS will put priority on fodder management and conservation (contribution to climate resilience), as well as milk hygiene (needed for market access) and processing. All topics are of interest for women, however, as required by the FFS methodology, thematic topics will be selected by participants according to their needs and this will also take into account women's need and preferences in addition to the above.

136. Furthermore, women will access information about climate resilient technologies and innovations that have been tested, adapted and validated by research institutions under Component 1. These will be demonstrated in the field to enable men and women farmers to acknowledge their benefits and feasibility, and select those that will be further popularized and tested in real farm conditions through FFS.

137. In order to allow farmers to access to these demonstrations, field days will be organized and women will account for 50% participants.

138. In addition to participation in FFS women will also be trained through CIGs (Activity 3.3.1. Identify individuals and establish Common Interest Groups around selected value chains and capacitate them) and receive trainings on climate smart resilient technologies and organization of business trainings: farm as business, business planning, proposal writing to enhance their business capacity and apply for grant financing . It is expected that women will account for 50% of participants for climate resilient technologies and business planning corresponding to 7,200 (50% of 14,200 beneficiaries).

139. A Matching Grant Facility (MGF) will be established and will have MGF Window 1 (livelihood diversification for vulnerable households) and Window 2 (commercialisation and agribusiness development). It is expected that a total of 10,200 households will access 1,020 Window 1 grants and 2,200 households will access 110 Window 2 grants.

140. Window 1 will be for grants of up to 6,000 USD and women will account for 50% beneficiaries of which 20% are expected to be WHHs . These grants could be for, e.g. small-scale processing equipment, local storage infrastructure, community-based seed production, inputs and service provision, drip irrigation, greenhouses, nurseries, shelterbelt establishment, riverbank stability, access to renewable energy. Farmers accessing Window 1 will match the grant with a 10 percent cash contribution. Window 2 will be for CIG grants that have an average value of USD 30 000.it is expected that 110 groups will access Window 2 and 30% should be women-led (corresponding to 33 women-led groups).

141. The productive areas to organize women around CIGs will be identified during the consultation process, in line with findings from the diagnostic study. As for FFs the training topics, location, time, will take into account the needs of women, to ensure the services is fully gender-sensitive and women are able to access.

142. Component 1: Support to University Students through scholarships. The project will also offer services relevant for young women. In addition of being indirect beneficiaries (as HHs members) the project will provide direct targeted services

for young girls (students). It is expected that the project will support universities to develop curricula specific on climate change and number of students will be enrolled and some of them will be granted a scholarship.

143. The scholarship available will be for 50 students in total (BA, MA and PhD level) and 25 will be young girls from target areas. The aim of the scholarship programme is to increase the climate resilience of communities by enhancing the capacities of young women and men in NRM, climate change and climate-resilient, diversified production systems. Vulnerable youth from the project areas who are interested in studying a bachelor's/master's/PhD programme (e.g. bee-keeping, horticulture, forestry and pasture management) at the Tajik Agrarian University will be identified. Their scholarship should cover expenses so that they can undertake research in their communities on natural resource management and climate resilience of production systems. During their studies, students should be coached and supported in identifying possibilities to take up posts in their areas of speciality in local public institutions or to develop start-ups. Support for start-ups on an individual or collective basis could be provided through CASP+. In addition, the Tajik Agrarian University is considering the development of a start-up programme so close coordination with them in the identification of additional funding possibilities will be necessary.

144. Once youth return to their villages, they should be involved in the preparation and implementation of the CsCAPs to share their knowledge and expertise. This is an opportunity for youth to take a leading role in mobilising communities around certain activities to manage NRM and increase their climate resilience.

Women in decision-making

145. Women's decision-making role is limited, although it varies depending on the types of decisions under consideration and if it is at households or community level. From the consultation with women in FGDs it appears that consultation among family members and joint decision-making is prevalent. This include expenses/income related to agriculture production. Kitchen gardens are mainly in the domain of women who decide on type and quantity of crops, how much to spend on production inputs, and whether to consume or sell their produce. The same apply for milk-product, although sale of animals remain in the domain of men.

146. From the consultation from remote with women through FGD, it also emerged that younger women, and particularly daughters-in-law, have few assets and little power in the household. Intra-household hierarchies among female members exist. Elder women are best positioned to make decisions that are accepted by other household members.

147. Conventionally, males conduct all the decision-making within Tajik households. However, due to male outmigration, women have become de facto heads of the household and decision makers. Land plots may be left to be operated by female heads, given for use of close relatives or rented out. In some cases, males formalize the land rights in the name of their wives to prevent additional problems during their absence.

148. Consultation with female dehkan farmers during FGDs confirm that they make most of the production decisions alone or with the support of male family members, especially on buying quality seeds and fertilizers. Decision over milk and dairy products is entirely controlled by women while decision over livestock is controlled by men.

149. At community level most of decisions are taken by male household members, as they are represented in higher percentage in Community Based Organisations. Presence of women in village development committees (as reported from women's interviews) is lower compared to men and they lack leadership skills to have their voice heard. This is confirmed by presence of women in decision making as per data reported in this assessment in relation to women in PUUs and WUAs.

Promotion of Women Leadership under CASP+

150. Women limited capacity to assume leadership role is often associated to cultural constraints and determining factors which include:

- Low status due to persistent gender discrimination and gender stereotyping, where women are generally viewed to be unfit for leadership, and subsequent lack of support for women's entry to leadership structures;
- Limited opportunity to engage full time in activities outside the home due to unequal burden of care work that falls upon them;
- Low self-esteem and inadequate leadership skills and experience as a result of the above factors.

151. In light of the above constrains which were also identified in the target areas through discussion with women, the project intends to support women's and women's leaders to increase their awareness about their rights, their presence in the decision making process of CBO and ability to exercise their rights and express their opinion/voice. Specifically, the project will set quotas to ensure a minimum representation of women in decision making and representation positions.

152. In line with available data it is confirmed that women are 30% representative in PUUs. The same strategy for quotas is also applied by the CASP gender strategy to have women as 30% representatives in Village Organisations (VOs). CASP + will apply quotas for women as decision makers in key committees such as Pasture Users Unions / Groups (PUUs, PUGs), Forest Management Groups (FMG) and Village Organisations (VOs).

153. Women participation as registered in the IFAD funded Livestock and Pasture Development Project II (LPDPII) is 30% women in the PUU board. Similar findings emerged from Focus Group Discussion (FGDs) held with women groups during Concept Note and Project Design (October 2020 and April 2021 respectively) where women interviewed (some of them members and representatives of PUUs) confirmed the 30% presence of women as board representatives and recognized the need to receive leadership trainings. Key notes from the consultation are available in the stakeholder consultation report . In order to create an enabling environment for women and ensure they can perform have an active role, the following activities are planned:

154. Raise the awareness of women and men leaders and members of CBOs (i.e. VOs and PUUs) on the manifestations of gender bias (against women) and on the effects of discrimination against women on the personal and interpersonal growth of its leaders and members, as well as on the organizational development of the organisation. The activity will be part of gender awareness session taking place in all targeted districts (1 day workshop).

155. The awareness session will also include briefing on women's legal status (equality of rights) and legislation about women in representation and key position as outlined by the national gender strategy. Other gender sensitive topics will be touched with particular attention to women and climate change as well as women's access to land (among others).

156. Trainings for women leaders, targeting 6 women per village, for a total of 2,400 women across the 400 targeted villages. The objective is preparing women members of community organizations to be leaders and change agents in their organizations. They will be provided with sensitization on topics including gender relations, self-awareness, leadership and accountability, negotiation and conflict management, advocacy and lobbying, effective communication. The training will specifically include abut 4 modules: Effective and gender-responsive leadership and comunication; group management; coping with challenges/conflict resolution strategy; and personal development.

157. The module on "Personal Development," provides the trainees with tools for self-analysis, reflection and development. This module is seen to be critical because the enhancement of the skills of women can only be translated into their more effective participation in leadership structures if they know how to constantly check themselves for deep-seated internalization of gender stereotypes, as well as to sustainably develop their self-esteem and confidence for leadership.

158. The training is planned to take place during year 1 with refresh training every year conducted by community facilitators. A specialised service provider also conducting the mobilisation activity will be in charge to conduct the training in the 21 districts covering 400 villages. ToR and tasks are described in the PIM.

Men and women needs and priorities captured by participatory processes under CASP+

159. Men and women in the target areas have different needs and priorities and this depends on their livelihood, age and also socio-economic status. Desk review analisis shows the following gender differences and links to climate change vulnerability:

	Women	Men	Link to climate change vulnerability
Role	Produce household-oriented crops and livestock products	Produce market-oriented crops and livestock products	Both crops and livestock are affected by climate change, and this has profound consequences for household food security. Men often claim safer/more fertile land for growing market-oriented crops, leaving women to grow household-oriented crops.
	Are responsible for food storage and preparation	Are responsible for selling valuable produce and livestock	In addition to the challenges described above, climate change has implications for food preparation and storage (in terms of water for food preparation and the vulnerability of food stores to extreme events). Harvests may be reduced or even wiped out by floods or droughts.
Resource	Have lower incomes and are more likely to be economically dependent	Have higher incomes and are more likely to own land	Men typically have more money and other assets than women. Men's savings provide a "buffer" during tough times and, along with other assets, make it easier for them to invest in alternative livelihoods.

		and other assets	
	Have less access to education and information	Have more access to education and information	Managing climate-related risks to agricultural production requires new information, skills and technologies, such as seasonal forecasts, risk analysis and water-saving agricultural practices. Men are more likely to have access to these resources and the power to use them and are therefore, better equipped to adapt.
Power	Have less power over family finances and other assets	Have more power over family finances and other assets	Without the power to decide on family resources and finances, women's ability to manage risks by, for example, diversifying crops, storing food or seeds or putting money into savings, is limited.
	Have limited engagement in community politics	Have greater involvement/ decision-making power in community politics	Men are likely to have more influence over local governance-promoting policies and programmes that may not support women's rights and priorities.
	Face many cultural restrictions/limited mobility	Face few cultural restrictions/ limited mobility	Mobility is a key factor in accessing information and services.

160. The activities proposed by CASP+ are relevant to both men and women, including from different socio-economic categories and vulnerable groups. Stakeholder engagement process has taken place and both men and women express their concern in relation to climate change and proposed solutions. In some cases, men and women shared the same view, while in other cases they expressed different opinions (major details can be found in the stakeholder report).

161. This has taken place during project design mission and reflected into the proposed activities. Furthermore, in order to comprehensively capture men and women's needs and priorities for investments, the project will undertake a diagnostic study in the 21 targeted districts. The analysis will integrate gender considerations.

162. Technical assistance (TA) to conduct gender analysis in the target area has been planned. This will be done in close coordination with the overall diagnostic process. Findings will support the identification of women's needs, potential priorities and opportunities to inform the development of CsCAPs and also the sectors for CIGs development. The findings from the study will then be discussed and validated by women's groups from targeted communities.

163. During the mobilisation and consultation process (community level) separate consultations with women will take place: women will be informed about the opportunities of the project, including acting as representatives in VOs, PUUs, and validate the findings from the diagnostic. They will be encouraged to develop clear ideas of their priorities for what concerns public (CsCAP) and private (CIGs) investments.

164. The outcome of the consultation is to ensure that women’s needs and priorities are identified and that during the community prioritisation process for public and private investments, they are participating (at least 50% of workshops participants) and able to clearly express their view. Training to women’s representatives will be provided by the facilitators to ensure that women’s take action to ensure that their priorities are integrated into the CsCAPs and for CIGs. The ToR of community facilitators will reflect these tasks.

CASP+ Gender strategy

165. The gender strategy of CASP+ is informed by the Gender Assessment and recognizes that rural women in Tajikitan play a key role in the natural resource management, and that they have a high stake in both climate change adaptation and mitigation measures.

166. By promoting positive shifts in the natural resource management, CASP+ will provide a major contribution to mainstream gender empowerment, increased access to agriculture and non-agriculture services promoted by the project on an equal basis. Activities will contribute to: (i) increase gender awareness and dissemination of knowledge; (ii) increase women’s decision-making and access to common resources and (iii) increase women’s resilience, economic and social empowerment through access to knowledge, services, capital and markets”.

It also reflects the understanding that women’s equal participation and as active actors and agents of change in the project needs to be facilitated through a set of specific measures, including those, related to leadership and decision-making skills. The gender strategy therefore aims to use every possible opportunity in the project actions to advance towards gender equality and women’s rights.

167. Underlying principles and key features of the gender strategy are as follows:

- Women will equally participate in the project implementation at all levels and benefit from its opportunities. A minimum of women’s quotas will be set for specific activities.
- The project, through the inclusive participation of stakeholders will support the strengthening of gender mainstreaming in the policy dialogue. Gender and climate change study will be prepared and finding disseminated through gender workshops at national level involving key stakeholders engaged in policy formulation.
- Women’s informed engagement in decision making processes on related matters (e.g. livelihood adaptation, natural resource management) – both at community and household levels – will be facilitated;
- Opportunities for women’s social and economic empowerment, as well as their leadership and decision-making opportunities, will be identified and supported. The project will target women and women head of households to participate at decision-making level in the executive committees of Pasture Users Unions (PUUs), Village Organisations (VOs) and Forest management groups (FMG).
- needs for women’s capacity enhancement on relevant topics will be addressed and acted upon, and all trainings will take gender issues into consideration in the modules, selection of participants, communication and mobilization channels, selection of venues and logistical issues.

- all project stakeholders will be sensitized and trained on the importance of gender mainstreaming under the project and of specific GAP actions;
- gender equality and mainstreaming are adequately introduced to the target communities, project staff and other stakeholders; all communication materials and project messages address gender aspects and use gender-sensitive languages;
- staff in the project unit will include a qualified personnel (Gender and Social Development Specialist) who oversees gender mainstreaming in the project and GAP implementation;
- Activities will conducted in close coordination with the committees of women and family affairs. This will enhance impact and avoid duplication of efforts.
- knowledge management of the project mainstreams gender, and the project will monitor and evaluate gender-differentiated outputs and outcomes through sex-disaggregated M&E indicators and other tools . Gender impact assessment will also be conducted.

Preventing increased risks of SEAH and GBV

The engagement of women in project's activities and their acquisition of new skills may upset the current gender balance and provoke SEAH, or even GBV. For prevention of SEAH and GBV, the project staff will train project-related personnel on the subject and sensitizes and mobilizes village heads/chiefs and relevant committees for community-driven support measures. The gender and social inclusion specialist will also be focal point for advice on SEAH related matters and monitor proper implementation of any activity/mitigation measure as required.

To minimize any possible risks the project will consider the following options during implementation:

- Increase local organizations engagement to work with local leaders and male household's members and promote campaign for sensitization on gender equality and against gender biases and GBV.
- Conducting gender-sensitive and participatory consultations while finalizing and designing the various sub-programme activities. These have to include safe spaces/ women-only focus groups to encourage women's meaningful participation in consultations.
- Sensitize the IP as to the importance of addressing SEAH in the programme, and the mechanisms that will be implemented.
- Work with local government or authorities to sensitize community members on SEAH safeguarding;
- Identify male champions where applicable to act as allies on SEAH safeguarding;
- Provide SEAH training to project stakeholders and communities.
- Provide in the community on SEAH risks, how to report them and the services available including SEAH GRM.

168. The Project Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM) will be strengthened so that SEAH and GBV related grievances are adequately managed in inclusive, survivor-centred and gender-responsive ways. Affected women and men will be able to file complaints and grievances against the project. IFAD and

project executing entities (EEs) will inform communities about the GRM through culturally appropriate mechanisms, ensuring information on the mechanisms at all three levels is communicated. Principles to be followed during the complaint resolution process include among others: impartiality, respect for human rights, equality, transparency, honesty, and mutual respect.

169. Affected women and men can make a complaint or appeal on any and all aspects of sub-activities' design and implementation. A complaint and grievance feedback form, as well as a pamphlet explaining the mechanism, will be developed under the project and distributed to all project communities for their use. Complaints and grievances can be filed orally, or in writing (digitally or via post) in a culturally appropriate manner.
170. Project beneficiaries will be clearly informed of the complaint and appeal channels (as described above) in community meetings and via other forms of communication that are convenient to them (including local languages where suitable). Women's organizations and networks in the project area will be informed of the project and GRM, and information on the GRM provided to ensure they are able to serve as key resource persons. Detailed information on the project's GRM is provided in appendix 4 of Annex 6 (SECAP) to the Funding Proposal.
171. The gender and social inclusion specialist will be part of stakeholder and community consultation throughout implementation, undertake regular consultations with women, youth, persons with disabilities and other vulnerable groups. All groups will be reminded of the GRMs and made aware of the SEAH services available in the project/program area, which can be accessed even if a survivor does not wish to make a complaint to the project/program's GRM.
172. The specialist will among others check mitigation measures are consistently being implemented, e.g., undertake spot checks to see if contracts include clauses, use basic records to track whether SEAH training is being delivered, check reporting mechanisms are functioning, use monitoring visits to check whether awareness-raising materials are clearly visible and awareness-raising exercises are being delivered and engaged with.

Promoting Gender awareness:

173. The gender assessment presents key areas where intra-household dynamics determined by socio-cultural aspects and gender norms limit women agency, knowledge, participation and decision-making. All areas presented in the Gender Assessment where women have limited access and participation reflect the presence of cultural gender norms and patriarchal attitude where gender stereotype determine the role of women. To address specifically these socio-cultural issues and negative gender norms the project propose gender awareness activities at all levels.

174. At community level the project will engage with male community members, men leaders and members of CBOs (i.e. VOs and PUUs) on the manifestations of gender bias (against women), GBV, and on the effects of discrimination against women on the personal and interpersonal growth of its leaders and members, as well as on the organizational development of the organization. The activity will be part of gender awareness session taking place in all targeted village. The awareness session will also include briefing on women's legal status (equality of rights) and legislation about women in representation and key position as outlined by the

national gender strategy as well as women’s land rights among others. The sessions will also be an opportunity to conduct conversations and awareness on key topics including e.g. imbalance and unpaid care responsibilities within families; women’s leadership role in the Hhs and decision making.

175. At jamoat, district and national level, the project will organize gender related sensitization events/sessions for institutions and local leaders to create awareness on gender with a specific focus on the role of women in rural developmentThe activity is a continuous activity through the implementation of the project. This is now reflected in the GAP. Activities will be conducted in coordination with the Committees of Women and family affairs and in line with existing work they conduct.

CASP+ Social inclusion strategy for vulnerable groups

176. Gender assessment and stakeholder consultations informed that certain groups in the rural community are socially disadvantaged, particularly poor families, women-headed households and youth, due to their weak social and economic standings.

177. The project therefore incorporates special actions to ensure their participation in the project. It is expected that youth will be 30% participants in key consultative workshops for public and private investments; they will be 20% participants in FFs and actively participating in CIGs (40%).

178. Youth (14-30) are largely unemployed, underemployed, and underpaid, and they rank among the working poor. The level of youth unemployment (working age 15-24) is 20.9% (WB, 2020)[73]. According to the WB (2017) study on addressing challenges to create more and better jobs in Tajikistan, only 43 percent of Tajikistan’s total working age population are in the labor force. The majority of those working are in low quality jobs in the informal sector. Moreover, too many jobs in Tajikistan are seasonal or temporary, and their share has increased over time. Women and youth are the least represented in the labor force. Inactive youth, i.e. those who are neither employed nor in school, represent 40 percent of the total youth population, which is high by international standards. While youth are more likely than adults to work in private sector wage jobs, almost one third of employed young people are in unpaid (informal) jobs, compared to 15 percent of adults[74].

179. For youth, in addition to ensuring their equal access to project information and benefits, particular attention will be paid to promote their engagement in business opportunities in the project supported value chains by proactively including them in business related capacity building activities. It is expected that youth will be 40% participants in CIGs. It is also expected that 25% of common interest groups will be youth-led. Furthermore, ranking criteria for evaluation of grant proposal include priority for youth.

180. Workshops bringing together different parties in the Value Chain will be provided where they will have an opportunity to engage and share information with each other and discuss specific problems within the value chain. This will be done as part of PPP approach and the programme will ensure that this social category

[73] World Bank, 2020: https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SL.UEM.1524.ZS?locations=TJ
[74] Tajikistan: Addressing Challenges to Create More and Better Jobs, WB 2017 available at https://www.worldbank.org/en/country/tajikistan/publication/tajikistan-addressing-challenges-to-create-more-and-better-jobs

(youth and also returning migrants) will be included in any platform/consultation held. In line with activities and programme conducted by the Ministry of Youth and Sport, the programme will also explore coordination with activities and initiatives undertaken at district and village level such as: Young farmers' schools, Young entrepreneurs club and related national competition for innovative ideas. To support youth mobilisation and information the programme will rely on support from existing youth unions and youth committees (districts and village levels) formed and organized under the Ministry of Youth and Sport[75].

181. Women headed households: about 40% of all extreme poor registered in rural and township jamoats in 2015 are women. Of the 30,404 extremely poor households listed in the same table, 11,013 were headed by women, which translates into a 36.2 % share of female-headed households (FHHs) among all extreme poor households. (UNDP, 2016). since they are a vulnerable category and extremely poor, women headed households are expected to be 20% members of FFS and 20% in CIGs. Furthermore, the grant financing schemes include priority for poor households and women headed households. In order to mobilise poor women and very poor households, the project will work in close collaboration with Ministry of Health and Social Protection.

182. Persons with Disabilities (PWD): The programme will make extra effort to include PWDs (with focus on women with disability) in its activities through: (i) assessment on activities where PWD can be included; (ii) special awareness sessions at community level to ensure inclusion of PWD in selected activities (ii) (iii) special trainings to support self-employed PWD in Income Generating Activities (IGAs) they can perform. The programme will work in coordination with Community Based Organisations (CBOs) already supporting the work of the Social Protection Units (Ministry of Health and Social Protection) to mobilise and engage with PWDs[76].

183. Targeting: Similar to the gender strategy above, the project will raise awareness among stakeholders on the risks of potential exclusion of the disadvantaged groups and importance of inclusive approach, and ensure their informed participation through a set of specific actions.

184. Selection will be conducted in a series of steps as follows: (i) mobilisation campaign to present the programme; (ii) wealth ranking exercise conducted by the Community facilitators (CF) including support from local CBOs, given their knowledge of poorest and disadvantaged households, especially recipients of social aid, pensions and also PWD; (iii) involvements of the local community leaders/committee to validate the proposed beneficiaries and avoid risk of elite capture; (iv) verification by programme staff through physical visits to the households and checking the community validation process (minutes of meetings and other documentation provided to ensure process is transparent and records are duly kept as part of M&E requirements including the way potential complaints are addressed during the process).

185. A participatory wealth ranking exercise will be conducted at community level to identify the poorest and the better off, following the example of the LPDPII where such exercise was conducted by Aga Khan Foundation (AKF)[77] and details for implementation are reported in the LPDP II Programme Implementation Manual

[75] Consultation with representatives was held during CN design remote mission.
[76] Consultation with representatives from Social Protection Unit of Ministry of Health and Social protection during the design confirmed validity of proposed interventions.
[77] Consultation with AKF representative and LPDP gender focal point during the design mission on the validity of the proposed methodology and lesson learned.

(PIM). The programme will promote services in line with needs of all target groups. Some activities will be of interest for the community as a whole: i.e. Climate Sensitive Community Action Plan (CsCAPs) for productive and social infrastructures/adaptation and mitigation activities and therefore all members will be mobilised through Village Organisations (VOs), PUUs, WUAs and Women Groups (WG). Targeted activities will be designed for specific groups, especially the poorest and vulnerable ones. Poor and poorest households will be identified and selected through the wealth ranking exercise (which requires validation from the community to avoid elite capture and keep tracking of process transparency) and key criteria related to poverty and vulnerability set for their participation in Farmers Field Schools (FFS) and Common Interests Groups (CIGs). It is expected that WHHs will be 20% of FFS and CIGs respectively. Furthermore, women from vulnerable households will be given priority for grant financing.

186. The project manager will take the full responsibility to ensure gender mainstreaming and social inclusion of the project. All members of the project team will be held accountable for gender mainstreaming and social inclusion, and will be technically assisted by the Gender and Social Development Specialist (part of the PMU).

Target Group	**Key Characteristics**	**Major Challenge**	**Opportunities under CASP+**
Poor households (including Women and WHHs) **26.3** Poverty national level (10% extreme poverty). **20%** WHHs total national population	• Households below poverty line • Subsistence farmers with household plots (‘kitchen gardens’ of about 0.2 ha) and a small number of animals (1-2 cattle, 5-10 small ruminants) • Work as labourers on others’ farm • WHHs, including those headed by ‘abandoned wives’ • Women and WHHs ranking among the poorest (40% of those registered among poorest are women). • Receiving assistance from National Aid schemes	• Food insecurity and malnutrition • Low production/productivity due to negative effects of CC. • Decrease of income due to a drop of remittance • Lack of productive infrastructures/connectivity to market • Women lack representation in decision-making bodies.	• Empowerment through participation in VOs/PUUs/FMGs and its CsCAP process. • Improved well-being through access to community (social and productive) infrastructure • Opportunities for cash income through income generation activities, particularly for WHHs through participation in FFs and CIGs (50% women and 20% WHHs) • Leadership training and representation for women in key committees of CBOs • Access to matching grants
Transitory Poor HHs (subsistence and semi-subsistence farmers	• Smallholder farmers with access to land beyond household plots through leasing arrangements (about 1 ha)	• Low farm productivity due to lack of access to mechanized power, irrigation, seeds and other inputs	In addition to the above: • Increased productivity and farm efficiency from productive infrastructure and farm mechanization (CSCAPs)

producing surplus)	• Vulnerable to fall back into poverty • In possession of about 5 cattle and 15-20 small ruminants, that graze on community pasture land • Family *dekhan* farms with similar size of productive resources (land and livestock) • Work as labourers on others' farm • No assistance from national aid schemes (full productive capacity)	and marketing opportunities • Vulnerable to climate and price shocks • Decrease of income due to a drop of remittances	• Higher cash income through participation in CIGs and linkages with Private Sector • Higher production capacity through FFs. • Access to matching grants
Unemployed and underemployed rural youth	• No agricultural land or livestock • Assist parents' or relatives' farming • Some with relatively good level of education	• Difficult entry to farming due to lack of access to land • Sharp decrease in migration opportunities • Lack of knowledge related to farming as a business/agribusiness opportunities along VCs	• Empowerment and learning of leadership and organizational management through participation in VO/PUUs and its CsCAP process. • Access to business development services /enterprise development training • Inclusion into dialogue/consultation Knowledge sharing at community level and with actors from Private Sector • Priority in accessing Matching grants
People with Disability (PWD)	• Ranking among the poorest • Rely exclusively on income from social pension (very low) • Social stigma and marginalisation • Women faced double marginalisation/discrimination	• Difficulties in identification of suitable jobs, • negative attitudes and lack of education and skills	• Assessment of activities for PWD awareness sessions targeting communities to ensure inclusion of PWD in identified training (IGA) • Special trainings to support self-employed PWD along activities they can perform. • Access to matching grants.

References

ADB, Assessment of Higher Education in Tajikistan, 2015

ADB, Tajikistan Country Gender Assessment, 2016

ADB, Women's role in irrigated agriculture in the lower Vaksh River Basin, 2020

Care International, Climate Change Brief: Adaptation, Gender and Women's Empowerment, 2010

CBD, The Sixth National Report on the Convention of Biological Diversity, 2019

Draft National Strategy for Adaptation to Climate Change of Tajikistan until 2030 (NACC)

FAO, National Gender Profile of Agriculture and Rural Livelihood, 2016.

FAO, Small Family Farms Country factsheet, 2018

National Development Strategy of the Republic of Tajikistan for the period until 2030

Oxfam, Climate Change, beyond coping, women smallholder farmers in Tajikistan, 2011,

Tajstat, Demographic and Health Survey (DHS), 2017

Tajstat, Dynamics of Poverty Reduction in Tajikistan,2014

Tajstat, Food Security and Poverty, 2020

Tajstat, Poverty measurement in Tajikistan: methodological note, 2015

Tajstat, Situation in the Labour Market in the Republic of Tajikistan, 2016

UNDP, Human Development Report, 2020

UNDP, Mapping registered extreme poverty in rural Tajikistan, 2016

UNFCC, National Communications of the Republic of Tajikistan on the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), 2014

United Nations Human Rights: Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women, Tajikistan's sixth report, 2018

USAID, Tajkistan Agriculture Technology and Commercialization Assessment, 2012

Part II: Gender Action Plan

The Gender Action Plan has been developed in alignment with national policies and strategies to promote gender equality: The National Strategy on Enhancing the Role of Women in the Republic of Tajikistan for 2011–2020 as well as the National Development Strategy of the Republic of Tajikistan for the period until 2030. Both strategies include key actions and recommendations to address the negative impact of climate change on women. Furthermore, the GAP aligns with gender specific recommendations as reported in the third National Communications of the Republic of Tajikistan on the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC, 2014) and the Sixth National Report on the Convention of Biological Diversity (CBD, 2019).

These policies recognize that promoting gender equality and empowering women is integral to climate change adaptation and that, whereas women have critical roles as educators, caretakers, practitioners, and agents of change in climate resilience the country is missing out on a strategic partnership with women. They emphasize the disproportionate effects of climate change on women and acknowledge (i) the need to enhance women's knowledge of climate change, (ii) increase women's participation in decision-making at all levels (iii) increase skills, knowledge and access to climate adaptive technologies for women working in agriculture, (iv) provide opportunities and strengthen rural women's voices and leadership capacities to advocate for gender-sensitive strategies and policies of adaptation to climate change (vi) develop gender-sensitive strategies and policies of adaptation to climate change.

The GAP focusses on women's visibility and agency as farmers and more broadly climate change agents at the community, governorate and national level. It recognizes that as a result of differences in socially constructed gender roles and social status, women and men experience the impacts of climate change differently and differentiated strategies are needed.

Consequently, CASP+ adopts a two-pronged approach to mainstreaming gender in the design and implementation arrangements. The first is to ensure that all the activities undertaken by the project are gender inclusive and the second is to explore how specific activities can be included to enhance women's agency in dealing with climate change risks by supporting activities targeted specifically at women (i.e. leadership trainings to increase women leadership skill in decision making).

Under Component 1 the project will increased gender awareness and dissemination of knowledge; under Component 2 CASP + will increase women's decision-making and access to common resources and activities in C3 will increase women's resilience, economic and social empowerment through access to knowledge, services, capital and markets.

The project is designed to deal with the specific issues that women face with respect to their roles and responsibilities at the farm level in their role on the homestead plots, backyard poultry, livestock feeding, kitchen gardening, etc as well as at community level as decision makers. The project caters to both these roles by ensuring that women are key participants in the decision regarding the Climate Sensitive Community Action Plans (public investment at community level) as well as private investments from livelihood diversification and improvements through their inclusion in the Farmer Field Schools and Common Interest Groups (CIGs). In addition, the project recognizes that women-headed households are especially vulnerable to climate change risks and often do not have the resources to adapt to them. Thus women-headed households will be given a priority in terms of their inclusion and selection in project activities especially in, participation in FFS, CIGs.

Allocated budget for activities directly supporting women under the Gender Action Plan account for USD 5,1 millions.

Project impact: The ***overall goal*** of the project is to ***contribute to the country's shift towards low emission sustainable development pathways and climate-adaptive agricultural production practices.*** The *specific objective* of the project is to increase public sector coordination and technical capacity for building climate resilience at the national level and enhance capacity at the district and village level for climate adaptive planning and mitigating the impact of climate change and building more effective links with the private sector to help address climate risks by improving integration with markets.					
Contribution to women's empowerment agenda: While promoting positive shifts in the natural resource management, CASP+ presents a major opportunity to mainstream gender empower women to access to agriculture and non-agriculture services promoted by the project on an equal basis. Activities will contribute to increased gender awareness and dissemination of knowledge; increase women's decision-making and access to common resources and increase women's resilience, economic and social empowerment through access to knowledge, services, capital and markets.					
Component 1. Strengthening enabling conditions for transformative climate adaptive natural resources management Outcome 1 (Component 1): Strengthened institutional and regulatory systems for climate-responsive planning and development.					
Output 1.1: Capacities of relevant national institutions for climate-resilient natural					
Output 1.2: Enabling environment for climate adaptive, inclusive and integrated management of pasture, forestry and livestock resources is enhanced					
Activities	Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Budget	Gender sensitive based on women participation
Gender activity (Sub-activity 1.1.4.1) Develop gender modules to be integrated into the CC curricula developed by the project for schools and specialized universities.	Number of gender modules prepared as part of curricula development. Target: 1 Baseline 0	By end of year 1	Entity responsible to develop the curricula	$ 5,000	12% budget gender sensitive
Gender activity (Sub-activity 1.1.4.2) Provide scholarships for male and female youth in training curricula on climate-resilient natural resources management.	Number of scholarships granted to female students Target: 15 (or 50% of 30) Baseline 0	By end of project	University	$ 360,000	50% of the budget for activity 1.1.2.2. is gender sensitive
Gender activity (sub activities 1.2.1.1) Recruit gender expert for (i) stocktaking tasks (policy review and analysis) and (ii) field work to contribute to the diagnostic assessment (gender and CC).	Number of gender studies: gender and climate change for policy briefs and diagnostic study Target: 1 Baseline 0	By end of year 1	PMU[78]	$ 27,000	100% budget gender sensitive
Gender activity (sub-activity 1.2.1.3 and 1.2.1.5) Thematic workshops on gender and climate change at national level for policy makers (through dissemination of findings from gender study, diagnostic , assessment)	Number of thematic workshops on gender and climate change are organized. Target: 7	By end of project	Executing Entity, led by: Gender expert PMU	$ 10,500	100% budget gender sensitive

[78] The MOA is an executing entity via the State Enterprise Project Management Unit (PMU).

to ensure CC policies/ legal frameworks consider gender-specific recommendations.	Baseline 0				
Gender activity (sub-activity: 1.2.1.5) Publication: Gender and Climate Change in Tajikistan	Number of Publication Target 1 Baseline 0	By end of project	Gender expert PMU	$ 2,000	100% budget gender sensitive
Subtotal Gender Component 1				$ 404,500	
Component 2: Investments in community capacity for adaption and resilience to climate change **Outcome2: Increased CO2e sequestration through improved pasture, forests and livestock management** **Outcome 3 (Component 2): Improved management of land or forest areas contributing to emissions reductions**					
Output 2.1: Climate-sensitive Community Action Plans (CsCAP)					
Output 2.2: CsCAPs executed by local institutions in timely and effective manner					
Activities	Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Budget	Gender sensitive ised on women participation
Gender activity (sub-activity 2.1.1.1) Develop gender-sensitive communication materials including key message on GBV and SEAH.	Number of communication (campaign) materials that contain gender analysis and gender-sensitive messages are developed. Target: 1 Baseline 0	By end of Year 1	Executive entity	$ 300	3% of budget for activity 2.1.1.1 (communication pack) is gender sensitive
Gender Activity (sub-activity 2.1.2.1, 2.1.2.3,2.1.2.4, 2.1.2.5 and 2.1.2.6) Gender- awareness trainings for local institutions, community members, including women's groups as part of VOs, PUUs, PUAs, PC, FUG establishment. Training include section on GBV and SEHA (e.g SEAH safeguarding; SEAH sensitization campaigns/trainings to the targeted communities).	Number of gender inclusive consultation and GBV/SEAH trainings Target: 400 Baseline 0	By end of Year 1 with refresh training sessions conducted 2 times a year until Y7	Community Facilitators Gender Expert In collaboration with focal point/local representatives of the Women's committees	$ 253,950	30% budget for formation of key institutions including training/workshops activities under: 2.1.2.1; 2.1..2.3;2.1.2.4 and 2.1.2.5 are gender sensitive
Gender Activity (sub-activity 2.1.2.1, 2.1.2.3,2.1.2.4 , 2.1.2.5 and 2.1.2.6.) Promotion of women membership and leadership in relevant local institutions (VO, PUUs, PUAs, PC, FUG,CIG).	Percentage of women in leadership position (board of committees)	By end of Year 1 with refresh trainings conducted two times a year every year until	Community Facilitators Gender Expert		

	Target: 30% Baseline 0	Y5			
Gender Activity (Sub-activity 2.1.3.1) Organize separate consultations (meetings) with women in target households for their input in the design of CcCAPs and identification of their priorities (public and private investments). Meeting should also be inclusive of young women and women with disability.	Number and percentage CsCAPs designed in consultation with women. Target: 400 CcASP Baseline 0	By end of Year 1	Community Facilitators Gender Expert In collaboration with focal point/local representatives of the Women's committees	$ 320,000	50% budget for Sub-Activity 2.1.3.1: CsCAP planning and design is gender sensitive
Gender Activity (sub-activity 2.2.1) Promote women's representation and voice as decision-makers through their inclusion in development and validation of CcCAPs Pasture, infrastructure and Forest Management).	Percentage of women from VOs participating in validation/prioritization workshops in the region (21 districts) Target: Women comprise a minimum of 30 percent of workshop participants to validate investment plans and youth 30% (the above categories shall be inclusive of PwD). Number of Investments plans validated by women representative. 400 Quality of women's participation in the validation workshop Target: Most women felt comfortable and confident expressing their views and endorse the plan.	By end of year 1	Community Facilitators Gender Expert In collaboration with focal point/local representatives of the Women's committees		
Gender Activity (sub-activity 2.2.1.1.) Promotion of women to access pasture through implementation of PMP .	Number of women accessing improved pasture land under PM plans. Target 30% women	By end of Y3 until Y7	Executing entity	$ 157,500	30% budget gender sensitive (activity 2.2.1.1)

	Baseline 0				
Gender Activity (sub-activity 2.2.3.2): Promotion of women to access to JFM contracts (agroforestry).	Number of women being selected for JFM Contracts Target: 20% women Baseline 0	By end of Y3 until Y7	Executing entity	$20,000	20% budget gender sensitive (activity 2.2.3.2 workshop and training)
Gender activity (sub-Activity: 2.1.2.7) Leadership trainings Organize leadership training for women representatives in PUUs/VOs/FMGs (6 women per village).	Women representatives trained in leadership skills Target: 2,400 Baseline 0	Continuous (one training Y 1 and other refresh training session until end of projects-Y7)	Specialized Service Provider/NGOs	$ 100,000	100% budget is gender sensitive
Gender and M&E activity: conduct Gender–sensitive impact assessment of Component 2 activities.	Consultations, analysis and findings of impact assessment are sex- disaggregated Target: Gender-sensitive impact assessment report C-2	By end of project	Company/ consultancy conducting Impact Assessment	Assessment (cost under project managment)	
Subtotal Gender Component 2				$ 851.750	
Component 3: Strengthening livelihoods for enhanced resilience through market based approaches **Component 3 - Outcome 4: Strengthened communities and individuals adaptive capacity and reduced exposure to climate risks**					
Output 3.1: Business partnerships between smallholder producer groups and private sector actors are established					
Output 3.2: Climate resilient livestock value chains developed					
Output 3.3: Diversifying Livelihoods for vulnerable households					
Activities	Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Budget	Gender sensitive ısed on women participation
Gender activity (sub activity 3.1.4) Number of women FFS facilitators trained	Number and percentage of women FFs facilitators Target: 8 (20% of 40) Baseline 0	By end of Year 1	Executive entity and FFs master trainers	$ 16,000	20 % of the budget for facilitators trainings under Sub-activity 3.1.4.1 is gender sensitive
Gender activity (Sub-activity 3.2.3.3): Formation of women FFs (customized to suit women's specific needs and preferences in terms of frequency, duration, timing, location).	Number and percentage of women-only FFS Target: 40 (or 50% of 80) total Baseline 0	By end of Year 1	Executive entity and FFs master trainers		50% of the budget for sub-activity 3.1.4.2 (roll out of FFS) is gender sensitive
Gender activity (Sub-activity 3.2.3.3) Training women and women head of households	Number and percentage of women participants in FFS	Year 3-7	Executive entity and FFs master	$ 131,300	

(WHHs) in climate smart agricultural practices through FFs. Assess impact on women	Target: 2,000 (or 50% of 4,000) of which 400 WHHs Baseline 0 Number of women and women head of households reporting increased knowledge as a result of their participation in FFS Target 1400 / 70% of 2000 Number of women and women headed of households reporting increased use of climate smart practices as a result of their participation in FFS Target: 1400 / 70% of 2000		trainers		
Gender activity (Sub-activity 3.3.1.1) Women *trained in income-generating activities or business management*	Number of women receiving trainings on production diversification Target: 7,200 (50% total beneficiaries, total 14,400) Baseline 0	Year 3-7	Responsible entity	$ 67,000	50% of the budget for subactivity 3.3.1.1. is gender sensitive
Gender activity (Sub-activity 3.3.1.3) Women receive organization of business trainings: farm as business, business planning, proposal writing.	Number of women receiving Business training Target: 55 CIGs (50% total CIG 110 targeted) Baseline 0	Year 3-7	Responsible entity	$ 47150	50% of the budget for subactivity 3.3.1.3. is gender sensitive
Gender activity (Sub-activity 3.3.1.4) Women receive trainings on climate smart resilient technologies	Number of women receiving trainings on Climate smart resilient technologies Target: 510 (or 50% of 1,020 final target CIGs) Baseline 0	Year 3-7	As above	$ 93,500	50% of the budget for sub activity 3.3.1.4. is gender sensitive
Gender activity (Sub-activity 3.3.2.4) Women access Grant Financing Opportunities (windows 1 for individuals) for livelihood diversification for vulnerable households.	Number of approved individual grants for women Target: 510 (or 50% of 1,020 final target CIGs))	Year 3-7	Responsible entity	$ 2,400.00	50% of the budget For individual grants (3.3.2.2) is gender sensitive

	Baseline 0				
Gender activity (Sub-activity 3.3.2.5) Women access Grant Financing Opportunities (windows 2 for groups) commercialization and agribusiness development.	Number of approved group grants from women-led groups. Target: 33 (or 30% of 110) Baseline 0	Year 3-7	Responsible entity	$ 990,000	30% of the budget for group grants (3.3.2.2) is gender sensitive
Gender and M&E: Gender–sensitive impact assessment of Component 3 activities conducted	Consultations, analysis and findings of impact assessment are sex- disaggregated Target: Gender-sensitive impact assessment report. C-3		Company responsible for the assessment	Assessment cost under project Management	
Subtotal Gender Component 3				$ 3,744,950	
Project Management					
Recruit staff responsible and accountable for mainstreaming gender in project: Gender Expert.	Gender expert recruited Target:1		PMU	**$ 84,000**	Salary Expert
To hire company to do the independent impact assessments, including gender impact assessment	Impact assessment conducted Target: 1		consultancy firm for impact assessment	Gender Impact assessment **$ 50,000**	100% budget for the gender impact assessment
Subtotal Project Management				$ 134,000	
Total Budget Gender sensitive				$ 5,135,200	

Component	Gender Sensitive budget
Component 1	$ 404,500
Component 2	$ 851,750
Component 3	$ 3,744,950
Project Managment	$ 134,000
Total	**$ 5,135,200**